

Categories

[See Also](#)

A *category* represents a type of information you want to store. For example, if you want to track information about people, you would use the Person/Company category for storing the data you enter in Commence.

Categories consist of named *fields*. For example, the Person/Company category consists of fields such as Name, Address, and Phone. When you enter data into Commence, you enter data into these fields just as you would enter data into a paper form. There are different types of fields, similar to ones you would find on a paper form. Unlike a paper form, Commence's field types also give you:

- a smart selection capability, called filtering, that lets you set different types of selection criteria based on field type. For example, if you are viewing the Notes/History category, you can create a filter that displays only the letters that were sent to the Acme Company during February, 2006. (For more information, see [Customize-Filter View](#)).
- other special capabilities based on field type. For example, you can dial a telephone field, perform calculations on number fields, access external files, etc.

You use a screen called a *detail form* to enter data into Commence. This form identifies the fields in an item that you want displayed and lets you enter data values. You also use a detail form when you edit data. Commence comes with at least one pre-defined form for every category. You can edit these forms at any time to change the arrangement of the fields, their fonts, which fields appear in the form, and so on. You can also add more forms for existing or new categories.

When you enter data into Commence using a form and save it, you are creating an *item*. Before you can save an item, you must enter a value in the name field. This special field type is the only required field type in Commence. Commence uses it to locate your data items, since every item in every category has one name field value.

Views and View Types

[See Also](#)

A *view* displays the items stored in one or more categories. Commence comes with one or more pre-defined views for each category.

A view is made up of one or more fields, such as Name, Address, Phone and Email. When you display a view, Commence gets the field values for each item in the category and displays the values in the view. Therefore, even if you defined a view weeks ago, it will always display up-to-date data.

How the view appears and what special capabilities it has are determined by the view type. Commence provides you with four different view types:

[Book](#) Displays up to four fields with alphabetical book tabs for quickly locating names.

[Calendar](#) Displays the names of items by day and time slot and displays a busy bar that summarizes the entire day. Provides navigational controls for moving quickly and easily to different days. Lets you color code your appointments based on data in the category, such as the type of appointment (meeting, phone call, etc).

[Gantt Chart](#) Displays the names of items as a Gantt chart showing the start and end dates of items in a category such as Task. Lets you color code your tasks to indicate, for example, the status of each task.

[Grid](#) Displays fields from one or more categories in a row/column format. It can be used in two modes: read-only and update mode.

[Document](#) Displays a Web page as a view window on the Commence desktop. The HTML view displays HTML content directly from the Commence database or from a remote URL

address by hosting the Internet Explorer Web browser within Commence.

[Multi-View](#) Displays a set of related views in one window frame. The view is split to show the primary and secondary views.

[Report](#) Displays fields from one or more categories in a row-column format. Optionally displays the total and averages of certain field types. This is the default view type.

[Report Viewer](#) Displays data from your Commence database in WYSIWYG format as a print preview. Data can be viewed, printed, and exported to various file formats.

When you define a view, you always select a view type as well as a category. Commence comes with a number of pre-defined views. Some of these can be seen on the View bar to the left of the Commence screen, and at the bottom of the [View menu](#). The entire set of pre-defined views in the active database can be seen and opened using the [View-Open/Manage Views](#) command. From this dialog box, you can add, edit, or delete a view at any time. Editing the view lets you change the name of a view and decide whether you want it to appear on the [view bar](#) and/or the Views menu. You can also create a new view for displaying your data.

You can use the [Customize-Sort View](#) command to change the sort order of the items displayed in report and Gantt view types.

You can view a subset of the items in a category by selecting [Customize-Filter View](#).

See the [Customize menu](#) topic for a description of these and other commands that change the active view.

Changing the attributes of a view is temporary unless you save the view definition changes using [View-Save](#) or [View-Save View](#)

As.

Connections

[See Also](#)

A *connection* ties together, or links, two related items. A connection definition is a link between two categories. It creates relationships between items in the same or different categories. To add a connection definition to a database, select Customize -> Database, followed by the Connection tab.

On a detail form, Commence provides you with a special three-button control for each connection definition called a *connection control*. This control lets you connect and disconnect items easily. If you use this control to add a new item in the connected category, Commence will automatically connect it to your source item. Double clicking on the item name field in the control lets you navigate to the detail form of the connected item.

You can easily add or rename a connection definition at any time without affecting your data. You can also delete a connection definition you don't want. Commence automatically updates your detail forms when you add, edit and delete connection definitions. It automatically updates saved views when you edit and delete connection definitions.

Agents

[See Also](#)

An *agent* lets you instruct Commence to automatically perform tasks for you.

A simple agent consists of a *trigger* and an *action*. The trigger defines the event or time that will cause the agent to operate, and the action determines what task will be performed. For example, an agent could trigger every Friday at 9 am and print a list of Calendar items for today.

There are four classes of triggers: timer, manual, data item and external. A **Timer** trigger can be set to occur periodically or can be set to occur only once at a given date and time. The manual triggers (**Menu Pick**, **Tool Bar Pick**, and **Keyboard Hotkey**) fire when you select the trigger from the [Tools](#) menu or the tool bar, respectively. The **Save Item** trigger fires when you add and/or edit an item, while the **Item Alarm** trigger fires based on the date and time in an item. The external trigger (**DDE**) fires when Commence receives a specified DDE message from another Windows application.

Agents can also depend on one or two optional *conditions*. These conditions can be used to further define the scope and operation of the agent. For example, a condition can filter for a particular subset of items in a category, such as all the Client type items in the Person/Company category.

Up to four actions can be included in a single agent. You can choose from four classes of actions: alerts, data modification/display, Commence commands, and external commands. The alerting actions that can be used as warnings, reminders or notifications. The data modification/display actions let you display views or let you add and edit data items. The Commence command actions, such as **Print Letter** and **Use Telephone** let you automatically perform certain menu commands

from within Commence. External command actions let you launch an application or send a DDE message to another application.

See the [Summary Tables](#), for a complete summary of all the triggers, conditions, and actions supplied with Commence.

For detailed information about how to create new agents or modify existing ones, see the [Customize-Database-Agent](#) command.

Databases

[See Also](#)

A database is a set of categories, views and agents that you want to store in Commence. Commence provides you with a pre-defined database which is a set of simple categories, views and agents that support customer service, project management and contact management. This database has the same category, view and agent definitions that you see when you use the Commence tutorial. You can use the database as-is or you can customize it to suit your needs. Or you can create a custom database from scratch.

On your hard drive, each database is stored in its own directory and, because Commence is based on a proprietary database, you will see many separate files on disk within that directory. Each file, no matter how small, serves a unique and important purpose. Deleting or renaming Commence data files can result in an unrecoverable loss of data.

Use the [Open/Manage Database](#) to open a different database; to add, delete or rename databases; or to backup or restore a database.

Regardless of the database you have open, you have access to all of the capabilities that Commence provides: view types, sorting, filtering, dialing, creating letters, etc.

You can move data between Commence databases or to other database applications using the [Tools-Export-By Category](#), [Tools-Export-By View](#), and [Tools-Import](#) commands. You can move category, view, and agent definitions (and optionally, data) between Commence databases using the [Tools-Transfer Out](#) and [Tools-Transfer In](#) commands.

You can synchronize databases on different PCs using the [Tools-Sync Link Out](#) and [Tools-Sync Link In](#) commands.

If you use more than one database, you will need to customize each database environment separately. See the various **Preferences** commands on the [Customize menu](#) for more information.

Drag and Drop Operations

Some view types allow you to use your mouse to pick up an item and perform one of the following drag and drop operations:

- Print the item
- Delete the item
- Dial a phone number in the item
- Send a letter using field values in the item
- Move the item to a new date or time in a calendar view
- Copy the item to another category
- Reset the field values of an item based on the filter in the destination view

You can also use drag and drop to re-structure filters and agents by dragging the filter, agent condition, or agent action and then dropping it to the new location.

To drag an item, click the left mouse button on the item and hold the button down while you move the mouse pointer. The icon changes to a sheet of paper (with a plus sign if it is a copy operation) when you are over a "draggable" location. If you are over an invalid location, the icon changes to a circle with a line through it.

To drop the item, simply release the mouse button.

If the destination view is not visible, you can drop the selected item on the magnet on the tool bar, open a different view, and then drag the item from the magnet to its new location.

Copy an Item

You can copy an item by dragging the item to the magnet, then dropping it back onto the same view, or by dragging an item to a different view of the same category. To copy an item from one

category to another, drop the item on an open view for the other category. If any field in both categories have identical field names, those field values will also be copied to the new item. The same applies to connections between the two categories. Whenever possible, Commence changes the values of the new item to match the values in the destination view's [filter](#) (if any).

Note: If you are dragging an item from a Calendar view, the default drag and drop operation is move. You can force a copy operation by holding down the **Ctrl** key while dragging the item.

If you drop the item on a calendar view, Commence will set the date and, if possible, the start time, depending on where the item was dropped.

Move an Item

You can move an item by holding down the **Shift** key while dragging the item and dropping it onto a different view of the same category. To move an item from one category to another, drop the item on a view for a the other category. Move works the same way as copy does with one major difference; the original item is deleted after the move operation. Field values, connected items and filters are handled in a move the same as with a copy.

Move an Item within the Calendar View

Since rescheduling appointments is the most common drag and drop operation done in the Calendar view, move is the default drag and drop operation. So is not necessary to hold down the **Shift** key in this case. (See the note above for information about forcing a copy operation.)

You can reschedule an item by dragging it to a new location on the calendar or the mini-calendars. If you want to change calendar dates or modes, you can drop the selected item on the magnet on the command bar, change your date or mode, and then drag your item from the magnet to its new date/time.

Reset Field Values Based on the Destination Filter

When you drop an item onto a filtered view, Commence tries to make the item qualify for the view.

Note: If your filter specifies an indeterminate value, such as a date range, Commence will not be able to set a value that qualifies your item for the filter, so it will not appear in the view.

Caution: If an item seems to disappear after using drag and drop, check the state of the Except checkbox in your filter. When the except checkbox is used to invert a filter, drag and drop will reset the field values of the item to match the filter but will disregard the except setting. This will prevent the item from appearing in the view.

Prefix Matching on the Name field

[See Also](#)

Prefix matching allows you to find a particular item in a long list of items in a report view, Gantt chart view, grid view Book view, or connection definition. For example: You are looking at a report view of people from your Person/Company category. You need to find the item for Paul Smith among the 30 other names starting with Smith in the category. Type "smith, p" at your keyboard. The characters typed are echoed in the status bar at the bottom of the screen (these characters are the current [prefix string](#)).

As you type the prefix string, the highlight in the view moves to the first item in the list whose Name field contains the prefix string. Use the **Ctrl + N** (hold down the Control key and then press the "N" key) to move to the next prefix match. If there is no match for a character that you type, you will hear a beep and the character does not appear on the status bar.

Use the **Backspace** key to cancel the last character typed, and return the highlight to the previous matching item (i.e., the first item in the list that begins with the remaining characters on the status bar).

The current prefix string remains in effect (and is displayed on the status bar) until:

- you press **Esc**.
- you use one of the arrow or other navigation keys.
- you activate another window.
- you select a menu command.
- a message box appears.
- the active view is updated with a new or edited item via an agent, a DDE message, or, for a client database, a synchronization with the Server database.

If you are searching through a connection control (either the list of connected items or the list of all items in the connected category), then choosing another connection control also cancels the current prefix string.

Note: In connection controls only, press **Ctrl + Spacebar** to insert a space in the current prefix matching string.

Natural Language Dates and Times Commence
interprets date and time values entered in plain
English words (e.g., tomorrow, noon).

Select a topic below to see a description of the valid formats for each type of field:

[Natural Language Dates for the Date Field](#)

[Natural Language Times for the Time Field](#)

Add a Command Line Option

[See Also](#)

Command line options are useful if you want to control how Commence starts up. For example, if you always want to open the same database, you can use the `/DATABASE=` option, or if you run multiple instances of Commence and do not want to be bothered with the message that there is already a copy running message, you can use the `/QUIET` option.

To add a command line option, follow the steps below:

If you start Commence with an icon on the desktop:

1. Single click on the icon to highlight it.
2. Right click the icon to bring up the menu.
3. Select **Properties**.
4. Select the **Shortcut** tab.
5. At the end of the text displayed in the **Target:** box, add a space, then the command line option.
6. Select OK.

If you start Commence with a menu selection from the Start menu:

1. Open the **Start** menu.
2. Select **Settings**.
3. Select **Taskbar**.
4. Select the **Start Menu Programs** tab.
5. Select the **Advanced** button.

6. In Explorer, find the Commence program menu item.
7. With the menu item highlighted, right click the selection to bring up the menu.
8. Select **Properties**.
9. Select the **Shortcut** tab.
10. At the end of the text displayed in the **Target:** box, add a space, then the command line option
11. Select OK and close all other dialog boxes.

Backup a Commence Database

[See Also](#)

You should regularly backup (make a copy) of your Commence database. This is incase you encounter problems with your PC or Commence in which your must recover your data. You can also schedule regular backups using an agent.

To backup a database:

1. Click the Commence Application button, and select [Open/Manage Database](#).
2. Highlight the database you wish to backup.
3. Select the **Backup** button.
4. Select the path and the filename you wish to use for the backup file. The default extension is .XFR. Note: If the database is large and you wish to backup to floppy, Commence will span the backup over multiple diskettes.
5. Select **Save**.

Restore a Commence Database

[See Also](#)

If you have hard drive problems or have had problems with your Commence database, it may be necessary to restore your database from a backup made earlier.

NOTE: You should regularly backup (make a copy) of your Commence database. This is incase you encounter problems with your PC or Commence in which your must recover your data. You can also schedule regular backups using an agent.

To restore a database:

1. Open a database other than the one you want to restore to. You cannot restore to the open database.
2. Select [Open/Manage Database](#).
3. Highlight the database you wish to restore to. If you want to restore to a new database, you will need to create it by selecting the **Add** button.
4. Select the **Restore** button.
5. If the highlighted database is already populated, a restore will totally delete all files in that directory. This cannot be reversed. Select **Yes** if this is what you want to do, otherwise, select **No** and then select a different database to restore to or add a new one.
6. Select the path and the filename of the file you wish to restore. The default extension is .XFR.
7. Select **Open**.

8. If the database is being restored from diskette and it occupies more than one, you will be prompted when to insert the next diskette.

Open a Database

Follow the steps below to open a Commence database.

1. Select the Commence Application button, then choose [Open/Manage Database](#).
2. Highlight the database you wish to open.
3. Select the **Open** button.

Shortcut: Double-click the mouse on a database name to open it without selecting the **Open** button.

Add a Database

Follow the steps below to add a Commence database:

1. Select the Commence Application button, then choose [Open/Manage Database](#).
2. Select the Add button.
3. Enter the Name of the database you wish to add. The name is limited to 50 characters.
4. Enter the path to the database. The path can be an existing Commence database that is no longer referenced, an existing directory, or a directory that does not exist yet.
5. Select Save. If the directory does not exist, Commence will ask you if you want to create it.

Edit a Database

Follow the steps below to edit a Commence database.

1. Select the Commence Application button, then choose [Open/Manage Database](#).
2. Highlight the database you wish to edit.
3. Select the **Edit** button.
4. Change the Name of the database. Only the Name can be changed. If you need to change the path, you should backup the database, add a new database, then restore into the new database.

Delete a Database

Follow the steps below to delete a Commence database.

1. Select the Commence Application button, then choose [Open/Manage Database](#).
2. Highlight the database you wish to delete.
3. Select the **Delete** button.
4. When prompted “Are you sure?”, select **Yes**.
5. When prompted for confirmation of deletion of all files and folders in the database directory, type in “**Yes**” and then the **OK** button.

You cannot delete the active database. Commence will also not let you delete a database if it is the only database defined.

Caution: When you delete a database, Commence gives prompts you for confirmation of the deletion. If you select **Yes**, Commence will warn you that all files and folders contained in the selected database will be deleted. If you wish to proceed, type “**yes**” then select the **OK** button. If you do not wish to continue, select the **Cancel** button. After the files are deleted, there is no way of recovering them.

Adding a Field to a Category

Sometimes you want to track some additional information for a category. For example, you may want to keep track of who you sent a card to during the holidays. To do this, you could add a check box field called **Sent Card**. When you send a card to the person, you would then check the **Sent Card** check box.

To add a field to a category:

1. Select [Customize-Database](#) select the **Category** [tab](#). Highlight the name of the category you wish to edit and click on the **Edit** button. This will display the **Category Definition** dialog box.
2. Select the **Add** button.
3. Enter a name for the field you wish to add in the **Field Label** text box. This name is limited to 20 characters and it cannot be the same name as any other existing fields.
4. Select a **Field Type** for the field. The following field types are available in Commence. To see a definition of the field, select the field type name below.

[Calculation](#)

[Check Box](#)

[Data File](#)

[Date](#)

[E-Mail](#)

[Excel Cell](#)

[Image](#)

[Number](#)

[Selection](#)

[Sequence Number](#)

[Telephone](#)

[Text](#)

[Time](#)

[URL \(Internet\)](#)

5. To specify a value to automatically appear when you add an item to the category, put a default value in the **Default** text box. For example, if you add a Date field, you may want the default value to be today's date. To do this, enter Today in the default value. To have a Check Box field value appear as checked, set the default value to checked.

Note: Not all fields are capable of having default values.

6. If you entered a date field, you have the option of making it a **Recurring Date Field**. Checking this box will allow you to add a group of items that occur at regular intervals. For example, a staff meeting that occurs every Monday.
7. To ensure that a field always has a value, check the **Mandatory Field** check box. Commence will display an error message if you save an item without a value for this field. You will not be able to save the item until you enter a value for all mandatory fields.
8. When all the options are set the way you wish, select **OK**. For more information of field specific options, select a field type then press F1.
9. To add another field, continue from step 3.
10. When you are done adding fields, select the **Save** button and all your changes will be saved. The time required to save the category depends on the number of items you have in the category.

11. To see the changes you have made, select the

 [image/additem_shg.gif](#)

button on the [tool bar](#). You will see the new fields at the bottom of the item detail form. To move the new field to another position on the form, , use the [Customize-Design View](#) command, while the detail form is open. This will display the **Design Detail Form** dialog box.

Editing a Field in a Category

To change a field's name or options::

Note: When editing a field, you can only change the field's name and options; you cannot change the field's type.

1. Select [Customize-Database](#). and click on the **Category** [tab](#). Highlight the name of the category you wish to edit and click on the **Edit** button. This will display the **Category Definition** dialog box.
2. Highlight the field you wish to edit in the **Fields** list box.
3. Select the **Edit** button.
4. Make the changes to the field label and field options as needed. Remember, the field type cannot be changed.

Note: If you change the **Total Size** of a [text field](#) to a smaller size, any existing items that have text in this field may lose some data. The field will be reduced to the new size. Also, any changes made to radio group will cause the existing items radio buttons to change to the new values. Lastly, if any letter template references a field whose name has been changed, Commence will not automatically update it. You must edit the [letter template](#) and update the [field code](#) to use the new field name.

5. Select **OK** when you are done editing the field.
6. To edit more fields, continue from step 3.
7. When you are done editing fields, select the **Save** button and all your changes will be saved. The time required to save the category depends on the number of items you have in the category.

Customizing a Detail Form

You can customize the [detail form](#) by:

- * Specifying individual field attributes such as font, size, label alignment, and color.
- * Arranging the position of the fields on the screen by manually moving fields.
- * Changing the color of the form's background.
- * Add graphics and text to the form.
- * Remove fields from the form.
- * Add form tabs and distribute the fields across multiple pages.

To arrange a detail form, do the following:

1. Open a view of the [category](#) for which you wish to edit the detail form. For help, see [Opening a View](#).
2. Select [Edit-Add Item](#) from the [menu bar](#).
3. A form is displayed. Select the  [image/design_shg.gif](#) button from the tool bar or the [Customize-Design View](#) command.
4. The [Detail Form Design](#) dialog box is displayed. For more information, see [Designing Detail Forms](#) or refer to Chapter 5 of the *Commence User's Guide*.
5. Select **File-Save** to save your changes when you are done editing the form.

Select the **File-Exit** to cancel all the changes you have made.

6. You are returned to the open detail form in Commence. Notice that the new form arrangement is in effect. Select the Cancel button on the form toolbar to return to the Commence [work area](#).

Working with Views

[See Also](#)

A [view](#) is a formatted display of category data. You create a view by combining a category and a view type. The format of the view is determined by the view layout.

To see how to work with views, select one of the following topics:

[Opening a View](#)

[Saving a View](#)

[Displaying a field that is not in a View](#)

[Changing the fonts used in a Report](#)

[Sorting a View](#)

[Filtering a View](#)

[Link Views](#)

Opening a View

If the [view](#) is on the [view bar](#), the vertical bar to the left of the Commence screen:

1. Locate the view you wish to open. If necessary, use the up and down arrows at the top of the view bar to scroll the buttons.
2. Left click on the view you wish to open.

Note: If you do not have a mouse, you cannot access any of the views on the view bar.

If the view is on the View menu:

1. Select the View menu.
2. Select the view you wish to open.

If you believe the view to be saved, but it is not on the view bar or View menu, select the [View-Open/Manage Views](#) command. This will display a list of all saved views.

If the view you are looking for doesn't exist:

1. Select the [View-Open/Manage Views](#) command from the [menu bar](#). The [Open/Manage View dialog box](#) is displayed. Select the **Create New** button.
2. In the **Category:** list box, highlight the name of the [category](#) you wish to view.
3. In the **View As** radio group, select the [view type](#) to use. For more information on view types, see [Views and View Types](#).

4. If you choose to use the Report view type, you have a choice of displaying all the [fields](#) in the category or just the [Name field](#).

5. Select the **View** button.

Note: This view is just temporary. If you close the view without saving it, the view will be lost. To make the view permanent, save the view with [View-Save View](#) or select **Yes** when Commence asks to save the view.

Saving Changes to a View

If you have made changes to a view and you want this view to always open with these changes, you must save the view.

To save changes to a view, either:

Select [View-Save View](#). The view will be saved under the original name.

Or select **Yes** when Commence asks to save changes to the view.

Displaying a Field that is not in a View

[From a Report/Grid View](#)

[From a Book View](#)

[From a Calendar View](#)

[From a Gantt View](#)

Changing the fonts used in a Report/Grid View

To change the font used by a field in a report or grid view:

1. With the view open and [active](#), select [Customize-Design View](#) and select the **Fields** [tab](#).
2. Highlight the field you wish to change in the **Fields in Report** list box. If the field you wish to change is not in the view, see [Displaying a Field that is not in a View](#).
3. Select the **Field Options** button. This will display the [Set Report Field Options dialog box](#)
4. Select the font, font size, and any other options you want.
5. Select **OK**.
6. Repeat from step 2 for each field you wish to change.
7. Select **OK** in the **Fields** tab dialog box when you are finished with your changes.

Note: This change is just temporary. If you close the view without saving it, the change will be lost. To make the changes permanent, save the view with [View-Save View](#) or select **Yes** when Commence asks to save changes to the view.

To change the font of every field displayed in a view one step:

1. With the view open and [active](#), select [Customize-Design View](#) and select the **Fonts** [tab](#).
2. Select the font and font size you want and select **Change All**.
3. Select **OK** in the **Fonts** [tab](#) dialog box when you are finished with your changes.

Sorting a View

The views that can be sorted are Report Views, Grid Views and Gantt Views.

1. Select the [Customize-Sort View](#) command.
2. Select the field to sort on from the **Primary Field** [drop-down list box](#)

Note: You cannot sort on a field other than the Name field of a connecting category.

3. Select an **Ascending** or **Descending** sort by selecting the appropriate radio button.
4. If more than 1 item has the same value for the **Primary Field**, you may wish to select a secondary sort field. To do this, select a field from the **Secondary Field** drop-down list box and select the **Ascending** or **Descending** radio button.
5. Continue until you have set all the desired sort fields.
6. Select **OK** and the view will be sorted.

Note: When sorting on selection fields, the order is not necessarily in alphabetic order. The sort is accomplished using the order of the selection field values.

Note: The sort is only temporary. If you close the view without saving it, the sort will be lost. To make the sort order permanent, save the view with [View-Save View](#) or select **Yes** when Commence asks to save changes to the view.

Filtering a View

A filter will select a subset of items for the [active category](#) and display them in the [active view](#). Note that a filter is temporary. Once the view is closed, the filter is gone. To make the filter a permanent part of the view, you must save the view using [View-Save View](#).

To filter a view, see:

[Filtering on a Single Field Value](#)

[Filtering on More than One Field](#)

[Filtering on a Date Range](#)

[Finding Items with Blank Fields](#)

Customize-Link Views

View Linking is a way to link two open views by a date, date range, or by the highlighted item. For example, using View Link, you can link your To-Dos view with the calendar. If your calendar is currently displaying the current week, your To-Dos view will also display the To-Dos for the current week. If you then change the display mode of your calendar to display the current month, the To-Dos view will change to show the To-Dos for the current month. Another example is that you can link your People/Company view to a view of Notes. When you change the selected contact, you can see the notes referring to that contact.

To use View Link:

1. Open the two views you want to link.

2. Select **Customize-Link Views**. Select what type of View Link you want to establish:

Selected Date in current Calendar view:

Will use a calendar view as the primary view to drive the secondary view.

The secondary view will become filtered on the selected date in the active calendar view. The secondary view must have a Date field.

Date Range of current Calendar view:

Will use a calendar view as the primary view to drive the secondary view.

The secondary view will become filtered on the date range displayed in the active calendar view. (If only one day is displayed (in day mode), the range is only one day. If a month is displayed (in month mode), the range is the whole month). The secondary view must have a Date field.

Connection to highlighted item:

Will cause the selected primary view to drive the secondary view. There must be a connection between the categories used in the primary and secondary view. The secondary view will display items connected to the highlighted item in the primary view.

Select the **Primary view**. This is the view that will drive the other view. For example, if linking views to show People who are connected to a highlighted Company, this would be the Company view.

Select the **Secondary view**. This is the view that will show the filtered set of items. For example, if linking views to show People who are connected to a highlighted Company, this would be the view of People.

Select the **Date Field** or **Connection Field** to use in the View Link.

When completed, select **Save**. The two views will be linked.

Note: A View Link is actually a filter on the secondary view. To see how the filter is setup, make the secondary view active, then select [Customize-Filter View](#). Also, since View Link is a filter, it is only temporary. You must save the view to save the Link.

Searching for Text in Multiple Fields and Across Multiple Categories

[See Also](#)

Commence provides a [global search](#) feature to find all [items](#) across all [categories](#) that contain or exactly match a particular text string. Using global search, you can quickly locate all pertinent information for an important meeting, find all the notes, phone calls, etc., that refer to a particular contact or topic, display all items from all categories with a certain date or time, and more.

Global search lets you scan all or part of a Commence [database](#) for items containing a specified text string or [wildcard pattern](#). If you want, you can restrict the search to a particular set of categories.

To perform a global search:

1. Select the [Tools-Global Search](#) command from the [menu bar](#). The [Global Search dialog box](#) is displayed.
2. Type the text you want to search for in the **Search Text** box.
3. Use the **Match** drop-down list to select whether you want to do a fuzzy search or an exact one. Fuzzy searches are forgiving of misspellings.
4. To restrict the search to exactly match the case (upper or lowercase) of the search text, turn on the **Match Case** check box.
5. Commence searches all categories by default. To exclude categories from the search, use the **Categories** button.
- 6 Select the **Start Search** button to start the search. Items are displayed in a list box as they are found. The **Search Status**

will be set to SEARCH COMPLETE when the search has finished.

Finding Items in a Large List

[See Also](#)

You can use prefix matching to find a particular item in a long list of items in a report view, Gantt chart view, Book view, or [connection control](#).

1. Display the view or connection control in which you want to find the item. For help, see [Opening a View](#).
2. Start typing the name of the item you want to find. As you type the [prefix string](#), the highlight in the view moves to the first item in the list whose name contains the prefix string. The prefix string also appears in the [status bar](#). If there is more than one item with the same string use **Ctrl + N** to move to the next prefix match. If there is no match for a character that you type, you will hear a beep

Copying an Item

Once data has been entered, you may need similar information in a different [item](#). You can copy any item to a new item. This allows you to duplicate data into a new item without retyping the information.

You can copy an item by dragging the item and dropping it on a view. To copy an item from one [category](#) to another, drop the item on a view for the other category. The values in fields having identical names in the source and destination fields are copied. For more information, see [Drag and Drop](#).

To copy an item within the same category:

1. Open the view where the item is stored. For more information, see [Opening a View](#).
2. Highlight the item or display its form by double clicking on the item name.
3. Select the [Edit-Copy Item](#) command.
4. A form appears for the [active category](#). This form contains the information from the existing item. Change any field values you wish for the new item. The original item will remain unchanged.
5. Select the **Save** button.

Designing a Custom Paper Layout

The [Page Setup](#) command is used to create new [paper layouts](#). With this command you can also edit, copy, and delete any paper layout. While Commence comes with a variety of paper layouts already installed, you may want to define a custom paper layout to print information from Commence on a custom form (such as an envelope or label form) and it to the choices presented in the **Paper list box** of the [Page Setup dialog box](#).

Commence's paper layouts allow you to print information from your Commence database on virtually any form that can fit in your printer. And you can do it just by entering the various dimensions of the paper you are going to use.

To design a paper layout and enter it into Commence:

1. Measure the characteristics of the paper you want to use, as shown in the diagram below.



The example above shows a paper layout with 2 columns and 6 rows (12 regions). The internal margin defined for all regions reduces the printed area in each region to the size of the gray box shown in each region. If no internal margins are chosen, the entire region area is used for printing.

Internal margins are particularly useful for labels that have rounded corners, that do not meet at their edges, or that have shipping holes.

2. Select the [Home-Page Setup](#) command.
3. Select the **Add** button on the [Page Setup](#) dialog box.
4. In the **Paper list box**, select the size of the paper you will use in the printer when using this paper layout. You can choose

from among Commence's many pre-defined paper sizes (which set the page height and width for you), or select **Custom** to specify your own page height and width.

5. Enter the measurements from Step 1 into the appropriate boxes on the [Add Paper Layout](#) dialog box. Make sure the **Sample** shown matches your specifications.
6. Type a name for the layout into the **Layout Name** [text box](#).
7. Select **Save**.

To use the new layout:

1. Open a view of the information you want to print using the new page layout.
2. Use the [Home-Printer Setup](#) command to verify that the current printer is the one you want to use.
3. Select [Home-Print](#).
4. On the [Print](#) dialog box displayed, select the **Layout Name** (see Step 6, above) that you gave the new paper layout from the **Paper** [list box](#). Choose other options as appropriate.
5. Make sure that you have the proper form(s) loaded into your printer and that your printer is turned on. Select **OK**.

The information in the active view is printed using the new paper layout.

Using Commence's Phone Features

Commence will dial phone numbers for you if you have Windows Telephony (TAPI) installed and setup with a supported device such as a modem.

The following How Do I? topics are available for Commence's Phone Features:

[Dialing a Telephone Number](#)

[Logging a Phone Call](#)

The Ribbon

The [Ribbon](#) (previously the menu bar) is the row of menu command buttons above the Commence [work area](#) just beneath the title bar. The ribbon menu is always displayed; it can be minimized to save space on the desktop. This collapses the ribbon to show just the top-level menu commands. (See [Edit-Preferences-Tool Bars](#))

Toolbar

The Home page of the Ribbon features a Toolbar group of buttons. These buttons are reserved for commonly used Commence menu commands. The menu commands are described below. Click each command for additional information.

[[Drag and Drop](#)] The first slot of the tool bar is not a button but a place holder for drag and drop items.

[Design View](#)

[Sort View](#)

[Filter View](#)

[Global Search](#)

[Add ? Item](#)

[Add Item](#)

[Delete Item](#)

[Dial Phone](#)

[Send Letter](#)

[Message Log](#)

Agent Toolbar

Also on the Home page of the Ribbon is an Agent Toolbar group of buttons. These buttons are reserved for user-created agent buttons that have a [Tool Bar Pick Trigger](#).

When creating the agent, you can choose a numbered position to arrange the button in that specific position. Agent buttons are shown in numerical order by position. A group can contain as few as one agent, or up to 15 agents with consecutive position numbers.

Quick Access Toolbar

The Quick access toolbar is a customizable row of buttons above the Commence [ribbon](#) and just beneath the title bar.

The Quick access toolbar can be shown either above or below the Ribbon. To switch positions, click the drop-down arrow at the end of the Quick access toolbar, and choose 'Show Below the Ribbon' or 'Show Above the Ribbon'.

Print

The Print button is shown on the Quick access toolbar by default. This button can be hidden without being removed. Click the drop-down arrow at the end of the toolbar, then remove the checkmark next to 'Print'.

Add Buttons

To add a new button, right-click on any object in the Ribbon, then choose 'Add to Quick Access Toolbar'. Buttons will be shown in the order in which they were added.

To add a view to the quick access toolbar, first the view must be added to the Ribbon. To do this,

1. Open the view.
2. Select **Open/Manage Views** from the **View** menu.
3. Click **Edit** on this screen to change the display settings for the active view. If the View is not currently on the Ribbon, then 'Display on View Menu for Desktop:' is set to (none). Change this to **(all)**.
4. On the Home menu, click the arrow in the Launch group for Views.
5. Find your view; it will be listed in alphabetical order.
6. Right-click on the view name, then choose 'Add to Quick Access Toolbar'. The view name will now appear in the Quick access toolbar for all desktops.

Remove Buttons

To remove a button, right-click on the button in the Quick access toolbar, then choose 'Remove from Quick Access Toolbar'.

Open/Manage Database

Selecting the **Commence Application button**, then choosing **Open/Manage Database** displays the [Open/Manage Database dialog box](#). With this command, you can:

- Open a different database
- Add a new database
- Edit an existing database to determine its location or change the database name
- Backup a database
- Restore from a backup of a Commence database.

A database consists of the information you enter into [categories](#), as well as the categories, [views](#), [agents](#), preferences, and other features that you use.

ACTIVE DATABASE

The database that was open when you last exited Commence is opened automatically when you start Commence; it is called the active database. To access the data contained in another defined database, you must open that database. When you do, the previously open database will be closed automatically. Its data is inaccessible until you open it again.

PASSWORD PROTECTED DATABASES

If you attempt to open a password-protected database, the [Database Password](#) dialog box is displayed. To access the database enter the password in the **Password** text box and select **OK**. When you enter the correct password, the database is opened. For more information on facilities to protect your data from unauthorized access, see [Database Protection](#).

ADDING DATABASES

You may want to create your own databases to keep certain data separate or to create a unique application database. You can define up to 1000 Commence databases. Views, categories, agents, preferences, etc. defined in a particular database are accessible only when that database is open. To open multiple databases at the same time, you will need to run multiple copies of Commence.

EDITING DATABASES

You may also want to change the name of an existing database, or delete old databases no longer in use. The only thing you cannot change once a database is created is the Windows folder in which it resides.

The databases delivered with Commence reside in separate directories under the **Application Data Directory** by default. Their locations are selectable on installation.

TUTORIAL DATABASE

Maintaining data in separate databases protects data in one database from changes you make in another. For example, if you use the tutorial database included with Commence, you will notice that none of the changes you make while in the tutorial affect the data or other features in any other database. That's because the tutorial data is contained in a separate database.

Note, however, that the tutorial database is *not* listed in the **Open/Manage Database** dialog box. Also the Open/Manage Database command is not available while you are using the tutorial database. This is because entering tutorial mode entails setting up an entire environment for your practice work as well as switching to another database. (See [Help-Tutorial Database](#) for more information about the tutorial database.)

Exit

[See Also](#)

Use this command to exit Commence and return to Windows. Selecting the **Commence Application button**, then choose **Exit**. This is equivalent to using the [Control Menu Box](#) to close the Commence window.

If there are any currently open [views](#), Commence checks to see if any of them are new, unsaved views, or saved views that have been changed and not saved.

If a changed view is a saved view, Commence checks your view preferences to determine what changes you want saved and whether to save the specified changes automatically (i.e., silently) or to display the [Save View dialog box](#). If your preferences are set to **Ask and then save View**, Commence will ask if you want to save the view. If you respond by selecting the **Yes** button, the **Save View** dialog box is displayed with the name of the view filled into the **Name** text box. You can save the changed view under its own name, or type in another name.

If a changed view is a new unsaved view, Commence checks your View Preferences. If the **New View** check box is checked, Commence will ask if you want to save the view. If you respond by selecting the **Yes** button, Commence will display the **Save View** dialog box for you to type a name for the view and select the **Save** button to save the view. All [properties](#) of the view are saved.

Home-Workgroup Sync

Choosing this menu command causes the client database to immediately synchronize any changes with the server database, and updates your client database with any changes from the server database. This command allows you to override the automatic synchronization that occurs periodically, in cases where you need to quickly retrieve any changes to the shared database.

This command is useful when your database contains changes that you want to share immediately with another user or if the server contains changes that you need quickly. For example, if you are using a client database stored on a notebook computer and you are leaving the office, you can use the **Workgroup Sync** command to retrieve the latest changes to the shared database before disconnecting from the network.

This command is also useful when a client database is connected to the network by a remote connection, such as remote access software connected to the network via a modem. This command can be used to quickly retrieve changes to the shared database while the connection is available, reducing the amount of time that the remote connection must be kept open.

Message Log This command displays a log of the messages that have been posted to the [status bar](#). You can display this log by selecting the Message Log command or selecting the equivalent toolbar button. These messages include informational messages displayed by commands and [agents](#) as they execute that will help you diagnose and correct problems encountered in Commence.

If the currently open database is a shared database and there is a synchronization problem, the **Message Log icon** will change color or shade. If this happens, you should check the **Message Log** to find out what is wrong.

When you select **Message Log**, Commence displays the [Message Log](#) dialog box. The Message Log icon is also included on the Home ribbon menu and also the Help menu for convenience, and may be added to the Quick Access Toolbar to ensure the icon is visible at all times.

Send Letter

[See Also](#)

Use this command on the **Home** [tool bar](#) to create a letter for the currently highlighted [item](#) (typically this is a person in one of your person [views](#)) or for the active view. You can use any word processor installed on your system to create your letter, as long as you make sure that your letter preferences are set correctly and the word processor has been configured for use with Commence (see [Word Processors](#) for information).

When you select **Send Letter**, Commence displays the [Send Letter dialog box](#), from which you select the template for your letter.

Shortcut: Drag an item in a view to the Letter button on the tool bar to create a letter for the item.

You pick an already defined letter template (some are included with Commence) as the model for the new letter. Based on the contents of the template, field values from the highlighted item are merged into the new letter. (See [Customize-Database-Letter Template](#) for details on letter templates.)

After you select a template, you can chose to either print the letter or preview the letter in your word processor (so you can modify the letter before you print it or save it to a file).

If you get any error messages when attempting to send a formatted letter from Commence, make sure you have followed all the instructions for [Configuring Your Word Processor for Use with Commence](#)

Dial Phone

[See Also](#)

Use this command on the **Home** [tool bar](#), to dial a phone number displayed by the [active view](#) or [item detail](#). The **Dial Phone** command is unavailable unless there is a [telephone field](#) present in the active view or [detail form](#).

If there is more than one phone number in the active view or item detail, Commence will display the [Select Telephone Number dialog box](#) from which you select the number you want.

Shortcut: Double click the left mouse button on a telephone field in an item detail to dial the number in the field without selecting **Dial Phone**. You can also drag an item in a view to the Dial button on the tool bar to dial the items phone number. You can also highlight a telephone number in a text field and then select the Dial button on the tool bar.

If you have a [dialing device](#) such as a modem attached and have correctly configured your **Dialer Preferences**, Commence will transmit the phone number to your dialing device and display the [Commence Dialing](#) dialog box. This dialog box displays the number being dialed. It also displays a **Hang Up** button and a **Change Options** button. The **Hang Up** button allows you to terminate the dialing by disconnecting the modem. The **Change Options** button allows you to change the dialing options via TAPI.

Note: You cannot select a phone number in a [connected field](#) from a report view for dialing.

Send

Use this command to export the data in the [active view](#) to a HyperText Markup Language (HTML) file. If there is a filter on the view, only the items and fields displayed in the view will be included in the HTML file. This command is available only if there is an active view in calendar or report format.

Perform the following steps to save an HTML file:

1. Open a calendar or report view. If the view is not currently in calendar or report format, use the [View-View As](#) command to change the view type to either Calendar or Report.
2. Select the **Send** command from the [menu bar](#) to launch your e-mail program. If prompted, enter your e-mail login or profile information.
3. The active view will be converted to an HTML file and attached to the e-mail message.
4. The subject of the e-mail message will automatically be filled with the View Name from Commence.
5. Type the e-mail address of the recipient or select an e-mail address from the Address Book of your e-mail program. The names of all your contacts from Commence can be made available to MAPI address books. For details on how to set up a Commence Address Book in your e-mail program, see the topic titled [Configuring MS Outlook Address Book](#).
6. You may also click anywhere above or below the attached HTML view and press Enter on your keyboard to insert a blank line. Type any additional comments or other information as needed in the body of the e-mail message.
7. Send the e-mail as you normally would when you are finished previewing the message.

Print

[See Also](#)

Use this command to print the [active view](#) or the currently displayed [item detail](#). You can select **Print** from the **Home menu bar**, press CTRL + P, or select the print button from the [tool bar](#) to invoke this command.

Selecting **Print** from the **Home** menu bar, or selecting the print button from the command bar, or dragging an item in a view to the print button, displays a [dialog box](#) specific to the view type of the [view](#) to be printed; there is also a specific dialog box for printing item details.

After choosing appropriate options from the dialog box displayed and selecting the **OK** button, Commence displays a window that tells you the currently printing page number and the view or item detail title. The page number restarts at **1** for each item detail printed, if you choose to print item details. There is a **Cancel** button in this window that you can select to cancel the job in progress.

You can also "[drag and drop](#)" an item from the active view to the Print button on the command bar. To do this from any view, click and hold down the left mouse button on the item, move the mouse pointer to the Print button, and release the mouse button.

Printer Setup

Use this command to choose printer options (such as available fonts and page orientation) and select the default printer for printed output.

Selecting **Printer Setup** from the **Home** [menu bar](#) displays the [Printer Setup dialog box](#).

Print Preview

[See Also](#)

The Print Preview option is used to see how a printout will look prior to actually printing it out. This is an invaluable tool when designing reports and other printed materials. By looking at the Print Preview for a view, it can be determined if all information will fit on a single page, if the information appears crowded, or if there is room for additional information that may be desired to be included

Page Setup

[See Also](#)

Use this command to create, edit, copy, and delete [paper layouts](#) for use with the [Print](#) command. You can also associate a specific printer with each paper layout; this printer will be selected whenever that paper layout is used.

A paper layout in Commence is a flexible template for printing [views](#) and [item details](#). It specifies the dimensions of a paper form you want to use in your printer and the printable area of the form. When you print information from Commence, the paper layout lets you specify exactly where you want view and item detail information to go on the paper. Commence includes many pre-defined paper layouts, which are suitable for various purposes. These pre-defined paper layouts may also be edited and saved under new names.

Selecting the **Page Setup** command from the **Home** menu bar displays the [Page Setup dialog box](#).

Launching Views from the Ribbon menu

A numbered list of [saved views](#) appears at the bottom of the **Home** menu. Selecting a numbered view from the list opens the chosen view.

You can place a view's name on the **Home** menu by selecting the [View-Open/Manage Views](#) command. Highlight the name of the view you want to place on the **Home** menu and click on **Edit**. Mark the **Display on Menu Bar** [check box](#).

The ability to place the names of up to 40 of your most frequently used views on the **Views** menu is provided as a convenient alternative to using the [View-Open/Manage Views](#) command.

Menu Pick Agents-1, 2, 3...

[See Also](#)

This topic describes the [menu pick](#) and [tool bar pick agents](#) in Commence.

Menu Pick Agents

If you define and activate an agent with a menu pick [trigger](#), the menu pick will be added to the bottom of the [Agent tab](#).

All [active](#) menu pick triggers are listed on the **Tools** menu. If a menu pick trigger is associated with a particular [category](#), then it will be grayed out unless a view of that category is currently active.

If you move the mouse over an agent menu pick, the [status bar](#) will display the help message (if it exists) that was defined for the trigger. When you deactivate an agent with a menu pick trigger, its menu pick is removed from the menu.

Tool Bar Pick Agents

If you define and activate an agent with a tool bar pick trigger, a user-selected button will be added to the [Tool bar](#).

Buttons for all active tool bar pick agents are displayed on the right side of the tool bar. If you move the mouse over an agent tool bar pick, the status bar will display the help message (if it exists) that was defined for the trigger. When you deactivate an agent with a tool bar pick trigger, its button is removed from the tool bar.

You can add your own buttons to the tool bar by defining an agent with a **Tool Bar** [trigger](#).

Edit-Cut

[See Also](#)

Use the **Edit-Cut** command (or press `SHIFT+DELETE`) to delete highlighted data and place a copy on the Windows Clipboard. This command can be used to delete the highlighted [item](#) in the [active category](#) from the [database](#). It can also be used to delete data from an individual [field](#) in an [item detail](#).

This command is particularly useful for moving field values between item details of items in the same or different [views](#).

Typically, you use the **Edit-Cut** command to delete data from a field that you want to move to another field. For items, only a subset of the item's fields are copied to the Clipboard (see below); any other data in the item is lost.

Display an item detail or view and highlight the field data or item that you want to delete. Then, select the **Edit-Cut** command from the menu bar.

For fields, only the visibly highlighted text is deleted and placed on the Clipboard.

For items, the entire item is deleted from the Commence database, regardless of how much of the item is actually visible in the active view. The fields copied to the Clipboard depend on the [view type](#) and category, as follows:

Book All fields in the view (see [Customize-Design View](#))

Calendar Start time field for view (see [Customize-Design View](#)), item name, and [clarify field](#) for the category (if any)

Gantt chart Item name and clarify field (if any)

Report Item name and clarify field (if any)

The **Edit-Cut** command is available for any item displayed by the active view. In an item detail, it is available only for image fields and any [edit box](#).

Edit-Copy

[See Also](#)

Use the **Edit-Copy** command (or press `CTRL+INSERT`) to copy highlighted data to the Clipboard. This command can be used on [items](#) in the [active category](#) and on [fields](#) in an [item detail](#).

It is particularly useful for copying [field](#) values between items in the same or different categories.

Typically, you use the **Edit-Copy** command to copy data from a field that you want to move to another field. For items, only a subset of the item's fields are copied to the Clipboard (see below).

Display an item detail or view and highlight the field data or item that you want to copy to the Clipboard. Then, select the **Edit-Copy** command from the menu bar. Typically, you would then display the item detail to which you want to copy the information and use the [Edit-Paste](#) command to paste the data into a field.

For fields, only the visibly highlighted text is placed on the Clipboard.

For items, the fields copied to the Clipboard depend on the view type and category, as follows:

Book All fields in the view (see [Customize-Design View](#))

Calendar Start time field for view (see [Customize-Design View](#)), item name, and [clarify field](#) for the category (if any)

Gantt chart Item name and clarify field (if any)

Report Item name and clarify field (if any)

The **Edit-Copy** command is available for any item displayed by the active category. In an item detail, it is available only for image fields and any [edit box](#).

Edit-Clear

[See Also](#)

Use this command (or press `DELETE`) to delete highlighted data without placing a copy on the Clipboard. This command can be used on [items](#) in the [active category](#) and on [image fields](#) and [edit boxes](#) in an item detail. If the cursor is in an edit box and no data is highlighted, this command deletes the character directly to the right of the cursor (if any).

Display an item detail or [view](#) and highlight the field data or item that you want to delete. Then, select the **Edit-Clear** command from the menu bar.

For fields, only the visibly highlighted text is deleted. For items, the entire item is deleted, regardless of how much of the item is actually visible in the active window.

The **Edit-Clear** command is available for any highlighted item displayed by the active view. In an item detail, however, it is available only for image fields and edit boxes.

Edit-Paste

[See Also](#)

Use this command (or press `SHIFT+INSERT`) to copy data from the Clipboard into a [field](#). It is available only when an [item detail](#) is displayed.

The **Edit-Paste** command is used to copy data into an item detail field from the Clipboard.

Display an item detail and select the field into which you want to copy the data that is currently on the Clipboard (optionally, highlight any data you want to replace). Then, select the **Edit-Paste** command. Data from the clipboard is copied into the selected field, replacing any highlighted data.

The **Edit-Paste** command is available only for image fields and edit boxes.

Edit-Copy To

[See Also](#)

Use this command to copy highlighted data to a file. It is available only when an [item detail](#) is displayed and data in an [edit box](#) is highlighted.

Display an item detail and highlight the field data that you want to copy. Then, select the **Edit-Copy To** command from the menu bar. A [Copy To File dialog box](#) is displayed that asks you for the file name to which the data should be copied.

Edit-Copy To is available only for edit boxes. Only the visibly highlighted text is copied to the file.

Edit-Paste From

[See Also](#)

Use this command to paste data from a file into a field. It is available only when an [item detail](#) is displayed and the cursor is located in an [edit box](#). This command cannot be used to paste an image from a file into an image field.

Display an item detail and place the cursor in the edit box into which you want to read the [field](#) data. Highlight any field data to be replaced. Then, select the **Edit-Paste From** command from the [menu bar](#).

The [Paste From File](#) dialog box is displayed. It asks you for the file name from which the data should be pasted.

Data from the file is copied into the currently selected edit box, replacing any highlighted data. If there is too much text in the file to fit in the field, Commence asks you if you want to continue. If you respond **Yes**, data is added to the field up to the capacity of the field.

Edit-Global Search

[See Also](#)

Use this command, or the corresponding button on the [tool bar](#), to locate items from any or all [categories](#) containing specific text or a [wildcard pattern](#).

Using global search, you can quickly locate all pertinent information for an important meeting, find all the notes, phone calls, etc., that refer to a particular person or topic, display all items from all categories with a certain date or time, and more. Commence searches all name, text, date, time, data file, check box, and radio group type fields for the given [Search Text](#) and displays a list of items with fields that contain the search text. Number, calculation, image, Excel cell, and sequence number fields, as well as connection definitions, are *not* searched by the global searching mechanism. To look for items based on information in field types not scanned by global search, use [Customize-Filter View](#) command

When you select **Global Search**, Commence displays the [Global Search dialog box](#). Type the text you want to search for in the **Search Text** text box and select the **Start Search** button (the label on this button then changes to **Stop Search**). Items are displayed in a list box as they are found. A message box informs you when the search is complete.

In the **Search Text** text box of the **Global Search** dialog box you can use a question mark wildcard character to substitute for any single character, and an asterisk (*) to substitute for one or more characters.

Fuzzy searching is selected using the **Match** dropdown list.

Select "Fuzzy", "Fuzzier" or "Fuzziest" to accommodate possible misspellings in the search text.

Commence searches all categories by default. Use the **Categories** button to exclude categories from the search.

Commence looks for any field that contains the search text. Look for exact matches of field contents by turning on the **Equals** radio button. The case (upper or lowercase) of the search text is ignored unless you turn on the **Case Sensitive** check box.

Selecting the **Categories** button on the **Global Search** dialog box displays the [Select Search Categories](#) dialog box from which you can alter the list of categories searched. On the first search after selecting the **Tools-Global Search** command, all categories are selected by default.

Find Find allows you to search for a text string in the items in the current view or item detail. The Find command will tell you of the first instance it finds of the text string and lets you edit the item. You can then continue your search. Find works on Name, date, number, phone, text, time, Excel cell, and data file fields.

If using Find in a view, Commence will only search the fields included in the view. If you want to search fields that are not in the view, you need to include them using [Customize-Design View-Fields](#). Also, Find will not search fields from connected categories, even if they are displayed in the view.

Find & Replace

Find and Replace allows you to search for a text string in the items in the current view or item detail and, if desired, replace it with another text string. Find & Replace works on Name, date, number, phone, text, time, Excel cell, and data file fields.

If using Find & Replace in a view, Commence will only search the fields included in the view. If you want to search fields that are not in the view, you need to include them using [Customize-Design View-Fields](#). Also, Find & Replace will not search fields from connected categories, even if they are displayed in the view.

WARNING Be careful when using Find & Replace in a view and using the **Replace All** button. All occurrences of the find text will be replaced without being prompted and the changes **CANNOT** be undone.

Note If you are using Find & Replace in an item detail, the changes are not saved until you save the item.

Edit-Add ? Item

[See Also](#)

Use this command to add an [item](#) to any [category](#). You can also select the equivalent button from the [tool bar](#) or press CTRL+A (with no active view) to invoke this command.

The **Edit-Add ? Item** command can be selected at any time to add an item to any category.

When you select this command, Commence displays the **Add Item dialog box**. After selecting the appropriate [category](#) and [detail form](#) from the dialog box, the detail form you selected is displayed.

Once you have completed filling in the fields on the detail form, select the **Save** button to add the item; the **Cancel** button on the detail form cancels the **Add ? Item** command.

If time conflict checking is enabled for the [active category](#) (see [Customize-Database-Category-Time Conflict](#)), Commence checks to see if the item being added conflicts with the date and time of another item already in the category. If so, you are asked for confirmation before the item is added.

If a detail form allows you to add recurring items to a category (such as the Initial Form for the Appointment category) and conflict checking is enabled for the, Commence checks to see if any of the recurring items being added conflict with the dates and times of any other items already in the category. If so, a list of all conflicting item names is displayed and you are given the option to ignore these conflicts or cancel the addition of all of the items.

Note that once the new item is added, it is not necessarily displayed by the [active view](#) (if any); this depends upon the [filter](#) used by the [view](#) and the contents of the item.

The new item is highlighted in any view containing it when it is added. Views containing the new item may need to be redrawn on your terminal when the new item is added.

Edit-Add Item

[See Also](#)

Use this command to add an item to the [active category](#). You can also select the equivalent button from the [tool bar](#) or press `CTRL+A` (with an [active view](#) of the [category](#)) to invoke this command. If there is no active view or [item detail](#), selecting the button or pressing `CTRL+A` invokes the [Edit-Add ? Item](#) command.

If there is an active view or item detail, Commence assumes you want to add an item to the active category and displays a [detail form](#) for that category.

If no views are currently open, the **Add Item** [dialog box](#) is displayed. After selecting the appropriate category and detail form from the dialog box, the detail form you selected is displayed.

Once you have completed filling in the fields on the detail form, select the **Save** button to add the item; the **Cancel** button on the detail form cancels the **Add Item** command.

If time conflict checking is enabled for the active category (see [Customize-Database-Category-Time Conflict](#)), Commence checks to see if the item being added conflicts with the date and time of another item already in the category. If so, you are asked for confirmation before the item is added. Time conflict checking also makes sure that you specify a start time that is later than the end time of the item.

If a detail form allows you to add recurring items to a category (such as the Initial Form for the Appointment category) and conflict checking is enabled for the category, Commence checks to see if any of the recurring items being added conflict with the dates and times of any other items already in the category. If so, a list of all conflicting item names is displayed and you are given the option to ignore these conflicts or cancel the addition of all of the items.

Note that once the new item is added, it is not necessarily displayed by the active view (if any); this depends upon the filter used by the view and the contents of the item.

The new item is highlighted in any view containing it when it is added. Views containing the new item may need to be redrawn on your terminal when the new item is added.

Edit-Edit Item

Use this command to select an [item](#) from the [active view](#) for editing. You can edit any of the [fields](#) in the [item detail](#) displayed. This command is available only if there is an active view.

Shortcut: You can also highlight an item and press `ENTER`, or double-click the mouse on the item name, to edit its item detail.

Highlight the item you want to edit from the active view and select the **Edit-Edit Item** command. Commence displays an item detail of the item.

A detail form for the [active category](#) is displayed, filled in with the field values for the selected item. Detail forms are specific to each category.

Once you have completed editing the item's fields, select the **Save** button to save your changes; the **Cancel** button cancels the **Edit-Edit Item** command.

Edit-Copy Item

[See Also](#)

Use this command to add a new [item](#) to the [active category](#) by copying the currently highlighted item or the displayed [item detail](#). This command is available only if an [active view](#) or item detail is displayed.

This command is useful if you want to add an item to a [category](#) that is similar to an existing item, without retyping all the identical information.

You can only copy items within the category used by the active view.

Highlight the item you want to copy from the active view, or display the item's item detail, and select the **Edit-Copy Item** command.

You can also copy an item from one category to another by dragging the item and dropping it on another view. The field values having identical names in the source and destination fields are copied. If an appropriate connection exists between the two categories, the destination item is connected to the source item. If possible, Commence changes the values in the destination item to match the values in the destination view's filter (if any). For more information, see [Drag and Drop Operations](#).

Note: If you drag an item from a Calendar view; to copy it you must hold down the **Ctrl** key while dragging the item. The default drag and drop operation for a Calendar view is move.

A detail form for the active category is displayed, filled in with the field values for the selected item, except for the item name which is left blank. Detail forms are specific to each category.

Once you have completed editing the fields on the layout (including supplying an item name for the new item), select the **Save** button to save your changes; the **Cancel** button cancels the **Edit-Copy Item** command.

The new item is highlighted in any view containing it when it is added. Views containing the new item may need to be redrawn on your screen when the new item is added.

Edit-Delete Item

[See Also](#)

Use this command (or press `CTRL+D`) to delete the highlighted [item](#) from the [active category](#). This command is available only if there is an [active view](#) or [item detail](#). You can also use the **Delete** key or the delete item button on the [tool bar](#) to invoke this command. For more information see [Drag and Drop Operations](#).

Highlight the item from the active category that you want to delete, or display the item's item detail. Then, select the **Edit-Delete Item** command from the [menu bar](#) to delete the item. You can also drag an item in a view to the delete button on the command bar and the item will be deleted.

Commence, depending on your preference settings, may ask for confirmation before deleting the item. If it does, select the **Yes** button to confirm the deletion; select the **No** button to cancel the deletion. (See [Edit-Preferences-Other](#)).

If the item you are deleting is a recurring item, Commence will prompt you for the range of items to delete.

The item immediately after the deleted item is highlighted in the [view](#). Views from which the item was deleted may need to be redrawn on your screen.

Edit-Delete All Items

[See Also](#)

Use this command to delete all the [items](#) displayed by the [active view](#) from the [active category](#). This command is available only if there is an active view and is not available for calendar views.

Select the **Edit-Delete All Items** command from the [menu bar](#) to delete all items in the view from the active category.

If the active view currently displays all the items from the active category, then the category is emptied. If the view is [filtered](#), only the items displayed by the active view are deleted.

Commence will ask for confirmation before deleting the items. Type “**yes**” and then select the **OK** button to confirm the deletion; select the **Cancel** button to cancel the deletion.

After the items are deleted, all open views of the active category are updated and redrawn.

Edit-Share All Items

Use this command to [promote](#) all the [items](#) displayed by the [active view](#) from the [active category](#). This command is available only if there is an active view for a [shared](#) category. It is not available for calendar views.

Select the **Edit-Share All Items** command from the [menu bar](#) to [promote](#) all items in the view to the [shared database](#).

A local item is one that is stored *only* on your [client database](#), you are the only person who can add, edit, or delete it. Shared items are used by all authorized Workgroup users.

If the active view currently displays all the items from the active category, then all the items in the category are promoted. If the view is [filtered](#), only the items displayed by the active view are promoted. If an item is already [shared](#), its status does not change.

You can tell the difference between a local and a shared item by opening the item detail and looking at the **Shared** check box. If it is turned on and grayed out, the item is shared. The **Shared** check box does not appear if you are in a local category.

Edit-Preferences-Calendar

[See Also](#)

Use this command to define preferences for [views](#) using the calendar [view type](#).

These preferences control the starting day of the week for the month displays in the day, month and year modes. It also affects printing for the Day, Week, and Month calendar styles (see the [Print Calendar](#) dialog box for an explanation of calendar printing styles).

Selecting **Preferences-Calendar** displays the [Calendar Preferences dialog box](#).

Edit-Preferences-Database

[See Also](#)

Use the **Preferences-Database** command to set a password for your database and to set preferences for shared databases.

This tab displays this [Database Preferences](#) dialog box.

Edit-Preferences-Dialer

[See Also](#)

If you want to use Commence's automatic dialing feature to dial telephone numbers from [views](#) and [item details](#), you must select your [dialing device](#).

In Commence there is, by default, only one choice for dialing the telephone from your PC:

-- **Dial Using:** Windows Telephony

Selecting the **Control Panel** button will switch you to the Windows Control Panel to change the Windows Telephony settings for your dialing device. Windows Telephony allows you to autodial from Commence using a calling card. You can also change the access codes used to dial your numbers based on your location. If your phone/modem manufacturer also provides you with a Telephony Service Provider (*.TSP), you may also be able to use Caller ID on incoming calls.

Note: You will have to close Commence and restart it for **Control Panel** changes to take effect.

Edit-Preferences-Event Logs

Use this command to change the [categories](#) used for logging phone calls and letters. The **Preferences-Event Logs** command displays the [Log Preferences dialog box](#).

Edit-Preferences-Meeting

[See Also](#)

Use this command to select the category, fields and connection definitions used when scheduling a meeting.

The **Preferences-Meeting** command displays the [Meeting Preferences dialog box](#).

Edit-Preferences-Other

Use the **Preferences-Other** command to set: whether you want to activate the automatic minimize feature; the short date range; name reversal on printing or exporting; your preference for agents that display message boxes requiring a response; and external data file preferences.

The **Preferences-Other** command displays the [Other Preferences dialog box](#).

Edit-Preferences-Other Apps

[See Also](#)

Use the **Preferences-Other Apps** command to configure Commence to be used with other applications such as:

- E-mail applications that are MAPI, VIM or CMC compatible
- Outlook E-mail Logging of Sent and Received messages
- MAPI E-mail address book, such as MS Outlook
- Palm Address Book
- Palm Date Book
- Palm Memo Pad
- Palm To Do List
- Mobile Link and Outlook Calendar
- Mobile Link and Outlook Contacts
- Mobile Link and Outlook Tasks
- Mobile Link Notes
- Symantec WinFax Phonebook (version 4.0 or later)

Edit-Preferences-Personal Info

[See Also](#)

The **Preferences-Personal Info** command has two purposes:

The Personal Information has two purposes:

- to designate an item that contains information about you in the open database.
- to designate connection definitions that should automatically be set to your item when adding items to particular categories.

After you fill out this dialog box for the first time, the information you entered can be viewed and changed using the **Preferences-Personal Info** command. If you do not enter the item for yourself information or if you later delete either the category or item selected for yourself, the dialog box appears again the next time you open the database.

Setting your personal information is particularly useful if selective permissions are configured for one or more categories in the database.

Note: If the active database is a shared database, be sure to choose a shared category in the **Category** list box. Shared categories are indicated by an asterisk at the end of the category name. By choosing a shared category and item describing yourself, agents, filters, and other data that use the special **(-Me-)** keyword will be properly resolved to the item chosen in this dialog box, both in your copy of the shared databases and in other clients' copies. You can select a local category and item, but this information will not be available to other shared database clients.

To use this dialog box:

1. Choose the category in which the item describing you exists, or in which you will create it, from the **Category** list box. This is called the *user category*.
 2. Choose the name of the item from the **Your Name** list box. This item is called the *user item*. If the selected category does not have an item describing you, use the **Add New Item** button to display an Add Item dialog box for the selected category. After you fill out the item detail, select **Save** to return to this dialog box.
 3. In the large list box, highlight the connection definitions that you want to automatically point to your item. For example, highlighting the **Activity - Relates to - Employee** connection tells Commence to automatically connect all new Calendar items to the item you chose in Steps 1 and 2 (you can override this for individual records on the item detail).
- Highlight multiple connection definitions by clicking the mouse over their names. Remove the highlight from a connection definition by clicking the mouse over the highlighted name.
4. Select the **Save** button.

Edit-Preferences-Tool Bars

[See Also](#)

Use this command to control how the agent bar, the view bar, and the [status bar](#) are displayed.

STYLE

The style you select alters subtle details such as the title bar colors, window borders, view bar and tool bar background color, and other visual attributes. Choose **None** to use the display settings for your Operating System set via Control Panel.

SHOW AGENT TOOLBAR BUTTON

The agent bar is the row of buttons corresponding to any active agents that have a Toolbar Pick trigger. If the **Show Agent Toolbar Buttons** check box is turned on, the agent bar is displayed; if not, the agent bar is hidden.

SHOW VIEW BAR

If the **Show View Bar** check box is turned on, the [view bar](#) is displayed; if not, the view bar is hidden.

The view bar is the vertical column of icons to the left of the Commence [work area](#). If you choose to display the view bar, you can choose to display [view](#) icons with or without labels. You can also choose to display a small or large icons on the view bar. The view bar can be used by mouse users only.

You can have up to 40 view icons on the view bar. The number of visible view icons that display depend on your display type as well as your view bar preferences. If your icons don't all fit on the view bar, Commence will display up/down arrows at the top of the view bar. You can select these with the mouse to scroll through the icons.

INCLUDE LABELS

Turning off this checkbox will display the view icon but hide the icon labels; hiding the labels reduces the icon size so the view bar takes up less space. You can see the view names displayed on the status bar when you hover your mouse over the icons.

USE LARGE BUTTONS

Turning on this checkbox will display full-size icons on the view bar.

To save space for your work area, turn off this checkbox, and smaller icons will be displayed on the view bar. Small icons allow you to display more icons (without scrolling).

ICON DIRECTORY

You can choose from Commence's internal icons and your own icons when selecting an icon for a view. You can create your own icons in files with **.ico** extensions, and place these files either in a database directory or in a central icon directory whose location is set via the **Icon Directory** text box. The path you specify is limited to 128 characters.

Icons can be created with a variety of drawing applications; you may also obtain these files from the Internet or other users.

SHOW STATUS BAR

If the **Show Status Bar** check box is turned on, the status bar is displayed; if not, the status bar is hidden.

Edit-Preferences-View

[See Also](#)

Use the **Preferences-View** command to set the conditions that tell Commence what kinds of [view](#) changes should be saved on closing a view, and whether to save such a view automatically (silently) or display a [Save View dialog box](#) that allows you to choose a different name under which to save the changed view.

If you are in the habit of having many views open during a session and closing them when you exit Commence, the automatic save option can save you some time and keystrokes.

Edit-Preferences-Letters

[See Also](#)

Use this command to set your preferences for the word processors that you will use with letters. These preferences will determine which word processor or text editor you use for text (unformatted) letters and which word processor you will use for formatted letters. You also use this command to tell Commence what directory to use when it creates new letter files.

Text letters are created with [text letter templates](#). These are flat ASCII files that only contain plain text and Field Codes associated with a particular category in Commence.

[Formatted letter templates](#) are used to create letters in a particular word processor's native file format. Formatted templates are themselves word processor documents and can contain whatever formatting information the word processor provides, in addition to the text and Field Codes used in text templates.

If you have WinFax installed on your system and you use one of the word processors that works with the Commence Letters facility, then you can set up a new Word Processor Letter Preference that allows you to fax a letter instead of printing it. See [Letter Fax Macros](#) for more information.

The **Preferences-Letters** command displays the [Letter Preferences dialog box](#).

View-Open/Manage Views

[See Also](#)

Use this command to open, create new, edit and delete a [view](#). When you select the **View-Open/Manage Views** command from the [menu bar](#), Commence displays the [Open/Manage Views dialog box](#).

The **Sort Views By** [radio group](#) controls the sorting order of the list box below. You can select one of the [radio buttons](#) in the **Sort Views By** radio group to sort the list by view name (the default), [view type](#), or category. Commence remembers your sorting preference until you exit Commence.

Open View:

To open a view from the list, highlight one of the views and select the **Open** button. As a shortcut, double-click the mouse on the desired view name to open it.

New View:

From the **Open/Manage Views** [dialog box](#) select the **Create New** button. Use this command to create a new [view](#) by choosing a [category](#) and [view type](#).

Selecting the **Create New** button displays the [New View dialog box](#).

To open a new view using the **New View** dialog box, highlight a category in the **Category** list box and select a view type from the **View As** list box. If you choose a report view type, choose a **Report Style** that includes all the [fields](#) from the highlighted category in the report or the item [name field](#) only. Then, select the **View** button to create and display the new view.

See [View-Open/Manage Views](#) to open a [saved view](#).

Edit View:

To edit a view, highlight a view name from the [list box](#) displayed and select the **Edit** button. This will display the **Edit View** dialog box which allows you to change the name of the saved view; choose whether or not to display the view's icon on the [view bar](#) for convenient opening; choose an icon and a label for the view; choose whether or not to display the view's name on the [Views menu](#) for convenient opening.

Delete View:

To delete a view, highlight a view name from the [list box](#) displayed and select the **Delete** button. As a shortcut, you can delete a view by double-clicking the mouse on the view name you want to delete.

Commence displays the [Delete View dialog box](#). A message is displayed asking for confirmation before deleting the view. Select **Yes** to confirm the deletion of the view.

View-Save View

[See Also](#)

Use this command to save a new [view](#) or to save changes made to a [saved view](#). This command is available only if there is an [active view](#).

If the active view is a saved view, selecting the [View-Save View](#) command silently saves any changes you have made to the saved view's options.

If the active view is an unsaved view, Commence displays the [Save View dialog box](#), which asks for a name for the view. View names are limited to 50 characters.

If active view is a saved view, and you want to save the changes under a new view name (leaving the original saved view unchanged), use the [View-Save View As](#) command.

This command does not close the active view. The active view remains displayed after the completion or cancellation of this command. (Press CTRL+F4 to close the view.)

If you don't save changes made to a (new or saved) view before closing it or exiting Commence, Commence asks you if you want to save the changes to the view before closing the view or exiting. Answering **Yes** for a saved view silently saves the changes to the view; for a new view, the [Save View](#) dialog box is displayed.

View-Save View As [See Also](#)

Use this command to save changes to the [active view](#) under a name other than the name displayed in the [title bar](#) of the view's window (leaving the original saved view unchanged), or to copy a [saved view](#). This command is available only if there is an active view.

Selecting [View-Save View As](#) from the [menu bar](#) displays the [Save View dialog box](#). The name of the active view is filled into the **View Name** text box. Type the name under which you want to save the active view and then select the **Save** button to save the view; select the **Cancel** button to cancel the command.

This command does not close the active view. The active view remains displayed after the completion or cancellation of this command. (Press CTRL+F4 to close the view.)

Use the [View-Save View](#) command to save the active view as itself.

View-Save View As File

Use this command to export the data in the [active view](#) to a file. This command is available only if there is an active view in calendar, report, or grid format. Simply open a saved view (or create a new view) then select one of the options below.

- **Create CSV** - this auto-creates a simple ASCII text (CSV) file suitable for importing to another application
- **Create HTML** - this auto-creates a basic HyperText Markup Language (HTML) file
- **Create HTML Wizard** - select this option if you would like to apply optional formatting to your HTML file. You will be prompted step-by-step to select a pre-formatted HTML to use as a template (for the fonts, colors, layout, etc.), you can add a header and footer, and also choose the destination folder and filename where the HTML file will be saved.

You can prepare your view ahead of time using the [Customize-Design View](#) command. Choose only the fields and connections you wish to include in the file.

- *Fields*: Open the Fields tab to select the fields and connections to display. Only these columns will be included in the saved file.
- *Field Labels*: If you have custom field labels for each column, these custom labels will be used as the column headers.
- *Filters*: If you have filters on the view, these are supported. Only the items displayed in the view will be included in the file.
- *Sorts*: The file will be sorted the same as your view.
- *Group Headers and Group Totals*: Grouping is not supported; these will be skipped.
- *Fonts and Color codes*: Font formatting is not applied when using the Create CSV or Create HTML commands. To create a formatted HTML, use the **Create HTML Wizard** command

and select your [custom HTML template](#) to apply these fonts and colors to your saved HTML file.

Create HTML Wizard

Perform the following steps to create an HTML file using the wizard:

1. Open a calendar, report or grid view.
If the view is not currently in calendar, report or grid format, use the [View-View As](#) command to change the view type to either calendar, report or grid.
2. Select the **View-Save View As File- Create HTML Wizard** command from the [ribbon](#) to save the view to an external HTML file. The [Save As HTML dialog box](#) appears.
3. Follow the on-screen instructions to create an HTML file with data from the active view.

The resulting file can then be viewed using a standard Web browser, such as Microsoft Internet Explorer.

Selecting the **Cancel** button will cancel the command and will not save a file.

The *Save View as File* commands do not modify the active view.

View-View As

[See Also](#)

Use this command to display the [active view](#) as a new view using a different [view type](#).

The [View-View As](#) group of commands effectively copies the active view to a new view type. Select any view type (Report, Book, Calendar, Gantt, Grid, Report Viewer) from the [menu bar](#).

A new view is opened using the (possibly [filtered](#)) [active category](#) and the new view type specified. The previous active view (on which the new view is based) remains displayed in the background and is left unchanged.

If you want to retain this new view, you must save it using the [View-Save View](#) or [View-Save View As](#) commands.

Switch Windows-1, 2, 3...

[See Also](#)

Make the selected [view](#) the [active view](#). Choosing an open view name from the **Window** menu makes it easy for you to switch to another view when you have a number of views displayed and some are hidden behind others.

Note that you can also use the key combination CTRL+F6 to successively select views on the desktop as the active view.

A numbered list of open views appears at the bottom of the **View** menu. The text of the entry on the menu for a view matches the view title shown in the title bar of the view window.

The currently active view has a check mark next to its name in the list. Selecting a view from the list makes the chosen view the active view.

View-Cascade

Use this command to layer all open windows on the [desktop](#), so that the [title bar](#) of each is visible. This makes it easier for you to switch between open views, while displaying as much of the active view as possible.

View-Tile Horizontally

Use this command to size and re-display all open views horizontally on the [desktop](#), so that no window overlaps another. This lets you see at least a portion of all the currently open views.

View-Tile Vertically

Use this command to size and re-display all open views vertically on the [desktop](#), so that no window overlaps another. This lets you see at least a portion of all the currently open views.

View-Resize All

Resize all open views to fit on the active desktop while maintaining the relative proportions and positions of the individual views.

View-Close All [See Also](#)

Close all open windows on the [desktop](#) (including any hidden behind other windows). This command provides an alternative to closing each individual window.

If any of the open views have been changed and the changes not saved, you will be prompted to save the views, depending on your view preference settings.

View-More Windows

[See Also](#)

Displays the [Select Window dialog box](#). This dialog box lets you select a [view](#) other than one of the nine shown on the **Window** menu to be the [active view](#). Only nine open views can appear on the **Window** menu. If more than nine views are open, the **More Windows...** command is placed on the **Window** menu. Choosing an open view name from the **Window** menu makes it easy for you to switch to another view when you have many views displayed and some are hidden behind others.

Note that you can also use the key combination CTRL+F6 to successively select views in the workspace as the active view.

The currently active view has a check mark next to its name in the list at the bottom of the **Window** menu. If the active view does not appear on the **Window** menu, a check mark appears next to the **More Windows...** command.

Customize-Design View

[See Also](#)

Use this command or the corresponding button on the [tool bar](#) to display and edit the [design](#) for the [active view](#) or displayed [item detail](#).

[Display](#) Specify a default title and paper layout for printing a [view](#).

[Fields](#) Select the fields to be displayed on the view, and decide what order to display them in. Combine multiple fields to be displayed on the same line. Change the font used for each field individually.

[Colors](#) Select the color code template to be used for the view. Turn on options to show legend or color code item text.

[Fonts](#) Select the font and font size used for item text and label text.

Report Viewer

When you select the **Customize-Design View** command with an active Report Viewer window, the following options are displayed.

[Filter/Sort](#) Select the filter and sort for the report viewer.

[Designer](#) Launch the Report Designer for the active report viewer window.

Detail Form

When you select the **Customize-Design View** command with an active [item detail](#), the [Design Detail Form](#) dialog box is displayed.

Note: The changes you make to views using the **Customize** menu commands are temporary unless you save the view; see [View-Save View](#) and [View-Save View As](#).

Customize-Filter View Use this command to select a subset of [items](#) from the [active category](#) for display by the [active view](#). This subset can be based on up to four [field](#) values, [connected](#) item names, and/or connected field values. You can also press CTRL+F or select the corresponding filter button from the [tool bar](#) to invoke this command.

The **Customize-Filter View** command displays the [Filters](#) dialog box.

The **Clear All** button on the **Summary** tab clears all filters and displays all items in the category.

Customize-Sort View (Gantt, Report and Grid view types only)

Use this command, or the corresponding button on the [tool bar](#), to change the sort [fields](#) for the [items](#) in a Gantt chart, report or grid view. This command is available only if the [active view](#) is a Gantt chart, report or grid view.

Items in a report and grid views, by default, are sorted in ascending ASCII order by the [name field](#) of each item.

Items in a Gantt chart view, by default, are sorted by three fields:

First, by the **Start Date** field, so that items with the earliest start dates are displayed at the top of the chart, the latest at the bottom.

Second, by the **End Date** field, so that items with the same start date are displayed in ascending date order within the group of items with the same start date.

Third, by the item name field, so that items with the same start and end dates are displayed in ascending ASCII order by their item name fields.

(Note that the fields used for **Start Date** and **End Date** in a Gantt chart view are set when the view is created; you can change them using the [Customize-Design View](#) command.)

Using the **Customize-Sort View** command, you can change:

- the number of sort fields
- the fields used to sort items (maximum of four fields)
- the sort type for each sort field (ascending or descending ASCII)
- the groups and sub-totals (for report and grid views only)

Selecting the **Customize-Sort View** command displays the [Sort Fields dialog box](#).

Customize-Desktops

A desktop is a group of open views. You may want to define one desktop for your Project Management reports and another for your Contact Management views. A database can have up to 100 desktops defined. You can display desktops as stacked tabs on the Commence view bar.

To open a desktop: Select **Customize-Open/Manage Desktop**.

From there you can highlight the desktop that you would like to open and select the Open button. If you have the desktop displayed as a tab, you only need to click on the tab for that desktop.

-

To display the Desktop Tabs:

Select **Customize-Open/Manage Desktop**. Check the **Show As View Bar Tabs** check box.

-

To Add a New Desktop:

Select **Customize-Open/Manage Desktop** Select the Add button. Choose a name for your new desktop. This name should describe the type of information that you will display on this tab.

If you mark the **Save Desktop on Exit** checkbox, the desktop will be saved each time you exit Commence.

If you mark the **Show As View Bar Tab** checkbox, a tab will be displayed the Commence View Bar. If you do not show the desktop tab, you will be able to access the desktop by selecting **Customize-Open/Manage Desktop**

You can also choose the color the desktop tab and you can choose a bitmap (*.BMP) or JPEG file to use as the background of the desktop.

-

To Edit or Delete a Desktop:

Select **Customize-Open/Manage Desktop**. From there you can highlight the desktop that you would like to edit or delete, select the appropriate button.

Customize-Database

One of the most powerful features of Commence is its flexibility. You can add and change categories, connections between categories, create agents, etc. to suit your specific needs.

For more information about a particular topic, select the topic from the list below:

[Agent](#) Add, edit, copy, or delete [agents](#) in the [active database](#).

[Category](#) Add, edit, copy, or delete [categories](#) in the active database.

[Color Code](#) Add, edit, and delete [color code templates](#) in the active database.

[Connection](#) Add, rename, and delete [connection definitions](#) in the active database.

[Detail Form](#) Add, edit, copy, and delete item [detail forms](#) for the selected category in the active database.

[Import/Export](#) Add, edit, copy, and delete import/export templates in the active database.

[Letter Template](#) Add, edit, and delete [letter templates](#) for the selected category in the active database.

Customize-Workgroup

The Customize-Workgroup Command is used in different ways depending on which database is open.

Enroll Client

When you select **Customize-Workgroup** from a standalone database (one which is not already a client in a workgroup) this command: * begins the Enroll client process, allowing you to access a shared database

Server Administration

When you select **Customize-Workgroup** at the Commence Server, this command allows you to:

- * set default and selective permissions for the active shared database*
- * assign user permissions for shared categories in the active shared database*
- * configure communication settings for using a shared LAN drive and/or E-Mail to sync with the Commence clients*
- * register clients*

Configure Client Synchronization Settings

When you select **Customize-Workgroup** at a Commence Client, this command allows you to:

- * configure communication settings for using a shared LAN drive, FTP Internet folder, or E-Mail to sync with the Commence Server*

Related Topics for Server Administration:

[Database Options](#)

[Permissions](#)

[Communications](#)

[Register](#)

Related Topics for Enrolling Client:

[Communications](#)

[Enroll](#)

Tools-Outlook Sync

[See Also](#)

Integrating Commence with Microsoft Outlook enables Commence users to share their meetings, contacts, and tasks/todos with Outlook users. The result is a comprehensive calendar, address book, and Task list in both applications.

To synchronize information between Commence and Outlook:

- 1** Start Commence and open the database that is configured to synchronize with Microsoft Outlook.
- 2** In Commence, select **Tools - Outlook Sync**.
- 3** A dialog will be displayed showing the status of the synchronization between Commence and Outlook.

Note: This command will synchronize all mapped Outlook applications at the same time.

Tools-Spell Check

Use this command to check the spelling of words in a [text field](#); either the cursor or some highlighted text must be present in the text field in order to start the spell checker. Otherwise, the **Tools-Spell Check** command is unavailable.

If spellings appear in the text that are not in Commence's dictionary, or your personal dictionary, Commence displays the [Spell Checker dialog box](#).

You can:

- accept single or multiple occurrences of a misspelled word
- edit the misspelled word by typing a correction from the keyboard or choosing a correction from a list of suggestions generated by the spell checker
- add spellings to your personal dictionary

Select a button from the dialog box to perform the indicated operation on the currently highlighted word or select **Done** to exit the spell checker.

If the spell checker finds no spelling mistakes in the field text, Commence displays a message box that informs you of this fact. Select **OK** from the box and the spell checker exits.

Tools-Field Summary

[See Also](#)

Use the **Tools-Field Summary** command to display a total and/or average of the selected [calculation](#) and [number](#) fields for the items in the view. For example, the field summary can be used to calculate total sales for a month, or to check if expenses have exceeded a maximum amount.

The summary takes the data in the selected fields for all the items in the [active view](#), and shows the name of each field followed by one or both of:

- the combined arithmetic average of the data in the field for all items
- the combined total of the data in the field for all items

The summary for the selected fields will appear in a **Field Summary** [dialog box](#). The field summary also appears at the bottom of the printed report. This command is available only if the active view is a report.

The fields shown in the summary report (and whether to calculate the average, total, or both) are selected using the **Customize-Design View** command. Select the **Fields** Tab. Move (append or insert) the field into the report and select the [Field Options](#) for that field. Check the boxes labeled **Total** or **Average** (one or both boxes may be checked as needed).

Note: Only the calculation and number fields displayed in the view *and* whose field options have been set for summary reporting appear in the field summary.

Tools-Schedule Meeting

If you are scheduling appointments for a group of people, you can use this command to find a date and time for a meeting based upon the availability of selected participants. Once you've selected a date and time, the item is added to your group calendar. Other meeting details (location, comments, resources, and a meeting coordinator) can also be chosen. Once you schedule the meeting, you can review the meeting's details by opening a view of the Appointment category or by selecting the item detail from your calendar.

When you select the **Tools-Schedule Meeting** command, the [Schedule Meeting dialog box](#) appears.

If Microsoft Outlook Calendar is configured in the Edit-Preferences-Other Apps menu command, the Schedule Meeting command will launch the Microsoft Outlook Meeting Scheduler. Refer to the Microsoft Outlook online help for additional information about using the Microsoft Outlook Meeting Scheduler.

Note: For information about using the **Schedule Meeting** command with custom categories and connection definitions, see [Meeting Preferences](#) command.

Tools-Sync Link In

[See Also](#)

Use this command to [synchronize](#) a database from an update file previously created with the [Sync Link Out](#) command.

Selecting the **Sync Link In** command displays the [Select File to Sync In dialog box](#).

Specify the file name of the [update file](#) and the sync in process begins when you select **OK**.

Tools-Sync Link Out

[See Also](#)

Use this command to:

- Define the remote PCs that will be in your [sync link group](#).
- Edit or delete the remote PCs in your sync link group.
- Create an initial [update file](#) for each of the remote databases.
- Create an incremental update of your database to take a remote database.

Selecting the **Sync Link Out** command displays the [Sync Link Out Options dialog box](#).

In this dialog box, you can define and maintain a set of two or more identical databases (called a sync link group). You can also manage this sync link group by adding, editing, and deleting remote databases. Once you establish a sync link group you can compress a Commence database into a single file (called an update file) to sync link the database changes from one PC to the other as you move between them. When you choose the database to synchronize and select **OK**, the sync out begins.

Tools-Transfer In

[See Also](#)

Use this command to copy the definitions (and data, if any) contained in a file previously created with the [Transfer Out](#) command.

Overview

Selecting the **File-Transfer In** command displays the [Select Transfer File dialog box](#). Specify the file name of the [transfer file](#) and If the selected transfer file contains *only* definitions and no data, the transfer in process begins when you select **OK**.

Data definitions are always added unless there is an existing definition of the same type with the same name (e.g., you try to transfer in a People category into a database that already has a People category). If **Transfer In** detects a definition in the transfer file with the same name as an already existing definition in the open [database](#), the incoming definition is not transferred. See the *Transferring In Definitions with Duplicate Names* section in the description of the [Transfer Rules](#) dialog box for information about using **Transfer In** to merge similar but different definitions with the same name.

Note: Data items may have been included in a transfer file explicitly as part of the transfer out operation, or included automatically by Commence because a category, view, or agent definition being transferred depends on them. See [Transfer Out](#) for more information on items included in a transfer file.

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Tools -Transfer Out

[See Also](#)

Transfer Out copies selected [categories](#), [views](#), and [agents](#) from a Commence [database](#) into a DOS file. You may optionally choose to copy the data contained in selected categories and views. The resulting [transfer file](#) is the input file for a [Transfer In](#) command.

Use this command to:

- Move definitions you have developed in one database into another of your own databases.
- Share definitions you have developed with another Commence user.

Overview

Selecting the **Transfer Out** command displays the [Transfer Out Options](#) dialog box.

In this dialog box, you specify whether to transfer all definitions for selected categories or just the definitions required by selected views of the categories. Then you select any agents to transfer. You also select whether to transfer items and related data files (DOS files pointed to by data file fields). Once you've made your choices and selected **OK**, then specify a transfer file name. Once you choose a file name, the transfer out begins.

Automatic Inclusion of Dependent Data and Definitions

When you select categories, views, or agents for transfer, Commence automatically determines the additional definitions and data that are required by a category or view, or those required for the operation of an agent. Dependent data for a category or view might be names of connected items in other

categories or color code templates. Dependent data for an agent might be another agent or items used by a filter in a trigger, condition, or action.

The following list shows the dependent data and definitions selected for categories, views, and agents:

Category All category field definitions.

All category connection definitions and all directly related definitions from the connected category.

All item detail forms for the category.

All view definitions that use the transferred category, their options and filters.

All color code templates for the category.

View Associated category's definition, along with the categories of any indirect fields.

All connection definitions used in the view.

All item detail forms for the relevant categories.

All color code templates usable by the view.

Agent All necessary categories, views, and other agents needed by the agent.

All data items from relevant categories used in trigger, condition, or action filters.

Note: If you want to transfer only items, use the [Export-By-Category](#) command or the [Export By-View](#) command to create a DOS file and use the [Import](#) command to read the file into a database.

Specifying Data File Transfer Location

The **File-Transfer Out** command lets you transfer out items as well as definitions to a DOS file. If you elect to transfer out items,

you may also choose to transfer out any related data files (i.e., DOS files pointed to by data file type fields) that are referenced by the transferred items.

When you transfer into a database a file that has definitions, items, and related data files, Commence needs to know where to put the related data files on your hard disk. This is because the directory structure on your computer and the directory structure of the computer on which the transfer file was created are most likely different.

Select the [Edit-Preferences-Other](#) command to choose a location in which to store related data files transferred into the currently open database. Enter the directory name and overwrite option in the **External Data Files** group box.

Tools-Import

[See Also](#)

Use this command to populate a [category](#) in your open Commence [database](#) using:

- data from external applications or
- data exported from another category in this or another Commence database

To import category data, highlight the name of the import/export template you want to use and select the **Import** button.

When you select the **Import** button, Commence displays the [Select Import File](#) dialog box so you can select the name of the external file you want to import.

Commence scans the import file you choose and displays a message box if it finds a problem with the file, such as incorrect formatting. The message displayed indicates the source of the problem. Select **OK** to return to the **Import** dialog box; to continue importing, you must either fix the import file or pick another one to import.

Provided the file you chose matches the format of your import/export template, and no errors are found in the file, Commence begins importing the data in the external file into the category in your open Commence database. Commence displays a message box as the import progresses. You can select **Cancel** to stop the import operation, but this will leave the import partially completed and your category contents in an indeterminate state. When the import is complete, select **OK**.

Tools-Export-By View

[See Also](#)

Use this command to copy data from [items](#) in the [active view](#) to an external file

- for use with external applications or
- for use in another [category](#), either in the open [database](#) or in a different Commence database

Only the items that appear in the view are included in the export.

Use the **Export By View** command with a [filtered](#) view to export data from a subset of the items in a category. If you use the **Archive** option when you export, only the items in the view will be deleted from the category; this is a handy way of backing up old items and deleting them from the category to make room for new items.

The [dialog boxes](#) displayed by and the behavior of this command are identical to the **Export-By Category** command, except that the items exported are a subset of the items in the category as determined by the view [filter](#). If the view is unfiltered, then all items from the active category are exported.

Selecting this command displays the [Export](#) dialog box.

Tools-Export-By Category

[See Also](#)

Use this command to copy data in a [category](#) to an external file:

- for use with external applications or
- for use in another category, either in the open [database](#) or in a different Commence database

You can export data that is in one of three external file formats, ASCII, dBASE, or DIF.

You tell Commence how to export to an external data file by defining an import/export template. This template tells Commence how to extract data from your category and how to write your external file. If you use the **Archive** option when you export by category, all the [items](#) in the category will be deleted from the database; this is a handy way of backing up old items and deleting them from the category to make room for new items.

The **Export-By Category** command displays the [Export dialog box](#).

Help-Index

Use this command to display the main index for Commence's on-line help system.

From the Index you can select one of the listed topics or search through the Help System for topics containing keywords.

Exit the help topic by selecting ALT+F4 or **File-Close** from the help screen's menu bar.

Getting Help on Dialog and Message Boxes

If a dialog or message box is displayed, press F1 or SHIFT-F1 to display a help topic from the Commence Help System that describes the dialog box or message box (including error messages) in detail. Exit the help topic by selecting **ALT+F4** or **File-Close** from the help screen's menu bar.

Help-How Do I?

This help section describes common Commence functions and steps to perform them.

It is divided into the following topics:

How Do I ...

[Work with Views?](#)

[Use Filters?](#)

[Search for text in multiple Fields?](#)

[Find Items in a large list?](#)

[Copy an Item?](#)

[Add a Field to a Category?](#)

[Edit a Field in a Category?](#)

[Customize where Fields appear in a Form?](#)

[Design a Custom Paper Layout](#)

[Add a Command Line Option](#)

[Backup a Commence Database](#)

[Restore a Commence Database](#)

[Open a Database](#)

[Add a new database](#)

[Edit the Name of an existing database](#)

[Delete a database](#)

Help-Tutorial Database

To enter the tutorial environment, select the **Tutorial Database** button on the Help ribbon menu. This creates a special 'sand-box' environment in which you can practice using Commence without affecting any of your live data in any other [database](#). Note this is not a self-running demo; you can try out any command or feature at your own pace.

The **Help-Tutorial Database** command:

- changes to an alternate database directory used only for tutorial data. Select the **Help-System Information-Directory Information** command for the path to the tutorial database.
- optionally re-populates the tutorial database with a fresh copy of the sample data
- highlights the **Tutorial Database** button on the Help ribbon menu, to remind you that you are currently in the tutorial environment
- disables the **Open/Manage Database** command, so that you must exit the tutorial database using the **Help-Tutorial Database** command before opening another database
- disables the **Sync Link In**, and **Sync Link Out** commands; these commands are unavailable while in the Tutorial

Each time you select this command, you are asked whether you want to replace the existing tutorial data with a fresh copy of the data. If you select **Yes**, the data currently in the tutorial database is overwritten with a new copy of the data as it first appeared when you installed Commence. Any changes you've made to the tutorial data are lost. This is a convenient way of starting with fresh tutorial data after you experiment with it for a while. Selecting **No** retains the

current data in the tutorial database so that you can return to the environment as you left it.

Once you change to the tutorial data, the [title bar](#) of the Commence main window changes to indicate you are using tutorial data.

To return to your live database, select the **Help-Tutorial Database** menu entry again; or, exit Commence and then restart it.

Some of the examples in the help system refer to the tutorial data. You may want to switch to using the Tutorial data as you read certain sections of help.

Help-System Information

Use this command to display information about your hardware and software operating environment, and other information. This information is useful for confirming that your system setup is as you expect and for reporting problems with Commence.

The **System Information** dialog box allows you to select the type of information you would like to display. Click on the **Display** drop-down list and choose one of the following:

- **Category Information** Displays the Commence category names and identification numbers.
- **Directory Information** Displays the full path names to various folders used by Commence.
- **Memory Information** See the documentation for your system hardware and software for explanations of displayed information.
- **System Information** See the documentation for your system hardware and software for explanations of displayed information.
- **Version Information** Displays the name and version number of the files installed that Commence requires for execution.
- **Workgroup Information** Displays the database workgroup ID number and other information pertaining to the workgroup.

When you select the **Save to file...** button, the information from all the different system information screens will be saved to a text file. By default, a file named COMMENCE.TXT will be saved in the Commence application data directory.

Select the **Close** button on the message box displayed to return to the [desktop](#).

Help-Check For Updates

Use this command to download and install software maintenance updates from Commence Corporation.

When running the **Check For Updates** command on a Commence server you will have two options:

- **Download:** Obtains the installation files from the Commence Corporation web server and saves the files to a directory of your choice. The files can then be copied to an intranet folder for off-line distribution to users who do not have an Internet connection. Refer to the Server Guide for additional configuration instructions.
- **Download and Install Update:** Obtains the installation files from the Commence Corporation web server and applies the update to your Commence Server installation.

Note: An Internet connection is required to update your Commence server installation using the *Check For Updates* command.

When running the Check For Updates command on a Commence client, the software will first check if a newer version is available. Then the update will automatically be downloaded and installed.

Help-About

Use this command to display information about Commence and its creator, Commence Corporation. This information includes how to contact Commence Technical Support.

Introduction

[See Also](#)

Commence Corporation offers different software products which let you operate in either [standalone](#) or [workgroup](#) environments.

In a standalone installation the Commence software is used to maintain databases to which only one user at a time from a single PC can have access.

This version of Commence is referred to as Commence standalone. See [Basic Concepts](#) for an introduction to basic Commence features.

In a typical workgroup environment, several Commence users on different PCs with access to a shared FTP directory, a local area network ([LAN](#)) or E-Mail may share database information using the Commence Server and Client software. This version of Commence is referred to as *Commence Workgroup*. Commence Workgroup's networking capabilities allow users to share and periodically synchronize a database with the server using either a local area network or a compatible Windows e-mail program. Users on different PCs can share information in the same databases, viewing and updating information simultaneously. They may also define private information which other users cannot see or access. Different levels of authorization can be defined to control various access privileges.

Commence uses a distributed database architecture where each client

of the workgroup has their own local copy of the shared database. This has many advantages, including:

- ***Users***

can use their local copy of the shared database off-line.

While connected to the LAN, data is automatically synchronized with all other users on the network. When disconnected, Commence remembers the changes that have been made. Then when remote users log back into the network, by physically re-attaching or by calling in from a remote client PC, their changes and updates are automatically synchronized with the other users, and vice versa, thereby keeping everyone's' data in sync. This has the added advantage of allowing users to continue using Commence when the network is down. Those who synchronize via e-mail will continue to communicate their changes to the server as long as they can send and receive e-mail.

. Similarly, users who synchronize using an Internet connection will continue synchronizing as long as the Internet connection is intact.

- ***There***

is no data locking so all information is available at all times, authorizations permitting. Some other workgroup products lock records as they are being viewed making them unavailable to other users. Your data is in a local database and is always available.

- ***Users***

can create private information that stays at their local copy of the shared database. Private or local information does not synchronize with the server or with any other users of the workgroup, thereby protecting the user's private information.

One copy of a shared database resides on the Commence server, which

is created when you, the Administrator, install the Server Edition of Commence. Each Commence user has his or her own copy of Commence, called the Commence client, and a copy of the shared database, called the client database. Together the server and Commence clients, along with their copies of the shared database, are called a Commence workgroup.

Typical Commence Workgroup Configuration

With this model, authorized workgroup users always have instant access to information in the shared database. All additions, edits, etc., that a user makes to the shared data at his or her client are sent via the LAN to the server copy of the database, and changes made by other workgroup users are sent to each user's client database. Even if the user disconnects the client PC from the LAN and make changes to the data, the changes are automatically sent to the server database when the user reconnects to the LAN. In other words, the workgroup server and its clients are constantly synchronized, and all workgroup users have the most recently updated information at all times.

Getting Started

There are several things that you must do to install and set up your Commence workgroup. These steps should be performed in the following order.

1. [Install the server software.](#) You need to run the installation program and determine the proper paths for the various components of the Commence Server.
2. [Administer licenses.](#) Before a user can be added to the Commence Administration Program, ComAdmin, you must first set the total number of users in your workgroup using the License Administration program.
3. [Add users.](#) Users of a Commence Workgroup need to be added to ComAdmin. A user must be added to be able to use a shared database and share information.
4. [Set up a shared database.](#) You must define a shared database. This will be the basis for your Commence workgroup. You set up the shared database in ComAdmin.
5. [Start the server.](#) To do any of the following things, the server must be running in the shared database defined in the previous step.
6. [Set permissions.](#) Commence Workgroup Information Manager has many different permissions that you can set per database and per user to restrict what they can see and what they can do in the shared database. Commence will use the default values unless you change them.
7. [Set communications settings.](#) Each user of Commence can synchronize their data with the server using either a shared LAN directory or e-mail. You must tell the server what method each client will be using.
8. [Register clients with the database.](#) You must tell the server what users are to be clients of the shared database. This will create a link between the clients and the server.

9. [Install the client software.](#) Each client can install the client software themselves, but you must make sure it is properly installed. If it is not, they may have problems with their Commence Workgroup.
10. [Enroll to the shared database.](#) Enrolling to a shared database will bring a copy of the shared database locally to the client. This process involves running the Enroll Wizard, entering a special authorization key, and some communication parameters.

What's New in Commence RM?

Commence RM is designed with two objectives in mind. First, to ensure that the software remains compatible with changes to current versions of Microsoft Office and Windows Operating Systems. These changes are not always visible to the end user, but are critical to protect the investment and usability of the software.

Secondly is to enhance the functionality and utilization of the software. These modifications are traditionally driven by our global customer base who periodically interacts with our product management staff and makes recommendations for future enhancements. We appreciate their initiative and invite all customers to reach out to us with any recommendations you may have for future enhancements.

The new features are summarized below.

Commence Email Dropbox

One of the core enhancements in RM 8.0 provides better integration with Microsoft Office 365 and Google Mail for logging of e-mails. A new Email Dropbox feature allows users to log emails by simply forwarding them to a configured email address, such as crm@mycompany.com. Commence can be configured to check this inbox and automatically download and log any emails that are received.

Report writer Improvements for Adobe PDF

Use the built-in Commence Report writer to create interactive forms in PDF format.

Use the full power of the report designer to publish pre-configured and ready to fill AcroForms.

Customize Database confirms Updates and Deletes

This improvement notifies the Commence administrator when making changes or deletions of the Application design, including views, agents, fields, and more.

For example, when removing a field from the application, Commence shows an alert and documents any dependencies such as views or agents that use this field. This makes it safer and easier to update and modernize your application without causing unintended changes.

Image fields support more image formats

The Commence application database provides the Image field and allows for the application to store images with each record, such as a contact's profile picture or a picture of a real estate listing. This image field has been enhanced to support most common image formats such as JPEG, GIF and more.

Agent documentation in System info

Provides an improved System Info screen including an Agents listing that can be exported to a file for review or printing.

Social Integration

Integration with popular social search sites will allow the user to search for contact information on sites like Twitter, LinkedIn and Facebook. This feature provides the ability to add social links within Commence RM and navigate to a social user's profile.

Commence Mobilelink Add-on

Want to synchronize your calendar and contacts from Commence to your Smartphone?

Well now you can. Commence includes our Mobilelink software, a plugin software component that synchronizes data with MS Outlook and Google.

Office 2016 Styles

Commence RM includes new styles to modernize the application look and feel.

Report Writer

The built-in report writer has been updated to include the latest Active Reports features, allowing you to create more informative and analytical types of reports as required by your business. Of course all your existing reports will continue to be supported, preserving your investment in your current application reports. Now supports creating reports including charts, tables, calendars, and mapping.

Integration with Cloud Based File Storage and Sharing Systems

Commence applications often include attached files, for example logging letters, logging emails, attached project and sales documents, and many other purposes. While Commence Workgroup includes file sharing features that allow attached files to be shared among clients, cloud-based file sharing services offer enhanced functionality and easier access from anywhere and from any device. Commence RM will allow these cloud-based files to be used as file attachments in your Commence application. This means that you can store and access files directly in the cloud instead of storing them locally on a desktop computer, making it easier to share files with other users and access them from multiple devices.

Integration with Third Party Marketing Programs

The Commence RM software includes email marketing features that allows you to send bulk emails to your customers and contacts using the “Connect for Email” application and your own email server.

In RM 6.1, we have extended this capability and will support integration with popular cloud based e-mail marketing services such as MailChimp and Constant Contact. The Connect for Email application will enable you to upload your contact list from Commence RM and send bulk emails through these email services. In addition, you will be able to access email marketing reports directly from within the Connect for Email application. Common reports include details about campaigns that were sent, which emails were opened, and which were deleted allowing you to better understand the effectiveness of your email marketing campaigns.

Microsoft Office 64-bit support

Commence RM includes support for 64-bit editions of Microsoft Office, including top used features such as mail merge letters and email logging. With support for both 32-bit and 64-bit Office versions, Commence allows you to use the Office version you require, removing any extra implementation work to install 32-bit Office versions.

Macros for unsupported word processors have also been removed from the installer.

Spell Checker

The built-in Spell Check feature has been improved to work with 64-bit versions of Windows, as requested by many of our customers. The feature has been rebuilt using a modern spell check engine that also includes support for multiple languages and dictionaries.

Modern Tabbed Dialog Boxes

The most frequently used dialog box screens in Commence have been updated with a modern look and feel, making them easier to navigate and use. In addition, these new screens can be resized

allowing more information to be displayed on larger desktop screens.

Save View as File

The *Save View as HTML* command has been replaced with a more versatile *Save View as File* command. A quick export is now available by choosing either *Create CSV* or *Create HTML*. The *Create CSV* command instantly saves a comma separated (CSV) file format that can be imported directly to Microsoft Excel or uploaded to online web services, such as email marketing services. Similarly, the *Create HTML* command saves your view with a single click to HTML format. The formatted HTML option is still available using the *Create HTML Wizard* command.

Redesigned Filter Summary

Setting the search criteria for reports and views is easier than ever using the new Filters window. The summary page now shows all 8 filters on a single page. Filters can also be drag and dropped from positions 1-4 to 5-8 as per earlier designs. This allows you to quickly move filters or clone filters as needed to change the Boolean logic of your query.

Security Improvements

Security has been improved by incorporating the latest secure features for email and FTP.

How to get the new version

Commence RM is a Windows desktop version that can be installed on premises or in a web-hosted environment. Customers with an Internet connection may download the update directly using the Check for Updates command found on the Help menu.

The online update feature is a service available at no additional cost to customers on a current maintenance plan. Installation CDs are available upon request.

Includes Features from Previous Releases

This release includes all the new features and enhancements to the product's user interface introduced in Commence RM 3.5 , RM 3.5.1, RM 3.6, RM 4.0, RM 4.1, and RM 5.0. A summary of the feature highlights are listed below. Contact Technical Support for more detailed information.

Commence RM 5.0

Database Capacities

- Database capacity increase to allow up to 250 fields per category (increased from 100 fields).
- View icon labels allow 50 characters (increased from 10 characters)
- Calculation field changes to support the new database format
- Database Backup tool updated to support data folders larger than 2Gb
- Resolved progress bar issues with Database Restore tool for backup (*.xfr) files larger than 1Gb

Microsoft Office 365 and 2013

- Installer improvements to better support Word macro installation for Office 365
- Resolved issues with Excel charting feature in Office 2013
- Improved Word Mail Merge macros to better support merging special character in connected item fields (i.e., large text field with carriage returns)

Report Writer

- Updated to latest version of Active Reports
- Conversion utility has been improved to handle mismatched fields when upgrading existing report viewers.

- Resolved error in creating new report viewer with all fields in the category.
- Unconverted reports can continue to be used indefinitely.

Grid Views & Multi-views

- Resolved grid view focus issue when a detail form is closed; highlight no longer moves to first record.
- Grid now supports copy function (CTRL + C) to clipboard.
- Resolved multi-view focus issue; no longer requires click to begin using prefix matching.

Miscellaneous

- Outlook Connect Email Add-In updated to use newer version of Visual Studio
- Mobile Link Add-In updated to better handle trivial updates to Notes during synchronization with Outlook.
- Increased default size for ACTIVE.LOG to capture more activity.
- Resolved read-only file permissions issue with COMMENCE.INI on Windows 7 (64-bit).
- Improved performance of Delete All Items command.

Commence RM 4.1

Microsoft Office 2013 and Windows 8

- Windows 8 installations supported
- Updated email integration for logging email in Outlook 2013 (32 bit)
- Office 2013 (32 bit) supported for Word mail merges and other integration features.

Report Writer

- New report designer interface including, new toolbar, new script editor and preview tabs, and toolbox properties.

- New chart control to insert bar, pie and line charts
- New report viewer features including Continuous scrolling and Annotation
- Conversion utility to easily update existing report viewers to the new format. Unconverted reports can continue to be used indefinitely.

Grid View

- Redesigned grid view for improved performance and user interface.
- New tool tip pop-up to improve visibility of truncated cells.
- Reposition columns on-the-fly with simple drag and drop.

Workgroup Expert Report

- Client sync status summary chart appears before detailed recommendation text.
- Client workgroup ID numbers appear in workgroup summary and client sync status charts for easier troubleshooting.

Installation

- Default installation for 'All Users' no longer requires Windows Administrator rights.
 - Program settings previously saved to the Windows Registry (HKLM) are moved to COMMENCE.INI file.
 - 'Current User' installations are unchanged and continue to be saved in the Windows Registry (HKCU).
- Database settings previously saved to the Windows Registry (HKLM) are moved to DATABASE.INI file.
- Outlook Add-in updated to read/write to INI file instead of the Windows Registry.

Miscellaneous

- Larger windows for Open Manage Views, Send Letter, and Workgroup Assign Users dialog boxes
- Ribbon and Quick access toolbar improvement for Agents
- Graphical charts can now be added to the Dashboard.
- Resolved window focus issues during Dashboard refresh.

Commence RM 4.0

Microsoft Office 2010 and Windows 7

- Windows 7 installations supported
- Ongoing development and improvements to support 64-bit operating systems. Commence installs and runs as a 32-bit application in 64-bit Windows OS.
- Updated email integration for Outlook 2007 and Outlook 2010.
- Office 2010 (Word, Excel) supported for the various integration features, including mail merges and Excel graphs of sales opportunity data.

Ribbon

- All new Ribbon replaces the Menu bar. Note: For ease of explaining the new features, the terms ribbon and menu will be used interchangeably.
- Commence Application button intuitively presents application-related commands to manage the active database, open a different database, or exit the application.
- Ribbon can be minimized to increase workspace area. Opens when clicked, collapses when not in use.
- New Aero-style icons for menu commands that were previously not featured prominently, such as Outlook sync and Schedule Meeting.

Quick Access Toolbar

- Customizable Quick access toolbar is provided for all your frequently used commands.
- Always on top for anytime/anywhere access.
- Each user in a workgroup can individually personalize his/her quick access toolbar.
- Right-click on any object in the ribbon, then choose 'Add to Quick Access Toolbar'
- Launch menu commands, toolbar agents, menu agents, even views!
- Everything you need in the smallest space possible. Minimize the ribbon and work entirely off the quick access toolbar.

Key Tips

- With the elimination of cascading menus, most commands are now accessible with fewer keystrokes.
- Hold the ALT key, press the letter for the menu tab, then press the letters shown in the Key Tip over the feature that you want to use.
- Backwards compatibility for common keyboard shortcuts from prior versions of Commence (e.g. CTRL+P still Prints the active view).

In-Ribbon Galleries

- Home menu is visible as soon as the application opens, and displays a gallery of graphical icons for each command.
- Built-in command toolbar and user-defined agent toolbar reside on the Home menu.
- Complementary features have been grouped together. For example: Global Search, Find, Find & Replace are now found in the Search group on the Edit menu.
- Commands to manage views (open, save, view as) and arrange view windows (tile, cascade) have been consolidated into a single core tab -- the View menu.

- Enhanced tooltips appear when hovering over a gallery icon. Tooltips briefly explain the command and give the shortcut keys.
- Visit the Reference book of this online help for a handy chart of all menu commands and keyboard shortcuts.

Dashboard

- Dashboard page provides an overview of your key Commence information similar to Outlook Today.
- Ready-to-use portals display your Calendar, Contacts, and Task list from Commence
- Contacts list also serves as an index to quickly access the selected contact's profile on LinkedIn and Twitter.
- Ability to create your own portals to display data from your custom Commence category
- Integrates with your MAPI mail client configured in Preferences to display the number of messages in the Inbox, Outbox, and Drafts folders.
- Dashboard can be viewed as (1) a separate document view within Commence, (2) a secondary tab within the Contacts multiview, or (3) an external web page running outside of Commence.

Social Networking

- Social Networking page of the Dashboard features three integrated portals: Contacts list, Contact Details window, and Social Network window.
- Selecting a Contact in the list displays that contact's details in the second window.
- In the Contact Details window, three new icons are used to interact with the social networking sites. Clicking on any of the three populates the corresponding social network details in the third window.
- Twitter button displays the selected Contact's Twitter profile. Tweets button displays recent messages left by the individual on their Twitter page.

Google and Smart Phone synchronization

- Mobile Link features direct synchronization with Google's web-based applications for managing Calendar appointments, Contacts, and Tasks.
- Enables Web browser access to your calendar, contacts, and tasks from anywhere you have Internet access
- Use any web-enabled device to access your Commence data via Google, including desktops, smart phones, and even the latest Apple iPad.
- Mobile Link also supports two-way syncs with most of the smart phones available today, including iPhone, iPad, BlackBerry, Android, Palm WebOS (Pre and Pixi), Windows Mobile, and Symbian S60 devices.

Workgroup synchronization

- Monitor your workgroup client right at the desktop level using enhanced Help menu features.
- Help-System Information command display additional Workgroup information such as date of last sync, exact number of changes behind, and specific sync points.
- Message Log Info button, found on the Home menu and also the Help menu, displays up to the minute alerts on the Ribbon
- White Message Log icon indicates a normal state and let's you know with confidence that you have received all updates from the Commence Server database.
- Yellow, Orange, and Red icons indicate varying degrees of alert conditions, i.e. how far behind or how long it's been since your last synchronization.
- Warning thresholds can be adjusted to meet your company's requirements, alerting you based on a certain number of days or hours, or a certain number of changes.

Outlook Email Logging

- Commence add-in updates include better support for Microsoft Exchange, Outlook 2007 and Outlook 2010.
- New Aero-style Log button for the Add-ins menu better integrates with the Outlook Ribbon for a more seamless look.

Calendar

- Week numbers are a new feature prominently displayed for each week in the mini-month calendars for Day, 2 Day, Week, 2 Weeks, Month, and 6 Weeks format.
- 'All Day Events' and 'Untimed' appointments are now displayed in their own row when using the Send command on the Home menu to send you calendar to an email recipient.
- Corrected calibration issues with using Right click on a calendar to add a new appointment on the selected date.
- Repaired minor issue in Calendar views which listed the incorrect calendar display mode (2 Day) when actually viewing Day mode.
- Improved Calendar printing to better handle monthly calendar views that span six weeks
- Mini-month dates are shown in bold text when appointments are added to that date.

Miscellaneous

- Continued support for custom high-resolution icons when designing Agent toolbar shortcuts for the Ribbon and Quick access toolbar.
- Added support for colon (:) character in view names when using the Send command on the Home menu to send a view to an email recipient.

Commence RM 3.6

New Styles and Icons

- Personalize your view bar, tool bar, and desktop with all new style choices (found under Preferences - Tool Bars). The various styles give a polished look to the Commence windows and tool bars by altering subtle details such as the title bar colors, window borders, view bar and tool bar background color, rounded edges vs square edges for view windows, and other visual attributes. Choices include Office 2007, Windows Vista, Windows Vista (Black) for a monochrome look, Windows XP Luna, and Windows XP Royal.
- High resolution icons replace the previous command bar buttons along the top of the Commence window (Drag & Drop, Print, Design View, Sort View, etc.).
- Number (0 - 9) icons have been added to the icon library for use with view bar and tool bar buttons.
- Existing view bar icons have all be converted to high resolution full color images and standardized to 16x16 and 32x32 sizes for small and large icons respectively.
- Custom high resolution icons stored in an external directory can now be used as Agent tool bar buttons in addition to saved view bar buttons.

Calendar

- Calendar has been redesigned to echo the styling of the Microsoft Outlook calendar.
- More at-a-glance features provide information such as the day of week above the time slots in Day format, and showing the short date before each week for 2 Weeks, Month, and 6 Weeks format.
- Browse buttons now appear on dates with no appointment to quickly view the date of your next or previous appointment.
- Expanded display area at top of day planner for appointments with no specific start time
- Calendars now support WYSIWYG printing.

- Week numbers are now displayed near the mini months on Calendar printouts.
- Better drag & drop support for Calendars within multi-views. Quickly reschedule appointments, extend meeting times, and more.

Views

- Multi-views now have the option of displaying the view icon next to the tab name. Icons are selected in the Save View As dialog when creating or modifying the secondary view.
- Color Code Template colors have been updated to offer lighter background color choices while still retaining some of the deeper colors which are the preferred choice for text color coding.

Usability Enhancements

- Natural date language now supports simplified phrases such as 'beginning of next month', where 'the beginning of next month' previously required.
- More custom views can now be saved. Database capacity has been increased from 1000 to 2000 for the maximum number of views per database.
- Calendar color coding has been turned off by default to maintain expected view appearances in upgraded databases. Please review your color code templates in converted databases to verify the appropriate colors are selected for foreground vs background use.

Miscellaneous

- Calendar Design view settings have been updated to support the redesigned calendar view options. Calendar preferences dialog has also been updated to remove obsolete options for day planner printing. Calendar Image

format and corresponding image packs are no longer available.

- Select Items window is no longer accessible by double-clicking on a date header in calendars.
- Improved detail form performance by resolving GDI memory usage issue.
- Improved multi-view performance with better caching.
- Resolved application error when configuring workgroup permissions dialog for more than 50 desktops and categories.
- Commence Outlook Address Book installation issue has been resolved.

Commence RM 3.5

Office 07 and Vista support

- Installs and runs on Vista 32-bit operating system
- Updated letter macros for Word 2007
- Excel 2007 support for analytic charts to measure sales performance

Automatic Updates

- Built-in command checks for new program updates
- No CD required. Downloads and installs updates directly to your computer

Automated Business Processes

- New business work flow plug-in for managing your customer list
- Integrate with your calendar or to-do list to ensure timely follow-ups
- Drip marketing, service and sales automation examples included in tutorial
- Simple, wizard-driven screens for creating your own processes

Installation

- Additional user guides are added to the Windows Start menu for easy access
- Viewbar is updated to support tablet PC input and other accessibility options on Windows Vista
- Commence Address Book service is available for installation into Microsoft Outlook
- Clearer messages are displayed during online activation of the server

International

- Date fields have been updated to support all regional short date and long date formats when set using agent keywords
- New keyword (-LongDate-) inserts the regional long date format for use in agents and letter templates
- Changed keyword (-Date-) to insert the regional short date format for use in agents and letter templates
- Regional currency and date formats are preserved when sending letter with Microsoft Word
- Calendar updated to support regional date and time options as set in Windows Control Panel

Workgroup

- Progress bar during workgroup synchronization displays estimated remaining work to complete synchronization
- Large number of categories is now supported when setting user access rights to data
- Switching to a new default detail form is now synchronized independently of other form changes
- Increased fault tolerance for brief internet connection outages. Automatically resumes file upload/download.
- Long connection names are displayed in their entirety on the sync progress message box

- Resolves intermittent application error with open forms during background synchronization
- Toolbar is now refreshed properly to show alert status of Message log button when synchronization is off

FTP Synchronization Enhancements

- Extra allowance for intermittent FTP connectivity
- Automatically retries the send/receive of data if the initial connection is not successful
- Support for Internet Explorer 7.0

LAN Synchronization Enhancements

- Automatically retries the send/receive of data if the initial connection is not successful

Synchronization status reports

- New HTML format for Workgroup Expert report is easier to read
- Color coding spotlights specific users so you can quickly determine who is not synchronizing
- Now shows exact number of changes behind in addition to percentages for a more accurate assessment

Multi-View Enhancements

- New highlighting scheme for the active row in the active window
- Switching to a different pane in the multi-view moves the active highlight to the new window
- Remembers the last selection in the inactive window and greys out the inactive row
- Facilitates using tool bar buttons, mail merges, and other features that require an item to be selected

Updated Contact Manager Application

- Enhanced Opportunity module supports multiple product Forecasts
- Clean and modern look for main data entry screens
- Advanced sub-reports gather data across multiple categories in a single report

New Look

- Microsoft Office style View Bar and Tool Bars provide a consistent look and feel with the Windows desktop and other Windows applications
- New View Bar can now be docked permanently or removed from the desktop
- New default icons for standard view types
- Additional icon selections for View Bar buttons
- Improved viewbar displays more desktop tabs and view icons
- Viewbar size and layout is preserved for each database
- Viewbar icons are refreshed properly when opening desktop with missing wallpaper file
- Viewbar icons are refreshed properly when switching desktop during workgroup sync
- Viewbar icons are refreshed properly after cancelling prompt to save view changes
- Desktop with no wallpaper is displayed properly after opening desktop with wallpaper
- Desktop name now supports and displays special ampersand character

Views

- Grid view in locked mode no longer allows characters to be erased using Delete key
- Pick-list items in multi-view filtering toolbar are sorted properly
- Grid view toolbar now wraps when view is resized
- Resolves intermittent application error when reopening a minimized calendar view

- Windows control buttons (minimize/restore/close) are displayed properly for maximized calendar view
- Calendar view is enhanced to support resizing view to narrow width

Miscellaneous

- Audible beep suppressed when closing detail form using Enter key with cursor on connection field
- Resolves application error when cancelling from Select Database menu when launching Commence
- Microsoft Excel (XLS) files are displayed properly in the public library of Connect for E-mail

Error Message Index

The following is a list of all the error messages you might see while using Commence. They are listed by number, the same number displayed in parentheses in the message window when the error occurs. You can use this number to look up a message in this list and select the number of the message below to see a help topic on that message.

Note that you can press F1 when the error message is displayed by Commence (i.e., when the error occurs) to see the same help topic.

- [100](#) This category contains items with duplicate names. 'Allow Duplicate Names' may not be unchecked while this is true.
- [101](#) <Category name> is an invalid category name.
- [102](#) A category with a recurring date field must allow duplicate names.
- [103](#) This data directory contains categories which allow more items than this version of Commence supports. Commence will now exit.
- [104](#) Invalid entry, please try again.
- [110](#) You cannot delete the Item Name field.
- [111](#) Replacing the text will exceed the field's maximum size. Text cannot be replaced.
- [112](#) The default string's length is greater than the field's size. You must reduce the size of the default string.
- [113](#) The default selection must have a label. Change the default or add a label.
- [114](#) Add another radio button. You must define at least two buttons.
- [115](#) You cannot delete selections from existing fields.

- [119](#) Enter a whole number that is zero or greater for this field.
- [121](#) The reserved word [Save, Cancel] cannot be used as a field name. Please enter a new field name.
- [122](#) Multiple radio buttons have the same name. Make each name unique.
- [123](#) The maximum number of characters cannot be greater than 30,000.
- [125](#) This equation has an unrecognized field name, operator or delimiter. Please correct the equation before proceeding.
- [126](#) Please enter a whole number between 1 and <8> for 'Buttons Per Row'.
- [129](#) There is a maximum of one Sequence number field per category. Delete any extra sequence number fields.
- [130](#) The formula entered is too long. It cannot be saved.
- [131](#) There is a maximum of one recurring date field per category. Deselect this option from all but one date field.
- [132](#) Enter an initial sequence number less than 2,000,000,000.
- [133](#) The formula for the calculation field <*field name*> contains a field name that is no longer valid. Delete this calculation field or change its formula.
- [140](#) Select a 'From' item and 'To' item before continuing.
- [141](#) Internal error during connection initialization - call technical support.
- [142](#) Give the connections different names.
- [144](#) There is not enough room to add this connection to the <*category name*> category.

- [145](#) Warning for category *<category name>*: If you edit the name of or delete this connection, recurring items will no longer be associated and cannot be edited or deleted in a group.
- [147](#) The connection *<connection name>* is reserved for connecting recurring items. Commence creates this connection automatically when recurring items are added. Rename this connection or cancel this operation.
- [150](#) This field cannot be removed from the detail form because it is the name field or it is a mandatory field without a default value.
- [152](#) The detail form cannot be deleted since it is the only one defined for this category.
- [153](#) There are no attributes to set for this field type.
- [154](#) Enter a valid width greater than 0 and no more than 250 characters.
- [155](#) Enter a valid height greater than 0 and no more than 50 lines.
- [156](#) Enter a valid number for the visible size that is greater than 0 but does not exceed 20 inches or 50.8 centimeters.
- [157](#) Add at least one field to this form before saving it.
- [163](#) Warning: Incoming E-Mail will not be processed since no E-Mail program has been configured. Select Edit-Preferences-Other Apps to add E-Mail information.
- [164](#) Select appropriate date/time fields before continuing.
- [165](#) The limit of *<number>* Tool Bar Pick agents per database has been reached. Either select a different trigger for this agent, or deactivate other Tool Bar Pick agents.

- [166](#) Define at least one trigger and one action before saving this agent.
- [167](#) A trigger must be defined before you can define a condition or an action.
- [168](#) Before continuing, please provide [Menu Text, a DDE Message, Status Bar Message Text, a Message, an Application path name, all requested information, a path name, a path].
- [169](#) Select a view before continuing.
- [170](#) This action requires a trigger/condition selection with only one selected category.
- [171](#) You entered an invalid number of items. Enter a number from 0 to 500000 before continuing.
- [172](#) This command requires you to highlight an item in the *<category name>* category.
- [173](#) Cannot save the actions. Each button label and corresponding action must be defined in pairs.
- [174](#) Please enter the required value before continuing.
- [175](#) Select a field before continuing.
- [176](#) The Agent Tool Bar position you have chosen is already in use or the Tools Menu is full. The agent cannot be activated.
- [177](#) The hotkey for this trigger is already used by the agent '*<agent name>*'. Please select a different hotkey.
- [178](#) Before continuing. please provide a valid [date, time, year, Start Time, End Time, menu text, DDE msg, status bar msg].
- [179](#) Enter between [1 and 60, 0 and 59] minutes before continuing.
- [180](#) Select Print Options before continuing.

- [181](#) The 'Process E-Mail' action can only be used with the 'Incoming Communications: E-Mail' trigger. Please use the appropriate trigger or select a different action.
- [182](#) The limit of 16 Menu Pick agents had been reached. Either select a different trigger for this agent or deactivate other Menu Pick agents.
- [183](#) This trigger/condition/action requires that at least one category or view be defined.
- [184](#) The field '<*field name*>' is mandatory and no default value is available. It cannot be left blank.
- [185](#) The field '<*field name*>' is mandatory and no default value is available. It cannot be left blank. Select 'Field Values...' or check 'Display Item(s)' before proceeding.
- [186](#) The field '<*field name*>' does not translate to a valid field in the <*category name*> category.
- [187](#) Enter a time interval between 0 minutes and 23 hours, 59 minutes.
- [188](#) You must check 'added to', 'edited in', or both before continuing.
- [193](#) The maximum number of messages that can be snoozed has been reached.
- [194](#) Enter a valid snooze time between 1 and 999 minutes.
- [195](#) Cannot create a Sync Link Out Agent. No remote databases defined. Use [Sync Link Out](#) to add one.
- [196](#) Cannot create an [Import or Export] Agent. Use Customize - Database - Import/Export to add an [Import or Export] template.
- [197](#) Multimedia functions unavailable.
- [198](#) Couldn't open multimedia file: <*file name*>.
- [200](#) Cannot display the legend. Select a color code template first.

- [202](#) The view will not be displayed because a field of type <field type> was not found in this category.
- [203](#) No image packs have been installed.
- [204](#) The Time Conflict layout you selected is not valid. Try again.
- [205](#) Couldn't create a default view for the <category name> category. The maximum number of views may have been reached.
- [206](#) The combined fields exceed the number of fields allowed by the view. Please remove some fields before saving.
- [207](#) The latest possible start time using this time interval is <time>.
- [208](#) The date, start time or end time field has not been selected or is invalid for this function. Choose your selections with the Customize-Design View-Fields command.
- [209](#) A required field was set to '(none)'. The appropriate default field(s) have been selected.
- [210](#) The Calendar layout you selected is not valid. Try again.
- [211](#) Select an item in the calendar. The highlight must be positioned on the name of the item to select it.
- [212](#) Please enter a valid time for the Start Time of the Calendar.
- [213](#) The start date or end date field has not been selected or is invalid for this function. Choose your selections with the Customize-Design View-Fields command.
- [214](#) The Gantt layout you selected is not valid. Try again.
- [215](#) Enter an Indent value greater than or equal to zero and less than [5.0 inches or 12.7 centimeters].

- [216](#) Time Conflict checking requires that the category have at least one date and one time field. Either edit the category and add the required fields or select a different category.
- [217](#) The Highlight color must be changed so it is different from the Background color, otherwise the view highlight will not be visible.
- [218](#) Decrease the field width to between 1 and 150 columns.
- [219](#) The field height must be between 1 and 750 lines.
- [220](#) Add at least one field to this view before saving it.
- [221](#) Enter a valid [horizontal or vertical] spacing between zero and [5.0 inches or 12.7 centimeters].
- [225](#) Vertical reports can have between 1 and 20 columns. Horizontal reports can have only one column.
- [229](#) Connected fields can have a total of 750 lines. The total you have entered is *<number>* lines. Either set the number of instances to *<number>* or set the field height to *<number>*, or simply decrease both values.
- [230](#) The number of instances must be between 1 and 750.
- [232](#) No more fields can be included in this report. Remove some fields first if you wish to add others.
- [233](#) For connected fields, Commence can only sort on the Name field in the connected category. You have selected a connected field that is not the Name field.
- [234](#) You have selected a type of field that Commence cannot sort on. Please select a different field.
- [240](#) This file is not in the proper format: '*<filename>*'.
- [241](#) [Backup, Restore] did not complete.
- [244](#) The backup file cannot be created in the database directory. Select a different directory for the backup file.

- [245](#) The [definition] could not be transferred in because the [definition] was not found in this database.
- [246](#) This database is password protected. Make sure you remember its password because you will need to know it when it is restored.
- [247](#) The file '<filename>' is a backup file and must be restored using Open/Manage Database - Restore.
- [248](#) The file '<filename>' is a transfer file and must be handled using Transfer In.
- [249](#) The file '<filename>' is a sync link file and must be handled using Sync Link In.
- [250](#) The transfer or sync file '<filename>' is from a newer version of Commence and cannot be processed. You must upgrade to the newer version in order to process this file.
- [251](#) The transfer or sync file '<filename>' is from a older version of Commence and cannot be processed.
- [260](#) Could not execute DDE command!
- [262](#) Could not communicate with application: <application name>.
- [270](#) Check the export template. It does not match the data. Commence cannot continue exporting.
- [271](#) Define the category <category name> so that Commence can import the file.
- [272](#) Enter a positive number less than 32,767 for the Start and End positions.
- [274](#) Commence cannot save an imported item. The import will end.
- [275](#) Unrecognized format in the import file. Make sure file is in DIF format.
- [276](#) Commence did not find the text delimiter for a field and cannot import the file.

- [277](#) Record *<record number>*, Field *<field name>* of this import file does not map to a field, and Commence cannot continue importing.
- [278](#) There are no items in the export category.
- [279](#) Make the 'End Position' greater than the 'Start Position'.
- [280](#) You defined field positions for *<field name>* that overlap with those defined for *<field name>*.
- [281](#) Commence cannot save the template. The item name field must map to an import field.
- [282](#) Delete this import template. It is associated with a category that no longer exists.
- [283](#) The specified file is not in the proper format (*<file format>*).
- [284](#) The dBASE field *<field name>* cannot be imported into the Commence field *<field name>*. They are of conflicting types.
- [285](#) The number of columns in this DIF file (*<number>*) is not the same as was given in the import template. Commence cannot continue importing.
- [286](#) Record *<number>*, Field *<number>* of this import file *<error condition>*. Commence cannot continue importing.
- [287](#) Cannot add more fields. Cannot import from a file with more than 102 fields.
- [288](#) Record *<record>* is too long to be imported.
- [289](#) Record *<record>*, Field *<field>* of this import file *<condition>*. Commence cannot continue importing. The field's value is *<value>*.
- [290](#) The maximum number (500000) of items was reached for this category. Not all records were imported.

- [291](#) Import field *<field 1>*, mapped to Commence field *<field 2>*, must be given start and end positions.
- [294](#) The number of fields in this file does not match the number defined in the import template. Cannot import.
- [295](#) The Commence mandatory field *<field>* is not mapped to an import field and has no default string defined. Halting import.
- [296](#) There were connections to unknown items in the *<category name>* category (for example, the item *<item name>*.) These connections could not be made.
- [297](#) Commence cannot save the template because the mapping is not valid for this category.
- [298](#) Cannot find matching memo file: *<filename>*.
- [299](#) Experienced internal error during import - call technical support.
- [300](#) You cannot delete the active Database.
- [301](#) Please enter text for the template before saving.
- [302](#) To define a color code, a category must have a check box, a selection field, or a connection field. The selected category contains none of these fields. Please select another category.
- [303](#) You have selected an item more than once. Select unique items.
- [304](#) Delete the invalid keyword *<keyword>* from the letter template.
- [305](#) There is not a data file field in the category *<category name>*.
- [308](#) Text letter templates are limited to 16000 characters. You have reached this limit. If you are pasting from the clipboard, reduce the amount of text being pasted and try again.
- [309](#) Select a category for the phone log.

- [310](#) The telephone number format is unrecognized and cannot be dialed.
- [311](#) Commence cannot dial because the phone line is currently in use. Please try again later when the phone line is free.
- [312](#) Commence cannot add *<path>* as a database since it is the *<directory type>*.
- [313](#) You cannot delete the active desktop.
- [317](#) The selected Icon Directory is not a valid directory. Please change the selection with the Edit-Preferences-Tool Bars command.
- [318](#) You must either change the number of digits required or enter *<number>* digits.
- [319](#) The selected External Data File Directory is not a valid directory. Please change the selection with the Edit-Preferences-Other command.
- [322](#) TXT is reserved for use with Text Letters only. Enter a different formatted letter extension.
- [323](#) Delete an existing [Agent, Category, Connection, View, Icon View, Menu View, Field, Template, Database, Form] before adding another. The maximum amount has been reached.
- [324](#) Please provide a name for the [Category, Connections, Form, Template, Item, Field, View] .
- [325](#) The name for [Agent, Template, View, First Connection, Second Connection, Import Template, Database, Item, Form, Field, Category] already exists. Use a different name.
- [326](#) The database *<database name>* already uses this path. Use a different path name.
- [327](#) In order to schedule a meeting a category (including date, start time and end time fields) must be selected.

- [328](#) The database <*database name*> already exists. Use a different name.
- [329](#) The desktop <*desktop name*> already exists. Use a different name.
- [330](#) The item <item name> already exists. Use a different name.
- [331](#) The selection <selection name> already exists. Use a different name.
- [370](#) The new password did not verify correctly; please enter the new password again.
- [371](#) Unable to change password, the old password is incorrect. Please enter the old password again.
- [372](#) A password must be set for the database to be password protected; either turn off the password checkbox or set a password.
- [373](#) Cannot add an item. No categories have been defined.
- [374](#) Cannot save User Item information. No item selected.
- [375](#) Cannot save User Item information in a database with no categories.
- [400](#) Enter a value for the filter.
- [401](#) The view <*view name*> cannot be used as a primary view since it does not have connections to other active views. Select a different primary view, try linking by date or start an appropriate secondary view.
- [402](#) The filter for view <*view name*> cannot be modified to link the views. Clear the filter and try again.
- [403](#) The category <category name> does not have any Date fields and cannot be linked by date. Select a different secondary view or try linking by connection.
- [404](#) One of your filters is set to 'OR (All Items)'. This will cause all items to be selected regardless of the settings of any other filters. Please select the

summary tab and change the AND/OR relationship to make your filter work.

[405](#) Enter the search text.

[406](#) The two views are already linked. Specify different views to link or select Cancel.

[407](#) The secondary view must have a date field but there are no active views with date fields. Start a secondary view that has a date field or use the 'Connected to highlighted item' option.

[408](#) Please enter a valid telephone number.

[409](#) Invalid field value specified, could not process <>.

[410](#) There is no item to copy.

[411](#) The maximum number (500000) of items has been reached for category <*category name*>. You must delete an existing item before adding a new one.

[412](#) The date <*date field*> is not valid.

[413](#) The recognizer is busy. Try again later.

[414](#) The default value entered is not valid for this field. Try again.

[415](#) Can't display this item.

[416](#) Please enter a valid Start and End date before continuing.

[418](#) The 'Related Recurring' connection could not be added for this category. You must either delete a field or a connection before recurring date items in this category can be associated.

[420](#) No items were added. No actual dates match the recurring date specification.

[421](#) You can only send letters from a book view, a report view or while editing a previously saved item.

[422](#) There is no window open, so no letter can be sent.

- [423](#) Commence cannot log this letter. Select a log category first using Edit-Preferences-Event Logs.
- [424](#) There are no letter templates defined for this category. You can define letter templates using Customize-Database-Letter Template.
- [425](#) Commence cannot save the letter. Make sure you have selected a valid directory for saving logged letters using Edit-Preferences-Event Logs.
- [426](#) This view has been modified. You must save the view in order to print letters to all with a formatted text template.
- [429](#) One Item Per Region must be set for layouts that contain multiple regions.
- [431](#) This page layout is too *<narrow/wide/short/tall>* for this type of view. Select a *<wider/narrower/shorter/taller>* layout.
- [433](#) Enter page width and height values greater than zero.
- [434](#) You have not selected a printer. Choose 'Printer Setup' from the Home menu in order to print.
- [435](#) Enter region width and height values greater than zero.
- [436](#) Reduce the internal margins to fit in the region width and height.
- [437](#) Enter a number between 1 and 100 for the number of copies.
- [438](#) Enter a starting label number greater than zero.
- [439](#) Enter a 'To' date that is after the 'From' date.
- [440](#) Enter valid dates for the 'From' and 'To' fields.
- [442](#) Commence will not begin printing. There is no way to cancel the print job.
- [443](#) An error occurred while printing. Check the printer.

- [446](#) Reduce the page margins or region sizes to fit in the page width and height.
- [447](#) This is the default page layout. It cannot be deleted (change the default to a different page layout before deleting this layout).
- [448](#) Invalid label template or improper paper size. Check the settings and try again.
- [449](#) Could not locate at least one font with a size of 8, 10, or 12 points.
- [450](#) There aren't enough lines with the available fonts to print within the Commence margins. Reduce the top or bottom margins to allow more space.
- [451](#) There is not enough disk space for print spooling.
- [452](#) The starting label number should be between 1 and *<number>*.
- [453](#) This view cannot print using One Item Per Region. Change the layout template or print from a report view.
- [454](#) This view can only print in multiple regions using One Item Per Region. Change the layout template.
- [500](#) Select from the list first.
- [501](#) Enter a valid whole number.
- [502](#) Enter a whole number greater than zero.
- [503](#) The End [Date or Time] cannot be sooner than the Start [Date or Time].
- [504](#) COMMDLG.DLL returned error code *<error code>*. Commence cannot continue the current operation.
- [505](#) Enter a valid file name.
- [506](#) A data conversion error was encountered while processing '*<database name>*' (error code *<error code>*). Data converter '*<converter name>*' cannot continue.

- [507](#) Data conversion initialization failed. Data conversion cannot complete (initial database version - final database version).
- [508](#) The path entry must not be blank. Enter a valid path specification or use the Select button to locate one.
- [509](#) Data converter [converter name] is an incompatible version (expected: [version number], actual: [version number]). Data conversion cannot continue.
- [510](#) Please enter a number between 1 and 30000, inclusive.
- [511](#) The specified directory name does not exist. Please enter a new directory name.
- [512](#) Directory '<directory name>' already exists.
- [513](#) Cannot find file <filename>; check to ensure the path and filename are correct.
- [514](#) An error was encountered while re-indexing database <database name>. Commence will now exit.
- [515](#) Please enter a valid file extension before saving.
- [516](#) Incorrect password. Try again or select Cancel.
- [517](#) The database <database name> is invalid. Please select another database.
- [518](#) The database <database name> is currently locked. Either it is being accessed by another user or was improperly closed. Please wait five minutes or select another database.
- [519](#) The Tutorial database is currently being accessed by another copy of Commence. Tutorial mode is not available.
- [520](#) The [Windows directory, Windows System directory, Commence Program directory, Commence Tutorial directory, root directory, DOS directory] cannot be used; select another directory.

- [521](#) Cannot change to this Database. It no longer exists. Create the directory or delete this database entry.
- [522](#) An error was encountered while converting database '%s'. Commence will now exit.
- [523](#) Invalid or unrecognized database specified (<*database name*>); Commence will now exit.
- [524](#) Commence is unable to open the Database selected because of low disk space. Free up at least <space> on drive <drive> and try again.
- [525](#) The data in the specified database requires a newer version of Commence to be used.
- [526](#) Commence cannot find the Tutorial files. Tutorial mode will not be available.
- [527](#) The tutorial.cmp file could not be found. New tutorial data will not be loaded.
- [528](#) The file <*filename*> contains nonprintable characters and can not be pasted.
- [529](#) Cannot paste the entire file. The file may be too large to paste here.
- [530](#) No telephone number is available for this operation.
- [531](#) Invalid or unrecognized command line option detected (<*command line option*>); it will be ignored.
- [532](#) The data in the specified database requires a special version of Commence. Please contact your vendor.
- [533](#) This type of window cannot be [filtered, arranged, sorted, printed].
- [534](#) The 'CONVERT.LOG' file in the database directory will have more information about the error(s) that were encountered. To recover the original database use the backup file created earlier.
- [535](#) Data conversion encountered an error while writing data to disk. Free up some disk space and try again.

You will need to restore the original data using the backup file created earlier.

[536](#) '<*database name*>' is a partially converted database from an earlier data conversion attempt. Restore the original data from backup and try again. If you are having difficulty converting your data please contact technical support for assistance.

[537](#) '<*database name*>' is an unsupported version and cannot be converted. Restore the original data from backup and try again. If you are having difficulty converting your data please contact technical support for assistance. (<*conversion name*>)

[538](#) No windows are available for [sort, filter, layout, print, tile, cascade].

[539](#) Please enter a valid directory name before proceeding.

[540](#) The <*database name*> database is locked and cannot be used with this version of Commence.

[543](#) There is nothing to delete.

[544](#) The '<*field name*>' field is full; additional data cannot be pasted in.

[545](#) The '<*field name*>' field is full; pasted data was truncated.

[546](#) The view '<*view name*>' is filtered by the User Item. The User Item is not defined. Use Edit-Preferences-Personal Info to define it.

[547](#) Commence Internal Error.

[548](#) Commence cannot dial a phone number in a connected field.

[549](#) The data in <*database*> is from an earlier version of Commence and cannot be used with this version of Commence. The data can be converted to work properly with this version of Commence, contact your vendor or technical support for information.

- [550](#) There is not enough memory available for this operation.
- [571](#) Commence cannot obtain a system timer. Commence will now exit.
- [575](#) Close a window. There are too many open windows.
- [576](#) You need to select a printer in order for printer fonts to be available.
- [577](#) Select an item from the Font Name list.
- [578](#) Select or enter a valid font size greater than 0 points and no more than 255 points.
- [579](#) Windows Telephony services have been disabled, dialing is not available.
- [580](#) The Windows Telephony driver encountered an error. Commence cannot continue dialing.
- [581](#) This image was stored under Windows for Pens, and cannot be read with this version of Windows. Use Windows for Pens to display the image.
- [582](#) This image was stored under a newer version of Windows, and cannot be read with this version of Windows. Use the new version of Windows to display the image.
- [583](#) This image was stored under an older version of Windows, and cannot be read with this version of Windows.
- [584](#) There is not enough memory to perform spell checking.
- [590](#) There is no [Extensions] information in WIN.INI for file '*<file name>*'.
- [594](#) Commence cannot find configuration data in COMMENCE.INI. Commence will now exit.
- [595](#) The database information in DATABASE.INI is missing or invalid. Commence will now exit.

- [596](#) Windows Telephony is not installed or is configured improperly. Use the Control Panel Telephone applet to configure. Commence cannot continue dialing.
- [597](#) Commence is unable to start application for '*<application name>*'. (Windows returned error code *<error code>*.)
- [598](#) Windows Telephony is not available with this version of Windows
- [600](#) *<item>*: Not *<action>*.
- [606](#) Unable to open '*<filename>*'.
- [607](#) Unable to open '*<filename>*'. The disk currently in drive '*<drive letter>*' might be disk number '*<number>*'.
- [611](#) Unable to create '*<directory name/filename>*'.
- [612](#) '*<directory name>*' is an invalid directory name.
- [613](#) Unable to read '*<filename>*'.
- [623](#) Unable to write '*<filename>*'.
- [633](#) There is no image to copy to a file.
- [634](#) There is a disk error. Commence cannot copy the image to a file.
- [635](#) This type of image cannot be copied to a file.
- [636](#) Commence cannot continue importing due to an error; please check the available disk space.
- [637](#) Commence cannot continue importing because of a disk error on the file *<filename>*.
- [638](#) There is a disk error on the file '*<filename>*'.
Commence cannot continue exporting.
- [639](#) Unable to delete '*<directory name/filename>*'.
- [640](#) There is a disk error. Commence RM cannot copy the view to the HTML file.
- [643](#) Commence cannot find the file '*<filename>*' on the disk.

- [644](#) Commence cannot load the file '<filename>'. It or one of its components was not found on the disk.
- [645](#) Commence cannot load the program '<program name>'. Be sure that it is installed correctly.
- [646](#) Insufficient disk space on drive %s to complete this operation. Free up at least <number> bytes of disk space and try again.
- [647](#) Warning: Data disk space is below <size>. To reclaim disk space, delete or archive any unused categories or remove any non-Commence files from your <drive letter> disk drive.
- [648](#) Commence was unable to delete the directory '<directory name>'.
- [649](#) Commence cannot access the directory '<directory name>'.
- [650](#) The directory '<directory name>' is empty or no longer exists.
- [651](#) Unexpected end of file on input file '<filename>'.
- [652](#) The input file '<filename>' is an invalid file type.
- [653](#) The input sync file '<filename>' is invalid for the current database.
- [660](#) Spell-checker Error - Word Not Found
- [661](#) Spell-checker Error - No Data Available
- [662](#) Spell-checker Error - No Aid Available
- [663](#) Spell-checker Error - Invalid Word Construction
- [664](#) Spell-checker Error - Too Many Dictionaries Open
- [665](#) Spell-checker Error - Dictionary is Not Updateable
- [666](#) Spell-checker Error - Updateable Dictionary Full
- [667](#) Spell-checker Error - Duplicate Dictionary
- [668](#) Spell-checker Error - Invalid Dictionary Name
- [669](#) Spell-checker Error - Bad Dictionary
- [670](#) Spell-checker Error - LEXAM Not Initialized

- [671](#) Spell-checker Error - Invalid Function
- [672](#) Spell-checker Error - Invalid Token in Dictionary List
- [673](#) Spell-checker Error - Invalid Word
- [674](#) Spell-checker Error - Illegal Input Flag Combination
- [675](#) Spell-checker Error - Missing or Illegal Value in
Parameter Area
- [676](#) Spell-checker Error - Passback Too Small
- [677](#) Spell-checker Error - Filename Not Allowed for
Updateable Dictionary
- [678](#) Spell-checker Error - Illegal Number of Dictionaries
- [679](#) Spell-checker Error - LEXAM Busy
- [680](#) Spell-checker Error - Memory Allocation Error
- [681](#) Spell-checker Error - File Not Found
- [682](#) Spell-checker Error - Path Not Found
- [683](#) Spell-checker Error - File Open Failed
- [684](#) Spell-checker Error - File Access Denied
- [685](#) Spell-checker Error - File Sharing Violation
- [686](#) Spell-checker Error - General File I/O Error
- [690](#) No spelling mistakes were found.
- [691](#) The spell-checker cannot locate the spelling
dictionary, <*dictionary name*>.
- [692](#) There was a system error in the spell-checker.
- [693](#) You may spell check only text fields.
- [800](#) Could not send e-mail, no mail programs are available.
Select Edit-Preferences-Other Apps to add e-mail
information.
- [801](#) E-mail services are not available; JJMAIL32.DLL not found or
wrong version.
- [802](#) Could not send e-mail. An error occurred while interacting
with your e-mail program.
- [803](#) No web browser detected. Please install an Internet browser
program and try again.

- [804](#) Could not launch web browser. An error occurred while interacting with your browser program.
- [805](#) An error occurred during synchronization with Outlook. Check the Message Log for more information.
- [806](#) Synchronization with Outlook was cancelled.
- [807](#) Microsoft Outlook could not be loaded; verify that the required version of Outlook is installed.
- [808](#) Could not logon to Microsoft Outlook; verify that your email preferences are set correctly.
- [809](#) The Outlook integration services could not be loaded.
- [810](#) The Outlook preferences should be configured using the Edit-Preferences-Other Apps dialog before using this command.
- [920](#) View '*<view name>*' cannot use color code '*<color code template name>*' (wrong category).
- [921](#) Transfer error: <error condition>
- [1016](#) This database is not empty and may not be used as a remote database.
- [1030](#) The remote database must have a unique name.
- [1031](#) A remote database must be selected; if a remote database is not defined, use the Add button to create one.
- [1036](#) SyncLink error: Accessing admin files failed.
- [1037](#) SyncLink error: disk write to output file or temporary directory failed.
- [1038](#) SyncLink error: reading or writing the database data files failed.
- [1039](#) SyncLink error: this stand-alone database must be used with a SyncLink file containing an initial sync.
- [1043](#) An error was encountered while initializing the database for SyncLink. SyncLink cannot continue.

Workgroup Error Message Index

[1000](#) Couldn't make items shared.

[1001](#) Shared categories with local fields are not allowed in this version of Commence.

[1002](#) You have marked the field *<fieldname>* as shared but the category is not shared. No fields in a non-shared category may be shared.

[1003](#) This database cannot create remote databases because it is not a client database.

[1004](#) This stand-alone database cannot be used with SyncLink; create a remote database in order to use SyncLink.

[1010](#) The permissions you have been granted do not allow this operation.

[1011](#) The permissions you have been granted do not allow you to add this shared *<data or definition>*.

[1012](#) The permissions you have been granted do not allow you to edit this shared *<data or definition>*.

[1013](#) The permissions you have been granted do not allow you to delete this shared *<data or definition>*.

[1015](#) The permissions you have been granted do not allow you to overwrite this shared *<view name>*.

[1017](#) The Login ID field is required for a valid login.

[1018](#) An error occurred accessing the Administration library.

[1019](#) Login was not successful. Try again or select Cancel.

[1020](#) The permissions you have been granted do not allow you to access this database.

[1021](#) The Admin directory could not be located or does not contain the proper admin files.

[1024](#) This version of Commence requires a different version of the Administration library.

[1025](#) An error occurred while using this database with the Administration library.

[1026](#) The server has failed to respond to the sync request; check that the server is running.

[1027](#) The database is not connected to the server and automatic syncing will be disabled.

[1028](#) This database is enrolled for a different user; select a different data directory or enter a different login name.

[1029](#) An error occurred while registering this client. Check the Message Log for additional information.

[1032](#) The Login ID was not found. It may have been deleted, or it does not exist.

[1033](#) The automatic login failed; please enter login name and password.

[1034](#) The Commence server license is not valid for the number of users defined in ComAdmin. Please use the License utility to update Commence with a valid license that authorizes *<number>* users.

[1042](#) Commence has detected an invalid filetype during syncing; use Transfer Out and In to a new database to correct this problem.

[1050](#) A workgroup error has occurred. ADMINENG.DLL returned error code *<error code>*.

[1051](#) *<Key>* is not a valid authorization key. Enter the key exactly as it appears on your instruction sheet. There should be no spaces or punctuations.

[1052](#) Template file for the client instruction sheet was not found *<template filename>*. Instruction sheet cannot be generated.

[1053](#) Server communication parameters not found. Please configure the server using the Customize-Workgroup command.

[1054](#) Commence cannot run while a copy of the Commence Administration program is active. Shut down ComAdmin before starting Commence.

[1055](#) The workgroup admin files are currently locked either by ComAdmin or another copy of Commence. Try again later.

[1056](#) Could not find the database registration information from the server. Verify that your communication parameters are entered correctly.

If problems persist, contact your Commence administrator to:

1. verify that your instruction sheet is up-to-date, and,
2. arrange for the server to re-send the registration information.

[1057](#) The communication settings for this workgroup database are missing or invalid and automatic syncing is disabled for this session.

To re-start syncing:

1. Use the Customize-Workgroup command to enter the correct communication parameters, or,
2. Connect to the network and re-start Commence.

[1058](#) The communication settings for this database are missing or invalid. Select the Configure button to change the settings.

[1059](#) Shared LAN directory is unavailable and synchronization is disabled.

Defined Terms Index

[action](#)

[activate](#)

[active](#)

[active category.](#)

[active view](#)

[active window](#)

[agent](#)

[agent tool bar](#)

[arrange](#)

[associated category.](#)

[backup](#)

[base database](#)

[busy bar](#)

[calculation field](#)

[category.](#)

[check box](#)

[check box field](#)

[clarify field](#)

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[data file field](#)
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[filter](#)
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[prefix string](#)

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[uniform resource locator \(url\)](#)
[update file](#)
[url](#)
[url address field](#)
[view](#)
[view bar](#)
[view type](#)
[wildcard pattern](#)

work area

Keyboard Commands and Mouse Shortcuts

You can use Commence with a keyboard only, or a mouse and keyboard. A mouse is recommended because it makes working in the Microsoft Windows environment easier.

The following topics explain the keyboard equivalents for those activities in Commence that do not require a mouse.

- the keys you use to select [menu commands](#)
- keys you use to fill out a [dialog box](#) or detail form
- keys you can use to select from and scroll through a [multiple selection list box](#)
- keys you use to arrange fields on a [detail form](#)
- keys you use to navigate around a [view](#) (in particular, the key equivalents for the calendar view control panel)
- [window control](#) keys

Two activities, however, cannot be performed without the aid of a mouse:

- choosing a view icon from the [view bar](#)
- choosing a command icon from the [tool bar](#)

We also list some [mouse shortcuts](#) that you can use in many dialog boxes within Commence.

Valid Field Codes or Keywords

[See Also](#)

General Commence keywords

<u>Keyword</u>	<u>Evaluates To</u>
(-ProgramDir-)	The full path to COMMENCE.EXE, e.g., c:\program files\commence
(-ProgramExe-)	The full path and filename of the COMMENCE.EXE, e.g., c:\program files\commence\commence.exe
(-AppDataDir-)	The full path to the Application Data Directory where user-created files and interactive files are stored by default (e.g. backups, exports, etc.) e.g., c:\program data\commence\commence\7.5 or c:\documents and settings\all users\application data\commence\commence\7.5
(-DatabasePath-)	The full path of the currently active database.
(-DatabaseName-)	The Name of the currently active database.
(-Category-)	The name of the current category.

The following keywords are supported in Filters.

<u>Keyword</u>	<u>Evaluates To</u>
(-Me-)	The item name selected in Preferences - Personal Info (found under the Customize menu or Edit menu depending on your version of Commence)
(-Date-)	The current date. In a date type field, this is equivalent to Today. In any other field, it is equivalent to today's date in long format, e.g. January 01, 2010.

(-Time-)	The current time. In a time type field, this is equivalent to Now. In any other field, it is equivalent to the current time, e.g. 1:34PM.
(-StartDate-)	The start of the date range displayed in the most recently active Calendar view. This is used for View Linking and Multi-View filtering
(-EndDate-)	The end of the date range displayed in the most recently active Calendar view. This is used for View Linking and Multi-View filtering. e.g., filter for all items in which the Date field Is Between (-StartDate-) and (-EndDate-)
(-SelectedDate-)	The selected date of the most recently active Calendar view. This is used for View Linking and Multi-View filtering.
(-SelectedItem-)	The highlighted item in the primary view. This is used for View Linking and Multi-View filtering.
(-SelectedText-)	Search string for field(s) in the primary view. This is used for Multi-View filtering.

In addition to the keywords listed above, agents also recognize the following (in filters, or when assigning field values, or when configuring DDE, etc.):

<u>Keyword</u>	<u>Evaluates To</u>
(-Clear-)	Will clear the current field value. This is valid for all field types, including Connections.
(-ClearAll-)	Will clear all connected items, regardless of any filter.
(-ClearFiltered-)	Will only clear items that match the applied filter.
(-TriggerItemName-)	The Name of the Trigger item.

(%Trig%%*FieldName*%)

The selected field value of the Trigger item. Refers to a direct field in the trigger category.

(%Trig%%*Connection Name*%%*To Category Name*%%*FieldName*%)

The selected field value of the Trigger item. Refers to an indirect field in a connected category.

(%Cond1%%*FieldName*%)

The selected field value of the Condition 1 item. Refers to a direct field in the category specified in Condition 1.

If there is more than one condition item, will use the first item.

(%Cond1%%*Connection Name*%%*To Category Name*%%*FieldName*%)

The selected field value of the Condition 1 item.

If there is more than one condition item, will use the first item.

(%Cond2%%*FieldName*%)

The selected field value of the Condition 2 item. Refers to a direct field in the category specified in Condition 2.

If there is more than one condition item, will use the first item.

(%Cond2%%*Connection Name*%%*To Category Name*%%*FieldName*%)

The selected field value of the Condition 2 item. Refers to an indirect field in a connected category.

If there is more than one condition item, will use the first item.

(%FieldName%)

The field value from the selected trigger or condition.

**(%Connection Name%%To
Category Name%%FieldName%)**

The field value from the selected trigger or condition.
Refers to an indirect field in a connected category.

The following keywords are only valid for Incoming Communication: Telephone Call agents and their actions: Note: Not all values are valid in all phone systems.

Keyword

Evaluates To

(-PhoneCallerName-)

Name of the caller.

(-PhoneCallerID-)

ID of the caller.

(-PhoneLine-)

The phone line.

The following keywords are only valid for Incoming Communication: E-Mail agents and their actions:

Keyword

Evaluates To

(-EmailSenderName-)

The Name of the sender.

(-EmailSenderAddress-)

The address of the sender.

(-EmailSubject-)

The subject of the message.

(-EmailMessage-)

The text of the message.

(-EmailStatus-)

The Read/Unread status of the message.

(-EmailDate-)

The date the message was sent.

(-EmailTime-)

The time the message was sent.

Command Line Options

[See Also](#)

You can customize your Commence shortcut by adding the following options to the end of the **Target**, e.g., "**c:\program files (x86)\commence\commence rm workgroup\commence.exe**" **/PROMPT /TRACE**.

Tips - To get started, right click on your Commence shortcut and choose Properties. Click in the Target box and use the END key on your keyboard to go to the end of this line. Start typing your command line options after the quote marks. You can add more than one command line option; just put a space between each one.

/QUIET

If you need to open more than one Commence database at the same time, use this option to suppress the warning message that there is another copy of Commence running. Commence will quietly go ahead and start another instance.

/DATABASE=database name

Will start Commence and open the named database. **Do not use quote marks around the database name.** Also note the forward slash character is not supported in database names.

/DATABASE=database path

Will start Commence and open the database located in the
named directory.

/PROMPT

Will present a list of installed databases so you can select one to open.

/NOVIEWS

Will not open any views when starting Commence. Note the View bar icons will also be hidden temporarily. Switching to a different desktop once in Commence will restore all views and view icons.

/NOAGENTS

Will prevent agent processing from occurring while Commence is running. This is useful if you think you have an agent that is causing problems with your database.

/NOTAPI

Will prevent Commence from loading and using TAPI. If used, Commence will not be able to auto-dial.

/TRACE

Will place additional information into the active.log file. The use of this option may be requested by Commence Technical Support to assist in troubleshooting.

/REINDEX

Will create new indices for all items when starting Commence. Depending on the size of the database and the number of items, this may take a while. If so, the PC should not be rebooted and you should wait until the reindexing has completed.

Database Capacities

The following lists the maximum allowed of the listed item.

All of the following are per database

Categories 800

Connections 1000

Views 2000

Color Codes 1000

Import/Export templates 600

Agents 1000

Letter Templates 600

Desktops 100

Tool Bar Pick agents 100

The following are per Desktop

View Bar views 50

View Bar Icon labels 50 characters

Views menu views 40

Menu Pick agents 16

Open views 20

All of the following are per category

Items 500,000

Detail Forms 50

Fields (includes Name field and connections) 250

Other:

Selections in a combo box 4000

Databases 1000

Tabs per detail form 25

Data Manipulation Functions

[See Also](#)

Commence supports functions that permit data manipulation. These functions can be used for numeric calculations and date/time manipulations. These functions can be used in calculation fields and in agents. The following table lists the available data manipulation functions (also known as @ functions).

Function Returns value:

@ABS(x) absolute value of x

@INT(x) integer value of x (truncates the decimal places)

@AVG(x,y, . . . ,z) average of values

@MAX(x,y, . . . ,z) maximum of the values

@MIN(x,y, . . . ,z) minimum of the values

@DATE(date) numeric value of date. Date can be any date or natural language date such as Today.

@DAY(date) day component of the date (1 . . . 31)

@MONTH(date) month component of the date (1 . . . 12)

@YEAR(date) year component of the date (1600 . . . 2999)

@DOW(date) day of the week for the date (0=Sunday, 1=Monday, etc.)

@QTR(date) quarter of the year in which the date falls (1 . . . 4)

@TIME(time) numeric value of time. Time can be any date or natural language time such as "Now"

@HOUR(time) hour component of the time (0 . . . 24)

@MINUTE(time) minute component of the time (0 . . . 59)

@AGE(date) age in years. The age calculation is based on today's date. If the date is in the future, @AGE returns 0.

@POW(x,y) x^y (x raised to the y-th power).

@FV(Payment,Rate,Term) future value of an ordinary annuity of equal *Payments*, earning a fixed interest *Rate* per term, compounded over several *Terms*. It is assumed that the first *Payment* is at the end of the first period. The formula used is:

$$\frac{\text{Payment} \left((1 + \text{Rate})^{\text{Term}} - 1 \right)}{\text{Rate}}$$

@PV(Payment,Rate,Term) present value of an ordinary annuity of equal *Payments*, earning a fixed interest *Rate* per term, over several *Terms*. It is assumed that the first *Payment* is at the end of the first term. The formula used is:

$$\frac{\text{Payment} \left(1 - (1 + \text{Rate})^{-\text{Term}} \right)}{\text{Rate}}$$

@PMT(Principal,Rate,Term) the periodic payment for a *Principal* based upon a fixed interest *Rate* per compounding period over a given *Term*. The formula used is:

$$\frac{(\text{Present Value})(\text{Rate})}{(1 - (1 + \text{Rate})^{-\text{Term}})}$$

@RATE(FutureValue,PresentValue,Term)
the fixed interest rate per compounding period needed for *PresentValue* to grow to *FutureValue* over *Term*. The formula used is:

$$(\text{FutureValue}/\text{PresentValue})^{1/\text{Term}} - 1$$

@TERM(Payment,Rate,FutureValue)
the number of compounding periods necessary for a series of equal *Payments*, earning a fixed interest *Rate*, to grow to *FutureValue*.

@LN(x) the natural logarithm of x.

@LOG(x) the base 10 logarithm of x.

@ROUND(x, y) Rounds a number to a specified number of digits.

In the above list, x, y, and z must be valid numeric arguments, and date and time must be valid date and time strings, such as "January 1," "Today," "Now," and "Noon." The values for Payment, Principle, PresentValue, FutureValue are all number or currency values. Rate is a percentage, without the %, i.e. 9.00 for 9.00%. The value for term is a number value, for example, 12 for 12 months or 1 for 1 year. If you use these functions with mismatched arguments, for example @DAY([Start Time]), the results will be unpredictable.

It is suggested that arguments be enclosed in double quotation marks (" ") since the field substitution may introduce commas or quotation marks which will alter the result of the function. For example, if using the function @MAX([Number], 500) and Number is "1,200", the result would be "500" since Commence would interpret it as @MAX(1,200,500), which is three numbers. If the function is changed to be @MAX("[Number]",500), the correct result "1,200" would be returned.

Note: When defining an Add Item or Edit Item agent action, Commence will automatically add the double quote delimiters.

Book View Type

[See Also](#)

The book [view type](#) displays [items](#) in a window that looks like an address book. Any [category](#) can be displayed in a view using the book view type.

An example is the Address Book view included with Commence; it is a book view of the Person/Company category.

Items are arranged alphabetically in the book. Each page in the book displays a letter of the alphabet at the top of the page; items appearing on the page have an item name field that begins with that letter of the alphabet. Items beginning with numbers or special characters (including a tab or space) appear under the # character.

The book view provides the following controls:

ALPHABETIC TABS

To see items in the view whose item name fields begin with a particular letter, use your mouse to select the appropriate tab on the left or right side of the book. You can also type the letter on your keyboard to go to the first page of items that begin with the letter typed. A grayed tab indicates that there are no items in the view beginning with that letter.

FOLDED PAGE CORNERS

Select a folded corner at the top of the page with your mouse (or use the left and right arrow keys on your keyboard) to move through the book one page at a time. Use the up arrow key on your keyboard to move to the first preceding page that contains an item. Use the down arrow key to move to the first following page that contains an item.

To display the item detail of an item in a book view, double-click the mouse on the item or highlight the item and press the ENTER

key.

Calendar View Type

The calendar [view type](#) is used to display [items](#) that occur on a particular date and have a time interval on that date. A [category](#) must have at least one time field and one date field to be displayed by a view using the calendar view type.

You can display the [item detail](#) of any item displayed by a calendar view in Day display mode (see below) by selecting the item name of the item you want to see. From the other display modes (Two Days Week, Two Weeks, Month, Six Weeks and Year) you can double-click on a date to display the [Calendar Items](#) dialog and then select any item to display its [item detail](#).

The topics listed below explain the various parts and display modes of the calendar view. Select a topic or use the **Browse >>** button to display each topic in order.

[Active Date](#)

[Display Modes](#)

[Calendar Tool Bar](#)

Gantt Chart View Type

[See Also](#)

A Gantt chart [view](#) provides a way to graphically display the durations of [items](#) (such as tasks) that may span more than one day. A category must have at least one date field in order to be used in a Gantt chart view.

The Project category included with Commence is an example of a category that has start date and end date fields and is used in a Gantt chart view. This is displayed in the Project Manager view.

The Gantt chart view type displays item names on the left side of the view window, while the right side of the window displays color coded triangles and horizontal bars to represent the duration of each item according to the time scale displayed at the top.

The time scale for a Gantt chart view can be changed using the [Customize-Design View](#) command and selecting the **Display** [tab](#).

Horizontal bars represent the duration of an item with different start and end dates; triangles are used for items whose start and end dates are the same date (one-day duration items).

A legend that explains the color coding scheme can be displayed by selecting the **Customize-Design View** command and selecting the **Display** [tab](#). You can change the color coding scheme used by a calendar view by selecting a color coding template with the **Customize-Design View** command and selecting the **Colors** tab. You can create new color coding templates using the [Customize-Database](#) command and selecting the **Color Code** tab.

Display the [item detail](#) of an item in a Gantt chart view by double-clicking the mouse on the item name or its associated duration.

Grid View Type

[See Also](#)

A grid view is a type of view that displays data in a row/column format. A grid can be used in two modes: read-only and update mode. When used in read-only mode grid views are similar to reports in many ways. Data can be viewed and printed; items can be rearranged and queried through sorting and filtering; letters can be created, and agents can be fired.

Special field handles are provided for some field types to perform functions unique to that field. These functions work in both update mode and read-only mode. Supported functions include:

- sending an email from an E-Mail Address field
- opening a Web page from an Internet Address (URL) field
- auto-dialing a phone number from a Telephone field
- launching the associated application from a Data File field

Grid Toolbar

The toolbar located at the top of the grid view is similar to that on a detail form. The **Switch Modes** button on this toolbar allows you to toggle between read-only and update mode. In update mode, the data in each row or column can be updated directly in the grid without opening a detail form.

Most of the buttons found on the Grid Toolbar are only used in update mode. All other buttons are inactive in update mode.

Button	Purpose
image/saveplus_shg.gif	SAVE AND ADD ANOTHER: Press this button to save pending changes to the active item and add new row
image/savechk_shg.gif	SAVE: Press this button to save pending changes to the active item.



Moving the cursor to a different item/row also saves all field edits for the previous item.

CANCEL: Press this button to undo changes; revert active item to last saved state.

 [image/cancel_shg.gif](#)

DELETE ITEM (Read-only mode): Press this button to delete the selected item/row.

 [image/delrow_shg.gif](#)

SHARE ITEM: This button is only active for shared categories. Press this button to share the selected item with other clients in the workgroup. Once shared, an item cannot be made local and the button will become inactive.

 [image/share_shg.gif](#)

REFRESH: Press this button to refresh the active view. Toggling from update mode to read-only also refreshes the view automatically

 [image/refresh_shg.gif](#)

SWITCH MODES: Press this button to toggle between read-only and update mode.

 [image/readupd_shg.gif](#)
f



PENDING REFRESH ALERT
(Update mode): This indicator reflects whether there are pending database changes that need to be integrated with the grid view.

Adding and Editing Items

Using a grid view in update mode is equivalent to opening a detail form. Changes can be made to most fields by simply typing directly into the cell. When working with connections or fields with unique properties, special field handles are provided to give you the same flexibility in modifying the field as in Detail Forms.

As records are changed in the database (due to agents, import, workgroup, etc.) the grid view holds these changes in the background allowing you to finish your record updates. The Pending Refresh Alert indicator reflects whether there are pending database changes that need to be integrated with the grid view. Pressing the REFRESH button will make the view include these changes, and will turn off the indicator. Exiting UPDATE mode will also make the grid view include these changes, and will turn off the indicator. When active it indicates that an update has been received or that a change has been made to the view requiring a refresh.

The grid view layout cannot be modified while in update mode. As with detail forms the **Design View**, **Sort View**, and **Filter View** commands on the **Customize** menu are inactive in this mode. The same buttons on the Toolbar are also disabled for a grid view in update mode. Synchronization can occur in the background but does not update the view immediately. This prevents unsaved items from being lost in the process. View refreshes are also suspended. Press the REFRESH button on the grid toolbar to apply and pending view updates to the active grid view.

Read-Only Mode

Using a grid view in read-only mode is very similar to using a report view. Prefix Matching is supported for quickly locating an item by name. The following keyboard shortcuts can also be used to expedite navigating through large views:

Page Up/Down: Set the active row one page above or below the selected row.

Tab/ Enter: Set the active column to the next field.

Shift+Tab: Set the active column to the previous field.

Arrow Keys: Move the cursor one field in the direction of the arrow.

Special Considerations

Grid views share many of the same features as report views and detail forms with a few exceptions. The following features are not supported in a grid view:

Visual Basic Scripting: A script defined on a detail form has no effect on items in a grid view, even in update mode. Any item modifications that affect or are affected by script processing should be performed in a detail form. A detail form can be launched for any item in a grid view by double-clicking on the header for the row, or by selecting the **Edit -> Edit Item** command.

Other preferences: The “Treat Enter like Tab key” preference for detail forms does not apply to grid views, even in update mode. Much like a spreadsheet, the “Enter” key is used to tab from one column to the next in a row. This functionality supercedes any other common uses of the Enter key, such as opening a detail form, saving

item changes, or inserting a carriage return into a large text field.

Keyboard hotkeys: Most keyboard hotkeys and shortcuts will perform different functions or may be suppressed when a grid view is active so that grid view functions can take precedence. Minimizing or closing the grid view restores normal keyboard operation.

Document View Type

The Document view provides a way to integrate Internet and Intranet based applications and pages directly on your Commence desktop. It creates a seamless link between your local data and applications and remote applications and content.

The Document view incorporates the Microsoft Internet Explorer browser, including all of the extensibility, scripting, and programming support offered on the web, including but not limited to HTML, DHTML, VBScript, Javascript, Java objects, and ActiveX controls. This allows you to display HTML content directly from the Commence database or from a remote URL.

Multi-View Type

[See Also](#)

A Multi-View is a set of related views displayed in one window frame. The window is split into two panes, either horizontally or vertically. The top or left pane is the primary window and displays one view. The primary view can be opened as a detail form or as any of the standard view types: Book, Calendar, Gantt, Report, and Grid. The various methods of navigation for these view types is unchanged in a multi-view. For example, you can click on the alphabetic tabs in a Book view or use prefix matching to locate a particular item.

The secondary pane is located either below or to the right of the primary pane. One or more views can be saved in the secondary window, but only one secondary view is displayed at a time. Each view is opened by clicking on the View Tab for that view.

View Tabs

The secondary pane in a multi-view window has a set of VCR-style buttons next to the view tabs. These buttons are used when there are too many secondary views defined to fit all the view tabs on the visible portion of the screen. The first button makes the first view tab visible, the last button makes the last view tab visible, and the middle buttons allow you to scroll right or left one tab at a time. Once you have located the view you wish to open, click on that view tab. Note that the active view is not changed until after you click on the view tab to open a different secondary view.

Using a detail form in the primary pane

When a detail form is saved as the primary window in a multi-view, only one item at a time will be displayed. The Next and Back buttons on the detail form toolbar can be used to navigate

to other items in the view. Closing and reopening a multi-view resets the display to the first item in the view.

Splitter Bar

A splitter bar separates the primary window from the secondary window in a multi-view. By default the primary window is sized to fit 45% of the window. You can adjust the proportions any time after the multi-view has been created by simply dragging the splitter bar on screen.

Report View Type

[See Also](#)

The report [view type](#) displays each [item](#) in a [view](#) in a horizontal row or vertical column format. Any [category](#) can be displayed in a view using the report view type.

The Person/Company, Support Call, and Opportunity categories are examples of categories with views using the report view type.

Items are displayed in a horizontal or vertical format, with one field per column. If a connection definition included in the report contains more values than can fit in a column or row, **(multiple)** appears as the last value for the field, indicating that there are more values in the connection definition. Edit the **Field Options** for the field using the [Customize-Design View](#) command and selecting the **Field** tab increase the size of the connection definition's display area and display more of the values in the report.

To see the [item detail](#) of an item in a report, double-click the mouse on the item or highlight the item and press the ENTER key.

If field labels are displayed, the primary and secondary sort fields are indicated by a solid underline and dotted underline, respectively. You can change the either sort key by pointing at a field label with the mouse and pressing the left (for the primary sort key) or right (for the secondary sort key) mouse buttons. Use the [Customize-Sort View](#) command to change any of the four allowed sort fields.

Report views also allow you to show different groups and sub-totals based upon the fields used for the sort order. See [Customize-Sort View](#) for more information on Report View Groups and Sub-Totals.

Report views provide a great deal of flexibility in the way your data is displayed, though they don't have controls like the other view types. To change the way a report displays your data, you use the **Customize-Design View** command or the

 [image/design_shg.gif](#)

icon on the [tool bar](#).

Report Viewer View Type

The Report Viewer displays data from your Commence database in read-only mode. Data can be viewed, printed, and exported to various file formats. Once the report has been generated, changes can be made only by redesigning the report. Features that require you to select an item in the view (such as sending letters, using drag and drop, or agents) are unavailable in the report viewer.

Toolbar

The toolbar located at the top of the report viewer window contains commands for:

- Exporting the report to other file formats
- Refreshing the report with the latest database information
- Changing the Zoom level of the view
- Navigating between pages of the report

Creating a new Report Viewer

To create a formatted report using the report viewer:

1. Select Views -> Open/Manage Views from the menu. Click Create New. The New View dialog box will appear.
2. In the View As radio group, choose "Report Viewer".
3. From the category list box, highlight the category that contains the data for the new view. Click View to open the new report.
4. A New View will be opened.
5. Select Customize -> Design View to begin formatting the report.

- Fields: This tab lets you select which fields will be displayed in the report viewer

- Filter/Sort: This tab lets you set filters and sorts for the report viewer
 - Design: This tab takes you to the Commence Report Designer so you can design your report layout and configure other report attributes
6. On the Design tab, click Launch Designer. You will be prompted to save the new report viewer.
 7. Enter a View Name and click Save.

Note: The report viewer may be saved to the View Bar or Views Menu along with your other Commence views.

8. After saving the report viewer, the Commence Report Designer will launch. For more information, see the “Commence Report Designer” in the User's Guide.

Report Designer

The Commence Report Designer is used to customize the report layout for the Report Viewer.

1. The report viewer window should be the active window.
2. After selecting Customize -> Design View, click the Design tab.
3. Click the Launch Designer... button to open the Report Designer window.
4. The fields you selected in the report viewer will be listed in the Fields toolbox.

Note: Each field in this list has been bound to a text box, also known as a control, within the Report Designer. As you customize the properties for each field, you are actually setting the properties for the control that the field has been bound to.

5. Use drag and drop to move each field into the report layout. Fields can be positioned anywhere in the Header, Body, or Footer of the report. When you drop the field into the report, it will be displayed as a box and the field label will be changed to 'txtFieldname' or 'Field1' indicating that this field is now a text or field control.

Tip To add multiple copies of the same field to the report, you can hold the CTRL key on your keyboard while dragging and dropping the field from the Fields toolbox to the report.

6. Each field can be resized to accommodate the amount of data expected for each field. To resize a field, click on the edge of the control for that field until handles appear on each side. A handle can be dragged in two directions to increase or decrease the field width and height as needed.
7. Additional controls, such as labels, lines and images can be added to the report.
8. As you design the report, you may click Preview at the top of the Commence Report Designer window to see what the report looks like at each stage in the design process.
9. Each field you add to the report has properties that can be set, such as font and color. In the Property Toolbox, select the field you want to customize from the drop-down list. Or click directly on the field in the report to access the properties for that field.
10. You can add page numbering to your report using the field's PageCount summary type. Page numbers are created using a running summary field.
11. When you are finished designing the report, click on Save to Commence to save the report viewer layout.
12. Select File -> Exit to close the Commence Report Designer.

More Information

See the Commence User's Guide for more details about

- using the Report Viewer commands

- creating and designing a Report Viewer view type

View Menu Commands

Use commands on the **Views** menu to:

[Open/Manage Views](#) Open a [saved view](#).

[Save View](#) Save a new view; save changes to a saved view.

[Save View As](#) Save a changed view under another name. (i.e. copy a view)

[Save View As HTML](#) Save a report or calendar view as an HTML file.

[View As](#) Click any view type in this group to copy a view to a new [view type](#).

[Cascade](#) Layer all open windows so that [title bar](#) of each is visible.

[Resize All](#) Resize all open views to fit on the active desktop while maintaining the relative proportions and positions of individual views.

[Tile Horizontally](#) Size and re-display all open windows horizontally so that no windows overlap.

[Tile Vertically](#) Size and re-display all open windows vertically so that no windows overlap.

[Close All](#) Close all open windows (including any hidden behind other windows).

[Switch Windows 1, 2, 3...](#) A numbered list of open views appears at the bottom of this menu. The active view has a check mark next to its name in the list. Selecting a view from the list makes the chosen view the active view.

[More Windows...](#) Activate an open view not appearing on the **Window** menu.

Customize Menu Commands

Use the commands on the **Customize** menu to:

[Design View](#) Change the display, fields, colors, or fonts for the active view.

[Filter View](#) Add or edit a filter that selects particular items from the active category for display by the active view. Also lets you remove the filter from the view so that it displays all the items in the category.

[Sort View](#) Alter the order in which [items](#) are sorted for display by the active view. This command is available only if the active view is a Gantt chart or report.

[Link Views](#) Setup a dynamic view link between two open views, enabling you to display a filtered set of items in one view related to the highlighted item in the other view. With Calendar views, you can display the items in another view for the selected date or for the date range displayed on the Calendar.

[Desktops](#) Add, edit, or delete [desktops](#); open existing desktops; show/hide all desktop tabs.

[Database](#) Add, edit, or delete [categories](#), [connections](#), [agents](#), [color code templates](#), import/export templates, [letter templates](#), and [detail forms](#).

Summary Tables

The following tables summarize Commence's [triggers](#), [conditions](#), and [actions](#) for [agents](#). The table indicates which triggers generate trigger data, which conditions generate condition data, and which actions either require or can optionally use this data.

These tables are best viewed in a maximized help window (press ALT+SPACEBAR and select **Maximize**).

Triggers

Type Name Trigger Data Fires...

Timer Timer No at predetermined times Commence Event No when Commence starts or closes

Manual Tool Bar Pick Optional when a tool bar button is pressed
Menu Pick Optional when an agent name is selected from Tools menu
Keyboard Hotkey Optional when a keyboard combination is pressed
Data Item Item Alarm Yes before a data item becomes current
Save Item Yes when a data item is edited and/or saved
External Receive DDE No on incoming DDE message Incoming Communication No when a telephone call or E-Mail message is received

Conditions

Type Name Condition Data Evaluates True...

Data Field Summary Yes if a field summary matches criteria
Item Count Yes if item count matches criteria

Time Time Interval No for specified time interval

Actions

Type Name Uses Data Description

Alerts Icon Modification No Changes the appearance of an icon on the icon bar
Message Box Optional Displays a message box and can also do sub-actions
Status Bar Message Optional Displays a message on the status bar
Play Multimedia Optional Plays a Windows multimedia file

Data Add Item Optional Adds a new item and optionally displays it
Modification/ Edit Item Required Edits an existing item and
optionally displays it Display Delete Item Required Deletes an
existing item

New View Optional Displays a new view

Open View No Displays an existing view

Commence Print Letter Required Generates a letter using a
template Commands Print Items Optional Prints a view or item

Import Required Import data from an external DOS file

Export Required Export data to an external DOS file

Sync Link Out Required Create an update file for synchronizing
databases Sync Link In Required Read an update file to

synchronize the database Backup Required Compress the

database into an external DOS file Outlook Sync Required

Exchanges data with Microsoft Outlook Use Telephone Optional

Will answer a telephone call, dial the phone, or hang up Set

Agent Status No Makes another agent active or inactive Manage

Desktop No Cascades, tiles, or closes all views. Can open a

desktop External Application Launch Optional Launches another
application with command line data Commands Send DDE

Optional Sends a DDE message

Create E-Mail Optional Creates and sends an electronic mail

message Process E-Mail Optional Deletes or moves E-Mail to a
folder

Customize-Database-Agent

[See Also](#)

One of the most powerful features of Commence is its [agent](#) facility. Agents let you instruct Commence to automatically perform tasks for you.

This command displays the [Agent](#) tab.

From this tab, you choose the [trigger](#), up to two optional [conditions](#), and up to four [actions](#) for a new agent. You can also edit and delete existing agents.

Natural Language Dates

[See Also](#)

You can specify dates in a [date type field](#) using plain English words. This is a convenient alternative to specifying exact dates, as it allows you to enter commonly used phrases, like "a week from today", "two months ago", and "a week from next Sunday". The sections below list the valid formats by keyword.

When you enter a date in one of these formats, Commence figures out the exact date for you. For example, if today's date is 1/3/94, and you enter "one week from today" in a date field, Commence inserts "1/10/94" into the date field for you when you switch to another field or save the item.

Always check Commence's interpretation of any natural language dates you use before you save the item. Do this by moving the cursor to another field after you type in the natural language date. If the format you used is valid, the natural language will change to a real date.

Commence will, given a vague phrase, make a best guess as to your meaning. That is, a phrase like "a day after next week" would evaluate the same as "a week from today"; "next january" would evaluate to January 1st of the following year. Remember that the phrases you use should indicate an exact date.

Some phrases, like "january after next week", are too ambiguous and will generate an invalid date error if you try to save the item with such a date.

Capitalizations, punctuation, and the words "a", "the", and "day" (as in "22nd day of august") are optional in natural language dates, but are allowed. For example, "The twenty-second Day of August, 1998" could be entered as "twenty-second of august 1998" with the same result.

Note: Another method of entering dates is to double-click on any date field in an [item detail](#) or [dialog box](#). This displays the [Select Date](#) dialog box where you can display monthly calendars to

select a date and then select the **OK** button to return to the previous window.

Day Names

You can specify any of the following day names in a date field:

Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday, Friday, Saturday, Sunday

Mon, Tues, Wed, Thu, Fri, Sat, Sun

Day names specified by themselves in a date field return either the current day or the next day with the name specified. That is, if today is Monday and you type "Monday" in a date field, Commence assumes you mean today; if you type "Tuesday", Commence assumes you mean tomorrow, etc.

The date returned by a day name used in conjunction with other date formats depends on the format used. In other formats, a day can be preceded by an ordinal, as in **First Tuesday, Second Thursday**, etc.

Special Days

Commence recognizes the following special days and substitutes the indicated date: **Lincoln's Birthday** February 12

Veterans Day November 11

Veterans' Day

Columbus Day October 12

Month Names

You can specify any of the following month names in a date field:

January, February, March, April, May, June, July, August, September, October, November, December

Jan, Feb, Mar, Apr, May, Jun, Jul, Aug, Sep, Oct, Nov, Dec

Month names specified by themselves in a date field return the first day of the named month in the current year. That is, if this

month is April and you type "April" in a date field, Commence assumes you mean April 1st of the current year; if you type "March", Commence assumes you mean March 1st of the current year, etc.

Day Aliases

The following day aliases:

Yesterday, Yest, Today, Tomorrow, Tom

return the date of the indicated day when specified alone in a date field. The date returned by a day alias used in conjunction with other date formats depends on the format used.

Month Ordinal

Days of the month can be specified in any of the following formats:

June First, June Second, June Third, June Fourth, June Twenty-Second, etc.

June 1st, June 2nd, June 3rd, June 4th, June 22nd, etc.

1st of June, 2nd of June, 3rd of June, 4th of June, 22nd of June, etc.

First of June, Second of June, Twenty-third of June, etc.

June 1, June 2, June 3, June 4, June 22, etc.

1 June, 2 June, 3 June, 4 June, 22 June, etc.

The current year is assumed unless you add a year at the end (e.g., June 2, 1995).

Last/This/Next

You can use the words **Last**, **This**, or **Next** in the following ways to specify a date: **Last/This/Next** <DayName/MonthName>

Last/This/Next week/month/quarter/year (date returned is the first day in the appropriate week, month, quarter, or year) <any of above formats> of **Last/This/Next week/month/quarter/year**

Last in this format means "previous" and not "final"; i.e., "the last day of 1989" is an invalid date format.

Some examples:

Next Monday

Last week

Third Tuesday of next quarter

Quarter

Specify the first day of a quarter of the year using the following formats:

1q, 2q, 3q, 4q

1st quarter, 2nd quarter, etc.

First quarter, Second quarter, etc.

The current year is assumed unless you add a year at the end (e.g., 1q 1995).

End of Period

You can specify the last day of the following formats using the form:

The end of <MonthName>/<Last/This/Next>/<Quarter> You can add a year at the end of the above format (e.g., "end of first quarter, 1989"), except when using <Last/This/Next> (e.g., "the end of last quarter, 1998" is not valid). You can also use a year by itself (e.g., "end of 1999").

Beginning/End

You can use the words **beginning** and **end** to indicate the end of a period: **The beginning/end of the week/month/quarter/year**

The beginning/end of <Last/This/Next>
week/month/quarter/year

month and **year** can also be literal months (i.e., June, July, etc.) in the first format.

Before/After

You can use the words **before** or **after** in the following ways to specify a date: **A day before/after** <any of the above formats> **A week/month/quarter/year before/after**

<DayAlias>/<MonthOrdinal>/<Last/This/Next> **Complex Formats**

The following complex formats are also allowed. The <format> string refers to any of the above formats, though some specific forms may not be allowed if they do not specify an exact date.

When using complex formats, be sure to check the interpreted value of the date field before selecting **Save** on an item detail; do this by moving the cursor to another field after you type in the natural language date. If the format you used is valid, the natural language will change to a real date.

The formats below cannot be combined with one another to construct even more complex formats.

The subsections below present examples of complex format usage. The lists are not exhaustive since the possible combinations of formats are almost limitless.

The <Ordinal> Day/Month/Week/Quarter Of/In The Week/Month/Quarter/Year

Second month of 1993

Third day of next week

Second week in June

Fourth quarter of 1998

<format> before <format>

First thursday before may first

The friday before the beginning of next month

One month before Lincoln's Birthday, 1998

<format> after <format>

Next thursday after 1/5/99

The second friday after the beginning of next quarter

<format> from <format>

Two weeks from today

One month from yesterday

Three weeks from the beginning of next quarter

<number of> days/weeks/months/quarters/years ago

Two weeks ago

A month ago

A year ago

Natural Language Times

[See Also](#)

You can specify times in a [time type field](#) using numbers (e.g., 9:00 am, 9 am, 9) and also using plain English words. Using words is a convenient alternative to specifying exact times, as it allows you to enter commonly used phrases, like "now" and "noon". Time type fields accept a limited set of keywords in place of exact times. The valid keywords and their translations are listed below.

begin

start

The system clock time at the time the item detail was opened using the **Edit-Add Item** command. These are typically used as start times in log items to record the beginning of a logged event (such as a phone call).

end

stop

The system clock time at the time the item detail (opened using the **Edit-Add Item** command) was closed and saved. These are typically used as end times in log items to record the end of a logged event (such as a phone call).

now

The current time.

noon

12PM or 1200 hours (midday).

midnight

mid-night

midnite

12AM or 2400 hours.

Short Time Formats

Time fields allow you to be flexible when entering times. A space can be used as the hour/minute separator and you can use A and P to substitute for AM and PM

The following are some examples of how the short time format works:

Time value entered: Evaluates to:

1 1:00

123 1:23

1234 12:34

1p 1:00 PM

1 23p 1:23 PM

Simple Calculations with Time Fields

Time fields allow simple operations using + and - to add or subtract some number of minutes.

The following are some examples of how the simple calculations work with time fields:

Time value entered: Evaluates to:

10 PM + 5 10:05 PM

10 AM - 5 9:55 AM

Midnight + 60 1:00 AM

Midnight + 720 12:00 PM

Start + 10 System time (when item was added) + 10 minutes

Open/Manage Database Dialog Box From here you can:

- [Open a different database](#)
- [Add a new database](#)
- [Edit the Name of an exiting database](#)
- [Delete a database](#)
- [Backup a database](#)
- [Restore a backup of a Commence database.](#)

This [dialog box](#) displays the names of all the Commence [databases](#) in the **Commence Databases** [list box](#). The name of the open, or active, database has the word **(active)** to its right in the list box.

Up to 1000 Commence databases can appear in the **Commence Databases** list box. [Views](#), [categories](#), [agents](#), preferences, etc. defined in a particular database are accessible only when that database is open. Only one database can be open at a time.

Detail Form Design Dialog Box

You can customize the [detail form](#) by:

Changing attributes for the entire form using the **Properties window**.

Customizing individual field attributes by highlighting one or more fields and selecting **Properties** from the right click menu.

Customizing the arrangement of the fields on the screen. See [Designing Detail Forms](#) for how to arrange detail form fields.

Keyboard users can change the automatic **field Tabbing Order** which is based on the arrangement of the fields on the screen. Setting the tab order ignores how the fields are arranged and follows the order you specify.

Customize the tab pages of a form by adding, editing, and deleting tabs. See [Working with Detail Form Tabs](#) for more information.

SAVE

Choose the **File-Save command**. If you make any changes to the form or field attributes, this button changes to a **Save Arrangement** button; select it when you are done editing the form to save your changes.

EXIT

Choose the File-Exit command if you have made no changes or if you want to leave the form as it is and discard your changes. This will cancel any unsaved changes you have made.

Designing Detail Forms

[See Also](#)

Use the lower part of the [Design Detail Form dialog box](#) to tune the arrangement of your fields so they don't overlap and are in an order you like .

To drag a field to a new position with a mouse, simply left click on it and, holding the left mouse button down, drag it to the location you want, and release the left mouse button. To drag a field to a new position using the keyboard, TAB to the field and select SPACE BAR to "grab" the field. Use the ARROW KEYS to move the field a small amount or use CTRL+ARROW KEYS to move the field by larger increments. When you have the field in the position you want, select SPACE BAR to release the field.

If you try to drag the field past the edge of the window, the screen will automatically scroll.

When you select a field, lightly colored "cross-hairs" will appear to help orient you in aligning the field with adjacent fields.

Commence automatically determines the tab order for the fields based on the position of each field on the detail form. The tab order starts with the field in the upper left corner, then tabs to the next field(s) in that row (if any), then tabs to the next row.

Commence's automatic tab order assumes the tops of the boxes are lined up for each row of fields on the form. You can also set your own [Tab Order](#) if you prefer.

For example, the **Field Start** options for a text field gives you a vertical cross-hair at the start of a text entry box, while the **Label Start** option gives you a vertical cross-hair at the beginning of the first letter of the field label. If you want to align by the end of the text entry box, use the **Field End** alignment option.

New View Dialog Box

The **New View** [dialog box](#) is displayed by the [View-Open/Manage Views](#) command and clicking on the **Create New** button. Use it to create a [view](#). After filling out this dialog box and selecting the **View** button, the new view is displayed and becomes the [active view](#).

The elements of this dialog box are:

CATEGORY

From the category [list box](#), highlight the [category](#) that you want to use to create a view.

Shortcut: You can open a new view by first choosing appropriate [radio buttons](#) in the **View As** and/or **Report Style** [radio groups](#) and then double-clicking the mouse over the name of the category you want.

VIEW AS

In the **View As** [radio group](#), choose the [view type](#) that you want to use to create a view. Choose one of the alternatives by clicking the mouse on the [radio button](#) next to the view type you want.

See [View Types](#) for a review of the view types. See [Choosing a View Type](#) for how to pick an appropriate view type for a category.

REPORT STYLE

For report views, choose **All Fields** in the **Report Style** radio group to include all [fields](#) in the report; select **Name Only** for a report that includes the [name field](#) alone.

Once you create the view, you can use the [Customize-Design View](#) command and select the **Fields** [tab](#) to change the fields included in the report.

VIEW

Once you have selected all the options you want from the **New View** dialog box, select the **View** button.

If you have selected a Multi-View, you will be presented with the [Multi-View Properties](#) wizard which allows you to set the various properties.

If you have selected a Document view, you will be presented with the [Document View Options](#) which allows you to specify the Document URL.

All views require a [view design](#). Commence will attempt to pick appropriate defaults for the view layout when you select **View**. This process may fail if you do not have appropriate fields for a calendar or Gantt chart view (default values can always be chosen for book, grid and report views).

A calendar one time field and one date field (the due date field; i.e., the date the item takes place). A Gantt chart view requires two date fields (one for start date and one for end date of each item). If appropriate time and/or date fields do not exist in the selected category, Commence informs you of this fact, and the view is not displayed.

You can change any view's layout using the [Customize-Design View](#) command and selecting the **Fields** [tab](#). You may want to do this after you create the new view if multiple time and or date fields exist in the category and you want to ensure that Commence picked appropriate view layout fields.

To see a field that isn't shown in the active report/grid view:

1. With the view open and [active](#), select [Customize-Design View](#) and select the **Fields** [tab](#).
2. On the left side of the Fields dialog box are the fields in the view. On the right side are the fields not in the view. Highlight the field on the right that you wish to see in the report.
3. To put the field at the end of the report, select the **Append Field** button. The field will be placed at the end of the view.
4. To place the field somewhere in the middle of the view, in the **Fields In Report** list box, highlight the field you want the new field to be above and then select the **Insert** button. The field will be moved above the highlighted field.
5. To add a combined field (multiple fields on one line) to a view, highlight the first field you want to include in the combined field and select the **Combine Fields** button.
6. Select **OK**.
7. The view will now show the field in the report.

Note: This change is just temporary.

If you close the view without saving it, the change will be lost. To make the changes permanent, save the view with [View-Save View](#) or select **Yes** when Commence asks to save changes to the view.

To see a field that isn't shown in the active book view:

1. With the book view open and [active](#), select [Customize-Design View](#) and select the **Fields** tab.
2. On the left side of the Fields dialog box are the fields in the report. On the right side are the fields not in the report. Highlight the field on the right that you wish to see in the report.

Note: The book view can show up to 20 fields, including combined fields. The book view can also display the name field of a connected item. You can define the number of lines provided for each field and, optionally, a label to be displayed for each field. See [Fields Tab \(Book views\)](#) for more details.

3. To put the field at the end of the report, select the **Append Field** button. The field will be placed at the end of the report.
4. To place the field somewhere in the middle of the report, in the **Fields In Report** list box, highlight the field you want the new field to be above and then select the **Insert** button. The field will be moved above the highlighted field.
5. To add a combined field (multiple fields on one line) to a report, highlight the first field you want to include in the combined field and select the **Combine Fields** button.
6. Select **OK** to make the changes.

Note: This change is just temporary. If you close the view without saving it, the change will be lost. To make the changes permanent, save the view with [View-Save](#)

[View](#) or select **Yes** when Commence asks to save changes to the view.

To see a field that isn't shown in the active calendar view:

1. With the calendar view open and [active](#), select [Customize-Design View](#) and select the **Fields** [tab](#).
2. On the left side of the dialog box, there are drop down list boxes. In each of the [drop-down list boxes](#) select the field you wish to display. Up to 5 fields to be displayed on the calendar view.
3. Select **OK** to make the changes.

Note: This change is just temporary.

If you close the view without saving it, the change will be lost. To make the changes permanent, save the view with [View-Save View](#) or select **Yes** when Commence asks to save changes to the view.

The Gantt view is a special view. For the Gantt view, you can only change the fields used to display the time bars.

Set Report Field Options Dialog Box

Type a font name and font size in the **Font Name** and **Font Size** [text boxes](#), or select from the associated [drop-down list boxes](#). The valid font names and sizes in the list box reflect the fonts you have installed in Windows. You can also change the font style to **Bold**, **Italic**, and/or **Underline** by selecting the appropriate [check boxes](#). The **Font Appearance** box shows you what the selected font and style look like. Select **OK** once you've made your selections.

Set the size of the area in which a field's contents will appear in the report, enter the appropriate number of characters into the **Width** text box, and the appropriate number of lines into the **Height** text box. This box originally contains the options set when the field was added to the active category.

Note that the height of a connected field is grayed out and cannot be changed from this dialog box. You can change this option by selecting the **Customize-Design View** command, then selecting the [Display](#) tab. You may want to do this in particular if one or more of your connected fields contains more connected item names than can fit in the default field height.

Set the amount of indentation for a field by entering a measurement into the **Indentation** text box.

You can label individual field values with the name of the field by turning on the **Include Field Label** check box. The field label will be shown as if it were part of the field data, just before the field value on the report. This is unlike the **Show Labels** setting, where the labels are included on the left side of a vertical format report and across the top of a horizontal format report.

Remove blank lines from within large text fields in a report by turning on the **Remove Embedded Blank Lines** check box.

Removing blank lines is particularly useful when printing labels. Blank lines may occur in an item if one or more fields do not contain a value. Turning this check box on eliminates blank lines within items while maintaining the space between items. Blank spaces are not removed, however, from the end of a field; i.e., if the space allocated for a field is too big for the field, blank lines

will appear at the end of the field, regardless of the setting of this check box.

Reverse names in text fields that are in the "last name, first name" format by turning on the **Reverse Name** check box.

Set the alignment of a field in the report column in which it appears. A field may be left justified, centered, or right justified. Choose the appropriate radio button from the **Alignment** [radio group](#). For example, to line up the decimal point in a currency value, the field must be right justified.

To calculate field summaries on selected calculation and number fields in a report, check one or both choices from the **Calculation** checkboxes. The **Total** checkbox sums up the field value for all the items in the view. The **Average** checkbox sums up the field value for all items in the view, then divides by the total number of items in the view. To view the field summary, open the report view then select [Tools - Field Summary](#) from the menu.

Filtering on One Field

If you wish to find a subset of items based on the value of a single field in the [active category](#) or the name of a [connected](#) item:

1. Select [Customize-Filter View](#) This will display the **Filter1** tab.
2. Determine whether to filter on a value in the active category, or on a connected item.

To filter on a value in the active category:

- A. Highlight the field you wish to filter on in the **Filter for All Items** box. The **Filter by** box will display (Field value).
- B. Enter the value to filter on and how to filter it. Methods of filtering a field depend on the field type.
 - For a calculation, number, or sequence number field type, the comparison operators are equal to, not equal to, less than, greater than, and is between. Select the comparison you wish to make from the drop down list and enter a numeric comparison value in the text box.
 - For a check box field, select the appropriate radio button to filter. You can choose if the value is **Checked** or **Not Checked**.
 - For a date field, the comparison operators are before, on, after, is between and is blank. Select the comparison you wish to make from the drop down list and type a comparison value (in the appropriate date format selected via the Windows Control Panel) in the text box. You can also use natural language date as a value, as described in [Natural Language Dates](#). For example, to find items with Today's date, select **On** and enter "today" in the text box.

- For name, telephone, and text fields, the comparison operators are equals, contains, does not contain, and is blank. Select the comparison you wish to make from the drop down list and enter a comparison value. For example, to filter on all items that have "Ask Bill" in the Notes field, select **Contains** and enter "Ask Bill" in the text box. **Note:** For Name and Text fields, you can select the **Options** button. This allows you to filter for all or one of up to 10 different strings.

C. Select the **OK** button. The view will now be filtered.

To filter on item connected to a particular item (for example, all appointments attended by Bill Smith):

- A. Highlight the connection you wish to filter on in the **Filter for All Items** box, and select the field in the connected category you want to make the comparison to from the **Filter By** drop down list box.
- B. Select the item you wish to filter on.
- C. Select the **OK** button. The view will now contain all the items connected to the item you selected

Filtering on More than One Field

If you wish to find a subset of items based on the values two or more fields in the [active category](#) or the names of a [connected](#) items:

1. Select [Customize-Filter View](#).
2. Select the **Summary** tab, then choose the next available filter.
3. Determine if you want to filter on a value in the active category, or on a connected item.

To filter on a value in the active category:

1. Highlight the field you wish to filter on in the **Filter for All Items** box. The **Filter By** box will display (Field value).
2. Enter the value to filter on and how to filter it. Methods of filtering a field depend on the field type.

For a calculation, number, or sequence number field type, the comparison operators are equal to, not equal to, less than, greater than, and is between. Select the comparison you wish to make from the drop down list and enter a numeric comparison value in the text box.

For a check box field, select the appropriate radio button to filter. You can choose if the value is **Checked** or **Not Checked**.

For a date field, the comparison operators are before, on, after, is between and is blank.. Select the comparison you want to make from the drop down list and type a comparison value (in the appropriate date format selected via the Windows Control Panel) into the text box. You can also use natural language date as a value, as described in [Natural Language Dates](#). For example, to find items with Today's date, select the on button and enter "today" in the text box.

For name, telephone, and text fields, the comparison operators are equals, contains, does not contain, and is blank. Select the comparison you want to make from the drop down list and enter a comparison value. For example, to filter on all items that have "Ask Bill" in the Notes field, select the Contains button and enter "Ask Bill" in the text box. **Note:** For Name and Text fields, you can select the **Options** button. This allows you to filter for all or one of up to 10 different strings.

3. Select the **OK** button.
4. Follow the process for the other fields you wish to filter.
5. Use the **And** and **Or** radio group to form a filter.
6. Use the **Not** check box to reverse the sense of a filter.
7. When completed, select **OK** to filter the view.

To filter if an item is connected to a particular item in a connecting category:

1. Highlight the connection you wish to filter on in the **Filter for All Items** box.
2. Select the item you wish to filter on.
3. Select the **OK** button.
4. Follow the process to achieve the filter you want.
5. When completed, select **OK** to filter the view.

Filtering on a Date Range

Filtering on a date range involves specifying two values to be compared to the same field. For example, you may need to see a list of your To-Dos due during a particular week. You would need to filter the calendar on the Date field using the [Customize-Filter View](#) command. One value specifies the items with Dates **After** the last day of the last week and the second with Dates **Before** the first day of the next week. Combining these two values with the “**Is Between**” comparison operator gives you a view of only To-Dos due during the week.

To set a filter for a date range (for example, September 19th through September 25th):

1. Display the view for the category for which you are setting a date range.

Make sure the category contains date fields to filter on and contains data that will pass through the filter.

2. Select **Customize-Filter View** from the menu or select the /filter_shg.gif button on the [tool bar](#)
3. To set the filter, select the **Filter1** tab.
4. In the **Filter for All Items** list box, select the [date field](#) you wish to base the filter on.
5. Select **Is Between** as the comparison value from the drop down list of comparison values.
6. Enter the values you desire for the **Minimum Value** (beginning of the date range) and **Maximum Value** (end of the date range).
7. Select the **Save** button.

Your view is re-displayed containing only items whose dates fall in the range you specified in the filter.

Note: This change is just temporary. If you close the view without saving it, the change will be lost. To make the changes permanent, save the view with [View-Save View](#) or select **Yes** when Commence asks to save changes to the view.

Finding Items with Blank Fields

To locate items that have no value in a field, use the **Is Blank** comparison operator. This operator can be used for a number of different field types, including [Text](#), [Time](#), [Date](#), [Calculation](#), and [Telephone](#) type fields.

1. Display the view you wish to filter. For help, see [Opening a View](#).
2. Select the [Customize-Filter View](#) command from the [menu bar](#). To set the filter, select the **Filter1** tab.

If you are creating more than one filter select the **Summary** tab.

3. In the **Filter for All Items** list box, select the **date** field to filter on.
4. Select the **Is Blank** comparison operator from the drop down list.
5. Select the **Save** button.

This returns you to the active view and the filter will be in effect.

Some field types are defined with specific allowed values and therefore can never have blank values. This applies to [Check Box](#), [Selection](#), [Sequence Number](#), [Number](#), [Name](#), and [Connected item Name](#) fields. Select a field type below to see a description of filtering for blank values for some of the special field types listed above:

[Number](#)

[Connections](#)

The remaining field types cannot be filtered; this includes [Data File](#), [Excel cell](#), and [Image](#) fields.

Global Search Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the [Tools-Global Search](#) command.

To use the dialog box, type the text you want to search for in the **Search Text** text box and select the **Start Search** button. The label on this button then changes to **Stop Search**.

The **Global Search** dialog box contains these elements:

SEARCH TEXT

Type the text for which you want to search into this text box. You can use a question mark wildcard to substitute for any single character in the search text, and an asterisk (*) to substitute for one or more characters. For example, typing "12/*/06" tells Commence to look for any number of characters between the slashes. Typing "12/?/06" tells Commence to look for exactly one character between the slashes. Typing "12/??/06" tells Commence to look for exactly two characters between the slashes.

To search the database for multiple values, such as John or Joe or Sue or Mary, you could create a multi-layered text string (for example, **John.OR.Joe OR.Sue.OR.Mary**). By specifying text strings in combination using the Boolean .AND. and .OR. operators, Commence will now search the active database for these text strings and return those items that meet the specified criteria. Notice that there are periods around the Boolean Operators. This is to distinguish the Boolean Operators **AND** and **OR** from the text strings *AND* and *OR*. Additionally, Boolean Operators are case sensitive, and must be entered as Upper Case in order for Commence to identify them as Boolean Operators.

MATCH

Select the degree of fuzziness to use for search. An "Exact" match will find text that is just as you have entered it in the **Search Text** box. "Fuzzy", "Fuzzier" and "Fuzziest" make ever greater allowances for possible misspellings. Fuzzy searches are always case insensitive.

MATCH CASE

Turn on this check box to specify an exact match of the case used in the search text. For example, with **Match Case** turned on, the search text "paul" may select a different set of items than the search text "Paul". This check box is turned off by default.

FIND WHOLE WORDS ONLY

By default, Commence searches for any item that has a field containing the search text; other text can also appear in the field. Marking the **Find whole words only** checkbox means that you only want to see items having a field whose entire contents exactly matches the search text. No other text can appear in the field.

ITEMS FOUND

After you select the **Start Search** button, this list box displays the name fields of all items matching the text string. The label on the list box changes to reflect the number of matching items found. Up to 500 item names can be displayed. If a global search produces more than 500 matches, only the first 500 are displayed.

Information about the currently highlighted item in this list is displayed in the **Information on Highlighted Item** group box (see below). You can display an item detail of the highlighted item by double-clicking the left mouse button over the name of the item, or by selecting the **Display Item** button.

If the name of an item appearing in the list changes (because of edits performed while the **Global Search** dialog box is open), the changed name is reflected in the list.

SEARCH STATUS

Indicates the status of the current, or last, search. If no search has yet been performed, it is blank.

INFORMATION...

Displays a summary of the item currently highlighted in the # **Items Found** list box, including the **Category** of the item, the **Matching Field** in which the search text was found, and the contents (**Text**) of that field.

START SEARCH

This button starts a search using the current **Search Text**. Once a search is begun, the label on the button changes to **Stop Search**, which you can use to stop the current search. If you cancel a search that is in progress, the button label changes to **Resume Search**; using this button will restart the search where you left off. The button label returns to **Start Search** once you change the **Search Text**, **Categories**, **Case Sensitive**, or **Contains/Equals** settings.

CATEGORIES

Select this button to alter the list of categories searched. It displays the [Select Search Categories](#) dialog box . By default, all categories are searched.

DISPLAY ITEM

Highlight an item in the # **Items Found** list box and select this button to display an item detail of the item. (Alternatively, you can double-click the left mouse button over the name of the item.)

CLOSE

Select this button to close the **Global Search** dialog box. The current **Search Text** is lost once you do this.

Note: The # **Items Found** list box displayed by the **Global Search** dialog box is not updated if you do a global search and then edit or add an item or items that will now match the previously performed global search. You will have to search again to add the item(s) to the list. Item deletions, however, are immediately reflected in the # **Items Found** list box.

Shortcut: To display the item detail of an item in the list box, double-click the left mouse button over the item name.

Page Setup Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed by the [Page Setup](#) command.

Select the **Add** button to create a new paper layout. To edit, copy, or delete a paper layout, highlight a layout name in the **Paper Layout** [list box](#) and then select the appropriate button.

Shortcut: Double-click the mouse pointer on the name of a layout in the **Paper Layout** list box to edit it without selecting the **Edit** button.

ADD

Displays the [Add Paper Layout](#) dialog box.

EDIT

Displays the [Edit Paper Layout](#) dialog box, filled in with all the details of the currently highlighted layout in the **Paper Layouts** list box.

COPY

Displays the [Copy Paper Layout](#) dialog box, filled in with all the details (except the name) of the currently highlighted layout in the **Paper Layouts** list box.

DELETE

Deletes the currently highlighted layout in the **Paper Layouts** list box.

SET DEFAULT

Selects the currently highlighted layout in the **Paper Layouts** list box as the default to be used when printing.

DEFAULT PAPER LAYOUT

Selects Displays the current default paper layout. Whenever a Print Options dialog box is displayed, the default layout appears in the Paper Layout drop down list. Use the Set Default button to change the default paper layout.

OK

Closes the **Page Setup** dialog box.

Add/Edit/Copy Paper Layout Dialog Box

[See Also](#)

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the **Add**, **Edit**, or **Copy** button on the [Page Setup](#) dialog box. To use the dialog box, fill in any missing information, accept or change any default values, and select the **Save** button.

To include the print title (if one is defined) for the [active view](#) on each printed page of view output, turn on the **Include Title** [check box](#) in the **Header group box**. To include today's date on each printed page of output, turn on the **And Date** check box.

LAYOUT NAME

Type or edit a name for the paper layout. The name can be up to 35 alphanumeric characters.

ORIENTATION

Select the **Portrait** [radio button](#) to use the longer edge of the paper as the vertical side, or select the **Landscape** radio button to use the shorter edge of the paper as the vertical side. The default for adding a layout is **Portrait**.

PAGE

Select a paper size for the layout from the **Paper** [drop-down list box](#). You can choose from the many standard paper sizes included with Commence, or select **Custom** to specify a non-standard **Width** and **Height** (these text boxes are otherwise uneditable). The radio buttons at the bottom of the **Page** group box specify the measuring system (**Inches** or **Centimeters**) used for the currently selected paper size; this setting affects all the measurements on the dialog box.

REGIONS

Enter the number of **Columns** and **Rows** for the layout. Commence will pick a **Width** and/or **Height** that spreads the columns out evenly over the page, but you can pick other values. If the number of **Columns** or **Rows** is 1, the column width or row height defaults to the page width or page height (minus margins), and cannot be changed. Note that the settings in the **Regions** group box change as you change the settings in the **Page** group box.

INTERNAL MARGINS

These text boxes specify measurements from the **Left**, **Right**, **Top**, and **Bottom** edges of a single **Region**, defining the printed area of the region. The measuring system depends on the radio button selected in the **Page** group box. Edit the internal margins by selecting the appropriate box(es) and editing the text. The default margin settings for all internal margins when adding a layout is 0 (no internal margins).

HEADER

Check the **Include Title** check box to add a header containing the view title (specified via the [Customize-Design View-Display](#) command) to the printout. If **Include Title** is checked, you can also check **And Date** to add today's date to the header. The default when adding a layout is to include both the title and the date.

MARGINS

These [text boxes](#) specify measurements from the **Left**, **Right**, **Top**, and **Bottom** edges of the page, defining the printed area of the page. The measuring system used depends on the radio button selected in the **Page** group box. Edit the layout margins by selecting the appropriate box(es) and changing the numbers. The default margin settings for all four margins when adding a layout is 1 inch or 2.54 centimeters.

SAMPLE

This non-selectable area allows you to preview the paper layout design as you enter information into the dialog box. A specification typed into a text box is reflected in the **Sample** as soon as you move the insertion point from the text box (e.g., when you press the **Tab** key or move the insertion point with the mouse).

PRINTER

Select the **Printer...** button to associate a printer with this paper layout. A Select Printer dialog box will be displayed, the selected printer will be used whenever this paper layout is used for printing. If you select no printer for a paper layout (or if you select "Commence Printer" from the list) the default Windows printer will be used. To determine the default Windows printer, see the Printers section of the Windows Control Panel.

SAVE

Select the **Save** button to save your selections as a paper layout under the **Layout Name** specified. If your specifications are outside the capacity of the currently selected page size, a message box is displayed that points out the error(s) and asks you to try again.

CANCEL

Select this button to cancel the **Paper Layout** dialog box and discard the current specifications.

If your margin specifications are outside the margins of the currently selected page size, a message box is displayed that points out the incorrectly specified margin(s) and asks you to try again.

Print Dialog Box

The **Print** [dialog box](#) is displayed while Commence is printing a [view](#) or [item detail](#). Select **Cancel** to cancel the print operation. Once the print job is completed, this dialog box disappears.

Dialing a Telephone Number

If you have a modem, and Windows Telephony (TAPI) installed, you can have Commence dial the telephone for you.

To dial a telephone number:

1. If the number shows in the view, highlight the item.

If the telephone number is not visible, double click on the item to open it's form.

2. Select the [Dial Phone](#) command on the Home tab.

Note: You can dial any number from a detail form by double clicking on a phone number field or by highlighting a phone number in a text field and selecting the Dial button.

3. If there is more than one telephone number entered for the item you are trying to place a call to, the [Select Telephone Number](#) dialog box appears. Select the telephone number you would like to call and select the **Dial** button.

4. The [Commence Dialing](#) dialog box shows the number being dialed. It also displays a **Hang Up** button and a **Change Options** button. The **Hang Up** button allows you to terminate the dialing by disconnecting the modem. The **Change Options** button allows you to change the dialing options via TAPI.

You can pick the phone up at any point after it has dialed.

Logging a Phone Call

Logging a phone call is similar to logging a letter. It tracks your phone calls, who they were to, their duration (in minutes), what they were about, date, time, etc. It automatically connects the log item to the item you are dialing. The Notes/History category is used when you log a call.

You can log a call even if Commence did not dial it. If you are using a modem, read this entire topic. If not, you can manually log a call.

To log a call not dialed through Commence, select the Dial button on the [tool bar](#). Skip to step 4 below and continue reading for a description of the process.

To log a phone call dialed using Commence:

1. Select the [Edit-Preferences...](#) command. Select the **Event Logs** tab. Set your preferences for when you would like to log phone calls. There are two options, if **Phone Call is answered** and if **Phone Call is not answered**. You may select both options.

Note: If both checkbox , **Phone Call is answered** and **Phone Call is not answered**, are not marked, all phone calls must be logged manually.

2. Dial the number as described in [Dialing a Telephone Number](#).
3. Select the **Talk** button in the ATSP Call Status dialog box. A phone log form appears, if the option **Phone Call is answered** was chosen.

Select the **Hang Up** button in the ATSP Call Status dialog box. A phone log form appears, if the option **Phone Call is not answered** was chosen.

4. In the **Date** field, the date will automatically be specified as **Today**. This changes to the current date when you move to the next field.
5. When you have completed your selections in the form, select the **Save** button.

Tool Bar Pick Trigger

Tool Bar Pick [triggers](#) provide a way to manually initiate an agent. It fires when you select the button on the [tool bar](#) associated with the trigger.

Tool Bar Pick triggers are added as new buttons to the agent tool bar. Use the **Button** [drop-down list box](#) to select the icon to use as an identifier on the button. Select the position of the button in the **Position** drop-down list box. Only the unused positions for that desktop will appear in the **Position** drop-down list box.

Commence checks for any active agents that use **Tool Bar Pick** triggers, then makes sure the positions they use will not appear in the list. You can also define a specific [desktop](#) on which the agent will appear and a keyboard hotkey.

You can enter **Help Text** that will be associated with the button (when the mouse is over the tool bar button, the help text will appear on the status bar). This is a useful way to remind yourself of what the agent does.

A **Tool Bar Pick** trigger can be associated with a specific [category](#) (e.g., Person/Company) using the [Active Category](#) drop-down list box. If you make this association, then the button is only enabled when either a view of the category or an [item detail](#) from the category has the focus. If you pick the button when a different a view or detail from a different category is active, you will get a message box reminding you that the button is not enabled for that category.

A **Tool Bar Pick** trigger that is associated with a specific category passes data from a single [item](#) in that category as the trigger item. This trigger item is either the selected data item in the active view, or the item from an active item detail.

If you check **All Categories**, then you can always select the menu pick, regardless of the active category, however, you will not easily be able to pass data to be used in the conditions or the actions.

Database Password Dialog Box

[See Also](#)

The database you are opening with the [Open/Manage Database](#) command is password-protected.

Enter the password for the database in the **Password** text box and select the **OK** button. When you enter the correct password, the database is opened. If you do not know the password select the **Cancel** button.

Caution: If you use the **Open/Manage Database** command to back up a database and then later restore from the [backup](#) file created, you can access the restored database only if you use the password that was in effect *at the time the backup was made*.

Database Protection

Commence provides several ways of protecting your data from being accessed by unauthorized users:

Database Scrambling

All of the information in a Commence database is scrambled automatically by Commence. As a result, no one can easily scan the database files on disk and read your data. This database scrambling is done behind the scenes and requires no action on your part.

Database Passwords

You can assign a password to a database to prevent someone from turning on your PC and opening the database from within Commence without your knowledge. After you assign a password to a database, you will need to enter the password each time you attempt to open the database.

Password-Protecting a Database

Any database can be password protected. To password protect a database, follow the steps below:

1. Open the database you want to password protect using the [Open/Manage Database](#) command.
2. Select the [Edit-Preferences-Database](#) command.
3. In the **Database Password** group box turn on the **Password Protect Database** check box.
4. To set (or change) your password, select the **Set Password** button. The [Change Database Password](#) dialog box appears.
5. If this is the first time this database has been password protected, the **Old Password** field is grayed out. Otherwise, type your current password in the **Old Password** field.

6. Type the password you want into the **New Password** text box. The characters you type are echoed with asterisks in the text box.
7. Type the password again into the **Verify Password** text box.
8. If you correctly entered the **Old Password** (if any), and entered the same password into the **New** and **Verify Password** text boxes, Commence returns you to the **Database** tab. If you made a mistake, Commence displays a message box asking you to try again. Select **OK** and go back to Step 4.
9. Select **Done** to close and save the **Database** tab.

Opening a Password-Protected Database

The open database is now password-protected. The next time you attempt to open this (or any) password-protected database, the [Database Password](#) dialog box is displayed.

Enter the password you chose in Step 6 above and select **OK**. When you enter the correct password, the database is opened.

Caution: If you use the **Open/Manage Database** command to backup a database and then later restore from the [backup](#) file created, you can access the restored database only if you use the password that was in effect *at the time the backup was made*.

Save/Save As/Edit View Dialog Box

These [dialog boxes](#) are displayed when you select the [Views-Save View](#), or [Views-Save View As](#) command. The Edit View dialog box is displayed when you select [View-Open/Manage Views](#), then select the **Edit** button.

This dialog box contains these elements:

VIEW NAME

The **View Name** (if any) of the [active view](#) is shown in the **View Name** text box; view names are limited to 30 characters.

VIEW ICON LABEL

The **View Icon Label** [text box](#) displays the label that the view's icon will have if it is displayed on the [view bar](#) (see the **Display on View Bar** check box below). You can change the contents of the text box as you see fit. Icon labels are limited to 10 characters. As delivered, default labels are defined only for the pre-defined views that appear on the view bar.

ICON

The **Icon** [drop-down list box](#) shows the current icon for the view. The default icon for a view reflects the [view type](#) of the view. You can change the current icon by selecting one from the drop-down list box.

Note: The icons displayed in the **Icon** drop-down list box include both internal Commence icons and external icons that you can supply. Commence searches the active [database](#) directory and the central icon directory (if one is defined) for all files with a **.ico** extension and displays the first 500 icons it finds in the list box. If you specify an icon in a **.ico** file for a view icon and this file cannot be found when the icon is needed, Commence uses the default icon for the type of the view. See the [Edit-Preferences-Tool Bars](#) command for more information on using external icons.

DISPLAY ON VIEW BAR

The **Display on View Bar** [check box](#), if turned on, indicates that the active view is currently marked to appear on the view bar. If it is turned off, the active view is currently not marked to appear on the view bar.

Use this option for frequently used views as an alternative to using the [View-Open/Manage Views](#) command or placing views on the **Views** menu (see below). Up to 40 view icons can appear on the view bar. To add the active view to the view bar, turn on the **Display on View Bar** check box; to remove the active view from the view bar, turn the check box off.

When you click the left mouse button on an icon on the view bar, the associated view is opened. If that view is already opened, clicking the left mouse button makes the view active. Clicking the right mouse button on the view icon opens another instance of a view. Multiple instances of a view have a colon and a number appended to their view titles. The number displayed increases from 1 as new instances are opened.

If a view does not have a label, no default label is assigned to it. If you don't choose a label for a view and you place that view on the view bar, no label will appear for the view when the view bar is displayed with labels.

Note that you can choose whether or not to display the view bar itself by selecting the [Edit-Preferences-Tool Bars](#) command.

DISPLAY ON VIEW MENU

The **Display on Menu Bar** check box, if turned on, indicates that the name of the active view currently appears on the [Views menu](#). If it is turned off, the active view's name does not currently appear on the **Views** menu.

Selecting a view name from the **Views** menu opens the view. Use this option for frequently used views as an alternative to using the [View-Open/Manage View](#) command. Up to 16 view names can appear on the **Views** menu. To add the active view to the **Views** menu, turn on the **Display on Menu Bar** check box; to remove the active view from the **Views** menu, turn the check box off.

OK

Select the **OK** button to save the view and return to the [work area](#).

CANCEL

Select the **Cancel** button to return to the [work area](#) without saving the view.

Message Log Dialog Box

When you select the [Help-Message Log](#) command, Commence displays the **Message Log** [dialog box](#).

This dialog box displays a log of the messages that have been posted to the [status bar](#). These messages include informational messages displayed by commands and [agents](#) as they execute that will help you diagnose and correct problems encountered in Commence. The entries for agent actions correspond to the firing of an [agent's trigger](#). The date and time is shown, along with the name of the agent. If the agent operated normally, the word "Fired" is shown after the name. If an error occurred, the type of error is noted after the agent name.

Use the [scroll bar](#) on the right side of the **Messages** [list box](#) to move through the list.

Turn on one or more of the check boxes in the **Show Message Level** and **Show Message Type** [group boxes](#) to select the message level and type of messages you want to see. This does not affect what is stored in the log, but only what you see in the **Messages** list box. Not all messages are written to the Message Log. The Log only includes messages from agents, **Sync Link In/Out**, and **Transfer**.

Select the **OK** button to return to the [work area](#).

Configuring Your Word Processor for Use with Commence

[See Also](#)

Summary

Commence lets you use your favorite text editor and word processor for writing letters. These letters can contain information from a Commence [database](#).

You can write a letter that contains information from the currently highlighted [item](#) using the [Send Letter](#) command on the Home menu; or, you can write multiple letters (one for each item in the [active view](#)) using the same [Send Letter](#) command.

After selecting one of these commands, you then choose a template for the letter. Letter templates specify common text for letters as well as the field codes used to pull information from the item(s) selected (see above). Commence supplies several sample letter templates; you can also add your own templates to Commence.

Commence launches the text editor or word processor application with which the template was created. You can make changes to the letter from within the selected application. Commence pulls the information specified in the template from the item or view, as appropriate, and uses this information in the letter(s). You can then print or fax the letter(s) for delivery to the recipient(s).

Sending a Fax from Commence

If you have WinFax installed on your system, you can fax a letter from Commence instead of printing it. The recipient's fax number is retrieved from Commence and sent to the fax software and the selected letter(s) are faxed automatically.

Configuring a Text Editor

Commence comes configured to use Windows Write for unformatted (text) letters. If you want to use a Windows-based text editor other than Write, simply specify another one via the **Letters** [tab](#) under preferences. This is the only configuration step necessary in order to use a text editor to write letters from Commence.

Configuring a Word Processor

To use a formatted word processor and take advantage of all the special features that word processors provide, you must configure both Commence and the word processor.

Basically, you need to tell Commence about the word processor you want to use and install macros for your word processor that will allow it (through Windows' Dynamic Data Exchange) to pull information into your letters from Commence.

The help topic for the [Letters tab](#) tells you how to specify the word processor you want to use with Commence.

When installing Commence you will be asked which word processor(s) you use. If you select your word processor at this time, Commence will automatically set your preferences and install the macros for you. If you skipped this step during installation, or if you've installed a new word processor after Commence was installed, then you should reinstall Commence.

Send Letter Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the [Send Letter](#) command. Choose the letter template you want to use for your letter and choose the **View** button to edit the template; select the **Print** button to print the letter. To log the letter, turn on the **Log** [check box](#) and optionally type in a name for the log [item](#).

The **Send Letter** dialog box contains these elements:

SEND LETTER TO

This option enables a letter to be sent to the selected item or to all items in the active view.

TEMPLATES LIST BOX

This [list box](#) shows the names and **Types** of all templates available for use with the [active category](#). Select which letter you want to send by highlighting one of the templates in the list.

Commence provides some initial templates, but you will probably want to customize these or create new ones. The details of setting up and using both text and formatted letter templates are discussed in [Customize-Database-Letter Template](#).

DESTINATION (Word 2000/XP)

This displays the possible destinations for the merged letter, label, or envelope template. Select where the letter should be sent after it has been merged. Current options include Printer, FAX, Draft or E-Mail.

APPLICATIONS (Word 97)

This displays the word processor applications that were installed when you installed Commence. If you have added any word processor applications since Commence was installed, you will need to re-install Commence.

When you create a letter, you can also choose to log it by turning on the **Log** check box. Logging creates a letter log item that is connected to the recipient and contains other information about the letter. See your [Event Logs Preference](#) for details.

MERGE BUTTON

When the **Preview** button is checked, this button enables you to type the body of your letter or to preview the letter and make changes before sending it. Any field codes in the letter will be filled in with the data from the item that was highlighted when you chose **Send Letter**.

If you select a template with a **Type** of **TXT** (a plain text file) and chose **Merge** in the dialog box, Commence launches your preferred text word processor with the text file. At that point, you can convert the letter into the native format of the word processor (usually the word processor offers you this option when it reads in the file.) From the word processor, you can edit the letter (including adding whatever formatting is supported by the word processor), print it, and/or save it as a normal word processor file.

If you select a formatted template (i.e., a file with a **Type** other than **TXT**, such as **DOC** or **SAM**) and chose **Merge** in the dialog box, Commence sends DDE messages to the word processor instructing it to copy the template into a new document file and then retrieve the needed data field values from Commence. (The data field substitution is done by a macro running in the word processor which communicates with Commence to get the needed data values.) After the data values are substituted into the document, Commence maximizes the word processor and you can manually edit, print, or save the new letter.

When the **Preview** button is cleared, and you select a **TXT** template and chose **Merge**, Commence creates a text letter by replacing the [Field Codes](#) in the template with data values from the highlighted item in the active view and displays the [Print Letter](#) dialog box.

If you select a formatted template and chose **Merge**, Commence sends DDE messages to the word processor instructing it to copy the template into a new document file and then retrieve the needed data field values from Commence. (The data field substitution is done by a macro running in the word processor

which communicates with Commence to get the needed data values.) After the data values are substituted into the document, the word processor prints the document and closes the file. Note that the printed document will be formatted with whatever formatting you have specified in the template file.

If you want to cancel printing a formatted letter, you must first interrupt the word processor macro and then cancel the print job. How you cancel a macro depends on the macro language of the word processor; pressing the ESC key cancels a macro in Word for Windows and WordPerfect.

The letter prints on the default printer selected for the word processor.

Note: If you want to specify other print options for a formatted letter (e.g., print multiple copies, print a subsection of the letter etc.) use the **Preview** option to create the letter, and then use the word processor directly to enter the options.

PREVIEW

This option enables the merged letter template to be viewed before sending it to its destination.

INCLUDE MERGED DOCUMENT WITH LOG ITEM

This option enables the document containing the merged letter template to be saved with the Log item stored in Commence. When this option is cleared, only the Log item is created, without the actual document.

CUSTOM LETTER FILENAME

You can type a full path or file name for a letter in this text box. If you enter a full path into the **Custom Letter Filename** text box, then Commence saves the letter in the location specified by the path. If you enter only a file name, then the letter is saved to a default directory specified via [Edit-Preferences-Letters](#).

--

CANCEL BUTTON

Select the **Cancel** button to return to the [work area](#).

Customize-Database-Letter Template

[See Also](#)

Use this command to display the [Letter Template tab](#), from which you can add templates, edit existing templates, and delete templates. Commence provides some initial templates, but you will probably want to customize these or create new ones.

Letter templates are used as the guideline for creating form letters. Letter templates can contain ordinary text (the body of the letter) as well as [Field Codes](#) that represent field values from items in a given category in Commence (like the Person/Company category). Each letter template is associated with a specific category, and can only be used to send letters to items in that category. All templates are word processor files that are stored in the **tmpls** subdirectory of your active database directory. Commence letter template filenames always start with the letters **PIM** followed by some numbers, and have an extension of .TXT or whatever is appropriate for your word processor.

Commence supports two types of letter templates, [text templates](#) and [formatted templates](#). You can use text templates with or without an external word processor. Text templates produce ASCII text letters, which are useful for transmitting letters electronically or for simple memos. Text templates cannot contain graphics or formatted text (i.e. bold, italic, etc.)

Formatted templates are more customizable and can take advantage of the word processor features which allow you to use graphics and different fonts in your letter template. Formatted letter templates can only be used if you have a word processor that has a macro language and supports both client and server modes of DDE (Dynamic Data Exchange). Commence currently provides macros for three such word processors: Microsoft Word and WordPerfect for Windows.

Select Telephone Number Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#), displayed when you select the [Dial](#) button, allows you to choose from among multiple telephone numbers displayed in an open [view](#) or [item detail](#).

The [list box](#) shows the field labels of the telephone fields in the [active view](#) or item detail. Highlight one of the numbers and select the **Dial** button to have your modem dial the number contained in the named field.

Shortcut: Double-click the left mouse button while pointing at one of the field labels to dial the number without selecting the **Dial** button.

Once you select the number to dial, the [Commence Dialing](#) dialog box is displayed.

Select the **Cancel** button to return to the active view or item detail without dialing a number.

Commence Dialing Dialog Box

[See Also](#)

This [dialog box](#) displays the phone number that is being dialed. Depending on how you set your dialing preferences (see [Dialer Preferences](#)), this phone number may include access codes as well as the number in the telephone field.

Selecting the **Change Options** button allows you to change the dialing options via TAPI.

You can pick the phone up at any point after it has dialed. Select the **Talk** button in the ATSP Call Status dialog box to start the phone conversation with the other party.

Selecting the **Hang Up** button in the ATSP Call Status dialog box allows you to terminate the dialing by disconnecting the modem.

Configuring MS Outlook Address Book

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the [Edit-Preferences-Other Apps](#) command.

Microsoft Outlook is an electronic mail package included with Windows. Multiple MAPI compliant mail systems can plug into MS Outlook in order to provide a single, consistent interface for electronic mail. Since MS Outlook operates as a front-end for multiple and possibly very different mail systems, there are some associated inherent problems. As an example, each mail system typically has its own address book, which leads to difficulty in locating an individual's address, as well as potential redundant data.

Commence solves this problem by providing its users with a universal MAPI-compliant address book. A specified category within Commence may now be accessed by Microsoft Outlook for use as an Address Book for such applications as addressing electronic mail messages, faxing documents, etc. This eliminates the need to enter duplicate information into both Commence and Outlook. To use this option:

1. From the **Configure Commence as:** combo box, select **Microsoft Outlook address book.**
2. Select the category you want to use as an address book. Usually, this is the Person category.
3. In order for MS Outlook to access the correct address information within a Commence category, the fields used by Outlook must be mapped to the fields in the Commence category. Double click on the desired **MS Outlook Type** field on the left side of the form, or highlight the desired **MS Outlook Type** field on the left and select **Edit.**
4. Select the corresponding **Commence Field** from the Combo Box. Select **OK** when done.

5. Repeat steps 3 and 4 for all remaining MS Outlook Type fields that are to map to Commence Fields. Only those fields that will be used need to be mapped.
6. When all MS Outlook Type fields have been mapped to Commence Fields, select **Done** to save the configuration.

Performing the steps below will add the Commence Address Book to the Microsoft Outlook Profile.

7. Run the **Windows Control Panel**.
8. Double click on the **Mail and Fax** icon. The **MS Outlook Settings Properties** dialog box will be displayed. Select the **Services** tab.
9. Select the **Add** button. A list of available services will be displayed.
10. Highlight the **Commence Address Book** selection. Select **OK** to add the Commence Address Book to the Outlook profile.

Performing the steps below will configure the default Microsoft Outlook Address Book to be the Commence Address Book.

11. The **MS Outlook Settings Properties** dialog box should still be displayed. (If not, repeat steps 7 and 8 above.) Select the **Addressing** Tab.
12. From the **Show this address list first:** pull-down menu, select **Commence Address Book**.
13. From the **Keep personal addresses in:** pull-down menu, select **Commence Address Book**.
14. Click on the **Add** button.
15. Highlight **Commence Address Book** and click on the **Add** button.
16. Click on **Close**.

17. The Commence Address Book is now shown in the list of Address Books for the **When sending mail, check names using these address lists in the following order:** option.
18. Move the **Commence Address Book** to the top of the list.
19. Select **OK**.
20. Select **OK** again, and then close the Windows Control Panel

Microsoft Outlook is now configured to use the information maintained within Commence as an Address Book, called *Commence Address Book*.

Print Setup Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed by the [Print Setup](#) command or by the Printer button in the [Add/Edit Paper Layout](#) dialog box.

This command allows you to setup your printers.

Menu Pick Trigger

A **Menu Pick** [trigger](#)

is manually controlled: it fires when you select the menu pick associated with the trigger. **Menu Pick** triggers are added as new menu entries on the [Home](#) menu. You enter the text of the menu item in the **Menu Text** [text box](#).

You can also enter **Help Text** that is associated with the entry (when the highlight is over the menu pick, the help text appears on the [status bar](#)).

The help text is useful to remind you of the [agent's](#) purpose. You can also define which [desktop](#) the agent will appear and a keyboard hotkey.

A **Menu Pick** trigger can be associated with a specific [category](#) (e.g., Person/Company) using the **Active Category** [drop-down list box](#).

If you make this association, then the menu item is only enabled when either a view of the category or an item detail from that category is active. If another category is active, the menu item is grayed out. If you check **All Categories**, then the menu pick can always be selected, regardless of the [active category](#).

A **Menu Pick** trigger that is associated with a category passes data from a single [item](#) in that category as trigger data. This trigger item is either the selected data item in a view, or the data item from the displayed [item detail](#) that has the focus.

Agent Tab

This [tab](#) is displayed when you select the [Customize-Database-Agent](#) command.

This tab lets you manage the [agents](#) provided with Commence and define and manage your own agents. You can:

- Select the **Add** button to add a new agent.
- Highlight an agent name in the **Agent Names** [list box](#) and select one of the **Edit**, **Copy**, or **Delete** buttons to edit, copy, or delete the highlighted agent.

The elements of this dialog box are:

AGENT NAMES LIST BOX

The **Agent Names** list box shows you all the agents that are currently defined. The status of each agent is displayed to the right of the agent name. An agent status can either be [active](#) or [inactive](#).

When an agent is highlighted, the **Agent Description** message box will show a summary of the agent's [trigger](#), [conditions](#), and [actions](#).

ADD BUTTON

To add a new agent, select the **Add** button. Commence displays the [New Agent](#) dialog box.

EDIT BUTTON

To examine or edit an agent, highlight it and select the **Edit** button. This brings up the details of the agent in the [Edit Agent](#) dialog box.

Shortcut: Double-click the left mouse button while pointing at an agent name in the **Agents** list box to edit the agent's definition without selecting the **Edit** button.

COPY BUTTON

To make a copy of an existing agent and edit the copy, highlight the agent and select the **Copy** button. The details of the copied agent are displayed in the [New Agent](#) dialog box.

DELETE BUTTON

To delete an agent, highlight it in the **Agents** list box and select the **Delete** button. Commence asks for confirmation before deleting the highlighted agent.

OK BUTTON

Once you are finished working with agents, select the **OK** button to return to the **Agent** tab.

Copy To File Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed by the [Edit-Copy To](#) command.

Type a file name into the [text box](#) and select **OK**. Select **Cancel** to cancel the copy to file operation.

If the file name you supply is an existing file, Commence asks you if you want to overwrite the file; if you select **Yes**, the highlighted text is written to the file and the existing contents of the file are lost. Select **No** and you are returned to this dialog box.

Paste From File Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed by the [Edit-Paste From](#) command.

The **Filename** [text box](#) displays the default wild card string used to selectively list the contents of the drive or folder named in the **Save in** list box. The files in this drive or folder are listed in the box.

Change the contents of the **Filename** box and the drive or folder name to examine filenames on your system. Do this by:

Typing a filename or [wildcard](#) string into the **Filename** text box and pressing the ENTER key; this changes the file list in the box.

Selecting a drive or folder name in the **Save in** [list box](#); this changes the directory whose files are listed in the box.

Once you find the filename that you want, select it from the list; the filename is moved to the **Filename** box. Select **OK** to confirm your selection. Select **Cancel** to cancel the paste from file operation.

Select Search Categories Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the **Categories** button on the [Global Search](#) dialog box.

To use it, select and deselect categories for the search by clicking the left mouse button over the name of a category in the list box (or use the arrow keys and the space bar). Select **OK** after all of the categories that you want to search are highlighted in the list box.

The **Select Search Categories** dialog box contains these elements:

SELECT ALL

Use the **Select All** button to highlight all of the categories in the list.

DESELECT ALL

Use the **Deselect All** button to remove the highlight from all categories.

ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Use the **Active Categories** button to search only the categories that have a view open on the active desktop.

OK

Select the **OK** button to return to the **Global Search** dialog box with the new list of categories to search.

CANCEL

Select the **Cancel** button to return to the **Global Search** dialog box without changing the list of categories to search.

Note: On the first search after selecting the **Global Search** command, all categories are selected by default.

Customize-Design View-Fields Tab

[See Also](#)

All views allow you to display different fields. The Report and Grid type allows you to display any fields in the category along with any fields from connected categories. The Book type allows you to display up to 20 fields in the category, along with the Name field from connected categories. The Gantt view displays the Name field and the [clarify field](#), and uses the date fields in the category to display a time line. You can select any two dates in the category to be used for the start and end of the time line. For the Calendar view, up to five fields can be displayed. You can select any Date and up to two time fields to be used for displaying the items on the Calendar.

Time Conflict

This button is found on the [Customize - Database - Category tab](#). When you press the **Time Conflict** button, Commence displays the [Time Conflict Layout](#) dialog box.

The **Time Conflict Layout** dialog box lets you:

- select the [fields](#) to be used for time conflict checking for the selected category
- enable time conflict checking for the selected category.
- specify a connection to use when checking for time conflicts.

Enabling time conflict checking for a [category](#) means that Commence will check each [item](#) added to the category for a time conflict with items already in the category. If a conflict is detected, Commence asks you if you want to add the conflicting item anyway.

For example, the Calendar category has time conflict enabled. If you attempt to add more than one item occurring at the same time on the same day, a warning message is displayed before the new item is added. You can choose to abort or continue the addition of the conflicting item. (Note that time slots with multiple items display the word **(multiple)** instead of the item names.)

Selecting fields for time conflict checking will also let Commence warn you if you specify a start time for an item that is later than the specified end time.

Print Calendar Dialog Box

When you select the [File-Print](#) command from the [menu bar](#) with an [active](#) calendar [view](#), or select a [Print Items](#) agent action from the [Add/Edit Action dialog box](#) with a calendar view selected, Commence displays the **Print Calendar** dialog box.

PRINT TITLE

The **Print Title** [text box](#) displays the default title for printing the view. The default title is either the title you specified using the [Customize-Design View-Display](#) command or (if you have not specified your own default) the name of the [category](#) used by the view.

You can edit the title that appears in the **Title** text box to change the title for this printing of the view only. Whether or not the title is actually printed with the view depends on the option set using the [File-Page Setup](#) command. The **Print Title** is unavailable for the **Day Planner**.

STYLE

Choose the calendar style to use when printing the view by selecting one of the [radio buttons](#) in the **Style** radio group. The items printed in each style are determined by the **From** and **To** dates (see below). This radio group is unavailable if the **Detail Only** button is selected. The calendar style options are:

Day List

Prints three monthly calendars (previous, present, and next months) at the top of the page, with a listing of items underneath.

Day Planner

Prints the date and three months of monthly calendars at the top of the page; with a day planner style calendar of items

underneath. You can display items for a range of 9 or 12 hours by selecting the appropriate radio button. Select the start time of the hour range from the list box. The start time must be between midnight and 3:00PM.

Week List

Prints a week's items in a grid of 7 days per page.

Week Planner

Prints the week and three months of monthly calendars at the top of the page; with the week's items on the page under each day of the week

Month Planner

Prints a month's items in a monthly calendar grid; each item is printed in the box for the day on which it occurs.

6-Week Planner

Prints six weeks of items in a six-week calendar grid; each item is printed in the box for the day on which it occurs.

FROM

The **From** text box specifies the start date for printing items from a calendar view. Only items in the range specified by the **From** and **To** dates are printed. Commence assumes the calendar view's active date as the **From** date for **Line** and **Day Planner** styles, and the beginning of the week or month for **Week** and **Month Planner** styles, respectively. Commence will change the **From** date accordingly as you choose different style options. You can change this date by editing the date in the **From** text box.

TO

The **To** text box specifies the end date for printing items from a calendar view. Only items in the range specified by the **From** and **To** dates are printed. Commence assumes the calendar view's active date as the **To** date for **Line** and **Day Planner** styles; the end of the week or month for **Week** and **Planner** styles, respectively. Commence will change the **To** date accordingly as you choose different style options. You can change this date by editing the date in the **To** text box.

OK

Select **OK** to return to the Print dialog box.

CANCEL

Select **Cancel** to cancel the print options.

Calendar Preferences Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you choose the [Edit-Preferences-Calendar](#) command.

Use the **Week Start Day** [drop down list box](#) to select the day you want to use as the start of a week. Wherever possible, the same starting day will also be used to display the mini-month calendars.

Note: The Week Planner mode of the calendar uses a combined Saturday/Sunday block and therefore cannot be displayed with a Sunday start day.

Database Preferences Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you choose the [Edit-Preferences-Database](#) command.

DATABASE PASSWORD

Turn on the **Password Protect Database** check box if you wish to restrict who can access the currently open database. If selected, Commence will prompt for a password whenever you open this database.

To set (or change) your password, select the **Set Password** button. The [Change Database Password](#) dialog box will be displayed. For more information see [Database Protection](#).

SET SHARED CHECKBOX BY DEFAULT

This option allows you to select whether data added to a shared database is automatically marked as shared. If you usually add shared data, then you should select this checkbox. If you usually add private data, then clear the checkbox.

This option applies to the shared toolbar button on detail forms, and to the **Shared** checkbox in the Add and Edit dialogs for the definitions that can be shared in a database. This option is used only to set the initial state of the Shared button, and you can always override this setting by setting or clearing the Shared button and then saving the data.

Note: If you are not authorized to update items in a category, the Shared check box will be grayed out.

SYNCHRONIZE DATA FILES

This option allows you to select whether data files referenced by shared items are automatically copied along with the shared items. If this option is cleared, data files will not be copied from this database to the server database. If this option is selected, which is the default, data files will be copied from this database to the server database and will be received from other client databases.

This option can be cleared if data files referenced by shared items are already located in a shared directory on the network. The file name and path referenced in the shared item are changed to reflect the path selected for the **External Data Files** directory. You will need to change this directory to reflect the path of the shared directory by selecting [Edit-Preferences-Other](#).

This option should be selected if you do not store data files in a shared network directory. Selecting this option will cause Commence to copy the data files associated with shared items so that they are available on every client database. Commence will also automatically update the data file path to reflect the file's location on the client workstation, and will attempt to preserve the filename if possible.

Note: This option must be selected at the server database to enable clients to synchronize data files. Disabling this option at the server will disable it for the shared database, even if the option is selected at the client databases.

Event Logs Preferences Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you choose the [Edit-Preferences-Event Logs](#) command.

LOG PHONE CALLS TO

The **Log Phone Calls to** [group box](#) lets you select the [category](#) to be used as the log category when you log incoming or outgoing phone calls. The default category is **Journal**, which contains fields that will time your phone call.

When choosing an alternate category for the letter or phone log, you should choose a category similar to the defaults given above so that Commence can keep proper track of your logged phone calls and letters.

For example, the default phone log has default time entries that allow Commence to place accurate start and end times in the log, and figure the duration of the phone call.

ADD LOG ENTRY FOR OUTGOING CALL IF...

If turn on the **Phone Call is answered** checkbox, Commence will log any outgoing phone calls which were automatically dialed by Commence, *only if* the phone call is answered by the other party. If a busy signal is detected, or the phone call does not complete properly for any reason, the call will not be logged.

If you need to log all phone calls, even if you do not connect with the other party, turn on the **Phone Call is not answered** checkbox. The attempted phone call will be logged, even if Commence receives a busy signal or for some reason is unable to complete the phone call.

LOG LETTERS TO

The **Log Letters to** group box lets you select the default category to be used as the log category when you use the [Tools-Send Letter](#) dialog boxes. The default category is **Notes/History**.

When choosing an alternate category for the letter or phone log, you should choose a category similar to the defaults given above so that Commence can keep proper track of your logged phone calls and letters.

For example, the default letter log has a [data file field](#) that points to the letter sent. You can view the letter directly from the item detail of the letter log item; if you choose a category with no data file field, you will not be able to view a letter from its letter log item. Use the [Customize-Database-Category](#) command to look at the definition of the default letter and phone log categories.

SAVE IN DIRECTORY

The **Save in Directory** section determines where Commence saves the letters that you log. By default, this is in a subdirectory called **\letters** in your Commence program directory. If you want to change this selection, type the name of the new directory in the **Save in Directory** text box. You can also use the **Select** button to browse your hard disk to find a suitable directory. This displays the [Select Directory](#) dialog box. After you choose a directory path and select **OK**, the **Event Logs Preferences** dialog box appears with the chosen directory shown in the **Directory** text box.

Note that the **Save In Directory** is not the directory where your letter templates are stored. Commence will always store your letter templates in the **\tplts** subdirectory of your current database.

Meeting Preferences Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you choose the [Edit-Preferences-Meeting](#) command.

The **Meeting Preferences** dialog box contains nine [drop-down list boxes](#).

MEETING CATEGORY

Select the category for which the **Schedule Meetings** command will add items. The **Appointment** category is the default for the databases shipped with Commence. This is a required field.

DATE FIELD

Select a field in the Meeting Category to use for the meeting date.

Date is the default for the databases shipped with Commence.

This is a required field.

START TIME FIELD

Select a field in the Meeting Category to use for the meeting start time. **Start Time** is the default in the databases shipped with Commence. This is a required field.

END TIME FIELD

Select a field in the Meeting Category to use for the meeting end time. **End Time** is the default in the databases shipped with Commence. This is a required field.

COMMENTS FIELD

Select a field in the Meeting Category to use for the agenda, comments, or notes for a meeting. This field is optional.

PARTICIPANTS CONNECTION

Select a connection definition to use when connecting a Participant to the meeting. This field is optional but highly recommended.

LOCATION CONNECTION

Select a connection definition to use when connecting the selected **Located-In** item to the meeting. This field is optional.

COORDINATOR CONNECTION

Select a connection definition to use when connecting the selected **Coordinated-By** item to the meeting. This field is optional.

RESOURCES CONNECTION

Select a connection definition to use when connecting the items selected in the **Resources** dialog box to the meeting. This field is optional.

DONE

Select this button to confirm your choices for **Meeting Preferences** and return to the [work area](#).

CANCEL

Select this button to cancel the currently specified **Meeting Preferences** and return to the work area without making any changes.

Other Preferences Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you choose the [Edit-Preferences-Other](#) command.

ITEM DETAIL

Use the **Treat 'Enter' Like 'Tab' Key** option to change how the `ENTER` key operates on a detail form. If it is checked, the `ENTER` key will move you to the next field just as the `TAB` key does. If it is not checked, the `ENTER` key will invoke the default button, that is, the button with the dark line around it. The sole exception is that if you are in a text field with more than one line, the `ENTER` key will insert a new line character regardless of how this preference is set.

If the **Confirm Item Deletes** option is checked, Commence will prompt you for confirmation whenever you select **Edit-Delete Item**. If not checked, Commence will delete the item from your category without asking for confirmation.

If the **Disable 'Save and add another'** option is checked, Commence will disable the button on the Item Detail toolbar that opens a new blank form upon saving the current item.

AGENTS / OUTLOOK SYNC

The **Agent** options determine how Commence handles message boxes, questions boxes, and error messages displayed by Commence during an agent's execution.

- Prompt for response to questions
- Automatically answer questions (this is the default)

Automatically answer questions causes Commence to affirmatively answer interrogative boxes with **Yes** or **OK** as a response, whichever applies (*except* for message boxes displayed by **Message Box** agent actions). The text of the box is copied to the **Message log** so that you can tell when a Commence agent has automatically answered questions for you.

The advantage of the **Automatically answer questions** option is that it allows you to run agents while your PC is unattended. The disadvantage is that it answers all questions affirmatively, and this may not always be what you want.

If you turn on the **Prompt for response to questions** radio button, then Commence will always prompt for an answer and will wait for a response.

The advantage of the **Prompt for response to questions** option is that it gives you the chance to respond to individual prompts appropriately. The disadvantage is that agent message boxes will wait an infinite amount of time for your response, and this may mean that required processing of your data is not performed as needed.

Note: The exceptions are noted below. These will always wait an infinite amount of time for your response, and are unaffected by the setting of this preference.

- Message boxes displayed by **Message Box** agent actions
- The message to insert another diskette when **Backup** runs out of disk space

The option to **Disable Outlook Sync Feature** prevents the unintentional use of the Outlook Synchronization feature. This gives you the ability to pre-configure the mappings for Outlook / Windows Mobile Calendar, Contacts, Tasks, and Notes and to have control over when and if that feature will be accessible to users.

This option is turned off by default. When the option **Disable Outlook Sync Feature** is enabled, the toolbar menu command to synchronize with Outlook becomes inactive. Agent actions designed to auto-synchronize with Outlook are also disabled with

this option, however the agent active/inactive status remains unchanged.

NAME FIELDS

If the **Reverse "Last, First"** check box is checked, whenever Commence is printing letters or exporting it will change any name field containing a comma to "First Last" name. If this check box is not checked, Commence will not reverse the contents of the name field in these situations.

SHORT DATE RANGE

Use the **Short Date Range** preference to control how you want Commence to expand a two-digit year that you enter into a date field. For example, if you enter a date such as "1/4/29" and this option is set to the default, the years 1930-2029, Commence assumes you mean "1/4/2029". If you changed the **Short Date Range** to be 1920-2019 and re-entered "1/4/29", Commence would expand it to "1/4/1929". Commence lets you enter dates from January 1, 1905 to December 31, 2083.

EXTERNAL DATA FILES

When you [transfer](#) in a file from another database that has related data files (such as logged letters), Commence needs to know where to put the related data files on your hard disk. This is because the directory structure on your computer and the directory structure of the computer on which the transfer file was created are most likely different.

The currently selected directory is displayed in the **Directory** box. If you check the **Overwrite existing file when file names conflict** option, then new files that are transferred in will be overwritten if the filename matches one that already exists. If the option is turned off, then files already in the directory with the same names as incoming files are retained and the incoming files are not added.

If you want to change the current data file directory, type the name of the directory in the **Directory** text box, or use the **Select** button to find a suitable directory. This displays the [Select Directory](#) dialog box.

After you choose a directory path and select **OK**, the **Other Preferences** dialog box appears with the chosen directory shown in the **Directory** text box.

Letter Fax Macros (Word 97, WordPerfect, AmiPro)

[See Also](#)

Commence supports macros for WinFax Pro. The macros, along with one of the word processors that works with the Commence Letters facility, allow you to fax a letter instead of printing it.

These macros retrieve the selected recipient's fax number from Commence, select your fax printer, send the fax number to the fax software, fax the selected letter(s), and then re-select your default printer. The macros retrieve the fax number by looking for a telephone number field that contains "fax" or FAX" in its name. You can decide whether you want to print or fax on a per-letter basis.

Because the macros send the fax number to the Fax software, the fax is sent without you having to interact with the Fax software. If you select [Tools-Send Letter](#), letters can be created and faxed for every item from a view in Commence. This is useful for sending a batch of customized faxes to a group of recipients. Batch faxes cannot be deferred to be sent at a later time.

Letter Preferences Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you choose the [Edit-Preferences-Letters](#) command.

TEXT LETTERS

The section entitled **Text Letters** is concerned with your selection of a word processor to use for letters created with text templates. The default word processor is Write, but you can select any word processor that is capable of reading in and saving flat ASCII text files.

Enter the word processor in the text box to the right of **Program Filename**. If the program is in your path, you can just enter the program filename, otherwise enter the complete path. You can also use the **Select** button to the right of **Program Filename** to browse your PC file system to find a program.

Enter the file extension that your word processor uses for its native files in the **File Extension** [text box](#). When Commence creates a text letter file (not a template file), it will use this extension if you have requested to view the new letter in your word processor.

Note: If you are using Ami Pro for Windows you must enter TXT not SAM since Ami Pro will not read in a text file unless it has this extension.)

FORMATTED LETTERS

This is used to set your preferences for [formatted letter templates](#). Highlight your word processor from the **Word Processor** [list box](#). Note that as you change your selection, the entries for the fields in the **Formatted Letters** section change.

ALWAYS PREVIEW

This is used to set the default value for the Preview option on the Send Letter dialog.

Open/Manage Views Dialog Box

The **Open/Manage Views** [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the [View-Open/Manage Views](#) command. Use it to open, edit or delete a [saved view](#) or create a new one. For more information on creating a new view, see [New View Dialog Box](#)

The elements of this dialog box are:

SORT BY

The [radio button](#) selected from this group determines whether the list of views is sorted by view name, category name, or view type. Select the radio button next to the sorting method you prefer, and the list is re-sorted automatically.

LIST OF VIEWS

The list of all saved views is displayed in a [list box](#); use the [scroll bar](#) at right to scroll through the list. Highlight the name of the view you want to display.

Shortcut: You can open a view by double-clicking the mouse on the view name.

OPEN

Once you've highlighted the view you want to open from the view list box, select the **Open** button to display the view. The saved view is displayed and becomes the [active view](#).

CREATE NEW

This button lets you add a new view for any category, using any view type. For more information on creating a new view, see [New View Dialog Box](#).

EDIT

If you select the **Edit** button, the **Edit View dialog box** is displayed. This box allows you to change the view name and location.

DELETE

Once you've highlighted the view you want to delete from the view list box, select the **Delete** button to delete the view.

DONE

Use the **Done** button to cancel the **View-Open/Manage Views** command.

Delete View Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the **Delete** button on the [View-Open/Manage Views](#) tab. The message asks you to confirm the deletion of the saved view.

If you select the **Yes** button, the selected view is deleted from Commence.

Note: Deleting a view does not delete the data contained within that view. If you delete the last view for a category, Commence will prompt you to delete the category. You should select **No**, unless you wish to delete all data and associated definitions which may depend on this category.

Formatting a custom .HTX file for use with Commence

You can override the default HTML templates used by Commence. To do so, create a set of .HTX files with specific filenames listed below and store these files in the \TMPLTS subdirectory beneath the database directory. The templates names are:

CALHTML.HTX This template is used when the active view type is a Calendar. The keyword `<%htmlcalendar%>` found in this template is replaced with data from the calendar view in Commence.

REPTHTML.HTX This template is used when the active view type is a Report. The keyword `<%htmlview%>` found in this template is replaced with data from the report view in Commence. The data is presented in a horizontal table format in the HTML file regardless of the view's layout in Commence. The items in the view will continue to be filtered and sorted in the HTML file as they appeared in the Commence view. The order of fields in the report is also maintained in the HTML file. Fonts and colors used in the view are not translated to the HTML file.

You may use any HTML editor to create new templates then save the completed templates using the filenames above. Alternatively, you may modify the built-in templates shipped with Commence. These templates are available when you install the Customer Relationship Management database. Open this database and determine the path to the data directory using [Help - System Information](#). The templates will be located in the \TMPLTS directory below this path. Copy the .HTX files from this directory to the \TMPLTS directory beneath your database directory.

Note: The default templates listed above contain important keywords used by Commence to merge the active view data into the HTML file. Do not remove these keywords from the HTX files.

Save As HTML Dialog Box

The Save As HTML wizard steps you through the creation of an HTML file containing a table of all the items in the active view. The number of columns in the table will match the number of fields and connections displayed in the view. The table will automatically size itself to contain as many rows as needed to include all items that were displayed in the view. If filters are defined in the view, only those items that meet the filter will be included in the table. The items will be sorted in the same order as they appeared in the view. The resulting table will be saved in an HTML file.

In the first step you will be prompted to make a choice:

- Should Commence create a basic HTML document containing the view information?
- Should the active view be inserted into an existing formatted HTML page?

See the corresponding sections below to determine which choice is best for you.

By creating an HTML document containing the view information When you select the first option the active view is inserted into a basic HTML template provided by Commence. Note that a very simple page is created when using these built-in templates. You can override the default templates used by Commence by saving a set of .HTX files with specific filenames in the \TMPLTS directory beneath your database directory. For additional information, see the topic titled [Formatting a custom .HTX file for use with Commence](#).

After you select the first option and click **Next>**, you will be prompted to enter some additional information about the view.

Feel free to enter values for any and all of the options below, or you may leave them all blank.

- **Title:** Any text you type here will appear at the top of the HTML page. Typically, a brief description or Title of the active view should be entered here.
- **Header:** Any text you enter here will appear centered on the line just above the table containing the items from the active view.
- **Footer:** Any text you enter here will be appear centered on the line just below the table containing the items from the active view.

By inserting the view information into an existing formatted HTML page If you would prefer to use a custom HTML template instead of the default templates included with Commence, you may select the second option then click Next> to continue. You will be prompted to enter the filename of any HTML file or template of your choice. The only requirement is that the HTML file you select must already contain a special keyword in the position where you want the table of data to appear. For additional information, see the topic titled [Formatting a custom .HTX file for use with Commence](#). This option provides greater flexibility by not requiring a specific .HTX template to be used as with the first option.

Select the filename for the HTML document to be created In the final step, you will be prompted to enter a new filename to store the finished HTML document. You may use the Browse button to select the directory where the file will be stored. If you do not enter a path or change directories then the file will be saved in the Commence program directory. Type any filename followed by an extension of .HTM then select the Finish button to save the file.

Select Window Dialog Box

[See Also](#)

Select a [view](#) to become the [active view](#). This is useful when you have many views displayed and some are hidden behind others.

Note that you can also use the key combination CTRL+F6 to successively select views in the workspace as the active view.

LIST BOX

This [list box](#) displays the names of all the currently open views.

OK BUTTON

To display a view as the active view, highlight a view from the list and select the **OK** button.

Shortcut: You can also double-click the left mouse button while pointing at a view name in the list to activate it without selecting the **OK** button.

CANCEL BUTTON

Select this button to return to the [desktop](#) without selecting a new active view.

Customize-Design View-Display Tab

[See Also](#)

Use this command to specify a default title and paper layout for printing a [view](#), so that you don't need to choose one each time you print the view. The following options can be set for all view types:

PRINT TITLE

Allows you to select a default print title for the active view that will be used unless you specify another title (or no title) at the time you select the [Print](#) command to print the view.

Type (or edit if there already is a default title) a title for the [active view](#). The title is limited to 80 characters. Select the **OK** button when you are satisfied with the title. Note that the view title will be printed only if printing titles is specified via the [Page Setup](#) command.

PAPER LAYOUT

Allows you to select a default paper layout to be used when printing the view. If none is selected, Commence will use the default paper layout defined with the [Page Setup](#) command.

The Book View is limited to the above display options. For all the other view types, there are additional options on the display tab.

Customize-Design View-Colors Tab

[See Also](#)

Change the color code template used in the [active view](#). Initially, a new view's [items](#) are displayed without color coding. To use color coding, you must first select a color code template.

Color coding the time bars for a calendar or Gantt chart view allows you to add visual appeal and differentiation between different kinds of [items](#). For example, you may want to use red to display meetings in a calendar view, green to display trips, and other colors for other appointment types. Optionally, the text entered in every field of an item can also be color coded for all view types.

SELECT COLOR FOR

Select the default colors for displaying the view. You can select colors for the item text, label text (used for field labels and the title of the view), window background, and the color of the highlight. Additionally, for book views, you can set the color of the book cover.

COLOR CODING

Select a color code template from the list. If no templates are listed, create a new one using the [Customize-Database-Color Code](#) command.

COLOR CODE ITEM TEXT

Use this checkbox to change the color of all text for an item based on the color code template. For example, incomplete To-Do's can be displayed in red text, while completed To-Do's are displayed in black text, making it easier to see important items at a glance. This setting affects all fields in the item.

SHOW LEGEND

Use this checkbox to toggle the display of a legend for a calendar or Gantt chart [view](#). A legend explains the color coding scheme (if any) for the view. The selected color code template is displayed in a **Legend** window in the active view's window.

Customize-Design View-Fonts Tab

Use this command to select the default font used to display [items](#) for the [active view](#).

SELECT FONT FOR

Choose which element of the active view to select the font for. You can select a font used to display the **Item Text** for all view types. For [calendar views](#), you can set the font for:

Item Text (1 column) The text used for items in **Day** [display mode](#).

Item Text (2 column) The text used for items in **Week**, and **2 Days** display modes.

Item Text (7 column) The text used for items in **Month**, and **6 Weeks** display modes.

Label Text The title bar text showing the date.

Mini-month Text The numbers and text on the small month calendars in Day display mode.

Type a font name and font size in the **Font Name** and **Font Size** [text boxes](#), or select from the associated [drop-down list boxes](#). The valid font names and sizes in the list box reflect the fonts you have installed in Windows. You can also change the font style to **Bold**, **Italic**, and/or **Underline** by selecting the appropriate [check boxes](#). The **Font Appearance** box shows you what the selected font and style look like.

CHANGE ALL

This button will change the font for every field and element in the view.

Shortcut: If you would like to select the same font for every field (or most of the fields) in the active view, use this button to quickly change the font for all fields in one step. Then, if desired, use [Customize-Design View-Fields](#) to selectively change the font for some of the fields.

OK

Select **OK** once you've made your selections.

Filter/Sort Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the [Customize-Sort View](#) command or the [Customize-Design View](#) command while a report viewer is the active view.

The items in the report viewer can be filtered as with any other Commence view. Setting a filter will determine which items are displayed in the finished report. Likewise, setting the sort order will affect the order in which those items appear in the finished report.

To filter and/or sort the items in the Report Viewer:

1. After selecting Customize -> Design View, click the Filter/Sort tab.
2. Press the Filter button on this screen if you wish to define a filter. The standard Filter dialog will appear.
3. Press the Sort button on the Filter/Sort screen to apply a sort to the items in the Report Viewer.
4. A modified version of the Sort Fields dialog for the Report Viewer will appear.
5. From here, select what fields are to be used for the sort and whether the sort on the field is to be in Ascending (A - Z) or Descending (Z - A) order.
6. When you have finished your changes, you may click OK to save your changes and close the window.

Note: Group Headers and Group Totals are managed from the Report Designer. These options cannot be set using the Sort dialog within Commence.

Design Dialog Box(Report Viewer)

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the [Customize-Design View](#) command while a report viewer is the active view.

Press the **Launch Designer** button on the Design Tab to begin customizing the report layout.

The Commence Report Designer is used to customize the report layout for the Report Viewer.

1. The report viewer window should be the active window.
2. After selecting Customize -> Design View, click the Design tab.
3. Click the Launch Designer... button to open the Report Designer window.
4. The fields you selected in the report viewer will be listed in the Fields toolbox.

Note: Each field in this list has been bound to a text box, also known as a control, within the Report Designer. As you customize the properties for each field, you are actually setting the properties for the control that the field has been bound to.

5. Use drag and drop to move each field into the report layout. Fields can be positioned anywhere in the Header, Body, or Footer of the report. When you drop the field into the report, it will be displayed as a box and the field label will be changed to 'txtFieldname' or 'Field1' indicating that this field is now a text or field control.

Tip To add multiple copies of the same field to the report, you can hold the CTRL key on your keyboard while dragging and dropping the field from the Fields toolbox to the report.

6. Each field can be resized to accommodate the amount of data expected for each field. To resize a field, click on the edge of the control for that field until handles appear on

each side. A handle can be dragged in two directions to increase or decrease the field width and height as needed.

7. Additional controls, such as labels, lines and images can be added to the report.

Filter Tab

[See Also](#)

The [Customize-Filter View](#) command displays a **Summary** tab of all [filters](#) selected for the [active view](#). If a simple filter is already defined for this view, its definition is displayed as **Filter #1**. You can reverse the sense of your filter (i.e., select all items that do *not* match the filter) by turning on the **Except** [check box](#).

To select or change one of these filters, select the tab ([Filter #](#)) for the filter you want. As you add more filters, you can use logical operations to relate the filters to each other using the **And** and **Or** [radio buttons](#).

The **And** radio button lets you chain up to eight filters together. For example, you can say you want only items that have *both* Filter #1 and Filter #2 to be true.

The **Or** radio button lets you filter on mutually exclusive conditions. For example, you can say you want only the items that have *either* **Filter #1** or **Filter #2** to be true.

You can also use a mix of **And**'s and **Or**'s. When you do this, you should pay attention to the grouping boxes on the **Summary** tab. For example, there is one group box around filters #1 and #2 and another group box around filters #3 and #4. The And/Or is applied within the group boxes first and then the And/Or is applied between the group boxes.

Sort Fields Dialog Box

[See Also](#)

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the [Customize-Sort View](#) command.

For each sort field, there is a [drop-down list box](#) for the field name and a [radio group](#) for the sort type. The drop-down list boxes contain a list of all the [fields](#) and [connections](#) in the view.

To choose a field for a sort field, select the down arrow on the right side of the appropriate list box (Primary Field, Secondary Field, Third Field, Fourth Field) and select one of the fields displayed. The default primary sort field is set to the Name field for that category.

To clear a sort, select the down arrow on the right side of the appropriate list box (Primary Field, Secondary Field, Third Field, Fourth Field) and select **(none)** from the top of the list. To clear all sorts at once, press the **Clear Sort** button. This resets the primary sort back to the Name field.

To change the sort type, select either the ascending or descending [radio button](#) that corresponds to the sort type you want for that field. Ascending sorts the field in a forward direction from the lowest field value to the highest, while descending sorts backwards. For more details, see the topic titled **Sort Order**.

Shortcut: In report and grid views, the primary sort field is indicated by a solid underline under the field label of the sort field (if displayed). The secondary sort field is indicated by a dotted underline under the field label of the sort field (if that field is displayed in the view). You can change the primary and secondary sort fields by following the steps below, instantly affecting the sort order of the view.

Left click on field label	sets primary sort, ascending
SHIFT + left click on field label	sets primary sort, descending
CTRL + left click on field label	sets secondary sort, ascending
SHIFT + CTRL + left click on field label	sets secondary sort, descending

If you choose a connection field as a sort field in a report or grid view, the view sorts (alphanumerically) on the [name field](#) of the first connected item, regardless of the actual connected field selected. If a connection field is chosen as the primary or secondary sort field, the solid or dotted underline indicator is placed under the field label for the connection.

If you choose a connection definition name as a sort field in a Gantt chart view, the Gantt chart sorts (alphanumerically) on the name field of the first item linked on that connection definition.

See [Customize-Design View-Fields Tab](#) for how to include connection fields in a view.

Customize-Database-Category

[See Also](#)

Summary of the commands on the **Category** tab:

Add: Add a new [category](#).

Edit: Edit the definition of the selected category. The category definition includes:

- category name
- [field](#) definitions; each field has:
 - field type
 - field [name](#)
 - field size
- allow items with duplicate name fields (toggle)
- [clarify field](#) for duplicate item Names

Copy: Add a new category by copying the definition of the selected category.

Delete: Delete the selected category.

Time Conflict: Enable/disable event time conflict checking for the selected category and select fields to be used for time conflict checking.

Customize-Database-Color Code

[See Also](#)

Selecting **Customize-Database-Color Code** from the [menu bar](#) displays the [Color Code tab](#).

Use this command to add, edit, and delete color code templates. Color code templates specify the colors used to accent entries in [views](#).

In a calendar, the color code is used in the background area behind the item description. In standard report views and grid views, the color code is used as the text foreground color. In general, items can be color coded according to the value of a check box [field](#), selection field, or a connection in each [item](#).

For example, in the default Calendar view, the color code template is based on the Type of Calendar item. If you turn on the **Show Legend** checkbox, a legend is displayed that explains the color code template in use. The color code template used by the Calendar view in the Tutorial Database is the **Appointment Type** template.

Color code templates are associated with a particular [category](#) and can be used by any view in that category.

You can define as many color coding templates for a category as you like, up to the maximum allowed per [database](#).

Customize-Database-Connection

A [connection](#) is a bi-directional link between two [categories](#) (or a category and itself). Use the **Customize-Database-Connection** command to add, edit, and delete connections between any two categories, or between a category and itself.

Once you establish a connection, you can link [items](#) from the categories participating in the connection together to create relationships among your data, and reduce the amount of redundant data in your [database](#).

Selecting the **Customize-Database-Connection** command displays the [Connection dialog box](#), which lists the names of the connections from the [active category](#) to other categories. The **Add**, **Edit**, and **Delete** buttons in this dialog box allow you to manage the connections between the categories in the active database.

SEE ALSO:

[Connections Overview](#) A discussion of the basics of connections and connecting items together.

[Connecting an Item to Another Item](#) Detailed instructions on using [connection controls](#) on [item details](#).

[Customize-Database-Detail Form](#) Describes [detail forms](#) and how to change their layouts (content, appearance, and arrangement of fields).

Customize-Database-Detail Form A detail form is used to enter data into a category. Detail forms are also used to view particular items in a category. Many different detail forms may be defined for each category, making it possible for very specific forms to be developed to meet various requirements.

The **Customize-Database-Detail Form** command displays the [Detail Form](#) dialog box. Use this command to customize how an [item detail](#) is displayed using a particular [detail form](#). You can:

- select which fields are displayed on a form
- change the arrangement of [fields](#)
- select different text and background colors

- select different font styles

- add new detail forms

- create VBScripts for forms

If you want to arrange the fields on an open item detail, however, we recommend you use the [Customize-Design View](#) command (or the design button  [image/design_shg.gif](#) on the tool bar) instead of this command. This will avoid having to save all the open item details before rearranging the fields. For example, if you are editing or adding an item for the Calendar category, and you don't like the arrangement of fields on the item detail form, select **Customize-Design View** instead of this command; the **Customize-Database-Detail Form** command requires that you close any open item details that use a detail form before editing the detail form.

Import/Export Dialog Box

Use the **Import/Export** [dialog box](#) to manage your import/export templates. An import/export template stores the name of the Commence [category](#) to use, how to read the external file, how the fields in the external file correspond with the [fields](#) in your category, and how Commence should update your category.

Commence is delivered with an import/export template for each category. Use the **Edit** button as described below to examine the template definitions.

Unless your external file is self-describing (that is, one with a sample file), you will need to know how the external file is formatted, including the order of the fields.

Note: There are some special measures that you must take when you import connections from an external file. See [Importing Connections](#).

ADD BUTTON

When you select the **Add** button, Commence displays the [Template Definition](#) dialog box.

EDIT BUTTON

Select the **Edit** command to view or edit the import/export template highlighted in the **Import/Export Templates** list box. Commence displays the [Template Definition](#) dialog box filled in with the details of the template.

You cannot change the category name or the [file format](#) for a template.

COPY BUTTON

Select the **Copy** command to make a copy of the highlighted template in the **Import/Export Templates** list box. The category selection, field mapping, import rules, and export rules (if applicable) will all be identical to the original template. You must, however, enter a unique Template Name to identify the newly copied template.

DELETE BUTTON

To delete an import/export template that you do not expect to use in the future, highlight the template name in the **Import/Export Templates** list box and select the **Delete** command. Commence displays a confirmation message before deleting the template.

Select **Yes** to delete the template, **No** to cancel the deletion.

CLOSE BUTTON

Select **CLOSE** to return to the [work area](#).

Database Options Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you choose the [Customize-Workgroup](#) command, then press the **Next >** button once to get to this screen.

DEFAULT PERMISSIONS...

Use this command to set the default user level and category permissions for the active shared database. Pressing this button displays the [Authorization Defaults](#) dialog box.

ASSIGN USERS...

Use this command to match up the Login ID's of Commence users in your workgroup with items in the Person category (or similar category). The names of all users should be entered into the Commence Person category before you can perform this step. This information will be used for selective permissions to determine which users should receive which items. Pressing this button displays the [Assign Users to Commence Items](#) dialog box.

SELECT CONNECTIONS...

Use this command to configure which connections (between each shared category and the Person category) to use for selective permissions. Pressing this button displays the [Select Connections for Selective Permissions](#) dialog box.

REQUIRE USERS TO LOGIN TO THE SHARED DATABASE

Turn on the **Require Users to Login...** check box if you wish to restrict who can access the currently open database. If selected, Commence will prompt for a login name and password whenever you open this database.

Initially, you can set the passwords for all your users. Start ComAdmin, then select the **Users** icon (or select **File-Users** from the menu). Select the user's name and press **Edit** to change or remove the password. Each user can then personalize that password from Commence, after they have logged in for the first time, by selecting Edit-Preferences-Database.

BACK

Use the **Back** button to go back to the previous dialog box.

NEXT

Use the **Next** button to advance to the next dialog box.

FINISH

Select the **Finish** button to close the Customize Workgroup dialog box. This will save whatever changes you may have made, or cancel if no changes were made.

Permissions Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you choose the [Customize-Workgroup](#) command, then press the **Next >** button twice to get to this screen.

SET PERMISSIONS FOR...

You may set permissions for clients to this shared database by selecting one or more user name(s) from the list box.

SELECT ALL/DE-SELECT ALL

Pressing the **Select All** button selects all the user names from the list, allowing you to set permissions globally for all users at once. To undo your selection, press the same button, which will now be labeled **Deselect All**.

EDIT PERMISSIONS...

After selecting the user names, categories, or desktops, press this button to change the permission from the current values shown. Pressing this button displays the [Edit Authorizations](#) dialog box.

BACK

Use the **Back** button to go back to the previous dialog box.

NEXT

Use the **Next** button to advance to the next dialog box.

FINISH

Select the **Finish** button to close the Customize Workgroup dialog box. This will save whatever changes you may have made, or cancel if no changes were made.

Communications Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you choose the [Customize-Workgroup](#) command, then press the **Next >** button until you get to this screen. For more detailed instructions, see:

- Configuring Server and Client Communications

CONFIGURE...

This button in the Server Communications group box is used to configure the communication parameters for the Server. If any clients will be syncing via E-Mail, the parameters entered would include the Server's E-Mail Login Name and password. If any clients will be syncing via a shared LAN directory, the only parameter you need to specify is which directory the server will use for storing updates for the active shared database. Pressing this button displays the [Workgroup Communications](#) dialog box.

CONFIGURE...

This button in the Client Communications group box is used to select the preferred method of syncing for each of your clients. Select one client at a time from the list and press the **Configure** button to display the [Workgroup Communications](#) dialog box.

BACK

Use the **Back** button to go back to the previous dialog box.

NEXT

Use the **Next** button to advance to the next dialog box.

FINISH

Select the **Finish** button to close the Customize Workgroup dialog box. This will save whatever changes you may have made, or cancel if no changes were made.

Register Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you choose the [Customize-Workgroup](#) command, then press the **Next >** button until you get to the Register screen. For more detailed step-by-step instructions see:

- How to register Clients

ALL USERS

In the list of all users, select a user who is not yet registered to the shared database. Pressing the **Register** button adds the selected user's name to the list of registered users who have access to the shared database. Note: Access rights (Read-Write-Delete) should be configured using the Permissions screen before the user is registered.

REGISTER

Use this command to add the selected user's name to the list of registered users.

Each user can only be registered once; if the user you select is already registered, the **Register** button will be grayed out.

REGISTERED USERS

Select the name of a registered user from this list, then press either the **Details** button or the **Remove** button. See the description of each button below for more information.

DETAILS

Use this command to see the user's authorization key, or to create an instruction sheet for that user. Pressing this button displays the [Registered User](#) dialog box.

REMOVE

Use this command to remove (i.e. un-register) a user from the workgroup. A confirmation message will be displayed before the user is permanently removed. This frees up that user's license to be used by another user. This also notifies the server to perform the necessary cleanup.

BACK

Use the **Back** button to go back to the previous dialog box.

NEXT

Use the **Next** button to advance to the next dialog box.

FINISH

Select the **Finish** button to close the Customize Workgroup dialog box. This will save whatever changes you may have made, or cancel if no changes were made.

Enroll Client Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the [Customize-Workgroup](#) command at a user's workstation from a database that has not yet enrolled to the shared database.

CANCEL

Select **Cancel** to return to the work area without enrolling in a shared database.

BACK

The **Back** button will be grayed out on this screen. Use the Cancel button to go back to the work area.

NEXT

Select the **Next** button to continue with the enroll process.

FINISH

The **Finish** button will be grayed out until all the enroll dialog boxes are filled in properly.

Spell Checker Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed by the **Tools-Spell Check** command when it finds a misspelled word in a [text field](#) on an [item detail](#).

As the spell checker finds a spelling it does not recognize, it displays a portion of the text containing the unrecognized spelling and highlights it.

The **Spell Checker** dialog box gives you three buttons for accepting the spelling of the currently highlighted word as correct, one that allows you to manually edit the word or ask the spell checker for suggested spellings, and a **Done** button to leave the spell checker. Once all misspelled words have been accepted or replaced, only the **Done** button remains selectable.

HERE

To accept only the currently highlighted occurrence of a word's spelling within the field being checked, select the **Here** button from the **Accept** group box. Commence then highlights the next misspelled word in the field (if any).

EVERYWHERE

To accept all occurrences of a word's spelling within the field being checked, select the **Everywhere** button from the **Accept** group box. Commence then highlights the next misspelled word in the field (if any).

PERMANENTLY

To place the current spelling of a word into your personal dictionary and accept all occurrences of a word's spelling within the field being checked, select the **Permanently** button from the **Accept** group box. This lets you add words, such as jargon or acronyms, common to your business or profession, so that the spell checker won't flag them as misspellings. Commence then highlights the next misspelled word in the field (if any).

SUGGESTIONS

Select the **Suggestions** button to manually edit the misspelled word or get spelling suggestions from the spell checker. Selecting this button displays the [Type a Correction or Select a Suggestion dialog box](#).

DONE

Select the **Done** button when you are finished checking the spelling of words.

Schedule Meeting Dialog Box

[See Also](#)

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the [Tools-Schedule Meeting](#) command.

The description of this dialog box is based on the Meeting Preferences set in Commence's pre-defined categories. If (Use Outlook) has been selected using the Edit-Preferences-Meeting menu command, the Schedule Meeting command will launch the Microsoft Outlook Meeting Scheduler. Refer to the Microsoft Outlook online help for additional information about using the Microsoft Outlook Meeting Scheduler.

The **Schedule Meeting** dialog box contains these elements:

NAME

Type in a descriptive name for the appointment or calendar to-do.
The name can be up to 35 characters. This field is required.

LOCATED IN

This [list box](#) contains the names of items from a location category. Select one item as the location for the meeting. This field is optional.

PARTICIPANTS AND NON-PARTICIPANTS

These list boxes contain item names from the Person/Company category. The boxes are used to build a list of participants for the meeting as described below. If you select **Find Time**, the appointment category of the selected Participants is checked for availability. See [Find Time](#) dialog box. If you select **Save**, the saved appointment is connected to these selected Participants.

To select Participants, highlight one or more people from the non-participants list box and select either the **Required** or **Optional** button to move them to the Participants list box. Required participants have check marks in front of their names in the list box. If you have a User Item selected, your name will already be selected as a "Required" participant.

To remove participants from the meeting, highlight a name from the Participants list box and select the **Remove** button.

To highlight multiple individual items in either of the **Participants** list boxes, press and hold down the **Ctrl** key as you click the mouse button over them. To highlight a range of items in either of the **Participants** list boxes, highlight the first item in the range, move the list box using the scroll bars (if necessary) to display the item at the other end of the range, then press and hold down the **Shift** key as you click the mouse button over the last item in the range.

Shortcut: To add a single optional participant, double click the mouse button over the name of a participant in the list box at right. To remove a single optional or required participant, double click the mouse button over the name of a participant in the list box at left.

FIND TIME

Select this button to find an available appointment date and time for the selected **Participants**. For more information, see [Find Time](#) dialog box.

DATE

Type in a date for the meeting. If present, it is used as the starting date for **Find Time**. This field is optional and defaults to today's date.

START TIME

Type in a start time for the meeting. This field is optional if you are using the Find Time feature or saving a Day Title.

END TIME

Type in an end time for the meeting. This field is optional if you are using the Find Time feature or saving a Day Title. If you save this information with a Start Time but a blank End Time, Commence automatically sets your End Time to equal your Start Time.

COMMENTS

Type in an agenda, notes, or comments for the meeting.

COORDINATED BY

This box lets you select the name of the person responsible for the meeting. When you select **Save**, this person will be connected to your appointment item. This person's appointments are **not** checked for availability.

RESOURCES

Select this button to choose resources such as a viewgraph projector or speaker phone needed for your meeting. See the [Resources](#) dialog box for more information. When you select **Save** from the **Schedule Meeting** dialog box, any resources you selected are automatically connected to the appointment.

SAVE

Select this button to add your new item and its connections to your calendar category.

CANCEL

Select this button to close the **Schedule Meeting** dialog box without adding an item to your calendar category.

Select File Dialog Box

This [dialog_box](#) appears when a command or operation requires a file name. The **Select File** dialog box lets you search through the available disks on your system for an appropriate file.

FILE NAME

Type a file name in the **File Name** text box or select a name from the **File Name** list box. This box lists all the files with the extension selected in the **List Files Of Type** box. If the file you want has an extension other than the one selected by Commence, or you want to search for other files, type an asterisk (*), a period, and an extension (example: .txt), then choose OK to see a list of files (from the current directory) with that extension in the **File Name** list box. To see files with more than one extension, type a semicolon (;), a second asterik (*), a period, and another extension. For example if you want to see all the files with the .XFR and .TFR extensions, type *.XFR;*.TFR.

FILES OF TYPE

Select the type of file you want to see in the **File Name** list box.

Backup

Commence puts an initial file name into the **Filename** text box that is the name of the database directory whose contents you are trying to backup plus the **.xfr** extension. You can change the file name to anything you want.

Restore

Commence puts the string ***.xfr** into the **Filename** text box so that, by default, only filenames with the **.xfr** extension are listed in the **Files** list box. If your backup file has a different extension, replace **xfr** in the **Filename** list box so your file will be listed. (See [Open/Manage Database](#) for an explanation of backup and restore.)

Import/Export

Commence will select a default file extension for the **Filename** edit box based on the file format specified in your selected import/export template. The default file extensions are shown below. (See [File-Import](#) for an explanation of import/export templates.)

ASCII *.txt

dBASE *.dbf

DIF *.dif

The **DOS Text** [checkbox](#) allows you to translate between the Windows standard character set and the DOS character set. If you are sharing information between Commence and other Windows applications, leave this box unchecked. If you are sharing information between Commence and other applications that run in DOS but are not designed specifically for Windows, you should check this box.

For an **Export** operation, an **Archive** [check box](#) also is displayed.

Caution: If you turn on the **Archive** check box, all items in the exported category will be *deleted* from your database. Use this option only to archive and delete items you no longer need in your database.

Transfer

Commence puts the default extension for [transfer files](#), the string ***.tfr**, into the **Filename** text box so that, by default, only filenames with the **.tfr** extension are listed in the **Files** list box.

Sync Link

Commence puts the default extension for [update files](#), the string ***.snc**, into the **Filename** text box so that, by default, only filenames with the **.snc** extension are listed in the **Files** list box.

Directories

Select the directory from the **Directories** list box.

Drives

Select the drive that contains the file you want to select.

Once the file name you want appears in the **File Name** text box, select **OK** to confirm your choice.

Shortcut: You can double-click the mouse on a file name in the **File Name** list box, or on a drive in the **Drives** list box or directory name in the **Directories** list box to select them.

Choose **Cancel** to cancel the select file operation.

Sync Out Dialog Box

[See Also](#)

This [dialog box](#) is displayed by the [Tools-Sync Link Out](#) command.

In this dialog box, you can define and maintain a set of two or more identical databases (called a sync link group). You can also manage this sync link group by adding, editing, and deleting remote databases. Once you establish a sync link group you can compress a Commence database into a single file (called an update file) to sync link the database changes from one PC to the other as you move between them. When you choose the database to synchronize and select **OK**, the sync out begins.

SYNCHRONIZE WITH DATABASE

Use the **Synchronize with Database** [drop-down list box](#) to select the name of the remote database for which you are creating an update file. Database names are added to this list when you select the **Add** button. See the heading *Adding A Remote Database* below.

SYNC FILENAME

Use the **Sync filename** text box to enter (or use the **Select** button to choose) a filename to hold the updates for the selected remote database. The [update file](#) is the input file for a [Tools-Sync Link In](#) command.

DEFINE REMOTE DATABASE

The buttons in the **Define Remote Database** [group box](#) allow you to **Add**, **Edit**, and **Delete** remote database names from the base database of a sync link group only. These buttons are unavailable on a remote database in a sync link group. See the headings *Adding/Editing/Deleting A Remote Database* below.

SYNC TYPE

This [radio group](#) is used to specify the amount of information in the update file. Select **Incremental** for an "incremental update" which consists of only the information which has been updated since the previous update file was created. This is the default setting. Select **Complete** for a "complete update" which consists of all definitions and data in the open database.

OK

Select **OK** to begin creation of the update file for the selected database.

CANCEL

Select **Cancel** to return to the [work area](#).

Creating An Update File

To create a [update file](#), first select the database you want to synchronize with from the **Synchronize with Database** [drop-down list box](#) and then select **Incremental** or **Complete** from the **Sync Type** [radio group](#). The name of the update file will appear in the **Sync Filename** [text box](#). If you want to change the filename, type it in or use the **Select** button to choose an update file name. Once you select **OK** the sync out begins.

Adding A Remote Database

To add a new database to a sync link group, select the **Add** button. This displays the [Add Remote Database](#) dialog box. Make sure that the base database is the last database in which you did a [Tools-Sync Link In](#) command.

Caution: If your base database does *not have* the most recent updates to the sync link group's data and you initialize your new remote database, your sync link group will now have inconsistent copies of the database. This means that your sync link group *will no longer be synchronized and you may lose data*.

Note: After adding a new remote database you will need to create an initial update file for the database. See [Creating the Initial Update File](#) for a description of this process.

Editing A Remote Database

Selecting the **Edit** button from the **Sync Out** dialog box lets you change the name of the currently selected remote database. This displays the [Edit Remote Database](#) dialog box.

Deleting A Remote Database

Selecting this button displays a message box that asks for confirmation before deleting the database name currently displayed. Select **Yes** to delete the indicated database name. Select **No** to cancel.

Caution: You can always re-add a deleted database name, but you will have to create an initial update file for the database (see the instructions given above under *Adding a Remote Database*). This means that you must start over with an empty remote database. The database formerly used as the remote under the deleted name cannot be used again as a remote database.

Transfer Rules Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) may be displayed after you select **OK** on the [Select Transfer File](#) dialog box. It appears automatically when Commence detects data (i.e., items) in a [transfer file](#). To use the box, choose appropriate options and select **OK** to begin the transfer.

TRANSFER IN ITEMS

This [check box](#) is on by default and if it is left on the items contained in the transfer file will also be transferred. If this check box is turned off, the other choices in this dialog box are disabled, and no items are transferred into the database.

NEW ITEMS

This [radio group](#) tells Commence how to insert items with new names into your category. Select the **Add** radio button to automatically add each item with a new name into the category. Select the **Ask before adding** radio button to have Commence prompt you for confirmation before adding each new item.

EXISTING ITEMS

This radio group tells Commence how to handle incoming items that have the same name as one or more existing items in the category. How you want to handle these items will depend in part on whether the category allows duplicates. The radio button choices in this group are described in the *Existing Item Rules* section, below.

OK

Select **OK** to confirm the selected transfer rules and begin importing items from the transfer file.

CANCEL

Select **Cancel** to terminate the transfer of items. Any definitions already transferred from the transfer file remain in the open database.

Existing Item Rules

The selected rule in the **Existing Items** radio group determines what happens when there is a conflict between the name of an existing item and an item (or items) being transferred into the open database.

In the explanations below, the "name" of an item includes the contents of the name field and the [clarify field](#) for the category (if one is defined). Items with the identical name values but with *different* clarify field values are *not* considered duplicates.

Replace duplicates, all fields

Delete each item in the target category with the same name as that of an incoming item, and replace it with the data item from the transfer file.

Replace duplicates, incoming fields only

For duplicate items, replace only the field values being transferred in. Other field values in the existing item remain unchanged.

Ask on duplicates, then replace all fields

Operates the same way as **Replace duplicates, all fields** (above), except that for each duplicate item found, displays a message box showing the item name and asks if the item should be replaced (**OK**) or skipped (**Cancel**).

Ask on duplicates, then replace incoming fields only

Operates the same way as **Replace duplicates, incoming fields only** (above), except that for each duplicate item found,

displays a message box showing the item name and asks if the fields in the item should be replaced (**OK**) or skipped (**Cancel**).

Add duplicates as new item

If the category allows duplicates, items with the same names as existing items will simply be added to the category.

Skip duplicates

Ignore an incoming item that has the same name as an existing item.

Transferring In Objects with Duplicate Names

During the transfer in, whenever Commence detects an object (category, view, etc.) in the transfer file that has the same name as an existing object of the same type in the target database, Commence uses the existing definition rather than the one in the transfer file.

For example, let's say that you have a Project category in your database that has four fields defined. You transfer in from a file that has a Project category with the same four fields as the existing category, *plus* another field. Commence will skip over the extra field in the transfer file and add only the items from the file. As it adds items, any fields in the incoming data that are not defined in the existing category are *not* transferred. In our example, the fifth field from the transfer file's Project category is *not* transferred into the target database.

If you want to replace the Project category with the category from the transfer file, then you will have to *first* change the name of the existing Project category (using [Customize-Database-Category](#)) and *then* start the transfer.

Note: Transfer cannot be used to update field definitions or to merge categories with the same name but different field definitions. If the category in the target database is modified to

match the category being transferred in, only then will all items and fields in the transfer file successfully merge with the target database. Use the [Sync Link Out](#) command to make changes to categories and fields in a target database.

Transfer Out Options Dialog Box

[See Also](#)

This [dialog box](#) is displayed by the [Tools-Transfer Out](#) command.

To create a [transfer file](#), first select **Category** or **View** from the **Transfer by** [group box](#). Then select the categories or views you want to transfer from the [multi-select list box](#) on the left, and any agents you want to transfer from the **Transfer Agents** multi-select list box on the right. If you want to transfer items and related data files (DOS files pointed to by data file fields), turn on the appropriate check box(es). Select **OK** and then select a transfer file name. Once you choose a file name, the transfer out begins.

TRANSFER BY

Select the **Category** or **View** button to display a list of categories or views in the list box on the left of the dialog box. You may select multiple categories or views from the list by clicking the left mouse button over them (see [Keyboard Commands](#) for how to do this using the keyboard).

Dependent definitions and data are included in the transfer file automatically.

TRANSFER AGENTS

Select the agents you want to transfer from this list box. You may select multiple agents from the list. Dependent definitions and data are included in the transfer file automatically.

SELECT ALL

These buttons allow you to highlight all of the entries in the list directly above the button selected.

ALSO TRANSFER

Turn on the **Items** [check box](#) to transfer out all items in the selected categories or views. If you turn on the **Items** check box, you may also turn on the **Related Data Files** check box to transfer out all files referenced by data file fields in the transferred items. See **External Data Files** group box in the [Edit-Preferences-Other](#) dialog box for more information on where data files are stored when transferred into a database.

OK

Select this button to confirm your transfer option choices and select a transfer file name. This displays the [Select Transfer File](#) dialog box

CANCEL

Select this button to cancel the **Transfer Out** command.

Note: If you want to transfer only items, use the [Export-By Category](#) command or the [Export-By View](#) command to create a DOS file and use the [Import](#) command to read the file into a database.

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Export Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed by the [File-Export-By Category](#) and [File-Export-By View](#) commands.

Use the **Export** dialog box to tell Commence which template to use when you want to export data. An import/export template stores the name of the Commence category to be exported, what data format to use when writing the external file, and which fields in your category you want to export.

The same templates and dialog boxes are used for importing and exporting; the only major difference between import and export is the direction of the transfer.

Note that there are special considerations concerning *importing* connection definition data from an export file. See [Importing Connections](#).

EXPORT BUTTON

Before selecting the **Export** button on the **Export** dialog box, highlight the name of the import/export template you want to use. When you select the **Export** button, Commence displays the [Select Export File](#) dialog box.

Commence displays a message box as the export progresses. You can select **Cancel** to stop the export operation, in which case nothing is written to disk.

CANCEL BUTTON

Select **CANCEL** to discontinue the export process and return to the [work area](#).

Basic Concepts

If you are learning Commence concepts for the first time, you should read this section.

This Basic Concepts section is divided into the following topics:

[Categories](#)

[Views and View Types](#)

[Connections](#)

[Agents](#)

[Databases](#)

[Drag and Drop Operations](#)

[Finding Items in a List with Prefix Matching](#)

[Natural Language Dates and Times](#)

Installing the Server Software

The first step to be done when establishing a Commence Workgroup is to install the Server Software. Any PC connected to a Local Area Network (LAN) or the Internet can be used as the Commence Server. Since the Server is the hub for all data changes within the Workgroup, it is recommended that a dedicated PC be used for the Commence Server, especially if there will be many Clients. For a small workgroup, the Server can run on the same PC as a Commence Client. The Commence Server must be installed from the PC that will run the Server software.

Perform the following procedure to install Commence Workgroup. The same procedure is used whether installing Commence for the first time or re-installing Commence.

NOTE: If working with a previous installation of Commence, a new copy of Commence can be installed over the previous installation, or it can be installed in a new location, resulting in two different versions of Commence residing on the same machine.

1. Insert the Commence CD into the computer's CD ROM drive.
2. If autorun is enabled the CD will run automatically. Otherwise, select the **Run** command from the **Start** menu on the Windows task bar.
3. Type **d:\setup.exe** then click OK. This example assumes d:\ is the drive letter that refers to the CD ROM drive. Click the Browse button if you are unsure of which driver letter to use.
4. An introductory screen will appear. You may click **Continue** to proceed or wait for the menu to appear.
5. Click **Install** to select which software to install. Select Commence RM Workgroup to begin the server installation.
6. The Software License agreement will be displayed. If you agree to abide by the terms of the license agreement click

- Yes** to continue. Clicking No will cancel the setup operation.
7. You will be prompted to enter your user information. You must enter a valid Commence RM license number in the box labeled Serial number. Click **Next** after all the information is entered correctly. Then click **Yes** to confirm your registration information.
 8. Select **Next**. Follow the instructions on the screen and enter the requested information. If additional assistance is required select the **Help** button provided on the installation screens.

When the installation is complete, you will be prompted to run the license administration program (license.exe). You should select **Yes** to do so. This will allow you to set the user limit for the number of clients that will be accessing the shared database. You will also need to activate the software before it can be used.

License Administration

Once the Commence Server has been installed, you will need to run the license administration software. Sales will provide you with a license upgrade key that indicates the number of clients you can enroll to a shared database in Commence.

To administer licenses:

1. Select the **Run** command from the **Start** menu on the Windows task bar.
2. Click Browse to locate the **LICENSE.EXE** program. This file can be found in the **ADMIN** subdirectory under the Commence program directory. This is the same directory as ComAdmin.
3. The License Administration Program will automatically fill in your user information (Name, Company Name, Serial No.) from the Commence installation.
4. In the **Authorization Key:** field, enter the key you received from Commence Sales.
5. Select OK.

This will set your user limit in ComAdmin allowing you to add the correct number of users.

Adding Users to the Commence Workgroup

After adding the client licenses, you will need to add users for your workgroup.

Note The “admin” Login ID identifies the special user that has permission to make all changes to the Commence workgroup in order to set it up, maintain users, and maintain shared databases. The “admin” Login ID is automatically added to your Commence workgroup during installation and does not have a password by default.

To add users:

1. Start ComAdmin from the Windows Program Manager or Start Menu. Note: The only Login ID that can add users is the “admin” ID.
2. Select the **Users** button.
3. For each user you want to add, select the **Add** button.
4. Enter the settings for the user, including their full name, their Commence login ID, and a password. Note that a password is not required and may be left blank.

Note: The login ID is the name that is entered when logging into a Commence shared database. This is typically the user’s initials, first name, last name, or a combination of the above. It is recommended that each user’s login ID be set to the same ID they use for logging into the network in order to make it easier to remember.

5. When complete, select **Save**.

Note You must have a license for each user. Additional licenses can be purchased from your dealer or Commence Corporation. If a user needs to have more than one client database, for example one at work and one on their laptop, they can use Sync Link. For more information see, *Using Sync Link in your Workgroup* in the *Server Guide* (*svrguide.pdf*).

Note Each Commence Server has a limit on the number of clients that it can service. This limit can be displayed by opening the About dialog box in ComAdmin with the **Help-About** menu command. You can only add as many client licenses and users as this limit allows and can upgrade the Commence Server Edition to handle more clients as necessary. Contact your distributor for information on increasing the number of clients allowed by the Commence Server.

Setting Up a Shared Database

The basis for any Commence Workgroup is a Shared Database, which is defined using **ComAdmin**. Whether creating a new database from scratch, or converting an existing stand-alone database to a Shared Database, the database will need to be added via **ComAdmin**.

Perform the following procedure to add a Shared Database:

To add a shared database:

1. Start ComAdmin from the Windows Program Manager or Start Menu. Note: The only Login ID that can add shared databases is the “admin” ID. By default, this user has no Password. You can change the password after you login for the first time.
2. In ComAdmin, select the **Databases** button. You will be presented with a dialog box that shows the defined shared databases.
3. Select the **Add** button.
4. Enter a **Name** and **Description** for the new shared database.
5. In the **Database Location** box, enter the path of the database that will become the shared database. This can either be the path of an existing database that you want to be shared or an empty, new database.

Note: This is the database that will be run by the Server. This database path can be located on a local drive of the server PC. Do not use a directory that is used for other Commence files such as the Workgroup Administration Files or Program Directory.

6. When finished filling out the **Add Shared Database** dialog, select the **OK** button to save the changes and create the shared database. For more information on shared databases, see the Server Guide (svrguide.pdf), or run

ComAdmin and search for 'Adding a Shared Database' in the on-line help.

Starting the Server

[See Also](#)

The Commence server must be running in order to:

- *set user access*
- *configure client communications*
- *register clients*
- *synchronize data*

Before any configuring of the database can begin, the Commence Server must be running and the Shared Database must be open.

Note: The following procedures assume that the Server was installed using the default path values. If the Server was installed in a location other than the default location, some the menu selections indicated will need to be modified.

Starting the Server:

1. From the **Start** Menu, select **All Programs -> Commence RM Workgroup -> Commence RM Workgroup**.
2. If Commence does not open in the shared database, select **Open/Manage Database** and open the desired database.

Note: The server **MUST** be running the shared database in order for any client to enroll or to have any synchronization occur.

After the Server has been successfully started and the Shared Database opened, the next step is to establish what the Default Permissions are to be for a newly added User. Proceed to **Set Default Permissions** to continue configuring the Shared Database.

Note You should always log into the server using the “*admin*” ID.

If you have more than one shared database, each database must be opened using a separate copy of Commence. For

more information, see [Running Multiple Commence Servers on One PC.](#)

Configuring Permissions

Commence can control who can see and change information in the shared database. This section describes how you can configure the default permissions which are assigned to all new users added to a Commence workgroup. These default permissions can be overridden for each user in order to fine-tune what data they can see or change. Permissions in a Commence shared database are described in more detail the *Server Guide* (*svrguide.pdf*).

Setting Default Permissions

The default permissions for a shared database are *User* for the User Level and *All* for the Category Permissions. If you do not want to change these defaults, you can skip this step.

To configure the default permissions for the database:

1. Verify that the proper Server database is open.
2. Select **Customize-Workgroup** and then select the **Next>** button until you reach the **Database Options** screen.
3. Select the **Default Permissions** button.
4. You can now set the default permissions for the database and the shared categories in the database. All users are assigned these default permissions unless you specifically override them on a per-user basis.
5. When completed, select **Save**.

Setting Client and Server Communications

The Commence server and clients communicate with each other by sending data files back-and-forth to each other. This communication can be accomplished by using an FTP directory, a shared LAN directory or an external e-mail program.

Before configuring the communications information first make a list of all users and how they should communicate with the server. If all the users will use the shared LAN directory then there is no need to set e-mail parameters. If e-mail will be used make sure that the users have been added to the e-mail program and that you know their user IDs.

Note The Commence server can synchronize using all available methods (FTP, shared LAN directory and e-mail) but each client must choose any one method.

 [image/chiclet.gif](#) Setting Server Communications

 [image/chiclet.gif](#) Setting Client Communications

Registering Clients

Each client must be registered with the Shared Database. Registering will create a link between the Clients and the Server. Registering from the Server will generate an Instruction Sheet, which is to be given to the appropriate user. This sheet includes information necessary in order to enroll as a user from the Client Database. Also, initialization information will be sent to each client using the communication settings as configured above.

This process gives the Commence administrator full control over which users can enroll to a shared database. Users cannot enroll to a shared database without the administrator's knowledge, because this process gives the Commence administrator full control over which users can enroll to a shared database. Users cannot enroll to a shared database without the administrator's knowledge, because the administrator must register the user for that specific database ahead of time.

Perform the following procedure to register a client with the shared database:

1. From the *Customize Workgroup - Communications* Dialog Box, click **Next >**. The *Customize Workgroup - Register* Dialog Box is displayed.
2. From the list of *All Users*, highlight the user that is to be registered with the Shared Database.
3. Click **Register**. The *Register User* Dialog Box is displayed.
4. Click **OK**. An informational Dialog Box is displayed, providing the authorization key for the user just registered. Additionally, it will ask if an Instruction Sheet should be generated for this user.

The instruction sheet provides step-by-step instructions for enrolling in the shared database. Since the instruction sheet is a text file generated by Commence, it can be printed out, e-mailed, or faxed to the user.

The instruction sheet is generated from a template file that should be customized to include information about the site. At a minimum, it should include the Commence Administrator's name and telephone number so that users can contact the Administrator if they experience any difficulties. The template file is a text file that can be edited using any text editor (such as Notepad or WordPad).

There are three template files included with Commence:

- .steps1.txt** - is the e-mail template file

- .steps2.txt** - is the shared LAN template file

- .steps8.txt** - is the Internet template file

The templates are stored in the server's Admin Path (e.g., **wgfiles7**) which is located in the Application Data directory.

Each template file has special markers that Commence replaces with the appropriate data to create the instruction sheet. Some examples of the special markers include **(-Directory-)** and **(-Serial Number-)**. Do not remove these markers or the instruction sheets will be missing vital information!

5. Click **Yes**. The Save Dialog Box is displayed.
6. Indicate in which directory the instruction sheet is to be stored, and what the name of the user-specific sheet is to be.
7. Click **Save**. An informational dialog box will be displayed indicating that the instruction sheet has been successfully saved.
8. Click **OK**.
9. Repeat steps 2 through 8 for each user to be Registered with the Shared Database.

Installing the Client Software

After the Server and Shared Database have each been configured, Client software must be installed for each user. The user can install the Client Software themselves, but it must be verified that the software has been properly installed.

Clients can install the software themselves. However, the Commence Administrator may be called upon for assistance.

WARNING: If running a Client on the same PC as the Server, **DO NOT** install Client Software.

Note: The same installation procedure is followed whether installing the Client software for the first time or re-installing software for an existing Client.

1. Insert the Commence CD into the computer's CD ROM drive.
2. If autorun is enabled the CD will run automatically. Otherwise, select the **Run** command from the **Start** menu on the Windows task bar.
3. Type **d:\setup.exe** then click OK. This example assumes d:\ is the drive letter that refers to the CD ROM drive. Click the Browse button if you are unsure of which driver letter to use.
4. An introductory screen will appear. You may click **Continue** to proceed or wait for the menu to appear.
5. Click **Install** to select which software to install. Select **Commence RM Workgroup** to begin the server installation.
6. The Software License agreement will be displayed. If you agree to abide by the terms of the license agreement click **Yes** to continue. Clicking No will cancel the setup operation.
7. You will be prompted to enter your user information. You must enter a valid Commence RM license number in the box labeled Serial:. This number can be found with the license agreement in the front of the *Getting Started Guide*. Click

Next after all the information is entered correctly. Then click **Yes** to confirm your registration information.

8. Select **Next**. Follow the instructions on the screen and enter the requested information. If additional assistance is required select the **Help** button provided on the installation screens.

Enrolling Clients

To become a client in a workgroup, you must register the user to the shared database at the server. This will generate a instruction sheet with instructions on how to enroll from the client and send initialization information to the client. After that, the client can enroll to the shared database. During this process, the client will receive a copy of the shared database. The client can complete this step on their own, but you as the Commence Administrator may be called upon for assistance. Remember that for a user to enroll or to transmit or receive updates, the server copy of the database must be open. The following is how you would enroll a client.

Perform the following procedure to enroll a client to the shared database:

1. Verify that the Commence Administrator has registered the user to be enrolled with the server.
2. Launch Commence at the Client PC.
3. Open a standalone database. This is a database that is neither a Client Database nor a Server Database. If necessary, create a new database by using the **File -> Open/Manage Database** command.
4. Select **Customize -> Workgroup**. The *Customize Workgroup – Enroll Client* Dialog Box is displayed.
5. Select the **Next >** button.
6. Enter the **authorization key** in the space provided. This number is found on the Instruction Sheet generated when the Client was registered with the Server, and is available for each user from the Commence Administrator.
7. Select the **Next >** button. When each user was registered with the **Commence Server**, it was established how the Client Database would synchronize with the server (i.e. via a shared LAN directory, by e-mail, or the Internet.) The specific communications parameters must now be defined in order to

enable the synchronization of data between the Server and Client Databases.

8. Select **Configure**. The *Workgroup Communications* Dialog Box is displayed.
9. Indicate by which method data synchronization will take place for the Client that is being enrolled.
10. Click **OK** and proceed as indicated below. Any information required may be found by referring to the information sheet provided by the Commence Administrator.
 - When synchronizing by Shared LAN, indicate the path to the **Shared LAN Directory**, as well as the frequency with which Commence is to check this shared LAN directory for synchronization requests. When the information is complete, select **OK**. Proceed to step 11.
 - When synchronizing by E-Mail, select the **Mail Program** that will be used, as well as all related information that is indicated based on the mail program selected. When all information is complete, select **OK**. See the following figure. Indicate the **Server E-Mail Address**, as well as the frequency with which Commence is to check the e-mail program for synchronization requests. When the information is complete, select **OK**. Proceed to step 11.
 - When synchronizing by Internet FTP Directory, enter the full path to the FTP directory, the user name, and password. When the information is complete, select **OK**. Proceed to step 11.
11. When all *Workgroup Communications* parameters have been defined, the *Customize Workgroup – Enroll Client* Dialog Box is again displayed. Select the **Next >** button.
12. Next, information about the Local Database needs to be completed. Complete the following information for the Local Database:

- **Local Database Name** - The Local Database Name appears across the top of the Commence desktop, or when **File -> Open/Manage Database** is selected from the Menu Bar.
- **Local Database Path** - This is the directory in which the Client Copy of the shared database is stored For example, **c:\commence\clientdb**. Do not choose the path of an existing database, or a directory that contains any files used by Commence or any other program. If the directory indicated does not exist, Commence will automatically create it.

13. Select the **Next >** button. When all information has been correctly entered, a message indicating this is displayed.
14. Select **Finish**. Commence opens the new client database and proceeds to process the initial sync from the Commence Server. This downloads all information from the Commence Server to the Client Database. This may take several minutes. While Commence is busy, the *Sync in Progress* Message Box is displayed.

CAUTION The procedure just described must be completed by each client in order to enroll and obtain a personal copy of the shared database. It is not possible to simply copy the shared database for use by a Client.

Note Some information in Commence such as Preferences do not synchronize regularly, but may sync once during the initial enrollment to facilitate the client setup.

Note If an error occurs during the enroll process, contact the Commence Administrator. It will be necessary to Re-Register the Client with the Commence Server.

100 This category contains items with duplicate names. 'Allow Duplicate Names' may not be unchecked while this is true.

All [item](#) names in this [category](#) must be unique before deselecting 'Allow Duplicate Names'. Either give all items in the category unique names or delete all but one of each group of items with the same name. To locate all duplicate items in the category, create a new view of the category. Then filter for Name - Has Duplicates.

The 'Allow Duplicate Names' option is found by clicking the Advanced button when Adding, Editing, or Copying a Category. (See [Customize-Database-Category](#).) The 'Allow Duplicate Names' option is found by clicking the Advanced button when Adding, Editing, or Copying a Category. (See [Tools-Customize-Database-Category](#).)

101 <Category name> is an invalid category name.

You are trying to give the [category](#) an invalid name. The name "(none)" cannot be used as a category name.

102 A category with a recurring date field must allow duplicate names.

If you do not want to allow duplicate names, change the recurring date field to a regular date field before saving the category.

103 This data directory contains categories which allow more items than this version of Commence supports. Commence will now exit.

There is at least one category in the selected database directory that may contain more than the maximum number of items allowed by the currently running version of Commence. This database cannot be used by Commence.

To specify a different database use the /database= [command line option](#).

104 Invalid entry; please try again.

110 You cannot delete the Item Name field.

Each [category](#) has one mandatory [field](#) that identifies each [item](#). The field's type is [name](#) and it is labeled **Name**, by default. Commence uses this field to sort all book and calendar [views](#). Default reports are sorted by the name field and default Gantt charts use the name field as the third sort field (though the sort fields for these two view types are user-selectable).

Although it cannot be deleted, you can change a name type field's label from **Name** to whatever you want, though this may adversely affect any [agents](#) that require a name field labeled **Name** for this category.

111 Replacing the text will exceed the field's maximum size. Text cannot be replaced

112 The default string's length is greater than the field's size. You must reduce the size of the default string.

You must limit the default string to the number of allowable characters for the field. For example, even though the size of a default string is 255 characters maximum.

Either reduce the length of the default string or increase the size of the field. Press F1 while a field type is highlighted on the [Add/Edit Field dialog boxes](#) for an explanation of limitations on the default value for that field type.

113 The default selection must have a label. Change the default or add a label.

The default button must have a label. Add a label for the chosen button, or change your default button selection.

114 Add another radio button. You must define at least two buttons.

A [radio_group](#) field requires at least two labeled [buttons](#) in order for the field to be valid. If you want to define a field for a single option, use a [check box](#) field.

115 You cannot delete selections from existing fields.

Once you have added selections for a [selection](#) field and saved the [category](#), you cannot remove any of the selections. You can label or re-label any selection, or you can change the default selection.

If you labeled a selection by accident and saved the [field](#), but did not save the change to the new or edited category, select **Cancel** until you are back in the [work area](#) and begin again. See [Editing a Selection Field](#) for additional considerations.

119 Enter a whole number that is zero or greater for this field.

Sequence numbers must have a starting value of 0 or more. Enter a value into the field labeled "Initial Value". Do not use a decimal point.

121 The reserved word [Save, Cancel] cannot be used as a field name. Please enter a new field name.

The words **Save** and **Cancel** are labels reserved for use when adding or editing [items](#). Choose a different name before proceeding.

122 Multiple radio buttons have the same name. Make each name unique.

All radio buttons must have unique names.

123 The maximum number of characters cannot be greater than 30,000.

The maximum number of characters for a [text field](#) is 30,000. If you use such a large field, be aware that it requires a great deal of memory and may keep you from using other functions.

125 This equation has an unrecognized field name, operator or delimiter. Please correct the equation before proceeding.

A calculation field can only be defined for [number](#), [date](#), and [time](#) fields. Only the delimiters of +, -, /, *, (,), and the currency symbol (\$) in the United States and some other countries) defined in the Windows Control Panel are valid.

**126 Please enter a whole number between 1 and <8>
for 'Buttons Per Row'.**

The **Buttons Per Row** field accepts whole numbers from **1** to **8**.

129 There is a maximum of one Sequence number field per category. Delete any extra sequence number fields.

A [category](#) can only have one [sequence number](#) type [field](#). You must delete all but one sequence number type field in order to save your changes to this category.

130 The formula entered is too long. It cannot be saved.

The number of [fields](#) in the [calculation](#) equation (including duplicates) plus the number of mathematical symbols used (including parentheses) cannot exceed 20. For example, the formula **([Miles]*[Rate])** has a length of five (two field names, one asterisk, and two parentheses).

131 There is a maximum of one recurring date field per category. Deselect this option from all but one date field.

A [category](#) can have at most one [date field](#) that has the **Recurring Date Field** [check box](#) turned on. Edit the date type fields in this category, and make sure that one of them at most has this check box turned on.

**132 Enter an initial sequence number less than
2,000,000,000.**

The initial [sequence number](#) must be less than or equal to
2,000,000,000 (two billion).

**133 The formula for the calculation field <field name> contains a field name that is no longer valid.
Delete this calculation field or change its formula.**

The [calculation](#) equation contains one or more [fields](#) that were probably deleted. Remove the invalid field(s) named in the error message from the calculation or delete the calculation field from the [category](#). Use the [Customize-Database-Category](#) command to edit the category and delete the field.

140 Select a 'From' category and 'To' category before continuing.

Highlight a [category](#) name in both the **From** and **To** [list boxes](#) to define a [connection](#). You can use the same category for both sides of the connection.

141 Internal error during connection initialization - call technical support.

Contact Commence Technical Support and report this message
(Select **Help-About**)

142 Give the connections different names.

A [connection](#) between the same [category](#) must be unique. Enter a unique name for each connection and try again.

144 There is not enough room to add this connection to the <category name> category.

No more [connections](#) can be added to this [category](#). Delete an existing connection (or one or more fields) before adding any new ones.

Remember, a paired connection (between two categories) counts as two fields, a simple connection (between a category and itself) counts as one field.

145 Warning for category <category name>: If you edit the name of or delete this connection, recurring items will no longer be associated and cannot be edited or deleted in a group.

Commence uses a simple [connection](#) called **Related Date** to associate recurring [items](#) with each other. If you delete this connection or change its name you will be unable to edit or delete recurring items as a group.

147 The connection <connection name> is reserved for connecting recurring items. Commence creates this connection automatically when recurring items are added. Rename this connection or cancel this operation.

Commence uses a simple [connection](#) called **Related Date** to associate recurring [items](#) with each other. Change the connection name to something other than **Related Date**.

150 This field cannot be removed from the detail form because it is the name field or it is a mandatory field without a default value.

Each [category](#) has one mandatory, unique [field](#) of type [name](#) that identifies the [item](#) and cannot be removed from the [detail form](#).

Also, all fields that have the **Mandatory Field** [check box](#) turned on when defined, but do not have a **Default Value**, must also appear on the form. Other mandatory fields (with a default value) may be removed from the form. They will be assigned their default values on saving an item regardless of whether they appear on a particular detail form or not.

152 The detail form cannot be deleted since it is the only one defined for this category.

Every [category](#) must contain at least one [detail form](#), so that you can add and display [items](#).

153 There are no attributes to set for this field type.

[Excel cell](#) and [data file](#) type fields have no attributes to set.

154 Enter a valid width greater than 0 and no more than 250 characters.

The visible field width is limited to between 0 and 250 characters.
Adjust the field width to be within these limits.

155 Enter a valid height greater than 0 and no more than 50 lines.

The visible field height is limited to between 0 and 50 lines. Adjust the field height to be within these limits.

156 Enter a valid number for the visible size that is greater than 0 but does not exceed 20 inches or 50.8 centimeters.

For [image](#) type fields, the visible field size (width or height) must not exceed 20 inches (50.8 centimeters).

157 Add at least one field to this form before saving it.

A detail form must have at least one field. Use the **Add Field** button to add a field to the detail form.

163 Warning: Incoming E-Mail will not processed since no E-Mail program has been configured. Select Edit-Preferences-Other Apps to add E-Mail information.

Commence needs some information before it can properly interact with your mail program. Please enter this information using [Edit-Preferences-Other Apps](#).

164 Select appropriate date/time fields before continuing.

In order to proceed, you must select a [date](#) and [time](#) field from the selected [category](#).

165 The limit of <number> Tool Bar Pick agents per database has been reached. Either select a different trigger for this agent, or deactivate other Tool Bar Pick agents.

To free up a space, make an [agent](#) that uses the Agent Tool bar [inactive](#), change the [trigger](#) of an agent from [Tool Bar Pick](#) to [Menu Pick](#) (with the same [category](#) selection), or delete an [active](#) agent using a Tool bar Pick trigger if it is no longer needed.

166 Define at least one trigger and one action before saving this agent.

An [agent](#) consists of at least one [trigger](#) and one [action](#).

167 A trigger must be defined before you can define a condition or an action.

In order to define a [condition](#) or an [action](#), a [trigger](#) must be defined first (select the **T** button or press ALT-T).

168 You must provide [Menu Text, a DDE Message, Status Bar Message Text, a Message, an Application path name, all requested information, a path name, a name] before continuing.

There is textual information required by this function, [trigger](#), or [action](#). Enter the information specified before proceeding.

169 Select a view before continuing.

A [view](#) must be selected from the list provided in order for Commence to accept the [Icon Modification Action](#). Only views that can be accessed from the [view bar](#) are listed (i.e., the views that have **Display on View Bar** turned on via the [Customize-Design View](#) command).

170 This action requires a trigger/condition selection with only one selected category.

You have selected an [action](#) that requires a single [category](#) selection. Change the [trigger](#) and/or [conditions](#) for this action so that at least one of them specifies a particular category as part of its options. If you cannot, you not be able to use this action as specified. (Press F1 for specific help while editing a trigger, condition, or action).

171 You entered an invalid number of items. Enter a number from 0 to 500000 before continuing.

A [category](#) can contain from 0 to 500000 [items](#). Your [item count](#) value does not fall within these limits.

172 This command requires you to highlight an item in the *<category name>* category.

This [agent](#) cannot be [triggered](#) until you highlight an [item](#) in the [category](#) specified

173 Cannot save the actions. Each button label and corresponding action must be defined in pairs.

Each [message box action](#) button, if labeled, needs an associated [action](#) before continuing. Each [message box action](#), if defined, needs an associated [action](#) button label before continuing.

174 Please enter the required value before continuing.

A required value was not entered. Please enter the value before continuing.

175 Select a field before continuing.

In order to proceed, you must select a [number](#) or [calculation](#) field from the selected [category](#).

176 The Agent tool bar position you have chosen is already in use or the Tools Menu is full. The agent cannot be activated.

In order to activate an [agent](#) that uses a [Tool Bar Pick](#) or [Menu Pick trigger](#), there must be at least one free space on the [agent tool bar](#) or the [Tools menu](#). The **Tools** menu is capable of holding up to 16 agents with Menu Pick triggers.

177 The hotkey for this trigger is already used by the agent '<agent name>'. Please select a different hotkey.

178 Before continuing, please provide a valid [date, time, year, Start Time, End Time, Menu Text, DDE Message, Status Bar Message].

There is date/time information required by this [trigger](#) or [action](#). Enter the information specified in the message before proceeding.

179 Enter between [1 and 60, 0 and 59] minutes before continuing.

You must enter a valid range of minutes before proceeding.

180 Select Print Options before continuing.

You have not yet selected print options for this [action](#). Select the **Print Options** button.

181 The 'Process E-Mail' action can only be used with the 'Incoming Communications: E-Mail' trigger. Please use the appropriate trigger or select a different action.

The Process E-Mail action can be used only if the trigger is Incoming Communication: E-Mail. The agent does not currently satisfy this requirement. Either change the trigger to Incoming Communication: E-Mail or select a different action.

182 The limit of 16 Menu Pick agents had been reached. Either select a different trigger for this agent or deactivate other Menu Pick agents.

In order to [activate](#) an [agent](#) that uses a [Menu Pick trigger](#), there must be at least one free space on the [Tools menu](#). The Tools menu is capable of holding up to 16 agents with Menu Pick triggers.

183 This trigger/condition/action requires that at least one category or view be defined.

For this [trigger](#), [condition](#), or [action](#) to be accepted by Commence, at least one [category](#) (or [view](#) of a category) must be defined.

184 The field '<*field name*>' is mandatory and no default value is available. It cannot be left blank.

Supply a value for the specified [field](#), or edit the [category](#) so that the field is no longer mandatory. Item [name fields](#) are always mandatory.

185 The field '<field name>' is mandatory and no default value is available. It cannot be left blank. Select 'Field Values...' or check 'Display Item(s)' before proceeding.

Select the **Field Values** button and supply a value for the specified [field](#), or edit the [category](#) so that the field is no longer mandatory. Item [name fields](#) are always mandatory. If you turn on the **Display Item(s)** [check box](#) instead, you do not need to fill in any mandatory fields.

186 The field '<field name>' does not translate to a valid field in the <category name> category.

The specified [field](#) name does not exist in the specified [category](#). If you associate this [action](#) with a [trigger](#) or [condition](#) that can use [items](#) from any category (i.e., **All Categories** in the [Menu Pick](#) or [Tool Bar Pick](#) triggers) you can use field names that are common across more than one category. Note that untranslated field names (depending on the selected category at the time the agent is triggered) will not be replaced by field values when the action is executed.

187 Enter a time interval between 0 minutes and 23 hours, 59 minutes.

Enter a time interval within the specified range before continuing.

188 You must check 'added to', 'edited in', or both before continuing.

The [Save Item trigger](#) can be triggered upon adding an [item](#), editing an item, or both. At least one of these [check boxes](#) must be checked before the trigger can be accepted by Commence.

193 The maximum number of messages that can be snoozed has been reached.

There are already 100 snoozed messages and Commence cannot snooze any more messages. Press the **OK** button instead of the Snooze button.

194 Enter a valid snooze time between 1 and 999 minutes.

The length of time for a snooze period must at least one minute and at most 999 minutes.

195 Cannot create a Sync Link Out Agent. No remote databases defined. Use File - Sync Link Out to add one.

A Sync Link Out agent will create an [update file](#) for a [remote database](#). You must first use the [File-Sync Link Out](#) command and select the **Add** button to create a remote database, then you can define a Sync Link Out agent.

Using Sync Link Commands

If you are using several PCs and are not on a LAN, you can still maintain identical databases by using the Sync Link feature. With Sync Link, you can create a compressed update file from the designated base PC and read it into the remote PCs. See [Sync Link Concepts](#) for an more complete explanation of the Sync Link facility.

This section describes procedures for using the [sync link group](#) and for adding, editing, and deleting [remote databases](#). To see more about a procedure, select a topic from the list below or use the **Browse >>** button to see each topic in order:

1. [Defining the Sync link Group](#)
2. [Creating the Initial Update Files](#)
3. [Initializing Remote Databases](#)
4. [Using the Sync link Group](#)

For more details, see the [Sync Link Out](#) and [Sync Link In](#) commands and their options.

196 Cannot create an [Import or Export] Agent. Use File - [Import or Export] to add an [Import or Export] template.

An Import agent will read an external file into the open database.. You must first use the [File-Import](#) command and select the **Add** button to create an import template, then you can define an Import agent.

An Export agent will create an external file from data in the open database.. You must first use the [File-Export by View](#) or [File-Export by Category](#) command and select the **Add** button to create an export template, then you can define an Export agent.

197 Multimedia functions unavailable.

Windows is not configured with the proper multimedia extensions.
The Play Multimedia
action is not available.

198 Couldn't open multimedia file: <file name>.

Windows is not configured with the proper multimedia extensions to play this file. Install the proper Windows multimedia drivers or select a different type of multimedia file for the action.

200 Cannot display the legend. Select a color code template first.

Select the [Customize-Design View-Colors](#) command and then select a color code template. If a suitable template doesn't exist, create one by selecting the [Customize-Database-Color Code](#) command.

202 The view will not be displayed because a field of type <field type> was not found in this category.

You tried to display a new calendar or Gantt chart [view](#), but the selected [category](#) did not contain a [date field](#). Calendar views need at least one date field; Gantt chart views need at least two date fields.

203 No image packs have been installed.

An image pack is a collections of pictures that can be displayed on-screen by the

Commence calendar view when in Image mode. No image packs are currently installed.

Contact the Jensen-Jones Sales Department for information about obtaining image packs.

204 The Time Conflict layout you selected is not valid. Try again.

In order for a Time Conflict layout to be valid, you must specify [fields](#) for Commence to associate with the date, start time, and end time of an [item](#). Once this is done, check the **Time Conflict** [check box](#) to enable Time Conflict checking for the specified [category](#).

205 Couldn't create a default view for the <category name> category. The maximum number of views may have been reached.

Commence automatically tries to create a default report [view](#) for a newly defined [category](#). This was not done for the named category since the new view could not be added. It may be that the maximum of 600 views per [database](#) has been reached for the currently open database. Count the number of views listed in the dialog box displayed by the [Views-Open/Manage Views](#) command to see if you have reached this limit. Use the **Delete** button to delete views that you no longer need.

206 The combined fields exceed the number of fields allowed by the view. Please remove some fields before saving.

The view you have defined contains more fields than the view will allow. Select the [Customize-Design View-Fields](#) command. Count the number of fields in the view. Each field in a combined field must be counted individually. Use the **Remove Field** button to remove any fields that you no longer need to display or use the **Edit Combined Field** button to include fewer fields in the combined field.

207 The latest possible start time using this time interval is *<time>*.

The calendar [view](#) (when in daily [display mode](#)) is designed to show 19 time slots regardless of the time interval (scale) selected. You must select a start time that will allow 19 time slots to be displayed in daily display mode using the currently selected time scale. Either decrease the current time scale value (using the [Customize-Design View-Display](#) command, or change the start time to an earlier time.

208 The date, start time or end time field has not been selected or is invalid for this function. Choose your selections with the Customize-Design View-Fields command.

The [design](#) for the selected [view](#) has become invalid. Select [Customize-Design View-Fields](#) and choose appropriate [fields](#) for this view. If appropriate fields are not available, add them using [Customize-Database-Category](#). **Edit** the category, then press the **Add** button to add new fields.

209 A required field was set to '(none)'. The appropriate default field(s) have been selected.

You have changed at least one of the required calendar [design fields](#) (**Date**, **Start Time**, or **End Time**) to **(none)**. Default fields have been selected for the missing required field(s).

210 The Calendar design you selected is not valid. Try again.

The [design](#) for a calendar [view](#) requires that one [date field](#) and two [time fields](#) be associated with the view. Choose appropriate [fields](#) for this view. If appropriate fields are not available, add them using [Customize-Database-Category](#). **Edit** the category, then press the **Add** button to add new fields.

211 Select an item in the calendar. The highlight must be positioned on the name of the item to select it.

To select an [item](#) from a calendar [view](#), the item name must be highlighted. (Highlighting a blank time slot associated with an item does *not* select the item.)

212 Please enter a valid time for the Start Time of the Calendar.

The calendar start time specified must be consistent with the time format set in the Windows Control Panel (via the International icon).

213 The start date or end date field has not been selected or is invalid for this function. Choose your selections with the Customize-Design View-Fields command.

The [design](#) for the selected [view](#) has become invalid. Select [Customize-Design View-Fields](#) and choose appropriate [fields](#) for this view. If appropriate fields are not available, add them using [Customize-Database-Category](#). **Edit** the category, then press the **Add** button to add new fields.

214 The Gantt design you selected is not valid. Try again.

The [design](#) for a Gantt chart [view](#) requires that two [date fields](#) be associated with the view. Choose appropriate [fields](#) for this view. If appropriate fields are not available, add them using [Customize-Database-Category](#). **Edit** the category, then press the **Add** button to add new fields.

215 Enter an Indent value greater than or equal to zero and less than [5.0 inches or 12.7 centimeters].

The value for the Indent field must be between zero and five inches or zero and 12.7 centimeters.

216 Time Conflict checking requires that the category have at least one date and one time field. Either edit the category and add the required fields or select a different category.

[Time Conflict](#) checking is used to alert you if you have added an item on the same date and time as another item. The category you have selected does not have the required fields to use time conflict checking. You can edit the category using the [Customize-Database-Category](#) command. Select the **Edit** button to edit the category. Add at least one [date](#) field and at least one [time](#) field to the category. Otherwise, select a different category to use time conflict checking.

217 The Highlight color must be changed so it is different from the Background color, otherwise the view highlight will not be visible.

The color you have selected for your Highlight is the same color as the Background for the view. The highlight color should be set to a contrast color, so that it will be visible against the background. For example, if your Background color is white, you should set the Highlight color to black, or any color which will be clearly visible on a white background. Use the [Customize-Design View-Colors](#) command to change the Highlight or Background color.

218 Decrease the field width to between 1 and 150 columns.

In a report [view](#), the [field](#) width can be between one and 150 columns.

219 The field height must be between 1 and 750 lines.

In a report [view](#), the [field](#) height can be between one and 750 lines.

220 Add at least one field to this report before saving it.

A report [view](#) must contain at least one field before it can be saved to disk. See [Customize-Design View-Fields](#).

**221 Enter a valid [horizontal or vertical] spacing
between zero and [5.0 inches or 12.7 centimeters].**

The values for the horizontal and vertical spacing of [fields](#) must be between zero and 5 inches or zero and 12.7 centimeters.

225 Vertical reports can have between 1 and 20 columns. Horizontal reports can have only one column.

A report [view](#) must have between 1 and 20 columns. Horizontal format report [views](#) can only have one column. Change the report format type to vertical, or change the number of columns to one.

229 Connected fields can have a total of 750 lines. The total you have entered is <number> lines. Either set the number of items to <number> or set the lines per item to <number>, or simply decrease both values.

A connected field can be no more than 750 lines long. Use the [Customize-Design View-Display](#) command to change the number of items or set the number of lines in the Connection Fields group box.

230 The number of instances must be between 1 and 750.

The maximum number of [connected items](#) that can be shown in a [connected field](#) (the number of instances) is 750.

232 No more fields can be included in this report.

Remove some fields first if you wish to add others.

A report [view](#) can contain up to 100 [fields](#). You need to remove a field from this view if you wish to add another field.

233 For connected fields, Commence can only sort on the Name field in the connected category. You have selected a connected field that is not the Name field.

When using [connected fields](#), Commence can only sort on the [name](#) field of a [connected category](#).

234 You have selected a type of field that Commence cannot sort on. Please select a different field.

Commence can sort on any [field](#) in a [view](#) except [connected fields](#) and [data file fields](#). You can, however, sort on the [name field](#) of a [connected item](#).

240 This file is not in the proper format: '<filename>'.

The specified file must be in the proper Commence format before proceeding with a restore (the file must have been produced using the **Backup** button on the [Manage Database dialog box](#)) , Transfer In.(the file must have been produced using the [File-Transfer Out](#) command) or Sync Link.

241 [Backup, Restore] did not complete.

The backup or restore operation was not completed. You may have run out of disk space, a disk error may have occurred, or you may have run out of available memory or buffers. If you suspect disk or file problems, run diagnostic utilities to isolate any problems before trying again.

244 The backup file cannot be created in the database directory. Select a different directory for the backup file.

To protect against accidental deletions the backup file cannot be created in the actual database directory. Try the backup again using a different directory for the backup file.

**245 The [definition] could not be transferred in
because the [definition] was not found in this
database.**

This error is displayed when Commence is processing a Transfer In request and a definition (field, connection definition, category, view, etc.) is not present in the target database that is required by the definition be transferred in. Check the Transfer Out options to see if all the related definitions were included when the transfer file was created.

246 This database is password protected. Make sure you remember its password because you will need to know it when it is restored.

This is an informational message that appears when you [Backup](#) a database which has a password defined with the [Edit-Preferences-Database](#) command. When Commence backs up a database that has a password, the password is included in the backup file. You must know the password to open the database after restoring it with the [File-Open/Manage Database](#) command.

247 The file '<filename>' is a backup file and must be restored using File- Open/Manage Database-Restore.

You have tried to use Transfer In or SyncLink In on this backup file. Typically, files with a '.XFR' extension are backup files and are accessed using [File-Open/Manage Database-Restore](#). Files with a '.TFR' extension are transfer files and are accessed using [File-Transfer In](#). Files with a '.SNC' extension are SyncLink files for use with [File-SyncLink In](#).

248 The file '<filename>' is a transfer file and must be handled using File-Transfer In.

You have tried to use Restore or SyncLink In on this transfer file. Typically, files with a '.TFR' extension are transfer files and are accessed using [File-Transfer In](#). '.XFR' extension are backup files and are accessed using [File-Open/Manage Database-Restore](#). Files with a '.SNC' extension are SyncLink files for use with [File-SyncLink In](#).

249 The file '<filename>' is a sync link file and must be handled using File- Sync Link In.

You have tried to use Transfer In or Restore on this SyncLink file. Typically, files with a '.SNC' extension are SyncLink files for use with [File-SyncLink In](#). Files with a '.TFR' extension are transfer files and are accessed using [File-Transfer In](#). Files with a '.XFR' extension are backup files and are accessed using the [File-Open/Manage Database](#) command, then press the **Restore** button.

250 The transfer or sync file '<filename>' is from a newer version of Commence and cannot be processed. You must upgrade to the newer version in order to process this file.

**251 The transfer or sync file '<filename>' is from a
older version of Commence and cannot be
processed**

260 Could not execute DDE command!

The receiving application has not responded to a Dynamic Data Exchange (DDE) command within the timeout period. Make sure the other application is running before retrying.

**262 Could not communicate with application:
<application name>.**

A Dynamic Data Exchange (DDE) error has occurred with the application noted in the message. Make sure the other application is running before retrying.

270 Check the export template. It does not match the data. Commence cannot continue exporting.

Check the number of fields you are exporting and be sure that the template mapping is correct. (See the [Template Mapping dialog box](#).)

**271 Define the category <category name> so that
Commence can import the file.**

The [category](#) that was used for this template is no longer available. Create the category again, or delete this template.

272 Enter a positive number less than 32,767 for the Start and End positions.

The **Start Position** and **End Position** value must be a positive integer that is greater than zero and less than 32767. Do not use decimal points.

274 Commence cannot save an imported item. The import will end.

A disk error occurred while trying to save an imported [item](#). Is the import file formatted correctly? If you suspect disk or file problems, run diagnostic utilities to isolate any problems before trying again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select the **Help-About** command).

275 Unrecognized format in the import file. Make sure file is in DIF format.

Make sure the file you are trying to import is in DIF format and that you are using the correct import/export template.

276 Commence did not find the text delimiter for a field and cannot import the file.

Change your **Import Rules** to reflect the lack of delimiters, or obtain an import file that contains appropriate delimiters. See [File-Import](#).

**277 Record <record number>, Field <field name> of
this import file does not map to a field, and
Commence cannot continue importing.**

Check the format of your import file and your mapping scheme.
See [File-Import](#).

278 There are no items in the export category.

There is nothing to export. Check the [category](#) name and the template definition to ensure that you are exporting the correct category using the appropriate template. See the [Template Mapping dialog box](#).

279 Make the 'End Position' greater than the 'Start Position'.

The **End Position** must be greater than the **Start Position** when defining column-delimited [fields](#).

280 You defined field positions for <field name> that overlap with those defined for <field name>.

Check the sizes of your import [category fields](#) to be sure the start and end positions do not overlap.

281 Commence cannot save the template. The item name field must map to an import field.

You must map the [item name field](#) to a field in the import file in order to save the template.

282 Delete this import template. It is associated with a category that no longer exists.

The [category](#) associated with this import template no longer exists. The template cannot be used. Either import the appropriate category before using this template or use the **Delete** button to delete the template.

283 The specified file is not in the proper format (<*file format*>).

ASCII, dBASE, and DIF import/export file formats are supported by Commence. The file you specified is not in one of these formats. Check the file or specify another one.

284 The dBASE field <*field name*> cannot be imported into the Commence field <*field name*>. They are of conflicting types.

The type of a dBASE field must be compatible with the type of the Commence [field](#) to which it is mapped. Correct the field mapping of the import template, and try again. See the [Template Mapping dialog box](#).

285 The number of columns in this DIF file (<number>) is not the same as was given in the import template. Commence cannot continue importing.

The file does not match the import template. Check the number of fields in the file, correct the import template, and try the import again. See the [Template Mapping dialog box](#).

286 Record <number>, Field <number> of this import file <error condition>. Commence cannot continue importing.

Correct the error indicated in the information message for the given record and field in the import file, and try the import again.

287 Cannot add more fields. Cannot import from a file with more than 102 fields.

You can map up to 102 fields in your import file to [fields](#) in the Commence [category](#).

288 Record <record> is too long to be imported.

There are restrictions on the size of records (i.e., [items](#)) and [fields](#) you import. The maximum record size is 1,020 characters. The maximum field size is 255 characters.

**289 Record <record>, Field <field> of this import file
<condition>. Commence cannot continue
importing. The field's value is <value>.**

You receive this message under a variety of conditions while importing data. The message indicates the record, field, value, and the reason Commence stopped importing. There are a number of reasons you may see in place of <condition> in the above message, all of which involve incompatibility of the data being imported. Correct the error indicated in the information message for the given record and field in the import file, and try the import again.

290 The maximum number (500000) of items was reached for this category. Not all records were imported.

Importing stops when you have reached the maximum number of [items](#) that can be kept in a single [category](#). (500000).

291 Import field <field 1>, mapped to Commence field <field 2>, must be given start and end positions.

When importing column-delimited data, you must specify start and end positions for each input [field](#). Edit the import/export template you are using to make sure the start and end positions you specified for <field 1> are correct.

To correct the problem, select the **Map** button; then highlight the field named in the message and select the **Field Position** button. Specify start and end positions for the field in the [dialog box](#) that appears.

294 The number of fields in this file does not match the number defined in the import template. Cannot import.

The number of [fields](#) in the file you want to import is not the same as the number you specified in the import/export template. Check the number of fields in the file, edit the template accordingly, and then try importing again. See the [Template Mapping dialog box](#).

295 The Commence mandatory field *<field>* is not mapped to an import field and has no default string defined. Halting import.

A mandatory [field](#) in Commence must have a field mapped to it, or the field must have a default value, in order for Commence to import the file. Edit the import/export template to map a field (see the [Template Mapping dialog box](#)) or edit the category to specify a default value (see [Customize-Database-Category](#)), and then try importing again.

296 There were connections to unknown items in the <category name> category (for example, the item <item name>.) These connections could not be made.

A [connection](#) to a non-existent [item](#) was specified in the import file. The connection was not made. See [Importing Connections](#).

297 Commence cannot save the template because the mapping is not valid for this category.

Correct the mapping values and try again. See the [Template Mapping dialog box](#).

298 Cannot find matching memo file: <filename>.

During an Import Commence could not find the memo file related to a dBASE file. Check the directory specified for the import file.

299 Experienced internal error during import - call technical support.

During an Import Commence experienced an unexpected error. Before calling technical support try the following.

Create a new import file and try the import again.

Recreate the import template being used to create the import file.

Create a new import file and try the import again.

If the import file is in dBASE format, attempt to open the file using another application that can read a dBASE formatted file (e.g. Excel) and then save as a new file.

If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

300 You cannot delete the active Database.

To delete the [database](#) you are currently using, first switch to a different database, then try deleting the original database again.

301 Please enter text for the template before saving.

You have not entered text for the [text letter template](#). Commence cannot save an empty text letter template.

302 To define a color code, a category must have a check box, a selection field, or a connection field. The selected category contains none of these fields. Please select another category.

Color codes can only be associated with a [check box](#), a [selection field](#), or a [connection definition](#).

303 You have selected an item more than once. Select unique items.

When you created a color code template, you selected the same [item](#) more than once. Each control must be matched to a unique item. Change the duplicate items and save the template.

304 Delete the invalid keyword <keyword> from the letter template.

There is an invalid keyword in the letter template. Delete the keyword shown in the error message, or change it to a valid keyword.

305 There is not a data file field in the category <category name>.

The [category](#) you select to log letters must have a [data file field](#) defined. Use [Customize-Database-Category](#) to edit the category and add a data file field, and try again; or, pick another category for your letter log.

308 Text letter templates are limited to 16000 characters. You have reached this limit. If you are pasting from the clipboard, reduce the amount of text being pasted and try again.

[Text letter templates](#) are limited to 16,000 characters. The actual text letter (after field values are substituted) can be up to 32,767 characters.

309 Select a category for the phone log.

In order to log a phone call, you must associate a [category](#) with the phone log by selecting [Edit-Preferences Event Logs](#) command from the [menu bar](#).

310 The telephone number format is unrecognized and cannot be dialed.

TAPI could not interpret the telephone number, it may contain invalid characters or be improperly formatted. To help TAPI recognize the telephone number please re-format the number using the 'canonical format' which is of the form +cc (ac) number where cc is the country code, ac is the area code and number is the local telephone number. For example, +1 (908) 555-1234 is in canonical format.

311 Commence cannot dial because the phone line is currently in use. Please try again later when the phone line is free.

TAPI allows multiple phone applications to share the same telephone line(s). All phone lines are currently busy.

312 Commence cannot add <path> as a database since it is the <directory type>.

The directory used for the Commence database must be devoted exclusively to Commence. The database files cannot reside in the Windows directory, the DOS TEMP directory, the Commence program directory or other special directories. Specify a different directory for the database.

313 You cannot delete the active desktop.

You have tried to delete the desktop that is currently being displayed. Open another desktop before deleting this one.

317 The selected Icon Directory is not a valid directory. Please change the selection with the Edit-Preferences-Tool Bars command.

Commence could not find the directory on the disk. Select the [Edit-Preferences-Tool Bars](#) command and enter an existing directory path.

318 You must either change the number of digits required or enter *<number>* digits.

The **Base Format** must contain exactly the number of digits specified within the **Digits** group box. Either enter this number or change the total number of digits in the **Digits** group box to an appropriate value.

319 The selected External Data File Directory is not a valid directory. Please change the selection with the Edit-Preferences-Other command.

Commence could not find the directory on the disk. Select the [Edit-Preferences-Other](#) command and enter an existing directory path.

**322 TXT is reserved for use with Text Letters only.
Enter a different formatted letter extension.**

Formatted letter extensions can consist of any three letters except the extension **.txt**, which is reserved for text letters.

323 Delete an existing [Agent, Category, Connection, View, Icon View, Menu View, Field, Template, Database, Form] before adding another. The maximum amount has been reached.

You have reached the limit of the specified object.

324 Name the [Category, Connections, Form, Template, Item, Field, View] before proceeding.

You must name the object in the message before continuing. The name you specify must be unique for all the objects of the same type within the active [database](#).

325 The name for [Agent, Template, View, First Connection, Second Connection, Import Template, Database, Item, Form, Field, Category] already exists. Use a different name.

An object of the same type as the one you are naming already exists with the same name. Specify a unique name.

326 The database <database name> already uses this path. Use a different path name.

Two [databases](#) cannot share the same directory. Either enter a new directory name (eight characters or less) or hit the **Select** button to select the new directory. If the directory does not exist Commence will create the directory

**327 In order to schedule a meeting a category
(including date, start time and end time fields)
must be selected.**

A category (e.g. Appointment) must be selected before a meeting can be scheduled. Select [Edit-Preferences-Meeting](#) and select a category.

**328 The database <database name> already exists.
Use a different name.**

Two [databases](#) cannot have the same name. Enter a new database name. The maximum number of characters for the database name is thirty. The database name can contain multiple words.

329 The desktop <desktop name> already exists. Use a different name.

Two [desktops](#) cannot have the same name. Enter a new desktop name.

330 The item <item name> already exists. Use a different name.

**331 The selection <selection name> already exists.
Use a different name.**

370 The new password did not verify correctly; please enter the new password again.

When you are changing your database password or your login password, Commence requires you to type the new password in twice. The purpose is to verify that you entered the password as you intended. Since the text boxes only show your entry on the screen as asterisks '*', this is done in case you mistype the password.

This message is displayed when the new password is not entered the same in the verify edit control. To correct the problem, re-enter the new password and the verify password.

371 Unable to change password, the old password is incorrect. Please enter the old password again.

When you are changing your database password or your login password, Commence requires you to first type the old password. The purpose is to verify that you have access to the database to change the password.

This message is displayed when the old password is entered incorrectly. It does not match the password for the database. To correct the problem, re-enter the old password. You do not have to re-enter the new password and the verify password.

372 A password must be set for the database to be password protected; either turn off the password checkbox or set a password.

You have checked the **Password Protect Database** checkbox in the [Database Preferences](#) dialog box, but you did not enter a password when prompted. You must enter a password or, if you do not want to password protect your database, uncheck the **Password Protect Database** checkbox. You can not close this dialog box until you enter a password or uncheck the checkbox.

373 Cannot add an item. No categories have been defined.

Commence cannot add an Item. Before attempting to add an item a category must be created. Use the [Customize-Database-Category](#) command to create a category.

374 Cannot save User Item information. No item selected.

Commence cannot add an Item for Yourself because a name was not entered. See the [Personal Info](#) dialog box.

375 Cannot save User Item information in a database with no categories.

Commence cannot add an Item for Yourself because the active [database](#) is empty. Use the [File-Open/Manage Database](#) command to select a different database.

400 Enter a value for the filter.

You must enter text to [filter](#) each [item](#) displayed. Enter an appropriate value for the [field](#) you specified.

401 The view <view name> cannot be used as a primary view since it does not have connections to other active views. Select a different primary view, try linking by date or start an appropriate secondary view.

Views can be linked so that the highlighted item in the primary view controls what is displayed in the secondary view. View linking requires that a connection exists between the primary view category and the secondary view category. If no connection exists then the views cannot be linked.

402 The filter for view <view name> cannot be modified to link the views. Clear the filter and try again.

Views are linked by creating a special filter in the secondary view. If the secondary view already has the maximum number of filters then additional view links cannot be created.

403 The category <category name> does not have any Date fields and cannot be linked by date. Select a different secondary view or try linking by connection.

Views can be linked so that the selected date or date range a Calendar view controls what is displayed in the secondary view. The secondary view must have a date field, if no date field exists then the views cannot be linked.

404 One of your filters is set to 'OR (All Items)'. This will cause all items to be selected regardless of the settings of any other filters. Please select the summary tab and change the AND/OR relationship to make your filter work.

This filter will not work properly. Any filter specifying **(All Items)** must have the **And** check box before it turned on. Make sure the filter is set to **AND (All Items)**.

405 Enter the search text.

Enter an appropriate value for the [search text](#) you would like to find. You can use [wild card patterns](#) to search for values.

406 The two views are already linked. Specify different views to link or select Cancel.

Views can only be linked once. Select a different view for the view link.

407 The secondary view must have a date field but there are no active views with date fields. Start a secondary view that has a date field or use the 'Connected to highlighted item' option.

Views can be linked so that the selected date or date range a Calendar view controls what is displayed in the secondary view. The secondary view must have a date field, if no date field exists then the views cannot be linked.

408 Please enter a valid telephone number.

409 Invalid field value specified, could not process

410 There is no item to copy.

Highlight an [item](#) to copy, and try again. Open the appropriate [view](#) or [item detail](#) if necessary.

411 The maximum number (32000) of items has been reached for category <category name>. You must delete an existing item before adding a new one.

You have reached Commence's capacity for storing [items](#) in a single [category](#). Delete an item from the category or see [File-Export-By Category](#) to find out how to archive items from a category.

412 The date <*date field*> is not valid.

You must enter a valid date in the named field. The date must be in the Short Date format specified in the International dialog box in the Windows Control Panel, or in a [natural language](#) format.

413 The recognizer is busy. Try again later.

The Microsoft Recognizer (used by Microsoft Windows for Pen Computing®) is already busy analyzing pen input.

**414 The default value entered is not valid for this field.
Try again.**

The default value does not match the field type. Enter a value that is appropriate for the field type or delete the default value.

415 Can't display this item.

Contact Commence Technical Support and report this message (select **Help-About**).

416 Please enter a valid Start and End date before continuing.

In order to use recurring dates, you must give Commence a range of dates to use when adding the new item. The range begins on the start date and finishes on the end date.

418 The 'Related Date' connection could not be added for this category. You must either delete a field or a connection before recurring date items in this category can be associated.

Defining a [date field](#) with the Recurring option causes a **Related Date connection** to be generated automatically. Since you are already too close to the maximum number of fields and connections, you must delete one in order to successfully define a **Recurring Date** field.

420 No items were added. No actual dates match the recurring date specification.

You must enter a recurring date specification that results in a valid set of dates for the recurring date specification. For example, "Every 31st weekday of the month" does not refer to a valid set of dates because there are never more than 23 weekdays in a given month.

421 You can only send letters from a book view, a report view or while editing a previously saved item.

Only book and report [views](#) and existing (i.e., saved) [item details](#) can be used to create a letter. Be sure that the [category](#) you are viewing has at least one letter template defined (see [Customize-Database-Letter Template](#)).

422 There is no window open, so no letter can be sent.

Only [views](#) and [item details](#) can be used to create a letter. Be sure that the [category](#) you are viewing has at least one letter template defined (see [Customize-Database-Letter Template](#)).

423 Commence cannot log this letter. Select a log category first using Edit-Preferences-Event Logs.

In order to log a letter, a letter log category must be specified using the [Edit-Preferences-Event Logs](#) command.

424 There are no letter templates defined for this category. You can define letter templates using Customize-Database-Letter Template.

Commence cannot create a letter for this category. You must create a letter template first (see [Customize-Database-Letter Template](#)).

425 Commence cannot save the letter. Make sure you have selected a valid directory for saving logged letters using Edit-Preferences-Event Logs.

Check the directory specified for saving logged letters to make sure it exists (see [Edit-Preferences-Event Logs](#)).

426 This view has been modified. You must save the view in order to send letters to all items with a formatted letter template.

When sending formatted letters to all items in the view, the [view](#) being used to supply item information must be a [saved view](#). Save the view first (using [Views-Save View](#), then select **Send Letter To All Items** again.

429 One Item Per Region must be set for layouts that contain multiple regions.

In the **Region** group box of the [Add/Edit Paper Layout](#) dialog box you have specified multiple rows and/or columns to define multiple regions. Check the **One Item Per Region** checkbox or change the rows and columns to specify only one region.

431 This page layout is too <wide/short/tall> for this type of view. Select a <wider/narrower/shorter/taller> layout.

You are printing a view with the [File-Print](#) command. In the Print <View> dialog box you selected a paper layout in the **Paper** drop-down list box which is not wide enough to print this view. To correct this problem, select a different paper layout in the **Paper** drop-down list box or select Cancel and use the [File-Page Setup](#) command to create a new paper layout.

433 Enter page width and height values greater than zero.

The width and height of a page must be positive numbers.

434 You have not selected a printer. Choose 'Printer Setup' from the File menu in order to print.

In order to proceed, a printer must be selected. Either a default printer has not been chosen, or no printers or printer drivers have been installed in the Windows environment. Select a default printer for Commence using the [File-Printer Setup](#). Use the Windows Control Panel to install printers and printer drivers for all Windows applications.

435 Enter region width and height values greater than zero.

The width and height of a region must be positive numbers.

436 Reduce the internal margins to fit in the region width and height.

The internal margins of a region in a page layout cannot be larger than the width and height of the region.

437 Enter a number between 1 and 100 for the number of copies.

You may make between 1 and 100 copies of this print request.

438 Enter a starting label number greater than zero.

You entered a negative value for the **Starting Label** field in the **Print Report [dialog box](#)**. Enter the number of the label with which to start printing. For example, for a three-column label form, the fifth label is located in the second row, second column (counting across the page from left to right, row by row).

439 Enter a 'To' date that is after the 'From' date.

The **To** date must not be earlier than the **From** date.

440 Enter valid dates for the 'From' and 'To' fields.

You must enter a valid date in the **From** and **To** fields. The date must be in the form specified in the International dialog box in the Windows Control Panel, or in a [natural language](#) format.

442 Commence will not begin printing. There is no way to cancel the print job.

Commence was unable to provide a way to cancel the print job and will *not* proceed with printing.

443 An error occurred while printing. Check the printer.

Check the paper path for paper jams. Is the printer on-line? Is the cable connected? Is the power on? Is the printer cable in the correct port on your computer?

446 Reduce the page margins or region sizes to fit in the page width and height.

The total of all regions on a page must fit within the margins of the page.

447 This is the default page layout. It cannot be deleted (change the default to a different page layout before deleting this layout).

Commence allows you to define a default page layout to use when printing. It is initially set to Letter (8.5 x 11 in.). You can change the default using the Set Default button in [File-Page Setup](#).

**448 Invalid label template or improper paper size.
Check the settings and try again.**

Your printer settings may not be set to the appropriate orientation and/or paper size for use with the selected label form. Select the [File-Page Setup](#) command to make appropriate changes.

449 Could not locate at least one font with a size of 8, 10, or 12 points.

When printing a Day Planner Style, Commence searches for a font with a size of 8, 10 or 12 points from one of the following font families (as defined in Microsoft Windows):

MODERN Examples: Pica, Elite, Courier **ROMAN** Examples:

Times Roman, Century Schoolbook **SWISS** Examples:

Helvetica, Swiss

Commence searches for an 8 point font first.

450 There aren't enough lines with the available fonts to print within the Commence margins. Reduce the top or bottom margins to allow more space.

A Day Planner cannot be printed within the specified margins using the available fonts. Change the top or bottom margins to allow more space, or load smaller printer fonts into the Windows environment, and try again. See [File-Page Setup](#) for setting printer margins.

451 There is not enough disk space for print spooling.

There is not enough disk space for spooling print jobs. Delete unwanted files, or increase the size of your disk.

2 The starting label number should be between 1 and *<number>*.

You entered a number for the **Starting Label** field in the **Print Report [dialog box](#)** that is outside the number of labels actually printed on one page. Enter the number of the label with which to start printing. For example, for a three-column label form, the fifth label is located in the second row, second column (counting across the page from left to right, row by row).

**453 This view cannot print using One Item Per Region.
Change the layout template or print from a report
view.**

You are printing a view with the [File-Print](#) command. In the Print <View> dialog box you selected a paper layout in the **Paper** drop-down list box which is has the **One Item Per Region** checkbox checked. This type of view cannot print with this paper layout. To correct this problem, select a different paper layout in the **Paper** drop-down list box or select **Cancel** and use the [File-Page Setup](#) command to create a new paper layout or change an existing layout. Report views do allow printing with the **One Item Per Region** option.

454 This view can only print in multiple regions using One Item Per Region. Change the layout template.

You are printing a view with the [File-Print](#) command. In the Print <View> dialog box you selected a paper layout in the **Paper** drop-down list box which is has the **One Item Per Region** checkbox unchecked. This type of view cannot print with this paper layout. To correct this problem, select a different paper layout in the **Paper** drop-down list box or select **Cancel** and use the [File-Page Setup](#) command to create a new paper layout or change an existing layout.

500 Select from the list first.

Make a selection from the list, or cancel the operation.

501 Enter a valid whole number.

Enter an integer value. Do not use decimal points.

502 Enter a whole number greater than zero.

Enter a non negative integer value. Do not use decimal points.

503 The End [Date or Time] cannot be sooner than the Start [Date or Time].

You have entered an End Date or End Time that is before the Start Date or Start Time. Correct one of the dates or times, and try to save this item again.

**504 COMMDLG.DLL returned error code <error code>.
Commence cannot continue the current operation.**

Commence uses the Windows Common Dialogs to retrieve certain types of information, such as file names and directory paths. If the Common Dialog fails then Commence cannot continue the current operation. Contact Technical Support for assistance in resolving this error. (See **Help-About**)

505 Enter a valid file name.

Check the file name specified for proper DOS syntax.

506 A data conversion error was encountered while processing '<database name>' (error code <error code>). Data converter '<converter name>' cannot continue.

Data from earlier versions of Commence must be converted to work properly with the current version. The automatic data conversion may not succeed if there are problems with the original data. Contact Technical Support for assistance in resolving this error. (See **Help-About**)

507 Data conversion initialization failed. Data conversion cannot complete (initial database version - final database version).

Data from earlier versions of Commence must be converted to work properly with the current version. The automatic data conversion may not succeed if there are problems with the original data or if the required data conversion modules are not found. Contact Technical Support for assistance in resolving this error. (See **Help-About**)

508 The path entry must not be blank. Enter a valid path specification or use the Select button to locate one.

The path to the directory containing the administration files for the Commence workgroup must be entered or selected using the dialog displayed by pressing the Select button. Commence needs this information to create or locate the directory.

509 Data converter [converter name] is an incompatible version (expected: [version number], actual: [version number]). Data conversion cannot continue.

Data from earlier versions of Commence must be converted to work properly with the current version. The automatic data conversion may not succeed if there are problems with the original data or if the required data conversion modules are not found. Contact Technical Support for assistance in resolving this error. (See **Help-About**)

510 Please enter a number between 1 and 30000, inclusive.

Commence text fields can store from 1 to 30,000 characters.
Enter a value within this range.

**511 The specified directory name does not exist.
Please enter a new directory name.**

Commence could not find the directory on the disk. Use the [dialog box](#) controls to find an existing directory (press F1 for help while viewing the dialog box).

512 Directory '<*directory name*>' already exists.

The specified directory already exists. Use the [dialog box](#) controls to create a new directory.

513 Cannot find file <filename>; check to ensure the path and filename are correct.

Check the directory path and file name for proper DOS syntax.

**514 An error was encountered while re-indexing
database <database name>. Commence will now
exit**

515 Please enter a valid file extension before saving.

Follow normal DOS conventions when specifying a file extension in Commence (up to three characters, with no spaces).

516 Incorrect password. Try again or select Cancel.

The password you have entered is incorrect. In order to edit this [field](#) or [category](#), you must supply the proper password. Contact the party responsible for locking the field or category for the password.

517 The database <database name> is invalid. Please select another database.

The [database](#) you selected cannot be used by Commence. Select a different database (using the [File-Open/Manage Database](#) command) or exit Commence.

518 The database <database name> is currently locked. Either it is being accessed by another user or was improperly closed. Please wait five minutes or select another database.

The selected [database](#) is either: -- located on a Local Area Network (LAN) drive and currently in use by another user, or -- located on a local drive and was improperly closed during the last Commence session.

If the database is on a LAN drive, you must request that the person using the database close it so that you can access it. Otherwise, select another database to open.

If the database is on a local drive, exit Commence, wait five minutes, and try again.

519 The Tutorial database is currently being accessed by another copy of Commence. Tutorial mode is not available.

Multiple copies of Commence cannot access the same database at the same time. Another copy of Commence is currently using the Tutorial database, Tutorial mode is currently unavailable.

520 The [Windows directory, Windows System directory, Commence Program directory, Commence Tutorial directory, root directory, DOS directory] cannot be used; select another directory.

Commence does not allow certain directories to be used in specifying, for example, a [database](#) pathname. Select another directory.

521 Cannot change to this Database. It no longer exists. Create the directory or delete this database entry.

The specified [database](#) no longer exists. Was this data copied from another system? If so, make sure that all appropriate directories were copied.

**522 An error was encountered while converting
database '%s'. Commence will now exit.**

**523 Invalid or unrecognized database specified
(*<database name>*); Commence will now exit.**

The /Database command line option was used with an unrecognized or invalid database name. Please check the database name and try again. The database name is case sensitive.

524 Commence is unable to open the Database because of low disk space. Free up at least <space> on drive <drive> and try again.

Use the Windows Explorer or equivalent utility to free up some disk space and try again.

525 The data in the specified database requires a newer version of Commence to be used.

You are trying to use data from a newer version of Commence with an earlier version of Commence. Use a more recent version of Commence with the data.

526 Commence cannot find the Tutorial files. Tutorial mode will not be available.

Commence cannot find its tutorial files or the tutorial configuration information. Re-install

Commence (you will need to explicitly specify that tutorial files should be re-installed) or contact Technical Support for assistance in resolving this error.

527 The tutorial.cmp file could not be found. New tutorial data will not be loaded.

Commence cannot find the compressed tutorial data (**tutorial.cmp**). If you are missing this file, it can be found on Commence Installation Diskette 1, in **gold\gold.cmp**. Copy this file to your Commence program directory, renaming it (as you copy it) to **tutorial.cmp**. For example, if the Installation Diskette is in drive A:, and your Commence program directory is in

c:\commence, you might enter this command from DOS: **copy a:\data\gold.cmp c:\commence\tutorial.cmp**

You can also copy this file via Microsoft Windows File Manager using the File-Copy command, or execute the Commence **install** program.

528 The file <filename> contains nonprintable characters and can not be pasted.

The file named in the error message may contain special control characters that cannot be used in the field to which you are trying to paste. Make sure the file is a plain ASCII text file (i.e., contains no special control characters such as those used by word processors to insert formatting characters) using the editor of your choice.

529 Cannot paste the entire file. The file may be too large to paste here.

Is the field large enough to hold the file you are trying to paste? Commence may not be able to reserve enough memory to hold the contents of the file. Close all unneeded applications, remove any unneeded memory-resident programs and try again. You may also try increasing the size of your Windows swap file (virtual memory), or adding more memory to your system.

530 This item does not have a telephone number.

This item does not have a telephone number, so automatic telephone dialing is not possible. Open a [view](#) or [item detail](#) that has one or more [telephone fields](#) and try again.

531 You must select an item with a telephone number before trying to dial.

Highlight an item that has a telephone number, and try again. If necessary, open a [view](#) or [item detail](#) that has one or more [telephone fields](#).

532 There is no telephone number to dial.

There is no telephone number displayed in the [active view](#), so dialing is not possible. Use the [Customize-Design View-Display](#) command to display telephone fields from the [active category](#) in the view. If the category does not have any telephone fields defined, open another view that does contain telephone fields or add telephone fields to the category. Telephone fields must also contain valid telephone numbers in order to use automatic dialing.

533 This type of window cannot be filtered/sorted.

Only [views](#) can be [filtered](#)/sorted.

534 This type of window does not have a layout.

Only [views](#) and [item details](#) can have a [layout](#).

535 The sort order cannot be changed for this type of window.

Only [views](#) and [item details](#) can have a sort order.

536 <Window name> windows cannot be printed.

You cannot print a letter template or an Add Item window.

537 '<database name>' is an unsupported version and cannot be converted. Restore the original data from backup and try again. If you are having difficulty converting your data please contact technical support for assistance. (<conversion name>)

The database was created by an earlier version of Commence but cannot be converted. Please contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

538 No windows are available for [sort, filter, layout, print, tile, cascade].

You need to open a Commence view or detail window before using this command. Use the View bar icons or the View menu to open a view. Open a detail window by using the commands on the Edit menu or the buttons on the tool bar. Open the window, and try again.

539 Please enter a valid directory name before proceeding.

**540 The <database name> database is locked and
cannot be used with this version of Commence**

543 There is nothing to delete.

There is no [item](#) selected, so there is nothing to delete. Open a [view](#) (if necessary) and highlight an item to delete.

544 The '<*field name*>' field is full; additional data cannot be pasted in.

The field already has its maximum amount of data. Additional data cannot be pasted in.

545 The '<*field name*>' field is full; pasted data was truncated.

The field is not large enough to accept all the pasted data. Some of the pasted data has been lost.

546 The view '<view name>' is filtered by the User Item. The User Item is not defined. Use Edit-Preferences-Personal Info to define it.

A view definition exists which is filtered for items connected to (-Me-). Commence cannot resolve the reference to (-Me-) because you did not select an item for yourself using the [Edit-Preferences-Personal Info](#) command.

547 Commence Internal Error.

Contact Commence Technical Support and report this message (select **Help-About**).

548 Commence cannot dial a phone number in a connected field.

[Connected fields](#) are not supported for automatic dialing purposes. To dial a phone number in a connected field, open the [item detail](#) of the connected item or a [view](#) displaying the connected item. Then dial the phone number again (select [Tools-Dial Phone](#)).

549 The data in <database> is from an earlier version of Commence and cannot be used with this version of Commence. The data can be converted to work properly with this version of Commence, contact your vendor or technical support for information

550 There is not enough memory available for this operation.

Commence could not reserve enough memory to complete a task. Close all unneeded applications, remove any unneeded memory-resident programs and try again. You may also try increasing the size of your Windows swap file (virtual memory), or adding more memory to your system.

**571 Commence cannot obtain a system timer.
Commence will now exit.**

Commence was not able to obtain a system timer, so Commence will not know when to advance to the next day. For example, after midnight, all calendar views will still display today's date. You may have too many open applications that require a system timer. Close one or more of these applications and try to run Commence again.

575 Close a window. There are too many open windows.

You must close one or more of your Commence windows before you can open this window. Select a window and press CTRL-F4.

576 You need to select a printer in order for printer fonts to be available.

Choose a printer by selecting [File-Printer Setup](#) from the [menu bar](#).

577 Select an item from the Font Name list.

You must make a selection from the **Font Name** list before you can continue.

578 Select or enter a valid font size greater than 0 points and no more than 255 points.

Commence limits the font size selection to 255 points regardless of the scalable font software that is in use.

**579 Windows Telephony services have been disabled,
dialing is not available.**

Check via the Windows Control Panel that Telephony is properly set up.

580 The Windows Telephony driver encountered an error. Commence cannot continue dialing.

A low-level [TAPI](#) error was encountered and Commence cannot continue dialing. Check the TAPI configuration by using the Windows Control Panel Telephony applet. You can also test TAPI by using the Dialer application (dialer.exe) that is installed with TAPI. If problems persist, contact Technical Support for assistance in resolving this error.

**581 This image was stored under Windows for Pens,
and cannot be read with this version of Windows.
Use Windows for Pens to display the image.**

If you create an [image](#) file under Windows for Pen Computing,
you should run the same version of Windows when trying to use
the image in Commence.

582 This image was stored under a newer version of Windows, and cannot be read with this version of Windows. Use the new version of Windows to display the image.

If you create an [image](#) file under Windows version 3.x, you should run the same version of Windows when trying to use the image in Commence.

583 This image was stored under an older version of Windows, and cannot be read with this version of Windows.

If you create an image file under an older version of Windows you should run the same version of Windows when trying to use the image in Commence.

584 There is not enough memory to perform spell checking.

Commence could not reserve enough memory to perform spell-checking. Close all unneeded applications, remove any unneeded memory-resident programs and try again. You may also try increasing the size of your Windows swap file (virtual memory), or adding more memory to your system. See you Windows and computer hardware documentation.

590 There is no [Extensions] information in WIN.INI for file '<file name>'.

Commence could not find the file's extension in the [Extensions] section of your **win.ini** file. Commence needs this information in order to launch the application that is appropriate for the data file. Add the file extension to **win.ini** and try again. See your Windows documentation for information on adding file extension associations to **win.ini**.

**594 Commence cannot find the configuration data in
COMMENCE.INI. Commence will now exit.**

The configuration data in COMMENCE.INI cannot be found.
Either Commence was not installed properly or the information
was deleted. Re-install Commence. If problems persist, contact
Technical Support for assistance in resolving this error (see **Help-
About**).

**595 The database information in DATABASE.INI is
missing or invalid. Commence will now exit.**

596 Windows Telephony is not installed or is configured improperly. Use the Control Panel Telephone applet to configure. Commence cannot continue dialing.

Commence uses the Windows [TAPI](#) system to dial phone numbers. Make sure TAPI is configured properly by running the Windows Control Panel Telephony applet. (Commence can start the Control Panel for you, go to [Edit-Preferences-Dialer](#).) You can also test TAPI by using the Dialer application (dialer.exe) that is installed with TAPI. If problems persist, contact Technical Support for assistance in resolving this error (see **Help-About**).

**597 Commence is unable to start application for
'<application name>'. (Windows returned error
code <error code>.)**

A Dynamic Data Exchange (DDE) error has occurred when
Commence requested Windows to start the application noted in
the message.

598 Windows Telephony is not available with this version of Windows

You are using a version of Windows that does not support Telephony. You will not be able to dial from within Commence.

600 <item>: Not <action>.

An error occurred, and Commence could not perform the add. Is there enough disk space? If you suspect disk problems, run diagnostic utilities to isolate any problems before trying again. Some common diagnostic utilities include **SCANDISK** (DOS 6.0 and later), and **CHKDSK**.

606 Unable to open '<filename>'.

An error occurred, and Commence could not open the specified file. Check the amount of free space on the disk. If you suspect disk failure, run diagnostic utilities and/or have your disk drive serviced before you continue. Some common diagnostic utilities include **SCANDISK** (DOS 6.0 and later), and **CHKDSK**. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

607 Unable to open '<filename>'. The disk currently in drive '<drive letter>' might be disk number '<number>'

Commence cannot open the listed file. You may have the incorrect diskette in the diskette drive.

611 Unable to create '<directory name/filename>'.

Check the amount of free space on the disk. Is the drive door closed? If you suspect disk failure, run diagnostic utilities and/or have your disk drive serviced before you continue. Some common diagnostic utilities include **SCANDISK** (DOS 6.0 and later), and **CHKDSK**.

612 '<*directory name*>' is an invalid directory name.

e directory name could not be created; please check the name you have entered and try again.

3 Unable to read '<filename>'.

A disk error occurred while trying to read the specified file. If you suspect disk or file problems, run diagnostic utilities to isolate any problems before trying again. Some common diagnostic utilities include **SCANDISK** (DOS 6.0 and later), and **CHKDSK**.

623 Unable to write '<filename>'.

An error occurred when Commence tried to write information to the disk. Is there enough free space on the destination disk? If you suspect disk or file problems, run diagnostic utilities to isolate any problems before trying again. Some common diagnostic utilities include **SCANDISK** (DOS 6.0 and later), and **CHKDSK**.

633 There is no image to copy to a file.

The image field must contain an image before using this command. Use the Edit-Paste command to copy an image into the field.

634 There is a disk error. Commence cannot copy the image to a file.

A disk error occurred while trying to write an image to a file. Is there enough free space on the disk? If you suspect disk or file problems, run diagnostic utilities to isolate any problems before trying again.

635 This type of image cannot be copied to a file.

Commence doesn't support writing this type of image to a file. Use the clipboard commands on the Edit menu to copy the image to the clipboard, where it can be accessed by other applications.

636 Commence cannot continue importing due to an error; please check the available disk space.

A disk error occurred while trying to write an image to a file. Is there enough free space on the disk? If you suspect disk or file problems, run diagnostic utilities to isolate any problems before trying again. Some common diagnostic utilities include **SCANDISK** (DOS 6.0 and later), and **CHKDSK**.

637 Commence cannot continue importing because of a disk error on the file <filename>.

A disk error occurred while trying to access the import file. If you suspect disk or file problems, run diagnostic utilities to isolate any problems before trying again. Some common diagnostic utilities include **SCANDISK** (DOS 6.0 and later), and **CHKDSK**.

**638 There is a disk error on the file '<filename>'.
Commence cannot continue exporting.**

Is there enough space on the destination disk for the export? If you suspect disk or file problems, run diagnostic utilities to isolate any problems before trying again. Some common diagnostic utilities include **SCANDISK** (DOS 6.0 and later), and **CHKDSK**.

Caution: Remember that the export file named in the message is incomplete.

639 Unable to delete '<*directory name/filename*>'. '

An error occurred, and Commence could not delete the specified directory or file name.

640 There is a disk error. Commece RM cannot copy the view to the HTML file.

Is there enough space on the destination disk for the export? Make sure the destination directory and drive are available. If saving to a diskette, confirm that a disk is in the drive. If you suspect disk or file problems, run diagnostic utilities to isolate any problems before trying again. Some common diagnostic utilities include **SCANDISK** (DOS 6.0 and later), and **CHKDSK**.

Caution: The HTML file was not created. Retry the operation.

643 Commence cannot find the file '<filename>' on the disk.

Be sure that the file exists on the disk. Check the file name for proper DOS syntax, and try again.

644 Commence cannot load the file '<filename>'. It or one of its components was not found on the disk.

A disk error occurred while trying to load the file or one of its components. Be sure that the file exists where it is expected. If you suspect disk or file problems, run diagnostic utilities to isolate any problems before trying again. Some common diagnostic utilities include **SCANDISK** (DOS 6.0 and later), and **CHKDSK**.

645 Commence cannot load the program '<program name>'. Be sure that it is installed correctly.

Commence cannot load the application. Be sure that you have properly installed the program as a Microsoft Windows application.

646 Insufficient disk space on drive %s to complete this operation. Free up at least <number> bytes of disk space and try again.

You chose an operation where Commence will need to create new files and disk space on the drive mentioned is getting too low to safely work with the active [database](#).

Commence creates temporary files while processing certain definition modification requests. When the process is complete, Commence will remove the original files and make the temporary files permanent. This is the safest method of expanding your database, but it will temporarily cause a need for additional disk space. To correct this problem, free up a sufficient amount of disk space before you continue to use the database.

647 Warning: Data disk space is below <size>. To reclaim disk space, delete or archive any unused categories or remove any non-Commence files from your <drive letter> disk drive.

Disk space is getting too low to safely work with the active [database](#). Free up as much space as possible before you continue to use the database. Either use the [File-Export-By-Category](#) command to archive categories, or delete categories (using the [Customize-Database-Category](#) command) that you no longer use.

**648 Commence was unable to delete the directory
'<*directory name*>'.**

An error occurred, and Commence could not delete the specified directory.

**649 Commence cannot access the directory
'<*directory name*>'.**

An error occurred, and Commence could not access the specified directory.

650 The directory '<directory name>' is empty or no longer exists.

Was the directory accidentally deleted or emptied? Create the directory using DOS commands, the Windows File Manager, or some other utility; or, restore data into the directory using [File-Import](#) or the **Restore** button on the [Open/Manage Database dialog box](#).

651 Unexpected end of file on input file '<filename>'.

The file does not contain any data. The file may be zero bytes in size. Please recreate the file.

652 The input file '<filename>' is an invalid file type.

The file selected for the [File-Sync Link In](#) command is not a Commence [update file](#). Check the filename and select a different file.

653 The input sync file '<filename>' is invalid for the current database.

Each [update file](#) is created for a specific database. If you attempt to use the [File-Sync Link In](#) command with a file for a different database, Commence will not perform the Sync Link In. You have selected the wrong database or the wrong update file.

660 Spell-checker Error - Word Not Found

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

661 Spell-checker Error - No Data Available

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

662 Spell-checker Error - No Aid Available

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

663 Spell-checker Error - Invalid Word Construction

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

664 Spell-checker Error - Too Many Dictionaries Open

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

665 Spell-checker Error - Dictionary is Not Updateable

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

666 Spell-checker Error - Updateable Dictionary Full

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

667 Spell-checker Error - Duplicate Dictionary

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

668 Spell-checker Error - Invalid Dictionary Name

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

669 Spell-checker Error - Bad Dictionary

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

670 Spell-checker Error - LEXAM Not Initialized

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

671 Spell-checker Error - Invalid Function

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

672 Spell-checker Error - Invalid Token in Dictionary List

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

673 Spell-checker Error - Invalid Word

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

674 Spell-checker Error - Illegal Input Flag Combination

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

675 Spell-checker Error - Missing or Illegal Value in Parameter Area

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

676 Spell-checker Error - Passback Too Small

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

677 Spell-checker Error - Filename Not Allowed for Updateable Dictionary

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

678 Spell-checker Error - Illegal Number of Dictionaries

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

679 Spell-checker Error - LEXAM Busy

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

680 Spell-checker Error - Memory Allocation Error

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

681 Spell-checker Error - File Not Found

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

682 Spell-checker Error - Path Not Found

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

683 Spell-checker Error - File Open Failed

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

684 Spell-checker Error - File Access Denied

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

685 Spell-checker Error - File Sharing Violation

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

686 Spell-checker Error - General File I/O Error

An internal spell checker error occurred. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

690 No spelling mistakes were found.

The spell checker did not find any spelling mistakes. Select **Yes** to continue.

691 The spell-checker cannot locate the spelling dictionary, <*dictionary name*>.

Commence cannot find the named dictionary. Make sure that the dictionary file has not been deleted, renamed, or damaged. The Commence dictionary is installed in the **program** directory selected during installation (usually this is **c:\commence**) If all else fails, you can re-install the Commence dictionary from the installation diskettes. The dictionary file name is **LOCAL.DIC**.

A personal dictionary (called **local.dic**) that is specific to the open [database](#) may exist in the open database's directory (see [File-Open/Manage Database](#)).

692 There was a system error in the spell-checker.

A system error occurred when trying to use the spell checker. Try again. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

693 You may spell check only text fields.

Only [text fields](#) may be checked for spelling errors.

800 Could not send e-mail, no mail programs are available. Select Edit-Preferences-Other Apps to add e-mail information.

You must tell Commence what mail protocol you are using (CMC, VIM, or MAPI). Go to Edit-Preferences-Other Apps and select E-Mail client. From here you can select the protocol, login name, password and other information specific to the protocol used.

801 E-mail services are not available; JJMAIL32.DLL not found or wrong version.

You should have a JJMAIL32.DLL file in your Commence program directory. If one cannot be found, re-install Commence.

802 Could not send e-mail. An error occurred while interacting with your e-mail program.

Commence could not send the E-Mail message. Please check your E-Mail Client settings in Edit-Preferences-Other Apps-E-Mail Client. Make sure you login name and passwords are correct. Also, double check that you can send e-mail outside of Commence.

803 No web browser detected. Please install an Internet browser program and try again.

Commence checks your registry for the default Internet browser.
None was found.

804 Could not launch web browser. An error occurred while interacting with your browser program.

Commence attempted to open your default Internet browser but had difficulties. Make sure you can start your browser outside of Commence.

805 An error occurred during synchronization with Outlook. Check the Message Log for more information.

The synchronization with Outlook did not complete successfully. If you selected Tools-Outlook Sync from the menu, more information about the error can be found by selecting Help-Message Log from Commence. When using an agent to synchronize with Outlook, more information can be found in the ACTIVE.LOG file located in the data directory. If the log file does not contain sufficient information, close Commence and restart using a command line option of /TRACE.

Confirm that all required fields contain data. The name field in particular cannot be left blank. Review the section titled "Prepare your Applications" in the *Outlook Integration User's Guide* to make sure that the data being synchronized meets all the guidelines.

806 Synchronization with Outlook was cancelled.

Commence was unable to continue because the operation was cancelled by the user.

807 Microsoft Outlook could not be loaded; verify that the required version of Outlook is installed.

Outlook must be installed on the same PC as Commence. Review the section titled “Requirements” in the *Outlook Integration User’s Guide* for more information.

808 Could not logon to Microsoft Outlook; verify that your email preferences are set correctly.

Commence was unable to login to Outlook. Make sure you have configured your [e-mail](#) preferences correctly. Review the section titled “Set E-Mail Client Preferences” in the *Outlook Integration User’s Guide* for more information.

809 The Outlook integration services could not be loaded.

A problem was encountered while loading the program files necessary for synchronizing Commence with Outlook. Try reinstalling Commence.

810 The Outlook preferences should be configured

using the Preferences-Other Apps dialog before using this command.

The Tools-Outlook Sync command cannot be used until after the Outlook Calendar or Outlook Contacts [preferences](#) have been configured. See “Outlook Field Mappings” in the *Outlook Integration User’s Guide* for a list of required fields that must be mapped.

920 View '<view name>' cannot use color code '<color template name>' (wrong category).

[Views](#) and [Color templates](#) are set for a particular category. The category of the view being transferred in is different than the category of the color code template selected for the view.

921 Transfer error: <error condition>

The indicated problem was encountered which prevented the transfer command from completing successfully. Transfer problems are usually due to insufficient memory or disk space on the current drive or in the temporary directory indicated by the TEMP= environment variable. Verify that you have enough available memory and disk space and try this command again. In order to check the integrity of a database, do the following: Turn on trace by appending a command line option of /Trace to the Commence icon.

1. Perform a File-Transfer Out. Press both 'Select All' buttons, and check the box to also transfer items. Send this to a file called "Test".

2. Go to File-Open/Manage Database-Add a new database, typing in "Test" into the Name and Path boxes.

3. Open this database, then perform a Transfer in of the "Test" file. (Warning: Do NOT transfer into the original database.) If no errors are detected during either the transfer Out or In process, then the database is probably OK.

Otherwise, check the active.log file in the data directory to see what Commence was attempting to process before the error occurred.

1016 This database is not empty and may not be used as a remote database.

You have selected the [File-Sync Link In](#) command, and specified an [update file](#) (*.SNC) which contains an initial synchronization information. An initial update file contains special commands that will change the open database to a [remote database](#) when it is processed, and it requires that the open database be empty.

Commence will not perform a Sync Link In because the open database is not empty. To correct this, select the [File-Open/Manage Database](#) command to open another database or create a new database with the [File-Open/Manage Database](#) command and then retry the **Sync Link In** command.

1030 The remote database must have a unique name.

You are defining a [remote database](#) in the **Add/Edit Remote Database** dialog box and you have not entered a name or the name that you entered is a duplicate of an existing remote database. To correct this problem, enter a different name in the **Database Name** text box and select the **OK** button or select the **Cancel** button to return to the **Sync Out** dialog box.

1031 A remote database must be selected; if a remote database is not defined, use the Add button to create one.

You have selected the **OK** button in the **Sync Out** dialog box to create an [update file](#) and you have not selected a remote database name from the **Synchronize with Database** [drop-down list box](#). If no names appear in the **Synchronize with Database** drop-down list box. select the **Add** button to create a remote database name.

Select the **OK** button to create an update file for the selected remote database or select the **Cancel** button to return to the [work area](#).

1036 SyncLink error: <error>.

Accessing admin files failed

Make sure the base database contains all the appropriate administration files. These filenames will all have .DAT extensions. The date and size of these files should match those found in the Workgroup Administration Files directory (e.g. \wgfiles5) on the Server.

To ensure that none of your changes are lost, you must perform a complete sync link out from the base database, then retry the sync link in at the remote database.

Canceled by user

This message is to inform you that the sync link was canceled at your request.

Insufficient permissions

Contact your Commence Administrator. The permissions you have been granted do not allow you to perform this operation. Only the administrator can modify your permissions to give you the required access.

Importing item data failed

The data you are attempting to import may be corrupt. At the source database where you produced the sync file, test the data by selecting [File-Transfer Out](#). Transfer all categories, agents, and item out to a file and take note of any error messages. Contact Technical Support if the Transfer fails.

Invalid sync id found in the database

Please contact Jensen-Jones Sales to obtain the latest version of Commence.

File could not be accessed

If your sync file is located on a shared drive, check to ensure that the sync file is not being accessed by another user or another copy of Commence. Make sure you have the correct read/write permissions to the drive where the sync file is located.

Disk read failed

The sync link file could not be read because of a disk error. If you suspect disk failure, run diagnostic utilities. Some common diagnostic utilities include **SCANDISK** (DOS 6.0 and later), and **CHKDSK**. To ensure that none of your changes are lost, you must perform a complete sync link out from the base database, then retry the sync link in at the remote database.

Disk write failed

The sync link file could not be created either because of a disk error or a lack of disk space. Make sure you have at least 2-3 times the size of the uncompressed database in free disk space. If you suspect disk failure, run diagnostic utilities.

Disk access failed

If you suspect disk failure, run diagnostic utilities.

Out of memory

Select [Help-System Information](#) in Commence. Take note of the amount of total free memory available. If your system resources are low (below 50%) close down any other applications and try again. Also try increasing the size of your swap file using Control Panel-386 Enhanced-Virtual Memory. Restart Windows and try again.

A maximum was exceeded

Check Appendix A in the *Commence User's Guide* for a list of the maximum capacities allowed for items, fields, views, etc. The information you are attempting to sync link in would cause Commence to exceed one of those maximum capacities.

Incorrect internal state. Please call Tech Support

Contact Technical Support (at the phone number listed in **Help-About**). Take note of what you were doing at the time the error occurred.

Database access failed

Test the data by selecting [File-Transfer Out](#). Transfer all categories, agents, and item out to a file and take note of any

error messages. Then try transferring in from the .TFR file. Contact Technical Support if either the Transfer In or Out fails.

An invalid parameter was found

Contact Technical Support (at the phone number listed in **Help-About**) for more information.

A required record was not found

The sync link in could not be completed because a required item is missing. One or more of your database definitions (connections, views, detail forms, agents etc.) views, is filtered by a connection to a particular item in the database. That connected item either cannot be created or does not exist.

If you are performing an initial sync link in, return to the base database and remove the dependency on this item. For example, if you have filtered a connection, select [Customize-Database-Connection](#) and edit that connection. Press the **Advanced** button. Press the **Select Filter** button, then press **Clear Filter**, and **Save**. Then perform an incremental sync link out using a new sync link group.

A duplicate record was found

The information you are attempting to sync link in would cause a duplicate item to be added to a category. If duplicate items are not allowed in any of your categories, you should change this setting by selecting [Customize-Database-Category](#). Edit the category and turn on the **Allow Duplicate Names** checkbox.

Internal error. Please call Tech Support

Contact Technical Support (at the phone number listed in **Help-About**). Take note of what you were doing at the time the error occurred.

Unknown error. Please call Tech Support

Contact Technical Support (at the phone number listed in **Help-About**). Take note of what you were doing at the time

the error occurred.

1037 SyncLink error: disk write to output file or temporary directory failed.

Commence was unable to save the sync link file. This error is usually due to insufficient memory or disk space on the current drive or in the temporary directory indicated by the TEMP= environment variable. To determine where your temporary directory is located, type SET at the DOS prompt and hit ENTER. Take note of the path specified after TEMP= or TMP=. Then verify that you have enough available disk space on that drive and try this command again. To perform a sync link in, make sure you have at least 10-15 times the size of the compressed .SNC file in free space in your temporary directory.

To perform a sync link out, make sure you have at least 2-3 times the size of the uncompressed database in free disk space.

1038 SyncLink error: reading or writing the database data files failed.

An error occurred and Commence could not process the data.

Check the amount of free space on the disk. If you suspect disk failure, run diagnostic utilities and/or have your disk drive serviced before you continue. Some common diagnostic utilities include **SCANDISK** (DOS 6.0 and later), and **CHKDSK**. If the problem persists, contact Commence Technical Support (select **Help-About**).

1039 SyncLink error: this stand-alone database must be used with a SyncLink file containing an initial sync.

The only way to create a sync file containing an initial sync is by adding a new Sync Link group at the base database. For detailed steps on how to establish a new sync link group for the first time, see the [File-Sync Link Out](#) command.

Once you have added a new sync link group, then perform an incremental sync link out with that remote database.

**1043 An error was encountered while initializing the
database for SyncLink. SyncLink cannot continue**

1000 Couldn't make items shared.

You selected the [Edit-Share All Items](#) command and Commence can not create shared items in a category which is not shared.

1001 Shared categories with local fields are not allowed in this version of Commence.

Commence does not allow you to add local fields to a shared category.

If you are trying to display a private field, you may add a local category to the database then add a connection from the shared category to the local category. Note that a local form will also need to be created for the shared category; connections to local categories cannot be displayed on shared forms.

To add a category, use the [Customize-Database-Category](#) command. To add a connection, use the [Customize-Database-Connection](#) command. To copy a detail form, use the [Customize-Database-Detail Form](#) command and click the Copy button.

To add a category, use the [Tools-Customize-Database-Category](#) command. To add a connection, use the [Tools-Customize-Database-Connection](#) command. To copy a detail form, use the [Tools-Customize-Database-Detail Form](#) command and click the Copy button.

1002 You have marked the field <fieldname> as shared but the category is not shared. No fields in a non-shared category may be shared.

Commence cannot save the shared field definition because the category is a local category. Only local fields can be added to local categories.

**1003 This database cannot create remote databases
because it is not a base database.**

A database which is itself a remote database cannot create other remote databases for SyncLinking. Only the base database may add new remote databases.

1004 This stand-alone database cannot be used with SyncLink; create a remote database in order to use SyncLink.

A SyncLink is not allowed into or out of a stand-alone database. The only exception to this rule is an initial SyncLink into a new, empty, stand-alone database.

1010 The permissions you have been granted do not allow this operation.

Your access to the shared database is controlled by a set of [user permissions](#). You have selected an action that is not allowed for your user level. Check with the Commence Administrator if you think your permissions should be changed.

1011 The permissions you have been granted do not allow you to add this shared <data or definition>.

You have chosen to add a shared item or a definition. Your [permissions](#) do not allow you to save this item or definition as shared. You may be able to save the item or definition as a local item or definition. Check with the Commence Administrator if you think your permissions should be changed.

1012 The permissions you have been granted do not allow you to edit this shared <data or definition>.

Your [permissions](#) do not allow you to save this item or definition as shared. Check with the Commence Administrator if you think your permissions should be changed.

1013 The permissions you have been granted do not allow you to delete this shared <data or definition>.

Your [permissions](#) do not allow you to delete this shared item or definition. Check with the Commence Administrator if you think your category and/or database permissions should be changed.

1015 The permissions you have been granted do not allow you to overwrite this shared <view name>.

You have chosen to save a [view](#) with the [Views-Save View As](#) command, and the name you have selected matches an existing, shared view's name. You do not have [permission](#) to overwrite the existing shared view. You can save the view with another name. Otherwise contact the Commence Administrator and request that your permissions be changed to Author level.

1017 The Login ID field is required for a valid login.

You must enter a User name in the [Log In to Server](#) dialog box before selecting **OK**. Commence can not log in to a server without this [Login ID](#).

1018 An error occurred accessing the Administration library.

Commence could not access one of the server program files, ADMINENG.DLL. This file should exist in your Commence program directory. Make sure you only have one copy of this file in the Commence Program directory. to locate the program directory, look at the properties of your Commence shortcut. On the Shortcut tab, the target should point to the Commence program directory. Perform the following steps to confirm that the Windows registry points to the correct program directory. Check the online Commence knowledgebase for more information about this error.

1019 Login was not successful. Try again or select Cancel.

Commence could not login to the server because a wrong password was entered. Enter the correct password to continue or select **Cancel** to terminate the Login process.

1020 The permissions you have been granted do not allow you to access this database.

You have not been given permission to access this shared database. Check with the Commence Administrator if you think your permissions should be changed.

1021 The Admin directory could not be located or does not contain the proper admin files.

The Commence Server will not start because it could not find the necessary Administration files.

Check the WGFILS7= stick in the ADMIN.INI file in the program directory. The path must point to the Workgroup Administration files (*.DAT) on the Server.

Then look at the properties for your Commence shortcut. On the Shortcut tab, the target should point to the Commence program directory. Confirm that the Windows registry points to the correct program directory. Contact Technical Support for additional assistance.

1024 This version of Commence requires a different version of the Administration library.

The version of the Commence program file (ADMINENG.DLL) for the Commence Administration library is not the proper version. .

- If multiple copies of Commence are installed, make sure you are running the correct shortcut. Check the shortcut properties to make sure program directory and path to commence.exe are correct.
- Restart windows to get fresh copy of ADMINENG.DLL into memory.
- Select [Customize-Workgroup](#), then press Next to view the Communication settings. Make sure shared LAN directory is available and that the path is set correctly.
- Check network permissions to the shared LAN directory. Clients must have FULL (read/write/create/delete/modify) permissions. Copy a small text file from the client to the shared LAN directory. Be sure you can edit, save, and delete the file.
- Run ComAdmin and check list of users, databases, etc. to make sure they appear intact.
- Right click on commence.exe and admineng.dll. Make sure the versions are correct.

- Reinstall Commence

1025 An error occurred while using this database with the Administration library.

A system error occurred when trying to access the Administration Library. This error is caused by:

- problems initializing the admineng.dll
 - problems initializing the communication settings for a particular database
-
- Close Windows and restart Commence with the /PROMPT command line option. When you are prompted for which database to open, try opening a personal database first, then retry opening the workgroup database.
 - Restart windows to get fresh copy of ADMINENG.DLL into memory
 - Select [Customize-Workgroup](#), then press Next to view the Communication settings. Make sure shared LAN directory is available and that the path is set correctly.
 - Check network permissions to the shared LAN directory. Clients must have FULL (read/write/create/delete/modify) permissions. Copy a small text file from the client to the shared LAN directory. Be sure you can edit, save, and delete the file.
 - Check the database.id file. Either delete that file at the server and reconfigure the Communication settings, or try pointing to new shared LAN directory. In both cases, the database.id file will be recreated.
 - Check the *.DAT files in the \wgfiles5 directory. One of these files may be corrupt, or abnormally large (e.g., over 100Mb), or unusually small (under 1kb). Run ComAdmin and check list of users, databases, etc. to make sure they are intact. Replace any suspicious DAT files with the equivalent file from any client data directory.

- Check the DATA.ini file on Commence server. Take note of the SharedDbID=? Note that this number will be in decimal format, not hexadecimal. Compare with databases defined in ComAdmin, especially if a new shared database was recently added. Note that the *.DAT filenames will be in hexadecimal. Don't forget to convert. (e.g. sharedDbID=20 matches up with auth0014.dat)
- Database was not properly administered. Run ComAdmin. Remove the database from the shared database list, then re-add it. Re-enroll all users.

If the problem persists, reinstall Commence.

1026 The server has failed to respond to the sync request; check that the server is running.

Commence did not receive a response from the server when requesting a database synchronization. The system may be busy or the server may be unavailable. Try again later or check with the Commence Administrator to see if there is a server problem.

1027 The database is not connected to the server and automatic syncing will be disabled.

Commence could not access the shared LAN directory when requesting a database [synchronization](#). Automatic synchronization will not occur until the problem is corrected. Check that the Commence Server is running. Also make sure that the client can access the shared LAN directory with full permissions. .

If you have turned off syncing, use the [Customize-Workgroup](#) command to reset your synchronization preferences.

**1028 This database is enrolled for a different user;
select a different data directory or enter a different
login name.**

The User name you entered in the [Log In to Server](#) dialog box was setup for a different [client database](#). Commence can not log in to the server for this [Login ID](#) with the open database. To correct the problem, enter a different Login ID or use the [File-Open/Manage Database](#) command to open a different database.

1029 An error occurred while registering this client. Check the Message Log for additional information.

The Commence Administrator's attempt to register this client to the shared database was unsuccessful. Select [Help-Message Log](#) for more information about what error occurred.

To re-register this client, the Commence Administrator must select the [Customize-Workgroup](#) command from the Commence Server PC. Select the **Next >** button until you get to the **Register** screen. Press the **Remove** button to remove the user's name from the list of Registered Users. Then try registering the user again.

Tips:

- Delete any files found in the server's workgrp directory
- If syncing via MS Exchange or Outlook, confirm that the Profile name is correct. Enter it case-sensitively
- Do not use blank password for e-mail syncing.

1032 The Login ID was not found. It may have been deleted, or it does not exist.

Upon opening the shared database, you entered a Login ID which was not valid. The ComAdmin program did not find this login ID in its records. It is possible that the user record never existed, or it has since been deleted. Once a user is deleted, only the Administrator can login to the shared database belonging to that user.

1033 The automatic login failed; please enter login name and password.

You have selected auto-login in the [Other Preferences](#) dialog box. Commence attempted to log in, but the login has failed. Your Login ID may be invalid or may have been deleted.

Restart Windows. Make sure the CAPS LOCK key is not on and try again. Check with the Commence Administrator if you can not determine the cause of problem.

1034 The Commence server license is not valid for the number of users defined in ComAdmin. Please use the License utility to update Commence with a valid license that authorizes <number> users.

When Commence launches, several checks are performed to ensure that the number of clients using the software does not exceed the total user limit. First confirm that you have purchased a sufficient number of Commence clients (one per user). Then run License and check the User Limit. Re-enter your key if necessary to increase the total user limit. If the key does not produce the desired User Limit, contact Commence Sales to obtain a new key or to purchase additional client software.

This error may also be caused during an upgrade from a prior version of Commence. If, for example, you owned 10 client licenses in a previous version but only upgraded 7 client licenses, then you must remove the additional 3 users before running Commence. Select the Users icon in ComAdmin to delete the extra users.

1042 Commence has detected an invalid file type during syncing; use Transfer Out and In to a new database to correct this problem.

This database contains information which Commence cannot recognize. It is possible that a file has been damaged.

If the database is a Commence Server database, then restore from a backup of the database. If a recent backup is not available, you can salvage your data by transferring out all categories and agents, including items. Then add a new, empty database using the [File-Open/Manage Database](#) command. Open the new database and use [File-Transfer In](#) to rebuild your database. See [Getting Started](#) for more information about how to set up your new database as a shared database.

If you are a client, you should re-enroll. See the section titled 'How to Enroll into a Commence Workgroup' in the *Commence User's Guide* for detailed instructions.

1050 A workgroup error has occurred. ADMINENG.DLL returned error code <error code>.

Check your communication settings using the [Customize-Workgroup](#) command.

If the problems persist, take note of the exact error message, including the error code number, and contact Commence Technical Support. Select **Help-About** for the Technical Support phone number.

1051 <Key> is not a valid authorization key. Enter the key exactly as it appears on your instruction sheet. There should be no spaces or punctuations.

The authorization key you have entered is not correct. Press the CAPS LOCK key on your keyboard (to toggle CAPS LOCK on or off) and try entering the key again.

If you do not have an authorization key, contact the Commence Administrator. At the server, make sure that the client is registered. You can verify the authorization key by selecting the [Customize-Workgroup](#) command at the server and going to the **Register** screen. Highlight the registered user and then select the **Details** button.

1052 Template file for the client instruction sheet was not found <s?>. Instruction sheet cannot be generated.

As part of the registration process Commence can generate an instruction sheet that walks a user through the client enroll process. The instruction sheet is saved as a text file you can print out, e-mail or fax to the user.

This instruction sheet is generated from a template file that you should customize to include information about your site. At a minimum, you should add your name and phone number so that users can contact you if they experience any problems. The template file is a text file that you can edit using any text editor (such as Notepad or WordPad).

There are two template files, one for e-mail and one for a shared LAN directory:

x:\commence\wgfiles5\steps1.txt is the e-mail template file, and x:\commence\wgfiles5\steps2.txt is the shared LAN template file, (where x:\commence is the Commence program directory).

**1053 Server communication parameters not found.
Please configure the server using the Customize-
Workgroup command.**

At the Commence Server PC, select the [Customize-Workgroup](#) command. Select the **Next >** button until you get to the **Communications** screen. To modify the communication settings for the Commence Server, press the **Configure** button on the top half of the screen.

**1054 Commence cannot run while a copy of the
Commence Administration program is active. Shut
down ComAdmin before starting Commence.**

You must close ComAdmin to save any changes to the Workgroup Administration files. Commence cannot access that information while ComAdmin is running. To shut down ComAdmin, switch over to that application and select **File-Exit** from the menu.

1055 The workgroup admin files are currently locked either by ComAdmin or another copy of Commence. Try again later.

The same Workgroup Administration files (*.DAT files in the \wgfiles5 directory) are shared by Commence and ComAdmin. Commence cannot access that information while ComAdmin is running, and vice versa. Make sure all Server databases in Commence are closed before attempting to change settings in ComAdmin. Likewise, make sure ComAdmin is closed before attempting to change workgroup settings in Commence. Select **File-Exit** from the menu to close either application.

1056 Could not find the database registration information from the server. Verify that your communication parameters are entered correctly.

If problems persist, contact your Commence administrator to:

- 1) verify that your instruction sheet is up-to-date, and,**
- 2) arrange for the server to re-send the registration information.**

Check your communication settings using the [Customize-Workgroup](#) command. Use the instruction sheet provided by your Commence Administrator to make sure any paths and other parameters have been entered correctly.

To re-send the registration information for this client, the Commence Administrator must select the [Customize-Workgroup](#) command from the Commence Server PC. Select the **Next >** button until you get to the **Register** screen. Press the **Details** button, then press the Re-Register button. This will resend the registration information to the user.

1057 The communication settings for this workgroup database are missing or invalid and automatic syncing is disabled for this session.

To re-start syncing:

- 1) Use the Customize-Workgroup command to enter the correct communication parameters, or,**
- 2) Connect to the network and re-start Commence.**

Check your communication settings using the [Customize-Workgroup](#) command. Select the **Next >** button until you get to the **Communications** screen. Use the instruction sheet provided by your Commence Administrator to make sure any paths and other parameters have been entered correctly.

Make sure you have access to the shared LAN directory, then try closing Commence and restarting it.

1058 The communication settings for this database are missing or invalid. Select the Configure button to change the settings.

Check your communication settings using the [Customize-Workgroup](#) command. Select the **Next >** button until you get to the **Communications** screen. Use the instruction sheet provided by your Commence Administrator to make sure any paths and other parameters have been entered correctly.

1059 Shared LAN directory is unavailable and synchronization

is disabled.

Verify the user's permissions to the shared directory. This directory requires full read, write, create, delete, and modify access for all workgroup users. Open this directory using Windows Explorer on the client PC. Copy a test file to this directory. Try to delete a test file created by the Commence server.

ACTION

An action specifies the work to be done by an [agent](#).

In most cases, actions use values or operate on data passed from the [trigger](#)

and/or [conditions](#)

defined for the agent. An action (and a trigger) are required to define an agent.

An agent can have up to four specified actions, chosen from among the following: modify a displayed icon; display a message box with a specified message; create and display a new view; open a saved view; add an item; edit an item; print an item or view; activate an agent; launch an external Windows application; send a DDE (Dynamic Data Exchange) message to another Windows application.

ACTIVATE

To activate an agent, select the [Customize-Database-Agent](#) command, highlight the agent that you wish to activate then select the Edit button. You can then select the Active check box.

ACTIVE

An agent is active when the Active check box is selected for that agent on the [Customize-Database Agent](#) dialog box; a check mark also appears next to the agent name in the Agents list box. An active agent is triggered by the occurrence of the trigger condition specified in the rule.

ACTIVE CATEGORY

The active category is the [category](#) used by the active [view](#).

ACTIVE VIEW

The active view is the currently displayed view; if more than one view is displayed, the active view is the view whose title bar is a different color or shade than all the other windows. On the Window menu, the active view is indicated by a check mark next to its name.

ACTIVE WINDOW

The active window is the selected window with which you are currently working. The active window appears in front (or on top) of all the other windows on your desktop or application work area; its title bar is a different color from the other windows. All keystrokes and commands that you type affect the active window.

AGENT

Agents allow you to specify criteria under which Commence will perform various tasks for you. An agent consists of a trigger, one or two optional conditions, and one to four actions. Agents are added, copied, edited, deleted, activated, and deactivated by selecting the [Customize-Database Agent](#) command from the menu bar.

AGENT TOOL BAR

The agent tool bar displays icons for agents with a tool bar pick trigger, providing the ability to quickly execute these agents by selecting an icon with the mouse. You must have a mouse to use the agent tool bar.

You can choose whether or not to display the agent tool bar using the [Edit-Preferences-Tool Bars](#) command. You can also

ARRANGE

To position fields when you customize an item detail form.

ASSOCIATED CATEGORY

When printing a calendar view, items from the associated category (chosen with the [Edit-Preferences-Calendar](#) command) that occur on the date(s) being printed are printed as well.

In addition to the Name field, you can select up to two checkbox or radio group fields from the associated category to appear on the calendar printout.

BACKUP

To make a copy of a Commence database for use if the original is lost or damaged. Use the [Open/Manage Database](#) command, then highlight the database name and select the **Backup** button. Commence will create a compressed copy of all the data in the database into a DOS file with a ".xfr" extension. Use the [Restore](#) button to recreate a usable Commence database.

BASE DATABASE

When using the Sync Link facility to synchronize databases, the active database where you define your [sync link group](#) is called the base database. You populate the [remote database](#) with the information from the base database. For detailed information on creating a a sync link group, see [Sync Link](#).

BUSY BAR

A vertical bar in a calendar day view that indicated when appointments are scheduled. This feature is no longer available.

CALCULATION FIELD

Calculation fields lets you define formulas based on data in other fields. Currency, number, date, and time fields can appear in formulas using addition, subtraction, multiplication, and division operations.

Calculation fields can contain a formula using up to 256 characters, including the +, -, *, and / operators, parentheses () for grouping, and the currency symbol defined via the Windows Control Panel (in the United States and some other countries, this is the dollar sign \$).

You create formulas by selecting other fields from the category and separating them with arithmetic operators. An example of a valid formula is: **([End Time]—[Start Time])*[Rate]/100**

Note that date and time fields are useful in calculations only when the difference between two dates or times are taken. For example, **[Start Date]—[End Date]** makes sense; **[Start Time]*60** does not.

You can use the [Tools Field Summary](#) command to display the sum or average of the calculation, currency, and number fields appearing in a report view.

CATEGORY

A category is a storage container for your data.

There is a limit to the number of categories that can be saved in a Comcommerce database. Refer to the [Database Capacities](#) topic for more information.

CHECK BOX

A check box allows you to select an option. When an option is selected that has a check box, the check box is filled with an 'X'. Otherwise the box is empty. When check boxes appear in groups, you can select as many or as few of the boxes as you want (i.e., check box options are not mutually-exclusive).

CHECK BOX FIELD

A check box field is used to represent a yes/no or on/off condition or option. When an **X** appears in a check box, the condition or option is turned on or enabled; when empty, the condition is turned off or disabled.

CLARIFY FIELD

A clarify field is a field used by categories to distinguish between items with duplicate names. Commence uses the clarify field when making connections, importing data, transferring in data, and creating letters and faxes.

To set the clarify field for a category select the [Customize-Database-Category](#) command, highlight the category that you wish to change, select the **Edit** button then the **Clarify Field** button. Choose the field that will make each item in the category unique.

CLIPBOARD

A temporary storage area provided by Windows for text or graphics. An application can cut or copy data to the clipboard for later pasting into the same or another application's workspace.

COLOR TEMPLATE

A color coding scheme to accent entries in views. You can create multiple color templates to choose from, up to the limit of 600 per database.

A color template can be based on the value of a check box, a radio group, or a connection to a particular item. To define a color template select the [Customize-Database-Color Code](#)

COMBO BOX

Used to display a list of choices from which to select when entering data. Select one of the choices as the default display..

CONDITION

A condition is an additional, optional constraint used to further define the scope or operation of an [agent](#). An agent's [trigger](#) plus any defined conditions must all be satisfied before the execution of the agent's [action\(s\)](#).

Conditions can be based on time intervals (such as "every Monday") or on the state of some discrete piece of data in Commence (such as the number of items scheduled for a particular week).

An agent can have one, two, or no conditions; if present, conditions are evaluated only after the trigger for the agent occurs. Some conditions can pass data to the agent's actions.

CONNECT

To establish a connection between two pieces of information in Commence.

CONNECTED FIELD

An connected field is a field from a connected category that you choose to display in a report view, to use in an agent action, or to appear in a letter. You select an connected field by choosing the name of a connection and then selecting a field from the connected category.

For example, if you choose the connection **Relates to...** to appear in a report view of the Contact category, you can choose any field from the Company category (the category on the other side of the connection), such as the company **Name**. In the report, all contacts connected to one or more Company items along the **Relates to...** connection display the company **Name** field from the connected item(s).

CONNECTION

A connection is a link between items in the same category or in different categories. It shows relationships among items in linked categories. An example is "Joe Jones has a lunch appointment on 5/10/97". This connects a Person item to an Appointment item.

You can establish a link between any two items by creating a [connection definition](#) in the category (if it does not already exist) and using the [connection control](#) to specify the connected item.

CONNECTION CONTROL

A connection control appears in an item detail as a box with three control buttons. It displays the item names of items that are connected to the currently displayed item. The connection control is labeled with the [connection definition](#) name.

A connection control is added to a category by adding a connection definition between that category and another category (or a category and itself). Selecting the name in the connection control displays the item detail of the connected item.

If more than one connected item exists, one or both of the arrows

 [image/connarrs_shg.gif](#)

at the right of the connection definition will be darkened depending on whether the item displayed in the connection control is at the top, bottom, or middle of the list of connected items. Use these arrows to scroll through the list of connected items.

Selecting the assign connection button  [image/conndiag_shg.gif](#)

at the right of the connection control displays a drop-down list of the item names of all the items from the connected category.

Connected items have a check mark in the left margin next to their names. Connect and disconnect items by selecting their names (click the left mouse button two times on a name, or use the arrow keys to highlight a name and then press the SPACEBAR).

Selecting the plus sign  [image/connadd_shg.gif](#)

at the far right of the connection control allows you to add an item to the connected category; the new item is automatically connected to the displayed item detail.

CONNECTION DEFINITION

A connection definition is a link between two categories. A connection definition allows you to create relationships among items in linked categories. You can establish a link between any two categories, or between a category and itself. An example of a connection definition is Person-Has-Appointment.

A connection definition is added to a category by adding a connection between that category and another category (or a category and itself). A connection control is added to the item detail and is labeled with the name given the connection when it was created. Selecting the name in the connection control displays the item detail of the connected item.

You can add a connection to your database by selecting the [Customize-Database-Connection](#) command.

CONTROL MENU BOX

A window's control menu box is the shaded box in the far upper left corner of the window, on the same level as the window's title bar. Commands in this standard Windows menu allow you to restore, move, size, maximize, minimize, close, and switch windows.

For an *application window* such as the main Commence window, press ALT+SPACEBAR to access this menu. For a *document window*, such as a view window within Commence, press ALT+- (hyphen). Then, use the mouse (or the UP/DOWN ARROW keys and ENTER) to select a command.

DATA FILE FIELD

The data file field is used to reference a file on your file system from an [item detail](#).

The data file field appears in its entirety (as described below) only on item details; the file name associated with a data file field can be displayed in a book, report or calendar view.

A data file field on an item detail contains the following elements:

FILE TEXT BOX

Contains the name of the file you want to reference. When adding an item that has an data file field, type a file name in this box, or use the **Select** button (see below) to search your available disks for an appropriate file.

VIEW BUTTON

Allows you to display the file from the item detail. The extension of the file must be associated with an editor in **[Extensions]** of the file **win.ini**. See your Windows documentation for how to do this.

For example, if the extension **.doc** is associated with Word for Windows in your **win.ini** file, you can select a **.doc** file in a data file field and select the **View** button to edit the file with Word for Windows.

SELECT BUTTON

Displays the [Select File](#) dialog box so that you can search your available disks for a file.

You can include spreadsheets, word processor files, drawings, images, and other types of information in an item.

DATABASE

A set of categories, data items, views, agents that define what data you can store in Commence and how Commence acts in this data. Commence provides you with a pre-defined databases that has a set of categories, desktops, views and agents that support calendaring, task management and contact management. You can use this database as-is or you can customize it to meet your specific needs. You can also create a custom database from scratch or you can transfer elements from a different database into your own database using the Transfer command. You can create additional databases and open them with the [Open/Manage-Database](#) command.

On disk, each database is stored in its own Windows folder and, because Commence is based on a proprietary database, you will see many separate files on disk within that directory. Each file, no matter how small, serves a unique and important purpose. Deleting or renaming Commence data files (using DOS commands or some other utility outside of Commence) can result in an unrecoverable loss of data.

DATABASE DIRECTORY

A database directory is a directory in which Commence keeps its data files. By default databases are created in a folder within the **Application Data Directory**. To determine the database folder containing the files for a particular database, select [Open/Manage-Database](#), highlight the desired database and select the **Edit** button. The path will be the database directory.

DATABASE PASSWORD

A password selected by a Commence user to protect a database from being opened by an inappropriate person.

DATE FIELD

The Date field type lets you enter a date using either the format you selected from the Windows control panel (such as **1/16/96**) or using English date phrases such as **next Tuesday**.

If a date field is enabled for recurring dates (done at the time the date field is added to a category), a [Recurring Item](#) button is displayed when an item is added to the category. To enter a recurring date, you can either select the **Recurring Item** button on the **Add Item** dialog or you can enter an asterisk (*) in the recurring date field. The asterisk tells Commence to invoke a dialog box that asks for the recurring date sequence (such as **Every Third Tuesday**) when you save the item.

Using filters, you can display all the items in a view that match a particular date. If you use an English phrase in your filter, such as **today**, the date won't be evaluated until you invoke the view. Using [Customize-Sort View](#), you can a view by ascending or descending date: this will be evaluated first by year, then month, then day.

A single date field indicates a specific date, while two fields (e.g., start date and end date fields) can be used in a category to specify a date range. Any category that has two date fields can use the Gantt view type for displaying items graphically by date interval.

DAY TITLE

Day titles are displayed at the top of the daily calendar just above the graphical display of time slots. Day titles are appointments or events that are scheduled for a day but do not have a start or end time. An example of a day title is "Anniversary".

DEACTIVATE

Prevents an agent from firing under all circumstances. To deactivate an agent, select the [Customize-Database Agent](#) command, highlight the agent name from the **Agents** list box, select Edit then select the **Inactive** check box.

DEFINITION

The category definitions, view layouts, agent definitions, detail form definitions, and color code templates that define a Commence database.

DESIGN

The arrangement and definition of fields in a view or detail form.

DESKTOP

A set of views and item details that can be started all at once. Multiple desktops can be defined for quick and easy access to data used for common operations (e.g. contact management, appointments, scheduling, etc.).

DETAIL FORM

A detail form is a formatted display of a single item from a particular category. The detail form is displayed whenever you add an item to or display an item from a category. The detail form specifies the arrangement, sizes, fonts, and colors of all fields included in the layout. Not all fields need be included in a particular detail form. You can create multiple detail forms for each category. Default forms can be chosen for item detail display and for the detail view displayed when adding an item to a category. You can also place a [filter](#) on a detail form so that it will be used for all items that meet the filter.

DIALING DEVICE

A hardware device that allows your PC to automatically dial the phone. This could be a modem controlled through Windows Telephony (TAPI), or it can be a direct connection to a supported TAPI-compliant telephone switch such as the AT&T PassageWay system.

DIALOG BOX

A dialog box displays a command's options and parameters, allowing you to review and change them.

DIRECT FIELD

A direct field is a field from the current category. For example, the Address field is a direct field in the Person category.

DROP-DOWN LIST BOX

A drop-down list box is a special list box that displays only one entry from a list (the currently selected entry) in a box with a down arrow button at right. Selecting the arrow button displays the entire list, with scroll bars (if necessary). You can then select a new item or select the arrow button again to hide the list.

EDIT BOX

An edit box on a detail form or dialog box is any box that can hold character data either typed in by you, pasted from the Windows Clipboard, or pasted from a DOS file.

E-MAIL ADDRESS FIELD

This field type is used specifically for electronic mail (E-Mail) addresses. Double clicking on an address within this field will open up a blank mail note (using the default e-mail software) with the **To:** field automatically filled in with the selected address. Commence allows up to eighty (80) characters for each e-mail address

EXCEL CELL FIELD

An Excel Cell field allows you to access a value from a Microsoft ExcelŽ spreadsheet and display it in an item detail. Excel cell values cannot be exported, printed or displayed in a view.

Excel cells appear on item details only. The field contains the following elements:

VALUE

Displays the current value from the Excel cell.

FILE TEXT BOX

Contains the name of the file containing the Excel spreadsheet. When adding an item that has an Excel cell field, type a file name in this box, or use the **Select** button (see below) to search your available disks for an appropriate file.

CELL TEXT BOX

Contains the name of the cell in the file named in the **File** text box to be used as the source for the field value.

SELECT BUTTON

Displays the [Select File](#) dialog box so that you can search your available disks for an Excel file.

EXPORT

To extract data from a Commence database into an external file in a pre-selected format that other applications can use. Select the [Export-By View](#) or [Export-By Category](#) command to create an export file from items in your open database.

FIELD

A field is a place within a category used to store a particular type of information. For example, some of the Person category fields are Name, Address, Business Phone, and Notes. A category definition can contain 1 to 100 fields, including connections. When you create a category or add fields to an existing category, you must specify the name of each field and its type.

The available field types in Commence are: calculation, check box, data file, date, Excel cell, image, name, number, radio group, sequence number, telephone, text, and, time. A category can have only one **Name** field by default. Labels for fields are limited to 20 characters.

FIELD CODE

A variable that can be used in an agent or letter to represent the data value of a field. See [Using Field Codes in Templates](#) for the basics of using field codes in letters. See [Using Field Codes in Actions](#) for the basics of using field codes in agent actions. A field code has the form of either **(%Field Name%)** or **(%Connection Name%%Connected Category Name%%Field Name%)**.

FIELD VALUE

The value stored in a field.

FIELD SUMMARY

Summary statistics that are displayed or printed for a report. You can include totals or averages for number and calculation fields provided the **Calculation Type** option has been set for the fields using the report layout's **Field Options** button. To request a field summary select [Tools-Field Summary](#) when a report view is active.

FILTER

A filter creates a subset of the items based on a field value in a category and displays the items in the view. For example, you can filter a view to show only your appointments for today or your To-Dos that are not completed. You can also filter on a connection to another category. For example, you can filter on all People employed by Wigits, Inc. Lastly, you can combine up to four filter criteria to get a set of items. For example, you can filter your To-Dos to show the items that are due today, are Priority 1, and are not completed. You can change the filter on a view by selecting [Customize-Filter View](#) from the menu bar.

FORMATTED TEMPLATE

Formatted templates are word processor documents and are used for writing letters using data stored in Commence. The word processor is used to view, print, or fax letters based on the formatted template. You can create a formatted letter template by selecting [Customize-Database-Letter Template](#).

Like [text templates](#), formatted templates can include Inserted Fields that are used to indicate merged values for the Commence data item. However, unlike text templates, formatted templates (and the letters you write with them) can include any special formatting supported by the word processor: e.g., multiple fonts, indents, bookmarks, fields, bitmaps, tables, etc.

GLOBAL SEARCH

A feature that lets you find all items in the database that contain or exactly match a particular text string.

GROUP BOX

The group box element of a dialog box is used to organize several options under one main heading.

GROUP CALENDARING

The capability to add an appointment to your client database and share it with all authorized workgroups users. Used in conjunction with the [Tools-Schedule Meeting](#) command and the Personal Information Preference.

HYPERTEXT TRANSFER PROTOCOL

The system for requesting HyperText Markup Language (HTML) documents from the World Wide Web (WWW).

HYPERTEXT MARKUP LANGUAGE

HyperText Markup Language is a collection of platform-independent styles (indicated by markup tags) that are used to define the various components of a World Wide Web document.

HTML

Refer to HyperText Markup Language

HTTP

Refer to HyperText Transport Protocol

IMAGE

Generally, an image is a piece of data produced outside of Commence. It can be an image produced by a scanner, video camera, illustration or presentation software, or any other software capable of copying images to and from the Windows Clipboard.

IMAGE FIELD

Image fields hold Windows device-independent bit maps that are produced by a scanner, camera, graphics software, and most software that is capable of copying images to and from the Windows Clipboard. To put a bitmap into an image field, it first must be placed onto the Clipboard, then you can use [Edit-Paste](#) to put it into the field. Alternatively, you can select the field and then choose [Edit-Paste From](#). This will allow you to copy an image directly from a file.

If you are using Microsoft's Windows for Pen Computing®, you can also draw into an image field. You can display an image field only in an item detail. It can be printed along with the rest of the item data.

IMPORT

To bring data from other applications into items in your open Commence database. Select the [Import](#) command to import a file.

INACTIVE

An agent is inactive when the Active checkbox is unchecked for that agent. An inactive agent cannot be triggered.

ITEM

An item is a record in the database. Each item can store values for one or more of the fields defined for the category. For example, a Person category would contain items that each describe individual contacts, and might have the following fields defined: address, phone number, comments, company employed by, etc.

There is an upper limit to the number of items that can be saved in a category. Refer to the [Database Capacities](#) topic for more information.

ITEM DETAIL

An item detail is a formatted display of a single category item; a category item is displayed in an item detail whenever you add items to or display items from a category.

The item detail's format is determined by the detail form chosen; the detail form specifies the arrangement, sizes, fonts, and colors of all fields included in the layout. Not all fields need be included in a particular detail form.

You can create multiple detail forms for each category. Default forms can be chosen for item detail display and for the item detail displayed when adding an item to a category.

LAN

Local Area Network.

LAYOUT

A pre-defined or custom template that defines the field arrangement in a view or an item detail. (See also: [Paper Layout](#))

LEGEND

A small window that explains the color-coding scheme in a calendar or Gantt chart view. To display a legend, select [Customize-Design View-Color Code](#), then check the **Show Legend** check box.

LETTER TEMPLATE

A form letter that tells Commence what literal text to display and where to insert data field values from the selected item(s).

It is stored as an external file in the **tplts** subdirectory of your active database directory. Letter templates can use fields from a category and automatically fill in values when you write a letter. Commence supports two types of letter templates, a [Text Template](#) and [Formatted Template](#). Both types can be used with an external word processor.

LIST BOX

A list box shows a column of available choices, with scroll bars provided if there are more than can fit in the box displayed. Usually, you highlight one of the entries in the list, but some list boxes allow you to highlight multiple entries.

MAPPING

The process of determining what fields and what order they should be in when doing an import or export of ASCII, dBASE, or DIF files. Select the **Map** button of the [Template Definition](#) dialog box to define your field mapping.

MULTI-SELECT LIST BOX

A multiple selection list box is a special [list box](#) where you can select more than one item in the list.

An item in the list box is selected (highlighted) by clicking the left mouse button on the item. Clicking on another item selects that item without removing the highlight from the already selected item. To deselect a highlighted item, click the left mouse button on it. If the list has more items in it than can fit in the list box, you can scroll through the list by clicking the mouse on the scroll bar on the right side of the box, or by clicking and dragging the box within the scroll bar.

SEE ALSO:

[Keyboard](#) How to use a multiple selection list box with a keyboard.

NAME FIELD

Exactly one item name field is required for every category item; it is used to store the item's name, which can be up to 50 characters. The name field is labeled "Name" by default, but you can change the label by editing the category's name field definition. This field type cannot be removed from the category.

NUMBER FIELD

A number field can hold whole numbers (123), floating-point numbers (123.45) or currency numbers (\$123.45). You can also use the [Tools-Field Summary](#) command to display the sum or average of the number fields in a report view.

PAPER LAYOUT

A pre-defined or custom template that defines how you want a view or item detail printed. You can define paper layouts for printing to a day planner, or printing envelopes and labels. to define a paper layout, select [Home-Page Setup](#). You can also define a default paper layout to be used when printing each view.

PASSWORD

You can set a password for your Commence database by selecting [Edit-Preferences-Database](#).

PREFIX STRING

Prefix string characters help you search for one item in a long list of items in a report view, Gantt chart view, grid view, Book view, or connection definition. Begin typing the name of the item you are searching for and the highlight in the view moves to the first item in the list whose name contains the prefix string you've entered.

PROPERTY

A property is a characteristic of a view or category that you can change. Properties include: data definition; size; layout; fonts; sorting order; filters; preferences; and other attributes.

All properties of the active view are accessible through Customize on the menu bar.

RADIO BUTTON

A radio button allows you to choose an option to a command by selecting the button. When selected, the center of the button goes dark, indicating that the option is currently selected. If the center of the button is not darkened, the option is not selected.

RECURRING ITEM

An item is recurring if the category is defined with a **Recurring Date Field** and the recurring button is selected.

If you add an item and select the **Recurring Item** button or enter an asterisk (*) in the recurring date field, and then select the **Save** button, the **Specify Date Range** dialog box is displayed. You can specify a frequency and date range for Commence to create multiple items (such as every Monday in June). These items are associated by a **Related Date** connection which allow these items to be changed or deleted as a group.

Note: The date range specified for **Recurring Items** are referred to as **Recurring Dates**. All recurring items are connected through the **Related Date** connection.

RELATED DATE

A category is that defined with a **Recurring Date Field** will include a **Related Date** connection. This connection is used to associate items which are added as **Recurring Items** and allows these items to be changed or deleted as a group.

REMOTE DATABASE

The databases in a Sync Link [sync link group](#) that are kept synchronized via the [base database](#).

Changes made on the remote database are re-synchronized to the base database.

To define one or more remote databases for the sync link group; open the base database and select the [Sync Link Out](#) command.

RESTORE

To select a compressed back up file and restore it to a usable Commence database. Click the Commence Application Button in the upper left corner, choose the [Open/Manage Database](#) command, then highlight the database to overwrite and select the **Restore** button. You can not restore into the active database.

RIBBON

An application Ribbon shows the available commands and is located at the top of the window, just below the title bar. Similar commands are grouped onto Tab pages. The available Tabs on the Commence Ribbon are: Home; Edit; View; Customize; Tools; and Help.

SAVED VIEW

A saved view is a view that has been stored on disk using the [View-Save View](#) or [View-Save View As](#) commands from the menu bar. When you create a new category, a default report view is automatically saved. When you alter the properties of an existing saved view, the resulting new view is not automatically saved; you must use either View-Save View or View-Save View As to retain the new view.

SCROLL BARS

A window's scroll bars allow you to view information that is longer or wider than the current window size. If present, they are located at the right side and bottom of the window.

SEARCH TEXT

The text for which you want to search all name, text, date, time, data file, check box, and radio group type fields in one or multiple categories. Specify the search text with the [Global Search](#) command.

SELECTION FIELD

A selection field can have one of two attributes:

radio group: presents two to eight mutually exclusive values for a field, depending on how many radio button fields you name when you add or edit the field. You select one of the radio buttons in the group as the default value.

combo box presents up to 4,000 mutually exclusive values for a field, depending on how many selections you define when you add/edit the field.

SEQUENCE NUMBER FIELD

A sequence number field is used to automatically assign a unique number to every item added to a category. You can assign your own starting value to this field type, which must be in the range +/-2,000,000,000.

SNOOZE

A feature of agent-generated message boxes that allows you to put a message box to sleep for a set period of time. When the time elapses, the message box reappears.

STATIC AREA

This is a part of the screen that cannot be changed by the user. The area can be changed by the program. The area is used to display information to the user.

STATUS BAR

The status bar is located at the very bottom of the Commence main window. It displays: a brief description of the currently highlighted menu command (if any); a description of the view icon at which the mouse is currently pointing (if any); operational messages; today's date; the current time; and, a count of the number of items from the active category displayed by the active view.

SYNC LINK

A feature that lets you maintain identical databases on PCs that are not connected via a LAN. See [Sync Link Concepts](#) for more information.

SYNCHRONIZE

The process of communicating changes from one database to another. Changes to definitions as well as to items are communicated.

TELEPHONE FIELD

A telephone field lets you store telephone numbers in any format you wish. If you have a modem connected to your computer and Telephony installed, you can dial a telephone field displayed in a view or a detail form.

Note: To dial international numbers, you must enter your telephone numbers using the canonical format, +cc (ac) number, where cc is the country code and ac is the area code.

TAB

When you select many commands in Commence a dialog box will appear with many choices. Each of these choices will appear on a **Tab** towards the top of the dialog box. Selecting a tab will bring all of the options available for that tab to the front of the screen.

TEXT BOX

A text box is a rectangle into which you type information. An insertion point (a vertical bar) indicates the editing point when you move to the box. If there is already text in the box, all the text is selected and anything you type replaces the entire selection. You can also edit any text in the box using the delete, backspace, arrow, and keyboard keys.

TEXT FIELD

A text field holds unstructured ASCII data. Text fields can be specified in three sizes: up to 80 characters; up to 30,000 characters; or a user-specified number of characters up to 30,000 characters. Blank spaces, blank lines, and new line control characters contribute to the character count.

TEXT TEMPLATES

A template for writing letters using data stored in Commence. A text template does not supply sophisticated formatting capabilities (i.e., no fonts, bold or italics, indents, etc.).

In the [Send Letter](#) dialog box, the type of a text template is **TXT**, the standard Windows file extension for text only files. Virtually all word processors can import, edit, and create text files. When you highlight a text template in the list box and select **View** or **Print**, Commence creates a text only letter by substituting the [Field Codes](#) it finds in the template with values from the highlighted item in the active view or from the active item detail. Field Codes are special text strings that are used to represent data values from Commence items. The use of Field Codes is described under [Customize-Database-Letter Templates](#).

TIME FIELD

A time field lets you enter a time using the format you selected from the Window control panel (such as 4pm or 18:00). A single time field can indicate a specific time, while two fields (e.g., **Start Time** and **End Time** fields) can be used to specify a range.

A default value of **Start** in a time field definition in a category tells Commence to start a timer when an Add item is opened. A default value of **Stop** or **Now** in a time field definition of the same category tells Commence to stop the timer when the item is first saved.

Any category that has at least one time field and one date field in it can use the calendar view type for displaying items graphically by time slot. A category that has a date field, time field and an alarm checkbox can also be alarmed using the **Item Alarm** trigger type.

TITLE BAR

A window's title bar shows the title or name of the window. The window title reflects the object(s) displayed in the window. The title bar is located at the top of the window, between the control menu box and the maximize and minimize icons. The title bar of the active window is a different color or shade than the rest of the windows on the desktop.

TOGGLE

A toggle is an option that can be either on or off. The toggle may be a check-mark toggle on a menu (which is turned on if a check mark appears next to the entry), a check box (which is turned on if the box has an 'X' in it), or a radio button (which is turned on if the button is darkened).

TOOL BAR

A toolbar is the area at the top of a view or form that displays icons for commands that affect the active view or form. Toolbars provide the ability to quickly execute these commands by selecting an icon with the mouse. In many cases, keyboard shortcuts are also available for toolbar commands.

The [Agent Toolbar](#) is an area reserved on the Ribbon to display user-defined buttons. The Agent toolbar is not displayed when there are no Agents defined with a Tool Bar Pick trigger.

The [Calendar Toolbar](#) appears at the top of calendar views.

TOOL BAR AGENT

A type of agent that appears as a button on the Home page of the Ribbon, in the Agents group of buttons. Selecting the button causes the agent to execute. Select the [Customize-Database-Agent](#) command to create or modify an agent.

TRANSFER

To copy a definition (such as a custom category, its views, and the data in that category) to another dissimilar Commence database. Optionally, you can transfer items and referenced data files along with their definitions.

TRANSFER FILE

An external file created by the [Transfer Out](#) command.

SYNC LINK GROUP

A group of Standalone PC's that are kept synchronized using [Sync Link](#).

TRIGGER

A trigger is an event or time that causes an activated agent to evaluate the other agent conditions (if any) and, pending the successful evaluation of the conditions, execute the action(s) specified for the agent. A trigger (and an action) must be specified in order to define an agent.

Triggers can be based on: the occurrence of a particular time; a menu bar or command bar selection; adding, editing, or deleting an item; the occurrence of date or time conflicts when adding an item; the occurrence of an item alarm; the receipt of a specified DDE (Dynamic Data Exchange) message from another Windows application.

UNIFORM RESOURCE LOCATOR (URL)

A standardized format providing a pointer to information available on the World Wide Web (WWW).

UPDATE FILE

The DOS file created by the [Sync Link Out](#) command.

URL

Refer to Uniform Resource Locator

URL ADDRESS FIELD

This field is used specifically for Uniform Resource Locator (URL) addresses. Double clicking on a URL address will launch the Web Browser (if not already open) and go directly to the indicated web site. Commence allows up to 1024 characters for each URL address.

VIEW

A view is a formatted display of category data. You create a view by combining a category and a view type. The format of the view is determined by the view layout.

VIEW BAR

The Commence view bar is a column of view icons on the left of the main Commence window. By clicking the mouse on an icon, you open the view associated with the icon.

Select the [View-Save View As](#) command from the menu bar to add or remove a view's icon on the view bar.

The view bar holds a maximum of 40 icons. You can display or hide the view bar, choose whether or not to display icon labels and/or the plus buttons for easy adds, by selecting the [Edit-Preferences-Tool Bars](#) command from the menu bar, and checking the appropriate check boxes.

VIEW TYPE

A view type is the basic display style for a view. The following view types are supported: Book, Calendar, Gantt chart, Grid, Document, Multi-View, Report (the default view type), and Report Viewer. When speaking of views, a shorthand phrase like "a book view" means "a view that uses the Book view type".

WILDCARD PATTERN

A wildcard pattern is used in commands which search for text or filenames. Search text may contain wildcard characters, the asterisk (*) and the question mark(?). A question mark means that any character can occupy that position. An asterisk means that any character can occupy that position or any of the remaining positions.

The combination of normal text and wildcard characters is called a wildcard pattern.

WORK AREA

Synonym for [desktop](#).

Menu Command Keys

These key sequences allow you to choose menu commands without a mouse. Mouse users may also find it easier to input some commands from the keyboard rather than using the mouse.

ALT+[Key Tip Letter]

Select one of the tabs from the Ribbon.

Once you select a tab, the Key Tips will appear for each command that is available. Press the letter shown in the Key Tip for the command you want to use.

CTRL+P [Print](#)

SHIFT+DELETE

CTRL+X [Edit-Cut](#)

CTRL+INSERT

CTRL+C [Edit-Copy](#)

SHIFT+INSERT

CTRL+V [Edit-Paste](#)

DELETE [Edit-Clear](#) (if the cursor is in a field on a detail form and some text is highlighted)

Deletes character to right of cursor if the cursor is in a field on a detail form and no text is highlighted.

[Edit-Delete Item](#) (if an item in a view is highlighted)

CTRL+A [Edit-Add Item](#)

ENTER [Edit-Edit Item](#) (i.e., highlight an item in a view using the arrow keys and press ENTER to edit the item. If you highlight an empty time slot in a calendar view and press ENTER, you execute the [Edit-Add Item](#) command)

CTRL+D [Edit-Delete Item](#)

F1 [Help-Index](#) or dialog and message box help

SHIFT-F1 [Help-Context-Sensitive](#)

CTRL-F4 Close the active view.

ALT-F4 [Exit](#) (close Commence)

Dialog Box and Detail Form Keys

Use the following keys to fill out dialog boxes and detail forms without the aid of a mouse:

TAB Select the next field in a [dialog box](#) or [item detail](#).

SHIFT+TAB Select the previous field in a dialog box or item detail.

CTRL+TAB Move to the next tab in an [item detail](#).

CTRL+ALT+TAB Insert a TAB character into a text field.

SPACEBAR Activate the currently selected [radio button](#) or [check box](#) field; place or remove a check mark next to an item name in a [connection field](#) list box.

ARROW KEYS Move the insertion point in any field containing text; scroll through connected item names in a connection field (this is the equivalent of selecting the harris_shg.gif buttons with the mouse); highlight items in a list box; select entries in a [selection field](#).

RIGHT ARROW For connection fields, opens a list box showing the names of connected items (this is equivalent to selecting the rdiag_shg.gif button with the mouse); once you do so, SPACEBAR connects and disconnects the highlighted item in the list box; ENTER closes the list box.

LEFT ARROW For connection fields, open the item detail of the connected item whose name currently appears in the connection field (this is equivalent to selecting the item name with the mouse).

PLUS SIGN on numeric keypad For connection fields, open an add item detail form for the connected category (this is equivalent to selecting the radd_shg.gif button with the mouse).

ENTER or CTRL + S Save the form or dialog box; close a connection field's list box.

SHIFT+ARROW KEYS Select text in a field.

DELETE Delete the selected field text.

ENTER Insert a carriage return into a text field.

INSERT Change the insertion mode in a field containing text.

ALT+BACKSPACE Undo an edit in a field containing text.
(Effective only before save item.)

ESC Cancels changes for item or connection pop-up.

CTRL+F For connection pop-up, toggles the filter

CTRL+1 For connection pop-up, displays pop-up in one list.

CTRL+2 For connection pop-up, displays pop-up in two lists.

CTRL+A For connection pop-up, saves changes and adds item to connecting category.

CTRL+E For connection pop-up, saves changes and edits highlighted item in connecting category.

CTRL+B Move to the previous item shown by the detail form.

CTRL+N Move to the next item shown by the detail form.

CTRL+K Move to the first item shown by the detail form,

CTRL+L Move to the last item shown by the detail form.

Multiple Selection List Box Keys

Use the following keyboard keys to select from and scroll through a multiple selection list box:

SPACEBAR For the list box item with the list box cursor (a dotted outline) on it, selects (or deselects) the item without affecting already selected items in the list.

RIGHT or DOWN ARROW Moves the list box cursor to the next item in the list.

LEFT or UP ARROW Moves the list box cursor to the preceding item in the list.

PAGE UP Scrolls the currently highlighted item to the bottom of the list box and moves the cursor to the first visible item in the list.

PAGE DOWN Scrolls the currently highlighted item to the top of the list box and moves the cursor to the last visible item in the list.

HOME Scrolls the first item in the list to the top of the list box and moves the cursor to it.

END Scrolls the last item in the list to the bottom of the list box and moves the cursor to it.

Keys for Arranging Detail Forms

The following keys allow you to arrange fields on the [Design Detail Form](#) dialog box without the aid of a mouse.

TAB select the field you want to move

SPACEBAR "grab" the highlighted field -- alignment guides appear when the field is "grabbed"; press SPACEBAR again to release the field

ARROW KEYS move a "grabbed" field in small increments

CTRL+ARROW KEYS move a "grabbed" field in large increments

View Control Keys

You can use the keys in the table below to navigate around any book, calendar, Gantt chart, grid, or report view).

UP ARROW highlight the item above the currently highlighted item

DOWN ARROW highlight the item directly below the currently highlighted item

HOME highlight the first item in the view

END highlight the last item in the view

PAGEUP scroll up

PAGEDOWN scroll down

CTRL+PAGEUP scroll left

CTRL+PAGEDOWN scroll right

LEFT ARROW (book view only) go backward one page

RIGHT ARROW (book view only) go forward one page

Calendar views provide additional mouse controls on the control panel located under the monthly calendar. Keyboard equivalents to using these controls are listed in the following table. These keys change the active date and may change the information displayed in daily, weekly, and monthly display modes (see [Customize-Design View](#)).

CTRL+T Return to daily display mode for today.

LEFT ARROW move the outline box in the monthly calendar to the previous day; change the active date to that day's date

RIGHT ARROW move the outline box in the monthly calendar to the next day; change the active date to that day's

date

CTRL+LEFT ARROW change the monthly calendar to display the previous month; change the active date to one month previous to the current active date

CTRL+RIGHT ARROW change the monthly calendar to display the next month; change the active date to one month after the current active date

CTRL+PAGEDOWN change the monthly calendar to display the current month for the following year; change the active date to one year after the current active date

CTRL+PAGEUP change the monthly calendar to display the current month for the previous year; change the active date to one year before the current active date

CTRL + 1 display in Day mode

CTRL + 2 display in Two Day mode

CTRL + 3 display in Two Week mode

CTRL + 4 display in Month mode

CTRL + 6 display in Six Week mode

CTRL + 7 display in Week mode

CTRL + 9 display in Grid mode

CTRL + Y display in Year mode

Window Control Keys

The following keys allow you to control the windows displayed by Commence. Most of them apply to all windows in the Windows environment.

Note that *document windows* are identified by the short dash displayed in a box in the upper left hand corner of the window. *Application windows* are identified by the long dash displayed in a box in the upper left hand corner of the window.

ALT+- Select the control menu box for a document window.

ALT+SPACEBAR Select the control menu box for an application window.

<underlined letter>

ARROW KEYS+ENTER Once you select a control menu, press the underlined letter of a command to execute that command, or use the arrow keys and ENTER to select a command.

CTRL+F4 Close a document window.

CTRL+F5 Restore a maximized document window to its previous smaller size.

CTRL+F6 Switch to the next document window.

SHIFT+CTRL+F6 Switch to previous document window.

CTRL+F7 Move a document window.

CTRL+F8 Size a document window.

CTRL+F9 Minimize a document window.

CTRL+F10 Maximize a document window

Mouse Shortcuts

For mouse users, *selecting* means pointing at something on the screen (like a time slot in a calendar view, a button in a dialog box, a name or label in a [list box](#), etc.) and *double-clicking* the left mouse button.

In [dialog boxes](#) where there are several command buttons, pointing and double-clicking on a list box entry with the mouse defaults to an *edit* operation, though not all dialog boxes have an edit operation (in this case, there usually is no default command). Pointing and double-clicking the left mouse button on an [item](#) in a [view](#) invokes the [Edit-Edit Item](#) command and displays the [item detail](#) of the item.

Pointing and clicking the left mouse button on a view icon on the [view bar](#) or on a command button on the [tool bar](#) opens the view or invokes the command.

As you pass the mouse pointer over a button on the view bar, tool bar, or the control panel of a calendar view, the message box on the [status bar](#) displays a short description of the button's purpose. A short command description is displayed in the status bar's message box when you point at a menu name on the [menu bar](#) with the mouse, hold down the left mouse button, and move the mouse pointer over the command names on the menu. Releasing the button while pointing at a command executes the command.

Calendar Items Dialog Box This dialog box is displayed when you double click on a [Day Title](#) arrow or on the date in a weekly, monthly, or yearly calendar [display mode](#).

This dialog box displays all of the appointments for the selected day. Highlight the name of the item from the list box and then select the **Add**, **Edit**, or **Delete** button. Selecting **Add** causes an **Add Item** screen appear. Selecting **Edit** causes an **Item Detail** screen to appear. This screen lets you view or edit the item. You can move the appointment by editing the date or time values. Selecting **Delete** deletes the highlighted item. Select **OK** to exit the dialog box without choosing an item.

Alternatively, you can double-click the left mouse button while pointing at the name of the item you want to select. This causes an **Item Detail** screen to appear (as does the **Edit** button).

Active Date

The calendar [view](#) initially displays today's date in the center of the Calendar Tool Bar at the top of the calendar window; this is called the *active date*. As you select different dates and calendar [Display Modes](#) using the [Calendar Tool Bar](#), the active date displayed changes to match the dates you select. The date is displayed in the format you set through the Windows Control Panel.

Display Modes

There are a variety of display modes for the calendar view. They are Day, Two Days, Week, Two Weeks, Month, Six Weeks, Grid and Year modes.

Item names associated with the [active date](#) are displayed in the calendar view window in a Day, Two Days, Week, Two Weeks, Month, and Six Weeks display mode. The Year display mode shows all the dates for the active year by displaying twelve monthly calendars.

The default display mode is the Day mode. To change the display mode, select a display mode from the drop down list on the left of the [Calendar Tool Bar](#).

Select one the buttons below to see a description of the features and controls in each display mode:

[Day](#) **Day Display Mode**

[Two Days](#) **Two Days Display Mode**

[Week](#) **Week Display Mode**

[Two Weeks](#) **Two Weeks Display Mode**

[Month](#) **Month Display Mode**

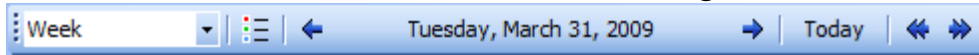
[Six Weeks](#) **Six Weeks Display Mode**

[Grid](#) **Grid Display Mode**

[Year](#) **Year Display Mode**

Calendar Tool Bar

At the top of every Calendar view there is a tool bar that lets you change certain aspects of the calendar display. Use the control buttons to change the display mode, move to a different active date or to show/hide the color code legend.



DISPLAY MODE

Select the calendar format you wish to display. Choose from day, 2 days, week, 2 weeks, month, 6 weeks, or year.

LEGEND

Selecting this button or selecting the **Customize-Design View** command ,click on the **Display** tab and mark the **Show Legend** checkbox, toggles the display of the legend. When the legend is displayed, a small window appears that explains the color coding used in the busy bars. You can change the color coding used in a Calendar view by selecting a color coding template with the **Customize-Design View** command and clicking on the **Colors** tab. You can create new color coding templates using the Customize-Database command and selecting the **Color Code** tab.

PREVIOUS DAY OR INTERVAL

Selecting this button displays the previous day, 2 days, week, 2 weeks, month, 6 weeks, or year, depending on the current display mode.

CURRENT DAY OR INTERVAL

Selecting this button lets you change the date, week, month or year that is displayed. This displays the Select Date dialog box where you can display monthly calendars to select a date and then select the **OK** button to return to the calendar view.

NEXT DAY OR INTERVAL

Selecting this button displays the next day, 2 days, week, 2 weeks, month, 6 weeks, or year, depending on the current display mode.

RETURN TO TODAY

Selecting this button displays today's appointments. This is a quick way to return to today's appointments after examining past or future appointments.

PREVIOUS DAY WITH ITEMS

Selecting this button displays the first day (before the currently displayed day or interval) for which items are scheduled.

NEXT DAY WITH ITEMS

Selecting this button displays the next day (after the currently displayed day or interval) for which items are scheduled.

Select Date Dialog Box

The **Select Date** [dialog box](#) is displayed when you click on the **CURRENT DAY OR INTERVAL** button on the [Calendar Tool Bar](#) or when you double-click on any date field in an item detail or dialog box. In this dialog box you can display monthly calendars to select a date and then select the **OK** button to return to the to the previous screen with the selected date.

The elements of this dialog box are:

YEAR BUTTONS

Select a button for the year you want to see in the **Monthly Calendar**. If the year you wish to select is not displayed, press the Left Arrow button to scroll to previous years or select the Right Arrow button to scroll the years ahead and then select a year button.

MONTH BUTTONS

Select a button for the month you want to see in the **Monthly Calendar**.

MONTH CALENDAR

This displays the month selected by the **Year** and **Month** buttons. The initial month displayed is the month of the date field from where you started this dialog box. Click on a day in the **Month Calendar** to change the selected date.

OK

Select the **OK** button to return to the previous screen and have the selected date replace the date field from that screen.

CANCEL

Select the **Cancel** button to return to the previous screen without changing the date.

Working with Detail Form Tabs

A detail form is organized into a series of “pages,” with each page displayed as a separate folder tab across the top of the opened detail window. Not all detail forms require multiple pages in order to display all pertinent information. In those situations, a single folder tab will appear rather than the multiple tabs shown above. By grouping related areas of a detail form, and including them on their own, dedicated page, completing a complex form can be done easily by switching between pages, which is as easy as clicking the left mouse button on the desired folder tab. Up to 25 individual tabs may be defined per Detail Form.

TAB NAME

The **Tab Name** identifies the tabbed window that will appear across the opened Detail Form and must be unique within a [detail form](#). It can be up to 16 characters.

CUT

Select an area of the detail form or a group of fields, then use **Edit-Cut** or Right click-Cut. This copies the selected objects into the buffer and deletes them from the visible tab. .

COPY

Select an area of the detail form or a group of fields, then use **Edit-Copy** or Right click-Copy. This copies the selected objects into the buffer.

PASTE

Pastes the buffer contents into the active tab.

DELETE

Deletes the selected objects. CAUTION: if nothing is selected then all objects on the form including all tabs are deleted. If you wish to cancel this command, select **File-Exit** from the menu without saving your changes.

ADD TAB PAGE

Adds a new page to the detail form. Fields can be displayed on the page using drag & drop, or using the copy/paste commands from another tab page.

DELETE TAB PAGE

This will delete the active tab. Be sure to click the tab you wish to delete so that the fields on that tab are visible before using this command. Commence asks for confirmation before deleting the tab and will not let you delete the only tab for a [detail form](#).

SWAP TABS

This allows you to rearrange the order in which the tabs will appear across the opened Detail Window. The active tab is replaced with the tab you choose from the list, and the active tab moves to the other tabs position. The tabs (and ultimately the corresponding pages of the Detail Form) should be arranged in the order in which the pages will be completed when entering data.

PROPERTIES

Lets you control the appearance of the form. Refer to [Form Properties](#) or Chapter 5 of the *Commence User's Guide* for more details.

Tab Order Dialog Box

Commence automatically sets the tab order based on each field's position on the detail form. The tab order starts with the field in the upper left corner, then tabs to the next field(s) in that row (if any). Then Commence tabs to the beginning of the next row, similar to hitting the carriage return key on a typewriter. You can determine which fields are in the same row by aligning the tops of the boxes.

Select **Format-Tab Order** the [Detail Form Design](#) dialog box to change the tab order for data entry, use the **Up** and **Down** buttons to reorder the fields.

UP OR DOWN BUTTONS

Highlight a field, then repeatedly click on the Up or Down buttons until the field is in the position you want. Repeat this step for the associated field label to keep the field and its label together for design purposes. Note the label will not be included in the tab order for the finished form. This will be used to determine the tab order of fields when entering data.

OK

Select the **OK** button to save the tabbing order for the fields on the detail form tab.

CANCEL

Select **Cancel** to cancel your changes.

AUTO TAB ORDER

Select this button to base the tabbing on the arrangement of the fields on the detail form tab.

View Types

[See Also](#)

When creating a new `viewterms_view`, you select a view `typeterms_view_type` to tell Commence how to structure the window used to display view data.

There are several view types delivered with Commence. Each provides a distinct display format. They are briefly described below; select the name of the view type below to see a detailed description of its capabilities:

[Book](#) displays [items](#) alphabetically by the item name [field](#) of each item (up to 20 fields can be included); each page of the book displays items whose item name fields begin with the letter appearing at the top of the page

[Calendar](#) displays items on a daily, weekly, or monthly basis in an appointment calendar format; each item must have start time, end time, and date values

[Gantt Chart](#) displays items in a traditional Gantt Chart format; each item must have start date and end date values

[Grid](#) displays fields from one or more categories in a row/column format. It can be used in two modes: read-only and update mode.

[Document](#) displays a Web page as a view window on the Commence desktop.

[Multi-View](#) Displays a set of related views in one window frame. The view is split to show the primary and secondary views.

[Report](#) displays user-selected fields of an item in a multi-row, multi-column format; the graphic format of the display (fonts, labels, etc.) is also user-selectable

[Report Viewer](#) displays data from your Commence database in WYSIWYG format as a print preview. Data can be viewed, printed, and exported to various file formats.

You can use [prefix matching](#) to find a particular item in a long list of items in a report view, Gantt chart view, Book view, or Grid View.

Once you choose an appropriate view type and display a view, you can refine how the view displays data items by selecting a command from the [Customize-Design View](#) menu.

Choosing a View Type and View Layout

A [view layout](#) specifies required information for the [view type](#) used in a [view](#). This information may be required [field](#) mappings (for a calendar or Gantt chart), the list of fields to display (for a book or report), or various display aspect of the view type such as fonts (for a report).

Calendar and Gantt chart views require specific field types in the [category](#) used by the view. A calendar one time fields (one for start time) and one date field (the due date field; i.e., the date the item takes place). A Gantt chart view requires two date fields (one for start date and one for end date of each item). Commence needs to know the names of the fields from the active category to use for these required pieces of information.

When you create a view, Commence picks appropriate defaults for the view layout, and displays the resultant view. Commence always successfully picks defaults for book and report views.

It is possible that Commence may not be able to pick appropriate defaults for a calendar or Gantt chart view, either because the view does not have required field types or has more than one field of the required type(s). If Commence cannot pick reasonable defaults, a dialog is displayed that informs you of this fact.

If the view does not have fields of the required type(s), the view cannot be displayed using the view type you selected. You must **Cancel** and try to create the view again using a different view type.

You can display and change the view layout for a view using the [Customize-Design View](#) command and clicking on the **Fields** [tab](#).

Multi-View Properties Wizard

[See Also](#)

When you create a new multi-view or edit an existing one, you are prompted for the various properties of the view. Select the appropriate values and then press the Next button until all options are selected.

PAGE 1: Setting the view properties

A multi-view window can be split into two panes, either horizontally or vertically. You can choose your preference based on what works best with the data you are displaying or how you like to arrange views on your desktop.

Enter a new view name to describe the multi-view as a whole. This unique “View Name” is used to identify the view and cannot be a duplicate of an existing view name in the Open/Manage Views list. All the required properties have now been set. You may click **Next>** to continue setting up the multi-view or configure the optional settings below.

To add a shortcut on the View Bar for the multi-view, set the following properties:

- 1** Type a brief View Icon Label.
- 2** Choose an appropriate icon to represent the multi-view in general.
- 3** Choose whether you wish to display the multi-view shortcut on the View Bar and/or Views Menu, and for which desktops.

PAGE 2: Setting the view pane size/position

The option to **Save Position, Size, and Panes on Exit** is turned on by default. This allows you to resize the multi-view window as a whole and retain that size and position on the desktop.

The splitter bar separates the primary window from the secondary window in a multi-view. The window panes are initially split with a default value, however the splitter can be reset to any proportion totaling 100%. If the option to **Save Position, Size, and Panes on Exit** is also enabled, then you can adjust the proportions any time after the multi-view has been created by simply dragging the splitter bar on screen.

Enabling the option to **Save Position, Size, and Panes on Exit** is the only way to save changes to the multi-view window; the View-Save View commands will continue to work on the active view within the multi-view. However the multi-view window as a whole will not be affected by the standard view commands.

PAGE 3: Setting the Primary View(s)

The primary view for a multi-view window can be any of the following view types:

- . Book View
- . Calendar View
- . Gantt View
- . Report View
- . Grid View

When selecting the primary views, you may choose a view-linked view. Linked views in the primary pane are able to interact with views outside the multi-view window or with the filtering toolbar in the primary pane of the multi-view. However, linked views in the secondary pane of a multi-view window will only respond to the primary view within the same multi-view window.

The list of views can be sorted by View Name, Type, or by Category. Double-click on the column heading to resort the list. Once you have found the view of your choice, click the **Select View** button or click on the handle to the right of the View Name. Confirm that the view you chose is shown in the “Selected

Primary Views” box below. You may click **Next>** to continue setting up the multi-view.

PAGE 4: Form Option

If the detail form option is left unchecked, double-clicking an item in the primary window of a multi-view opens the form in a new window. Because the new window is outside the multi-view frame it is not linked to the secondary views in the multi-view window. For example, browsing to the next item in a new form window will not update the secondary views in the multi-view window.

When the form option is turned on, double-clicking an item in the primary window opens the form within the primary window of the multi-view frame. The primary view will use the filters and sorts defined for the view you selected to determine which items to display.

When you select the form option, you must also choose a default detail form layout from the list of forms in the category. The form layout you select will be used to display all items as you traverse through the items in the view using the browse buttons on the Detail Form toolbar. For this reason, it is recommended that you select a general form displaying all the necessary fields, regardless of the item data. Filtered detail forms would typically not be appropriate.

To save your choice, click the **Select Form** button. Confirm that the view you chose is shown in the “Selected default form view” box below. Click **Next>** to continue setting up the multi-view.

PAGE 5: Setting the Secondary Views

At least one secondary view must be defined before you can save the multi-view. Secondary views in a multi-view window can be any of the following view types:

- . Book View
- . Calendar View
- . Gantt View

- . Report View
- . Grid View

The list of views can be sorted by View Name, Type, or by Category. Double-click on the column heading to resort the list. When selecting secondary views, keep the following guide-lines in mind:

- Including a view in a multi-view window does not limit you from re-using that view elsewhere in the application. Views that are part of a multi-view window can still be opened independently outside the multi-view window.
- Multi-views can support up to 100 view tabs in the secondary window.
- Multi-views are optimized to handle numerous large views in the secondary window. Large views are those displaying hundreds of thousands of items or views approaching the maximum number of fields.
- Each view in the secondary window is not loaded until after the view tab has been opened, not when the multi-view window is opened.
- Linked views in the secondary pane of a multi-view window will only respond to the primary view within the same multi-view window.
- Unlinked views and views that are linked to different categories can also be added as view tabs in the secondary window. However, there is no dynamic relationship between the data in unlinked views and the data in the primary window of the multi-view.

Once you have chosen a view, click the **Select View** button or click on the handle to the right of the View Name. Confirm that the view you chose is shown in the “Selected Secondary Views” box below. Repeat this step to select as many secondary views as needed. To undo a selection, click the {X} button. This will remove

the view tab from the multi-view window. De-selecting a view in this manner will not delete the view from the database.

After you have selected the secondary views, you can customize the tab label for each view as needed. The tab label can be up to 15 characters. This label is used for display purposes only, to aid you in locating a particular view in the multi-view window. Duplicate tab labels are allowed but are not recommended to avoid confusion. The tab labels are not used to determine the order of the tabbed windows.

The tabbed windows will be arranged in the secondary window from left to right in the order shown here, not alphabetically. If you would like to rearrange this order, use the [up arrow] and [down arrow] buttons to move the tabs up or down in the list. Views accessed most often should be moved to the top of the list.

Click **Finish** to save the multi-view configuration. The completed multi-view can now be accessed from the list of views defined under the **View - Open/Manage Views** dialog. The multi-view is now ready to use.

Document View Options

The Document view provides a way to integrate Internet and intranet based applications and pages directly on your Commence desktop.

Document views are created using the same command as regular views. When in Document Options:

1 Enter the URL pointing to the HTML document you wish to display, using the following examples.

- Type the Internet address - for example, `www.commerce.com`
- Type the complete path and file name to an HTML file - for example, `c:\program files\commerce workgroup\Web Companion.htm`
- Type the complete path and file name to a Microsoft Office document - for example, `c:\my documents\test.doc` (assumes test.doc is an existing file in this directory)

2 Click **OK** to open the view.

Tip [Keywords](#) can be used when specifying the URL - for example, `(-ProgramDir-)\Web Companion.htm`

For more information on the Document View, see [Document View Type](#).

Customize-Design View-Fields Tab (Book Views)

[See Also](#)

Selecting the [Customize-Design View](#) command while a report [view](#) is the [active view](#) displays the Design View tab.

This tab allows you to choose the [fields](#) to appear in the book and set field options as explained below. You can also select the [name type field](#) of items from connected categories to display in the book. A book view can display up to 20 fields per item.

Any changes you make to the design are temporary unless you use [Views-Save View](#) or [Views-Save View As](#) to save the changed view.

The **Fields in Book** and **Fields Not In Book** [list boxes](#) show the list of fields that appear in the book and those that don't appear in the book, respectively.

To append a field to the list of fields in the book (making the new field appear last in the book), highlight the field name in the **Fields Not In Book** list box and select the **Append Field** button.

Shortcut: Double-click the mouse on a field in the **Fields Not In Book** list box to append it to the **Fields In Book** list without selecting the **Append Field** button.

To insert a field into the list of fields in the book, highlight a field name in the **Fields Not In Book** list box and highlight the position where you want the field inserted in the **Fields In Book** list box. Then, select the **Insert Field** button.

To remove a field from the book, highlight the field name in the **Fields In Book** list box and select the **Remove Field** button.

Shortcut: Double-click the mouse on a field in the **Fields In Book** list box to remove it without selecting the **Remove Field** button.

The **Fields in Book** list box displays field names in the order in which the fields appear in the book. If a field is in the the incorrect position, you must remove the field from the report, then place the field in the correct position by using either the **Insert Field** or **Append Field** button.

You can also combine fields in the report by selecting the Combine Fields button and then selecting the desired fields.

Customize-Design View-Display Tab (Report and Grid Views)

In addition to the print title and paper layout options, Report and Grid views also allow you to set the following display options:

FORMAT

REPORT VIEW

Select the format for a report by choosing the **Horizontal** or **Vertical** [radio buttons](#) from the **Format** group box. Horizontal format prints one [item](#) per row with [fields](#) listed from left to right; field labels appear across the top of the report. Vertical format displays one item per column, with fields listed from top to bottom; field labels appear on the left side of the report. Fields are listed in the order in which they appear in the **Fields In Report** list box in the [Fields](#) tab.

GRID VIEW

Select the format for a grid view by choosing **Detailed** or **Summary** from the **Format** group box. Detailed displays the groups with the items. Summary displays just the group heading.

ALLOW UPDATE MODE (GRID VIEW ONLY)

If checked, this option allows updating of items in the view without opening a detail form.

SPACE BETWEEN FIELDS (REPORT AND GRID VIEW)

Set the space between columns and rows in either format by changing the values in the **Space Between Fields** group box. In the **Horizontal** [text box](#), type the amount of space between columns. In the **Vertical** text box, type the amount of space between rows.

NUMBER OF COLUMNS

REPORT VIEW

Specify the number of columns for a vertical format report by typing in the appropriate number in the **Number of Columns** text box. The default is 1; the maximum is 20.

GRID VIEW

This option is not customizable in a grid view.

SHOW LABELS

REPORT VIEW

Include labels for fields in a view by turning on the **Show Labels** [check box](#). Labels are included on the left side of a vertical format report and across the top of a horizontal format report.

GRID VIEW

Include labels for fields in a detailed grid view by turning on the **Show Labels** [check box](#). Turning on this option displays the view with group headings. Note, to show the groups, the sort order for the view must at least have group headers on for the primary sort field.

REMOVE BLANK LINES BETWEEN ITEMS

REPORT VIEW

By default, all items in a report are assumed to be of the same height as the largest item. For horizontal reports, this is the height of the largest field in the report; for vertical reports, this is the height of the largest item in the report. If the largest item is significantly bigger than other items in the report, this can lead to a great deal of wasted space on the report. To eliminate this space for items that are smaller than the largest item, turn on the **Remove Blank Lines Between Items** check box.

GRID VIEW

This option is not customizable in a grid view.

COMPRESS LINES BETWEEN FIELDS

REPORT VIEW

Check to remove any extra blank lines between fields. This option does not affect the blank space inside a field.

GRID VIEW

This option is not customizable in a grid view.

SHOW GRID LINES (GRID VIEW ONLY)

Displays grid lines on the view.

CONNECTION FIELDS (REPORT AND GRID VIEW)

Connection fields are fields from a connected category. When you select a connection definition name on the [Fields](#) tab, you specify the field from the connected category to be displayed on the view. Since an item in your report may be connected to more than one other item, you must specify the maximum number of connected items that can be displayed, and the number of lines needed to display each connected field. These options are global settings for the view; they apply to all the connection fields in the report.

Number of Items specifies the maximum number of connected items for which the connection field will be displayed. The default number is set to 2. You may enter any number between 1 and 750. For example, say your view is defined for the Person/Company category, and you wish to display Notes connected to each person. A person may be connected to one note or hundreds of notes. The default setting would display only the first 2 connected notes per person, even if they are connected to more notes.

Lines Per Item specifies the amount of space allocated on the view for each instance of the connection field in the view. The default is a height of 1 line per item. You may enter any number between 1 and 750. Using the example above, only the first line of each note would be displayed in the view.

If you select values that are too small to display all the connected items for a particular connection field, the word **(more)** is

displayed at the bottom of the connection field.

Finding Items with Blank Number Fields

To filter for a blank [number field](#), you need to obtain all the items with a zero value.

1. Display the view you wish to filter. For help, see [Opening a View](#).
2. Select the [Customize-Filter View](#) command from the [menu bar](#). To set the filter, select the **Filter1** tab.

If you are creating more than one filter select the **Summary** tab.

3. In the **Filter for All Items** list box, select the **number** field to filter on.
4. Select the **Equal To** comparison operator from the drop down list.
5. Enter the number **0** into the **Field Value** text box.
6. Select the **OK** button.

This returns you to the active view and the filter will be in effect.

Finding Items with Blank Connections

To filter for a blank [connection](#), you need to obtain all the items except those which have the connected Name field filled with any characters. To do this:

1. Display the view you wish to filter. For help, see [Opening a View](#).
2. Select the [Customize-Filter View](#) command from the [menu bar](#). To set the filter, select the **Filter1** tab.

If you are creating more than one filter select the **Summary** tab.

3. Next to the **Filter for All Items** list box, turn on the **except** checkbox.
4. In the **Filter for All Items** list box, select the **connection** field to filter on.
5. Highlight the [Name](#) type field for the connected item in the **Filter by** list box.
6. Select the **Contains** comparison operator from the drop down list.
7. Enter the ? [wildcard](#) character into the **Field Value** text box.
8. Select the **Save** button.

This returns you to the active view and the filter will be in effect.

Edit-Preferences

[Calendar](#) Choose calendar [view type](#) preferences.

[Database](#) Allows you to password protect your database.

[Dialer](#) Choose a [dialing device](#).

[Event Logs](#) Choose the categories to use for logging letters and phone calls.

[Letters](#) Choose preferences for writing letters, including which word processor to use for formatted letters.

[Meeting](#) Select the category, fields and connection definitions used when scheduling a meeting.

[Other](#) Choose miscellaneous preferences.

[Other Apps](#) Configure Commence to be used with other applications, such as your E-Mail application, Outlook Calendar, or handheld.

[Personal Info](#) Designate an item that contains information about yourself and select which connection definitions will default to this item.

[Tool Bars](#) Display or hide the [tool bar](#), the status bar, and the [view bar](#). Specify a directory of icon files to be used on the Tool bars.

[View](#) Choose preferences for saving views.

Change Database Password Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the **Set Password...** button on the [Database Preferences](#) dialog box. This option lets you set a password for your copy of the database, whether it be a personal, local database, or a shared client database. This password is different from the login ID and password which must also be entered when you attempt to open a shared database which has been password protected by the Commence Administrator.

To change or create a password follow these steps:

1. If this is the first time this database has been password protected, the **Old Password** field is grayed out. Otherwise, type your current password in the **Old Password** field.
2. Type the password you want into the **New Password** text box. The characters you type are echoed with asterisks in the text box.
3. Type the password again into the **Verify Password** text box.
4. If you correctly entered the **Old Password** (if any), and entered the same password into the **New** and **Verify Password** text boxes, Commence returns you to the **Other Preferences** dialog box. If you made a mistake, Commence displays a message box asking you to try again. Select **OK** and go back to Step 4.
5. Select **Save** to close the **Database Preferences** dialog box. Select the **Cancel** button to return to the **Database Preferences** dialog box without changing the database password.

Print Letter Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the **Print** button on the [Send Letter](#) dialog box with a [text template](#) highlighted.

COPIES

In the **Copies** [text box](#), enter the number of copies of the letter that you want to print.

DRAFT QUALITY

Check the **Draft Quality** [check box](#) if you want a lower resolution printout and your printer supports this print mode.

FONTS

If you want to select a different font for the letter, chose the **Fonts** button. Commence shows you the [Select Font](#) dialog box. The specific fonts available depend on the configuration of your system. Keep in mind that the font you select will be applied to *all* the characters in the letter.

OK

Select **OK** in the **Print Letter** dialog box to start printing the letter. The letter prints on the default printer selected by Commence (see [Printer Setup](#)).

CANCEL

As with other printing done by Commence you can cancel the printing operation by selecting the **Cancel** button from the dialog box displayed while printing.

Letter Template Tab

[See Also](#)

This [tab](#) is displayed when you select the [Customize-Database-Letter Template](#) command. Select one of the **Add** buttons to add a **Text** or **Formatted** template, or choose a letter template from the list and select either the **Edit** or **Delete** buttons.

The **Letter Template** tab contains these elements:

CATEGORY NAMES

Use the **Category Names** [drop-down list box](#). [category](#) to select the category containing the data for your letter.

LETTER TEMPLATES LIST BOX

This [list box](#) shows the names and types of all letter templates available for use with the category you selected.

ADD TEXT BUTTON

Select this button to add a text template for the selected category; Commence displays the [Letter Template](#) dialog box.

ADD FORMATTED BUTTON

Select this button to add a formatted template for the active category; Commence displays the [Add Formatted Template](#) dialog box.

EDIT BUTTON

Select this button to edit the template highlighted in the **Letter Templates** list box; Commence displays the [Letter Template](#) dialog box or [Edit Formatted Letter Template](#) dialog box, depending on the type of the letter template.

Shortcut: You can double-click the left mouse button while pointing at a template name to edit the template without selecting the **Edit** button.

DELETE BUTTON

Select this button to delete the template highlighted in the **Letter Templates** list box. Commence asks for confirmation before deleting the template. Select **Yes** from the confirmation message box to delete the template; **No** to cancel the deletion.

CLOSE BUTTON

Once you are done working with letter templates, select **OK** to return to the [work area](#).

Home Menu Commands

Use commands on the **Home** menu to:

[Message Log](#) View a log of error messages, agent messages, and other informational messages.

[Send Letter](#) Create a letter using fields from a highlighted item or the [active view](#). A letter template (which specifies the fields to use in the letter) must be defined for the [active category](#) in order to write a letter using fields from that category.

[Dial Phone](#) Dial the phone number of the highlighted [item](#); if there is more than one number displayed, a [dialog box](#) is displayed so that you can choose the number to dial.

[Send](#) Generate a report or calendar view in HTML format and attach to an email message.

[Print](#) Print [views](#), [item details](#), and labels.

[Printer Setup](#) Setup printers.

[Print Preview](#) Preview the printout prior to sending it to the printer.

[Page Setup](#) Define Page layouts; set printed page margins; choose whether or not to print a title and date on each printed page

[Agents Menu 1, 2, 3 ...](#) Launch user-defined agents with [menu pick triggers](#); also reviews the pre-defined menu pick and [tool bar pick](#) agents..

[Launch Views 1, 2, 3 ...](#) Open a view whose name appears at the bottom of the **Views** menu.

Commence Application button Commands

Commands to manage your database are available by clicking the Commence application button in the upper left corner.

[Open/Manage Database](#) Open a [database](#), add, edit, delete, backup, and restore databases.

[Exit](#) Exit Commence.

New/Edit Agent Dialog Box

[See Also](#)

If you select the **Add**, **Edit** or **Copy** buttons on the [Agent](#) tab, you get a dialog box that lets you setup an agent's components.

The title of the dialog box will be either **New Agent** (if you are adding or copying an agent), or **Edit Agent** (if you are editing an existing agent). The elements within the **New Agent** and **Edit Agent** boxes are identical.

If you are adding a new agent and just want to review the options for [conditions](#) and [actions](#), first press the **T** button to select any [trigger](#). Then select either **1** or **A** to view the possible conditions and actions, respectively. You can make selections for both conditions (**1** and **2**) and still go back and change the trigger. However, you should not make a final selection of the agent actions until after you have decided on the trigger and conditions for the agent since different selections can change the available options for some actions.

The elements of this dialog box are:

AGENT NAME TEXT BOX

If you are adding or copying an agent, this [text box](#) is blank; you must fill in an agent name before you can save an agent. If you are editing an agent, the **Agent Name** text box contains the name of the agent you are editing; you can change the name by typing new text into the box.

ACTIVE CHECKBOX

Turn this checkbox on to activate the agent. Uncheck the box to deactivate the agent. Another way to temporarily deactivate all agents is to use a command line option on /noagents.

Note: When you save a new agent, the status of the new agent will be set to activate so you can start using your new agent immediately.

IF THIS TRIGGER OCCURS GROUP BOX

This box shows the current trigger selection for the agent. If there is a label of **(none)** to the right of the button, then there is no trigger currently set for that agent.

If you want to view or change the trigger, select the button labeled **T** to bring up the [Add Trigger](#) dialog box; if a trigger is already defined, the **Edit Trigger** dialog box is displayed. The **Edit Trigger** dialog box is identical to the **Add Trigger** dialog box, except it is filled in with the details of the existing trigger.

AND THESE CONDITIONS ARE TRUE GROUP BOX

This box shows the current condition selections for the agent. If there is a label of **(none)** to the right of the button, then there is not a condition currently set.

To view or edit a condition, select one of the buttons labeled **1** or **2** to display the [Add Condition](#) dialog box; if a condition is already defined, the **Edit Condition** dialog box is displayed. The **Edit Condition** dialog box is identical to the **Add Condition** dialog box, except it is filled in with the details of the existing condition.

You cannot select either of the **1** or **2** buttons unless a trigger has been selected.

THEN PERFORM THESE ACTIONS GROUP BOX

This box shows the current action(s) selected for this agent. If there is a label of **(none)** to the right of a button, then there is not an action specified for that position. To view or edit one of the actions, select one of the buttons **A**, **B**, **C**, or **D** to display the [Add Action](#) dialog box; if an action is already defined, the **Edit Action** dialog box is displayed. The **Edit Action** dialog box is identical to the **Add Action** dialog box, except it is filled in with the details of the existing action.

You can look at the selection of triggers by selecting the **T** button under **If this Trigger occurs**. However, you will not be able to select a condition button (**1** or **2**) or an action button (**A** to **D**) unless a trigger has been selected.

OK AND SAVE BUTTONS

If you are editing an agent in the **Edit Agent** dialog box and have not made any changes, select **OK** to return to the **Agent** tab. If you have made any changes to the agent, the **OK** button changes to a **Save** button. If you select **Save**, Commence saves any changes that you make to the agent (its name or the specifications of its components).

CANCEL BUTTON

Select the **Cancel** button to return to the **Agent** tab without saving a new agent or to undo changes to an edited agent.

Time Conflict Layout Dialog Box

In order to enable time conflict checking for the selected category, you must specify the name of a [date field](#), and the names of two [time fields](#), and select the **Report Time Conflicts** [check box](#). Once you do so, Commence will warn you if a new [item](#) conflicts with the time and date of an existing item.

Another feature of time conflict checking is checking start time and end time fields to make sure you specify an end time that is later than the start time. To enable this checking for the active category, you need only select fields for **Date**, **Start Time**, and **End Time**, and select the **Save** button (you don't need to turn on the **Report Time Conflicts** check box).

If you cannot select fields for one or more of the parameters, you will not be able to enable time conflict checking for the category. You can, however, add date and/or time fields to the category and then enable time conflict checking. See [Adding and Editing Fields](#)

The date field specifies the date on which the item, occurs, and the time fields specify the time span of the event described by the item. You can specify the same field for **Start Time** and **End Time**, indicating that items in the category have no time span (i.e., they occur at a particular time, not for a duration of time).

Commence uses the date field to select items from the category with which to compare the new item; it uses the time fields to calculate a time span that is compared to the time span of other items occurring on the date in the date field. If the date field of the new item matches the date field in an existing item and the time spans of the items overlap in whole or in part, a time conflict is reported.

If the **Connection to use for conflict checking** connection definition is not set and you have time conflict checking turned on

(the default), you are warned whenever you add an appointment to a time slot with an existing appointment, regardless of who is involved in the appointment.

The fields you choose for time conflict checking can be changed at any time.

Enabling Time Conflict Checking

1. Select the [Customize-Database-Category](#) command. You will see a **Category Names** list box. Select the category for which you want to enable time conflict checking.
2. Press the **Time Conflict** button. The **Time Conflict** dialog box is displayed.
3. Select the arrows on the [drop-down list boxes](#) for **Date**, **Start Time**, and **End Time** to display a list of all the date and time fields (as appropriate) in the active category. If there are no fields of a particular type, only the name **(none)** will appear in the associated drop-down list when you select it. Select a field from each list box, or **Cancel** if appropriate fields don't exist.
4. Turn on the **Report Time Conflicts** check box.
5. Select the name of the connection definition you want Commence to use when checking for time conflicts by highlighting that connection definition in the **Connection to use for conflict checking** drop-down list box.
6. Select the **Save** button.

If one of the field boxes is set to **(none)** when you select the **Save** button, Commence attempts to pick an appropriate field. If it cannot, time conflict checking will not be enabled for the category.

Disabling Time Conflict Checking

1. Select the [Customize-Database-Category](#) command. You will see a **Category Names** list box. Select the category for which you want to enable time conflict checking.

2. Press the **Time Conflict** button. The **Time Conflict** dialog box is displayed.
3. Turn off the **Report Time Conflict** check box.
4. Select the **Save** button.

Print Items Action A **Print Items** [action](#) can print single [items](#) or sets of items. You can chose to print the [trigger](#) item, the [condition](#) items, or a [saved view](#) by selecting one of the [radio buttons](#) under **Print Items In**. If you select **View**, the [drop-down list box](#) under **View Name** lets you select from your existing set of views.

Selecting the **Print Options** button will allow you to specify details about the printing.

The print action is useful for agents that will periodically print reports. For example, you can create an agent that will print out your calendar for the week every Monday morning at 9 AM.

Add/Edit Action Dialog Box

To add, edit or delete an [action](#) in your [agent](#), select one of the four action buttons (**1** to **4**) on the [New Agent](#) or [Edit Agent dialog boxes](#). You then see the **Add Action** dialog box (if you are adding a new action) or the **Edit Action** dialog box (if you are editing an existing action). The controls and operation of the two boxes are identical.

The same dialog box is used for all actions, but its contents vary depending on what action you highlight in the **Action Type list box**. A brief description of the action you have selected is shown under the list box. The right hand side of the dialog box is used to set the options for the action type you select. As you select different action types, this side of the box will change to show you the appropriate options.

Every agent can have up to four actions. Actions define the work that an agent does when its trigger has fired and its conditions (if any) are true. You can specify some actions independently of the agent's trigger or conditions, but in most agents actions use the trigger or condition item(s). Thus it is necessary to define an agent's trigger and conditions before defining the actions. In fact, you cannot even view the condition and action options until you make a trigger selection. (The trigger can be changed later, but if any actions were specified using the trigger item from the first trigger, they also have to be changed.)

For complex agents, it is important to know that an agent's actions are performed in the order that they appear in the agent's definition. This is significant because if one action edits the trigger item or the condition items, then a subsequent action will receive the edited items, not the original ones.

Actions can range in sophistication from displaying a simple message on the status line to editing multiple fields in an incoming set of data items. One action, the message box, even

lets you define up to four sub-actions that can be performed in response to the selection button on the message box.

If you select [Clear](#) in the **Add Action** or **Edit Action** dialog box, the options for the current action are cleared. The **OK** command saves the current options, and the **Cancel** command restores the previous values (in an edit situation).

If an action is changed or cleared *before* selecting **Cancel**, you can select the original action type and the original values will appear.

Option specification for individual agent actions is described with each action type; choose an action from the list below.

The full set of actions available for Commence agents is the following:

[Add Item](#)

Adds a new item and optionally displays the item

[Application Launch](#)

Starts an application with command line parameters [Backup](#)

Make a backup of the open database

[Create E-Mail](#)

Create and send an electronic mail message

[Delete Items](#)

Deletes an existing item

[Edit Item](#)

Edits an existing item and optionally displays the item [Export](#)

Exports to a pre-selected file using a pre-selected template

[Icon Modification](#)

Changes the appearance of an icon on the icon bar

[Import](#)

Imports from a pre-selected file using a pre-selected template
[Manage Desktop](#)

Cascades, tiles, or closes all views. Also, opens a desktop.

[Message Box](#)

Displays a message dialog box (and optionally presents user selectable sub-actions) [New View](#)

Displays a new view

[Open View](#)

Displays an existing view

[Outlook Sync](#)

Starts a synchronization of data with Microsoft Outlook [Play](#).

[Multimedia](#)

Play a Windows multimedia file.

[Print Items](#)

Prints a view or an item

[Print Letter](#)

Generates and prints a letter using a template

[Process E-Mail](#)

Deletes or moves electronic mail message into a folder [Send DDE](#)

Sends a DDE message to another application

[Set Agent Status](#)

Makes another Agent active or inactive

[Status Bar Message](#)

Displays a message on the status line

[Sync Link In](#)

Apply Sync Link In updates using a pre-defined file [Sync Link Out](#)

Generate a Sync Link Out to a pre-defined file

[Use Telephone](#)

Will answer a telephone call, dial the telephone, or hang up the telephone

All the actions (except **Icon Modification**, **Open View**, and **Set Agent Status**) allow you to use the trigger item or one of the two condition item sets (if you have selected conditions for the agent) as part of the action specification. See [Using Trigger and Condition Data](#).

Using Field Codes, you can also insert values from a trigger or condition item into your action specifications. See [Using Field Codes In Actions](#).

Select Directory Dialog Box This [dialog box](#) appears when you choose the Select button from a dialog box that requires a directory path in a text box. The Select Directory dialog box lets you search through the available disks on your system for an appropriate directory path.

The elements of this dialog box are:

DIRECTORIES

This element contains two items a Directory Line to display the selected path and a list box of the directory structure.

DRIVES

This is a list of available drives for your system. Select the drive where the directory your are selecting is located.

OK

Use this button to accept the directory specified. The path shown on the **Directory Line** is the resulting path used by the dialog box to which you return.

CANCEL

Select the **Cancel** button to cancel the select directory operation.

HELP

Select the **Help** button to provide help for the **Select Directory** dialog box.

CREATE DIRECTORY

If you cannot find the directory or you would like to create a new directory select the **Create Directory** button.

Using Transfer Commands

[See Also](#)

The general procedure for transferring definitions from one database to another is:

1. Use the [Open/Manage Database](#) command to open the database containing the definitions you want to transfer.
2. Select the [Transfer Out](#) command. This command copies selected categories, views, agents, and data (if desired) from your database to a DOS file.
3. In the [Transfer Out Options](#) dialog box, select either **Category** or **View**. Then select the specific categories or views and agents to transfer.
4. Turn on the **Items** check box to transfer data as well as definitions from the selected categories or views. If you select the **Items** box, you may also choose to transfer any DOS files pointed to by data file fields in transferred items. Turn on the **Related Data Files** check box to do so.
5. Select **OK**. The [Select Transfer File](#) dialog box appears.
6. Type a file name for the transfer file in the **Filename** text box and select **OK**.

The transfer out begins. Commence keeps you informed of its progress and tells you when it is finished. Select **OK** when the message box indicates that the transfer is completed.

7. Using the **File-Open/Manage Database** command, open the database into which you want to read the transfer file just created. If this database resides on a computer other than the one on which you created the transfer file, be sure to make the transfer file accessible to this computer via floppy disk, a shared LAN drive, etc.
8. Select the [Transfer In](#) command. This command copies the definitions (and data, if any) from the DOS file that was

created with the **File-Transfer Out** command into the currently open database.

9. In the **Select Transfer File** dialog box, enter the path name of the transfer file in the **Filename** text box and select **OK**.
10. If the transfer file contains data, the [Transfer Rules](#) dialog box appears. Make the appropriate selections and select **OK**.

The transfer in begins. Commence keeps you informed of its progress and tells you when it is completed. Select **OK** when the message box indicates that the transfer is completed.

Customize-Design View-Display Tab (Calendar and Gantt Views)

In addition to the print title and paper layout options, Calendar and Gantt views also have one or more of the following display options:

DISPLAY MODE

For calendar views, selecting **Display Mode** opens a cascade menu from which you choose one of the mode options, **Image**, **Day**, **2 Days**, **Week**, **2 Weeks**, **Month**, **6 Weeks**, **Year** and Grid modes. The currently selected option has a check mark to the left of its entry on the cascade menu.

Shortcut: As an alternative to using the **Display Mode** command, you can use the mouse to click on the display mode drop down list in the calendar view window (see [Calendar Tool Bar](#)).

TIME SCALE

Allows you to change the time scale for a calendar or Gantt chart [view](#). The time scale determines the time interval used in the view and also affects how many items can be viewed on one screen.

For calendar views, selecting **Time Scale** opens a cascade menu from which you choose one of the time scale options, **5, 6, 10, 15, 20, 30, or 60 Minutes**. The currently selected option has a check mark to the left of its entry on the cascade menu. The time scale specifies the number of minutes between the appointment slots (default: 30 minutes) in Day display mode (see [Display Modes](#)).

For Gantt chart views, selecting **Time Scale** opens a cascade menu from which you choose one of the time scale options, **Day, Week, Month, Quarter, Year, or Auto**. The currently selected option has a check mark to the left of its entry on the cascade menu. The time scale specifies the time gradation to be used for displaying task intervals (default: auto -- Commence examines the range of data being displayed and selects an appropriate scale).

START TIME

Allows you to change the starting time of a calendar [view](#) (i.e., the time associated with the first time slot in day display mode).

In day display mode, a calendar view displays multiple time slots, each of which displays the names of the appointments scheduled for the time associated with the slot. By default, the first time slot is associated with **8:30AM**.

You can change the time associated with the first time slot of a calendar view by typing in a new **Start Time**. The time specified must be in the same format that you have selected in the Windows Control Panel.

Commence validates your chosen start time according to the currently set time scale. That is, you cannot specify a start time that, given the currently set time scale, would result in empty time slots in day display mode. Commence will display a message box and ask you to choose another time if your start time is invalid; the message box also tells you the latest possible valid start time given the currently set time scale.

Filter Tabs

When you select one of the **Filter** tabs on the [Filters](#) tab, it displays the [fields](#) and [connections](#) from the [active category](#), along with the buttons described below.

FILTER FOR ALL ITEMS (By field value)

To filter by field value, first highlight a field **Filter for All Items** list box. The available filter options on the right half of the screen will change, depending on the field type of the highlighted field. See [Filtering by Field Value](#) for more information.

Note: If you are filtering for all items based on the value in a field and not a connection, the **Filter By** list box will be grayed out, and the words (Field value) will appear in this list box.

FIELD VALUE

Enter the field value to filter for in this text box. You may use [wildcards](#) to keep the filter broad based. In the case of date and time fields, you may also use natural language date and time.

FILTER BY

To filter for all items connected to a particular item name, first highlight a connection name in the **Filter for All Items** list box. Notice that the words (Connection to item) appear in the **Filter by** list box and the right half of the screen now displays a list of all the item names and clarify fields (if any) for the connected category. Then select an item name from the list of items in that category.

If you prefer, rather than selecting a particular item name, you can turn on the checkbox to **Use highlighted item in open view**. The latter option filters the view so that the only items shown are those connected to whatever item is currently highlighted in an open view for the connected category. For more information about setting up view links, see [Customize-Link Views](#).

You are not limited to filtering on the [name type](#) field only. To filter on any field within the connected category, highlight the field in the **Filter by** list box and select a field value on the right. To filter on a connection within the connected category (selected in the **Filter for All Items** list box) you can highlight a connection name in the **Filter by** list box and select the connected item name from the list box on the right half of the screen.

Color Code Tab

This [tab](#) is displayed when you select the [Customize-Database-Color Code](#) tab. From this tab, you can select the **Add** button to add a new color code template, or highlight an existing template and choose the **Edit** or **Delete** buttons.

CATEGORY NAMES

This [list box](#) shows all the [categories](#) in the active [database](#).

COLOR CODE TEMPLATES

This [list box](#) shows all the currently defined color templates for all [categories](#) in the active [database](#).

ADD BUTTON

Selecting this button displays the [Select Color Field](#). Pick the field on which to base your color code template, then the [Color Code Template](#) dialog box is displayed.

EDIT BUTTON

Selecting this button displays the [Color Code Template](#) dialog box filled in with the definition of the color template highlighted in the **Color Code Templates** list box.

Shortcut: Mouse users can double-click the left mouse button while pointing at a template name to edit it without selecting the **Edit** button.

DELETE BUTTON

To delete a color code template, highlight the appropriate template name from the **Color Code Templates** list box on the **Color Code** tab, then select the **Delete** button. Commence asks for confirmation before deleting the template.

CLOSE BUTTON

Select **Close** when you are finished working with color code definitions.

Connection Dialog Box

Selecting the [Customize-Database-Connection](#) command displays the **Connection dialog box**, which lists the names of the [connections](#) from the [active category](#) to other categories. Use this dialog box to establish connections between categories.

See [Connections Overview](#) for a discussion of the basics of connections and connecting items together.

See [Connecting an Item to Another Item](#) for how to connect items using [connection controls](#) on [item detail](#) forms.

Use the buttons on the right side of the dialog box to add, edit, and delete connection definitions as described below.

ADD BUTTON

To add a connection definition for the active category, select the **Add** button to display the [Add Connection](#) dialog box. From this box, you can add a connection definition between any two categories (or between any category and itself) in the currently open database.

EDIT BUTTON

When editing connection definitions, you are allowed to rename both directions of the connection definition; no other changes are allowed.

To edit a connection definition shown in the list for the active category, highlight the connection definition whose name you want to edit and select the **Edit** button. The [Edit Connection Names](#) dialog box is displayed, with the current connection definition names filled in. You can then edit the name(s) for the connection definition.

Shortcut: Double-click the left mouse button on the connection definition name you want to edit.

Caution: Changing certain connection definitions may cause unintended effects in your data. An example would be changing the name of the simple connection (**Related Date**) between the Calendar category and itself; changing the name of this connection definition would remove the associations among recurring date items in the category and these items would not be able to be changed or deleted as a group.

Commence detects when you choose such a connection definition for editing and displays a warning message box that informs you of the potential problems in changing the name of the connection definition you've selected for editing. Select the **OK** button on the warning message box to continue. If you want to abort the editing of this connection definition, select **OK** and then select the **No** button on the next dialog box displayed.

DELETE BUTTON

To delete a connection definition shown in the list for the active category, highlight the connection definition in the list box and select the **Delete** button. Commence asks for confirmation before deleting the connection definition. Select **Yes** from the message box asking for confirmation to delete the connection definition.

Typically, you will want to delete a connection definition that you are not using to free up space in a category for more field definitions. A connection definition adds two fields to the total number of fields in the category. You should be careful, however, when choosing a connection definition to delete.

Caution: Deleting certain connection definitions may cause unintended effects in your data. An example would be deleting the simple connection (**Related Date**) between the Calendar category and itself; deleting this connection would remove the associations among recurring date items in the category and these items would not be able to be changed or deleted as a group.

The same is true for agents. If you delete a connection definition on which an agent depends, the agent will no longer function as intended. You will have to update any agents that depend on the deleted connection definition yourself using the [Customize-Database-Agent](#) command.

Commence detects when you choose such a connection definition for deletion and displays a warning message box that informs you of the potential problems in deleting the connection definition you've selected for editing. Select the **OK** button on the warning message box to continue. If you want to abort the deletion of this connection definition, select **OK** and then select the **No** button on the next dialog box displayed.

ADVANCED BUTTON

The list of items in the connected category can be sorted and filtered to make items easier to locate. For example, you may want to filter your connection to To-Do's to only show uncompleted To-Do's.

To filter the connection list, press the **Select Filter** button. The filter can be toggled on and off by the end-ser by clicking the filter button on the connection toolbar. Checking the **Filter by default** box will apply the filter automatically when the connection list is opened. (See [Filter Tab](#) for more information about how to filter a list of items)

To sort the connection list, press the **Select Sort** button. (See [Sort Fields](#) for more information about the Sort Fields dialog box.) For example, you may want to sort connections to the Calendar in date descending order so the most recent items appear at the top of the list.

To layout the columns of data displayed in the connection field, press the **Field Option** button. (See [Connection Field Options](#) for more information about the Field Options dialog box.)

By default, connections allow as many related items as needed to be selected. For example, an Appointment can be related to multiple attendees, and likewise a contact may be related to many appointments. This is known as a “many-to-many” relationship. If necessary, the connection can be configured to allow “many-to-one”, “one-to-many” or “one-to-one” relationships by turning on the option to **Allow At Most 1 Connected Item**. This option must be enabled in both directions of the connection for a true one-to-one relationship.

CLOSE BUTTON

Select **Close** when you are finished working with connection definitions.

Connections Overview

A [connection](#) is a bi-directional link between two [categories](#) or between a category and itself. Use the [Customize-Database-Connection](#) command to add, edit, and delete connections between any two categories.

Once you establish a connection, you can link [items](#) from the categories participating in the connection together to create relationships among your data, and reduce the amount of redundant data in your database.

A connection is named when you create it, and the name should reflect the reason that the categories are linked together.

For example, let's say you have a Contacts category and a History category, as in the tutorial data. A link from the Contact category to the History category called "Relates to" can be used to connect a Contact item to the History item for the notes that refer to that person in the Contact item. Likewise, the History item would have a connection called "Relates to" that links the person to the note in the History category.

You must specify a name for both directions of a connection between two categories, as in the example in the previous paragraph. A connection that has two directions is called a *paired* connection.

For a connection between a category and itself, you give the same or different names to both sides of a connection. A connection between a category and itself that describes only one direction is called a *simple* connection.

An example of a simple connection would be one between the Contact category and itself that is given the name "Works with". It would be used to link together people who work together without qualifying the relationship in the way a paired connection does.

For example, a paired connection between items in the Contact category that expresses the same relationship could have the names "Works for" and "Manages", indicating a staff/supervisor relationship.

Linking items together using connections is a two-step process.

1. Set up the simple or paired connection at the database level using the [Customize-Database-Connection](#) command. This specifies the categories for both sides of the connection and allocates connection controls on category detail forms.
2. Connect an item to another item by displaying an [item detail](#) for one of the items you want to connect and choosing the name of the other item from the [connection control](#) for the connection to the other item's category. Each item-to-item connection can be thought of as an instance of the simple or paired connection.

In the case of the "Relates to" paired connection between the Contact and History categories, an individual item in the Contact category is linked to an item in the History category by selecting the name of the History item in a connection control on the Contact item. Thereafter, you can display the item detail of either item and display the other item by selecting its name from the connection control.

Connection controls are displayed only in an [item detail](#). When you create a connection definition, a connection control is allocated automatically on every [detail form](#) of the category or categories involved in the connection.

image/confield_shg.gif

The label above the connection control is the connection name and contains the name of the connected category, in the case of our example, **Has History** indicates a connection to the Contact category.

The connection control shows the item name of the first connected item in the text portion of the box (connected item names are listed alphabetically in a connection control). The fields displayed in the connection control can be customized using the the [Customize-Database-Connection](#) command and clicking the **Advanced** button. On the right side of a connection control, there are three control buttons.

Use the up and down arrows image/connarrs_shg.gif to scroll through the list of connected item names; there is more than one name if one or both of the arrows is darkened . The middle control, the connection button image/conndiag_shg.gif, is used

to connect and disconnect items from the connected category. The add item button image/connadd_shg.gif on the extreme right is used to add a new item to the connected category and automatically connect it to the currently displayed item detail. (See [Dialog Box and Detail Form Keys](#) for how to use these controls without a mouse.) See [Connecting an Item to Another Item](#) for detailed instructions on using connection controls on item detail forms.

Connecting an Item to Another Item

Individual [items](#) are connected using the [connection control](#) boxes that appear on [detail forms](#). This procedure shows you how to [connect](#) two items together using an existing [connection definition](#).

If an appropriate connection definition does not already exist between the categories in which the items reside, you must add the connection definition before starting this procedure (see [Customize-Database-Connection](#)).

1. Open a view of one of the categories in the connection definition and display an item detail of one of the items you want to connect. The detail form chosen for the item detail must display the connection control for the connection you want to use to connect the items.
2. Select the connection diagram  on the connection control labeled with the name of the connection definition you want to use to connect the displayed item to another item.

For example, if you wanted to connect the item in the tutorial data's Contact category to the item in the mailingType category that describes the various mail lists to which the person has subscribed or shown interest, you would select the connection diagram on the connection control labeled **Mailing/Event Type**. A list box displaying the names of all the items from the connected category appears.

3. Select the items from the list that you want to connect to the contact item. You can select as many item names as you want. Each time you select an item name, a check mark appears to the left of it. The check mark indicates that a connection instance exists between the Contact category item and the checked item in the mailingType category.

If an appropriate item in the connected category does not exist, you can create a new item in the connected category by selecting the add item icon  in the connection control. The plus button may not be visible if the connection has been designed to 'HidePlusButton' or the button may be disabled if you do not have write (add and modify) permissions to the category.

The buttons on the connection toolbar are as follows:

Button	Purpose
image/savechk_shg.gif	SAVE: Press this button to save the connection to the selected item(s).
image/connbut1_shg.gif	SAVE AND ADD ANOTHER: Press this button to save the connection to the selected items and add new connected item
image/connbut2_shg.gif	SAVE AND EDIT HIGHLIGHTED ITEM: Press this button to save the connection to the selected item and open the detail for the linked item.
image/cancel_shg.gif	CANCEL: Press this button to undo your changes.
image/filter_shg.gif	TOGGLE THE FILTER: Press this button to toggle between a filtered and unfiltered list of items. The sort order will be determined by the sort (if any) specified in the connection definition.

 SHOW SINGLE LIST: Press this button to display both connected and unconnected items from the connected category in one list.

 SHOW TWO LISTS: Press this button to display the connected items in the top list, and all remaining items in the connected category in the bottom list.

4. After selecting all the item names that you want from the connected item list, select the save button on the connection toolbar to return to the detail form.

Once you connect items to the displayed item, the connection control displays the connected items in a list. You can scroll through the list of connected items using the up and down arrow buttons  to the left of the connection diagram.

5. Select the **Save** or **Cancel** button on the detail form to return to the view you opened in Step 1.

Detail Form Tab

The [Customize-Database-Detail Form](#) command displays the **Detail Form** [tab](#). From this tab, you can select the **Add** button to add a new detail form, or highlight an existing detail form and choose the **Edit**, **Copy**, or **Delete** buttons. At the bottom of the tab, the **Detail Form Description** displays a description of the highlighted form.

CATEGORY NAMES

This [list box](#) shows all the [categories](#) in the active [database](#).

DETAIL FORM NAMES

This list box shows all the currently defined detail forms for the selected [category](#). Commence automatically creates a default form called **Initial Form** for each newly created category. All the [fields](#) in a category appear on the **Initial Form** at creation, though you can edit the initial form like any other form.

ADD BUTTON

Selecting this button displays the [Design Form](#) dialog box. This allows you to add a new detail form for the category.

EDIT BUTTON

Selecting this button displays the [Design Form](#) dialog box filled in with the definition of the detail form highlighted in the **Detail Form Names** list box. This allows you to make changes to the existing form.

Shortcut: Mouse users can double-click the left mouse button while pointing at a template name to edit it without selecting the **Edit** button.

COPY BUTTON

Add a new form by Copying the form highlighted in the **Detail Form Names** list box and saving it to a new name; choosing the **Copy** button displays the [Design Form](#) dialog box.

DELETE BUTTON

Delete the existing form highlighted in the **Detail Form Names** list box (if you have more than one); Commence asks for confirmation before deleting the form and will not let you delete the only form for a [category](#).

SET DEFAULTS BUTTON

Set Defaults for adding and displaying [items](#); choosing the **Set Defaults** button displays the [Set Default Detail Forms](#) dialog box.

CLOSE BUTTON

Select **Close** when you are finished working with detail form definitions.

Importing Connections

If you attempt to import data from a file, and the template you are using maps information from the file into [connection definitions](#) in your [category](#), *the connected data must be present in your database, or the connections will not be made*. If this occurs, a message box telling you that connections have not been imported is displayed at the completion of the import operation.

For example, let's say you received an exported file that contains Project data for various customers. Let's also assume that the exported Project category and your Project category are exactly the same and that this file contains valid connection data for each [item](#) in the file. Each item in the exported file, then, contains the names of the connected items in the Person/Company category at the time the category was exported.

In order to import this connection data, the exact same connected items in the Person/Company category must exist in your database, or the connections specified in the export file will be ignored. In other words, the Projects will be imported into the Project category, however the connection to the Person/Company will be left blank.

To import connection data contained in an exported file, we recommend the following procedure. We'll use the example of importing a Project category with connection definitions to the Person/Company category to illustrate the procedure.

1. Create two import templates:

- A. one for the Person/Company category that imports the items required for the Client Person/Company connection. This data should contain information about the client who contracted the project. Only fields should be mapped (and no connections).
 - B. one for the Project category that imports all the project-related fields you want including the connection to the Person/Company category
2. Import the Person/Company category using template A above.
 3. Import the Project category using template B above. During this second import, the newly added Projects will automatically be connected to the existing Person/company items that were imported previously.

Note: If one or more of the connection definitions in the category you want to import point back to the category itself, you have to import the category twice; once to import the items (without connections) and the second time to import the connections.

Template Definition Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you are adding, editing, or copying an import/export template from the [Import/Export](#) dialog box.

Type or edit the template name in the **Template Name** text box. The name can be up to 30 characters and must be unique.

Choose your target [category](#) by selecting a category name from the **Category Name** [drop down list box](#).

You have to tell Commence three more things before you are done defining a new import/export template:

1. How to read the external file. You do this by selecting a file format from the [File Format](#) radio group.
2. Which [fields](#) you want to update in your target category and how those fields relate to the external file. You do this by selecting the **Map** button, which displays the [Template Mapping](#) dialog box.
3. How to process incoming data with new and duplicate item names. You do this by selecting the **Import Rules** button, which displays the [Import Rules](#) dialog box.
4. How to process outgoing data to an external OLE DB/ODBC database that may contain duplicate item names. You do this by selecting the **Export Rules** button, which displays the [Export Rules](#) dialog box.

Select the **Save** button to save your template definition. Select **Cancel** to discard the template you are working on.

File Format

In order to read your external data file, Commence needs to know how this file is formatted. Commence can read three different formats: ASCII, dBASE, and DIF. Commence can also read/write data directly from/to an OLE DB/ODBC database.

ASCII formats are very simple: each [item](#) appears on a separate line and [fields](#) are separated by a pre-defined delimiter, such as a comma or tab, or by having fixed column positions. Commence supports all three of these ASCII formats: comma, tab, and column delimited.

dBASE and DIF are more sophisticated file formats that include, besides the data, descriptive information about the file's field names, sizes and data types. Because dBASE and DIF formats are self-describing, if you provide a sample of the file you want to import, Commence can read the format and use that information to help you define your import/export template.

In all, Commence supports seven choices of file formats: three ASCII formats, dBASE and DIF without sample files, and dBASE and DIF with sample files. These choices are displayed in the **File Format** radio group on the [Template Definition](#) dialog box and are described below. The default format is ASCII, comma delimited.

ASCII, comma delimited

Each field is separated by a comma and surrounded by quotation marks. Each item starts on a new line. For example: "Jones, Jim", "Red Bank, NJ","(908)530-5221"
"Sands, Sally", "New York NY","(212)226-3345"

ASCII, tab delimited

Each field is separated by a tab and surrounded by quotation marks. Each item starts on a new line. For example: "Jones, Jim"
"Red Bank, NJ" "(908)530-5221"

"Sands, Sally" "New York NY" "(212)226-3345"

ASCII, column delimited

The fields start and end at specified positions. Each item starts on a new line.

Jones, Jim Red Bank, NJ (908)530-5221

Sands, Sally New York, NY (212)226-3345

dBASE, sample file

dBASE IV files ending with a .DBF extension, and memos stored in a .DBT file, are common file formats accepted and created by many different database programs. If you have a sample dBASE file appropriate to this category, Commence can help create your template definition by reading the field names and the size of the field. Commence can also do type checking on the field [mapping](#) you define.

Note: To import a dBASE-format file that contains memo fields, your target category must have fields that are capable of containing the data in the dBASE file, namely text fields with a size of **Large** (which holds up to 30,000 characters).

dBASE, no sample file

dBASE IV files ending with a .DBF extension, and memos stored in a .DBT file, are common file formats accepted and created by many different database programs.

DIF, sample file

Data Interchange Format (DIF) is a file format used primarily by spreadsheet applications. If you have a sample DIF file appropriate to this category, Commence can help create your template definition by telling you how many fields are imported or exported.

DIF, no sample file

Data Interchange Format (DIF) is a file format used primarily by spreadsheet applications.

OLE DB/ODBC data source

Many applications support ODBC including Microsoft Access, Oracle, and SQL.

(Edit) Authorization Defaults Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you choose the **Default Permissions...** button on the [Database Options](#) dialog box. This screen lets you set the default permissions for one or more categories in the shared database. The default permissions are applied to all new users when they enroll to the shared database.

A similar dialog box is displayed by pressing the **Edit Permissions...** button on the [Permissions](#) dialog box. From this screen, you can override the default permissions for any category and choose the level of access to a category for each user individually. The **Edit Authorizations** dialog box will have an additional option of **(Default)** in every drop-down list to accept the default permissions.

USER(S)

The names of the user(s) whose permissions are being modified will be displayed here. This is only shown on the **Edit Authorizations** dialog box.

DATABASE:

The name of the active shared database will be displayed here.

DEFAULT USER LEVEL

Select the default user level for the active shared database. The choices are [Author](#), [User](#), or [None](#).

CATEGORIES AND DESKTOPS

Select one or more categories or desktops from the list. Categories are listed as Type C and desktops are listed as Type D. The default permissions will be shown to the right of the category name. To change the default permissions for all categories and desktops at once, press **Select All**.

Note: The only permission that needs to be set for desktops is the Read permission. When setting permissions, if the selection includes one or more desktops, only the Read permission may be set. For full control over all applicable permissions, it may be helpful to sort by the **Type** column to group similar objects together.

READ PERMISSION

To change the default [read permission](#) for the selected categories or desktops, select [All](#), [Selective](#), or [None](#) from the list choices.

For a category, if the read permission is set to None, the user(s) will not receive any shared items for the selected category. In this case, it is not necessary to set the write and delete permissions.

WRITE PERMISSION (for CATEGORIES ONLY)

To change the default [write permission](#) for the selected categories, select **All**, **Selective**, or **None** from the list choices.

DELETE PERMISSION (for CATEGORIES ONLY)

To change the default [delete permission](#) for the selected categories, select **All**, **Selective**, or **None** from the list choices.

SAVE

Select **Save** to accept any changes you have made on this screen.

CANCEL

Select **Cancel** to exit without saving your changes.

Assign Users to Commence Items Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you choose the **Assign Users...** button on the [Database Options](#) dialog box. Selective Permissions lets you decide which users will have access to the items in a shared category, simply by connecting the user to the item. If the user is not connected, they will not be able to read, write, or delete that item.

This screen lets you select the “Person” category in your database containing the names of all Commence users in your workgroup. This category may be called Person, as in the Main Database, or you may have your own custom category, such as Employees, where only the names of Commence users are entered.

Note: You must enter the names of all your users (Commence clients) into your Person category before you can complete this dialog box.

USERS

The login IDs (as they were entered in ComAdmin) of all users of the shared database will be listed on the left side of the screen. Select one user name at a time from the list.

PERSON ITEMS

The names of all your Commence users (as they were entered in the Commence Person category) will be listed on the right side of the screen. Select the one item name from the list that matches the login ID of the user selected on the left side of the screen.

ASSIGN PERSON

Press this button to match up the selected items on the left and right sides of the screen. The word **(none)** to the right of the login ID will be replaced by the item name of the Commence user you selected.

UNASSIGN PERSON

Press this button to undo your selection. The word **(none)** will appear to the right of the login ID.

OK

Select **OK** to accept any changes you have made on this screen.

CANCEL

Select **Cancel** to return to the **Database Options** dialog box without saving your changes.

Select Connections for Selective Permissions Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you choose the **Select Connections...** button on the [Database Options](#) dialog box. Selective Permissions lets you decide which users will have access to the items in a shared category, simply by connecting the user to the item. If the user is not connected, they will not be able to read, write, or delete that item.

If you have not done so already, you must first [assign users](#) to items in your Person category. Then on this screen, you must choose which connection to the Person category should be used to determine selective permissions. This is useful if you have more than one connection to the Person category, for example “Appointment Coordinated by Person” can be used to allow only the person who added the Appointment item to have write and delete permissions to the item. “Appointment With Person” can be used to allow only the attendees (i.e., any user whose name appears in this connection) to have read permissions to the appointment item.

CATEGORY:

Select a shared category in the active shared database. This category will be configured to use [selective permissions](#).

CONNECTION FOR READ PERMISSIONS:

Select a connection to the “Person” category. Only those users who are connected to the item via this connection will receive the item.

CONNECTION FOR WRITE PERMISSIONS:

Select a connection to the “Person” category. Only those users who are connected to the item via this connection will be able to edit the item.

CONNECTION FOR DELETE PERMISSIONS:

Select a connection to the “Person” category. Only those users who are connected to the item via this connection will be able to delete the item.

OK

Select **OK** to accept any changes you have made on this screen.

CANCEL

Select **Cancel** to return to the **Database Options** dialog box without saving your changes.

Workgroup Communications Dialog Box

This dialog is displayed when you choose the **Configure** button (in the Server Communications group box) on the [Communications](#) dialog box.

SYNCHRONIZE WITH CLIENTS VIA...

Select a method of synchronization from the list. The default method of syncing with clients is via a shared LAN directory. All three methods can be configured at the server. This offers each client the most flexibility in choosing a convenient method of synchronization. For example, on-site users who are typically connected to a network may choose the shared LAN method, while remote users may prefer FTP.

EDIT

After selecting a method of synchronization, press the **Edit** button to enter the communication parameters. The [Server Communication](#) dialog box will be displayed.

CLEAR

If all your clients will be using the same method of synchronization, and you want to ensure that no users attempt to sync via any other method, then select the method of syncing you no longer want to use and press the **Clear** button to clear the parameters for that option.

OK

Select **OK** to accept any changes you have made on this screen. Click **Next** to continue.

CANCEL

Select **Cancel** to return to the **Communications** dialog box without saving your changes. Note you will be allowed to continue only after the communications setup has been filled out properly.

Registered User Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you choose the **Details** button from the **Register** dialog box.

Use this command to get more information about the registered user you've selected. The user's Full Name, Login ID, and Authorization Key are displayed. Other options on this screen include:

CREATE INSTRUCTIONS

Use this command to generate an instruction sheet for the registered user you've selected. The instruction sheet will include the user's information displayed above, and any additional information the user will need to know to enroll to the shared database. For more information about how to customize the instruction sheet, see [Registering Clients](#).

RE-REGISTER

Use this command to resend initialization information to the selected user. This must be done if an error occurs during the enroll process.

RESYNC

Use this command to resend database information to the user.

OK

Press the **OK** button to close this dialog box and return to the **Register** dialog box.

Type a Correction or Select a Suggestion Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#), displayed when you select the **Suggestions** button from the [Spell Checker](#), allows you to correct a misspelled word found by the [Tools-Spell Check](#) command by either:

- editing the text in the **Correction** [text box](#), or
- selecting an alternative spelling for the misspelled from the **Suggestions** [list box](#). If you choose a suggested spelling, it appears in the **Correction** text box.

Once you are satisfied with the text in the **Correction** text box, select one of the buttons explained below to tell the spell checker how to perform the substitution of the new spelling for the incorrect one.

CORRECTION TEXT BOX

This text box originally contains the misspelled word found by the spell checker. Change its contents using the mouse and keyboard, or by selecting one of the spell checker's suggestions from the **Suggestions** list box. Use one of the buttons on the right side of the dialog box to use the contents of the **Correction** text box to replace the misspelled word or return to the **Spell Checker** without correcting the word.

SUGGESTIONS LIST BOX

Lists suggested spellings for the misspelled word. Selecting one of these suggestions places it in the **Corrections** text box.

HERE

Substitute the contents of the **Correction** box for the currently highlighted occurrence of the word within the field being checked by selecting the **Here** button from the **Apply** box. Commence then highlights the next misspelled word in the field (if any). (The currently highlighted occurrence is the one that was highlighted when you selected the **Suggestions** button from the **Spell Checker** dialog box.)

EVERYWHERE

Substitute the contents of the **Correction** box for all occurrences of the word within the field being checked by selecting the **Everywhere** button from the **Apply** box.

CANCEL

To leave the misspelled word unchanged, select the **Cancel** button. Commence returns you to the **Spell Checker** dialog box, with the highlight still on the original misspelled word.

Find Time Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the **Find Time** button on the [Schedule Meeting](#) dialog box. The purpose of this dialog box is to let you choose a meeting date, start time, and end time for the Participants you selected in the **Schedule Meeting** dialog box.

Time slots are color coded so that you can find free time at a glance. White space indicates a time when all selected participants are free. Red indicates a time when at least one required Participant is busy. Blue indicates a time when none of the required participants are busy but at least one Optional Participant is busy.

The **Find Time** dialog box contains these elements:

HRS/MINS

The value in these boxes determines the size of the free time slot you want Commence to find. When you first enter the **Find Time** dialog box, these boxes display the meeting duration. If you set a **Start Time** and **End Time** in the **Schedule Meeting** dialog box, Commence calculates your meeting duration and displays the value here. If no **End Time** is entered, this value defaults to 30 minutes. Use these boxes to change the duration of the meeting.

DATE

When you first enter the **Find Time** dialog box, this text box displays either today's date or the **Date** specified on the **Schedule Meeting** dialog box. Either type a new date in the text box or use the **Time/Date Grid** (see below) to select a date.

START TIME

When you first enter the **Find Time** dialog box, this text box displays either the current time or the **Start Time** specified on the **Schedule Meeting** dialog box. Either type a new start time in the text box or use the **Time/Date Grid** (see below) to select a start time.

END TIME

When you first enter the **Find Time** dialog box, this text box displays either the **End Time** specified on the **Schedule Meeting** dialog box or, if no **End Time** was specified, 30 minutes after the **Start Time**. If you change the **Hrs/Mins** value (indicating meeting duration), Commence recalculates the **End Time**.

SKIP BY DAY

Select one of these buttons to move the **Time/Date Grid** backward or forward by one day.

SKIP BY SCREEN

Select one of these buttons to move the **Time/Date Grid** backward or forward by 14 days.

LEGEND

Shows the colors or shades used to identify which time slots are free for all selected participants (**None**), busy for at least one **Required** participant (**Required**), and busy for at least one **Optional** participant (**Optional**).

TIME/DATE GRID

Displays 24 time slots for each day in a 14 day period. When this box first appears, the day displayed on the left of the grid is either today or the day selected as the **Date** for the appointment on the **Schedule Meeting** dialog box.

Click the mouse button over a single time slot. The **Date**, **Start Time**, and **End Time** boxes change to reflect your selection.

OK

Select this button to confirm your choices for **Date**, **Start Time**, and **End Time** and return to the **Schedule Meeting** dialog box.

CANCEL

Select this button to cancel the currently specified **Start Time**, **End Time**, and **Date** and return to the **Schedule Meeting** dialog box without making any changes.

Resources Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the **Resources** button on the [Schedule Meeting](#) dialog box. The purpose of this dialog box is to connect the appointment you are scheduling to items in your Resource category. Connecting resources serves as a reminder to the coordinator and attendees that particular resources are required for the meeting and must be reserved in whatever way is appropriate for your organization.

The **Name**, **Located in** and **Date/Time** text is copied from the information in the **Schedule Meeting** dialog box to identify the meeting.

The **Needed** and **Not Needed** list boxes in the middle of the dialog box, and the buttons between them, are used to build a list of required resources for the meeting.

To add a resource to the meeting, highlight one or more resources from the **Not Needed** list and select the **Add** button. To remove resources from the meeting, highlight them in the **Needed** list box and select the **Remove** button.

To highlight multiple individual items in either of the list boxes, press and hold down the **Ctrl** key as you click the mouse button over them. To highlight a range of items, highlight the first item in the range, move the list box using the scroll bars (if necessary) to display the item at the other end of the range, then press and hold down the **Shift** key as you click the mouse button over the last item in the range.

Select the **Save** button to confirm your choices. Select **Cancel** to return to the **Schedule Meeting** dialog box without choosing resources.

Add/Edit Remote Database Dialog Box

These [dialog boxes](#) are displayed when you select the **Add** or **Edit** buttons on the [Sync Out](#) dialog box. The **Edit Remote Database** dialog box looks the same as the **Add Remote Database** dialog box, except that the name of the [database](#) you are editing appears in the **Database Name** [text box](#).

This dialog box lets you give a descriptive name to the remote database you are defining. The database name you specify must be unique within the currently defined list of names and must have 60 characters or less. It is advisable to use a database name that identifies both the database and the PC on which it resides. For example, if you want to use a database named "Sales Contacts" as a base database and have a remote database on your home PC, then enter a name like "Sales Contacts on Home PC". This will help you to remember which database you currently have open and the PC for which you are creating an update file.

Enter or edit the database name and select **OK** to confirm your changes. Select **Cancel** to return to the **Sync Out** dialog box without making any changes.

Creating the Initial Update File

With the [Sync Out dialog box](#) displayed, follow the procedure below:

1. The names of your [remote databases](#) are listed in the **Synchronize with Database** [drop-down list box](#). In the **Sync Filename** [text box](#), type in (or use the **Select** button to choose) a filename to hold the updates for the selected remote database, that is, the one displayed in the **Synchronize with Database** drop-down list box.

If you have more than one remote database, you must select a different filename for each update file. Choose an update file name that identifies the remote database. You may be synchronizing different remote databases at different times, so the update files can contain different information for each remote database. Commence writes the remote database name in the update file and will not let you update a remote database using the wrong update file.

2. Select the **OK** button to create the update file. The **Sync Out** message box is displayed to show you the status of the update.

When the Sync Out is finished, the button changes to **OK**. Select **OK** on the message box.

3. Clearly label the diskette with the name of the PC and the remote database for which the update file was created. (The update file may be created on any drive; it often created on a diskette or copied to a diskette to move to a remote PC.)

Now, you are ready to initialize the remote database(s). Select the **Browse >>** button to see how to do this.

Running Multiple Commence Servers on One PC

[See Also](#)

It is frequently convenient to have more than one copy of Commence running on a single PC. The following command line options can be used to control Commence's behavior when it first starts.

/Database

The **/Database** option controls the database that Commence opens initially. For example,

"c:\program files\commence\commence.exe" /Database=Contact Manager

will start Commence with the Main Database and

"c:\program files\commence\commence.exe"
/Database=c:\commence\data

will start Commence with the database that is in the c:\commence\data directory.

/Prompt

The **/Prompt** option causes Commence to display a list of available database when it starts. You can then select the database to open. For example:

```
"c:\program files\commence\commence.exe" /Prompt
```

/Quiet

If Commence is already running you will get a warning message if you try to start another copy of Commence. Adding the **/Quiet** option will suppress this warning message. For example:

```
"c:\program files\commence\commence.exe" /Quiet
```

Note: Each server **MUST** use a separate shared LAN or FTP directory. Open each database and use the [Customize-Workgroup](#) command, then press **Next >>** until you get to the Communications screen. Make sure you have selected a different shared LAN or FTP directory for each server database. Also, if you are synchronizing via e-mail, each server can use the same e-mail ID.

Tip For each copy of Commence you start, you will get a message telling you that Commence is already running and asking you if you want to start another copy. You can bypass this message by using the **/Quiet** command line option. To use it, just append “/Quiet” to the end of the command line.

Setting Server Communications

Three sets of Server Communications Settings are provided (e.g. one for each of the available synchronizing methods.) Depending upon the method(s) used for synchronizing updates, one or more of these sets of parameters must be configured. The methods available for synchronizing data are:

- **Shared LAN Directory** - used when a Local Area Network (LAN) is used by the Workgroup; a directory which is accessible by both the Server and Clients is used to distribute updated information
- **E-Mail** - uses electronic mail to send and receive updated information for the Shared Database
- **Internet FTP Directory** - uses File Transfer Protocol (FTP) commands to send and receive updated information for the Shared Database over the Internet.

It is not necessary for all three sets of parameters to be defined if only one or two of the methods are going to be used for the synchronizing of data. For example, if there is no Internet connection available to the Server, then synchronizing via the Internet will not be possible, and those parameters may remain undefined.

Perform the following procedure to define Server Communications Settings:

1. From the *Customize Workgroup - Database Options* Dialog Box, click on **Next >** two times. The *Customize Workgroup - Communications* Dialog Box will be displayed.
2. In the *Server Communications* section, click **Configure**. The *Workgroup Communications* Dialog Box will be displayed.
3. Highlight each method that will be used, in turn, and set the parameters:

 E-Mail

 Internet FTP Directory

 Shared LAN Directory

Setting Client Communications

Once the Commence Server has been configured properly for each of the methods to be used for synchronizing, each Client must in turn be configured as well. Unlike the Commence Server, which is capable of being configured for all three means of synchronizing (i.e. Shared LAN Directory, e-mail, and/or the Internet), a Commence Client is capable of using only one method of synchronizing at any given time. The choice of synchronizing method may be changed at any point by reconfiguring the Client Communications Parameters, but a Client cannot be configured for multiple methods of synchronizing simultaneously.

Perform the following procedure to define Client Communications Settings:

1. From the *Customize Workgroup - Database Options* Dialog Box, click on **Next >** two times. The *Customize Workgroup - Communications* Dialog Box is displayed.
2. From the *Customize Workgroup - Communications* Dialog Box, highlight a user name in the **Client Communications** box and select **Configure**.
3. Select the method that the client will use to synchronize. Note, only one method can be used per client.

 E-Mail

 Internet FTP Directory

 Shared LAN Directory

Repeat for each client.

Users' communications parameters may need to be updated if the methods available for syncing change. For example, if a user usually works in the office, they would typically be connected via a shared LAN directory. If they begin using Commence on a laptop from outside of the office, e-mail communication would

allow the Client Database to communicate with the Server even when away from the office. The server will then need to be reconfigured so that it sends (and receives) synchronization data from the Client via e-mail. Additionally, the user will need to configure the Client Database to communicate via e-mail.

Add/Edit Field Dialog Box

When you are adding, editing, or copying a category (see [Category Definition](#) dialog box), the **Add** and **Edit** buttons on this dialog box allow you to add new fields or modify existing fields in the selected category.

FIELD LABEL TEXT BOX

When adding a field, this [text box](#) is blank. Type a field label into the box that is indicative of the field's purpose. You must label a field in order to save its definition using the **OK** button.

When editing a field, this box is filled in with the current field label. You can change the label by editing the box's contents and selecting the **OK** button.

Field labels are limited to 20 characters.

FIELD TYPE LIST BOX

This [list box](#) shows Commence's field types (the name field type is omitted unless you are editing the [name field](#)).

When adding a field, Commence highlights the **Text** field type by default. Change the type by highlighting another in the list.

When editing a newly added field, the current field type is highlighted and can be changed by moving the highlight to another field type in the list. This can be done until the field is saved.

When editing a previously defined (saved) field in an existing category, the field's type is highlighted but it cannot be changed; this also applies to the name type field of any category.

Note: If you have not yet entered any data into a field and you want to change the field type, you can delete the field and add a new field with a different field type. If you have entered data and want to transfer this existing data to a new field with the type you want, use the [File-Export-By Category](#) command to export the data values from the old field, define a new field with the type you want, and then use [File-Import](#) to import the data values.

FIELD OPTIONS

The options displayed on the right side of the dialog box depend on the field's type, so the right hand side of the **Add** or **Edit Field** dialog box changes when you select different field types in the **Field Type** list box.

Since each field type has special capabilities and different definition options, consider how you will use a field before you add or edit it.

The following is a list of all the available field types. To see a definition of the capabilities of the field, select the field type name below. To see a description of the field's options as they appear in this dialog box, as well as an explanation of valid field values, select the word **Options** next to the field type whose options you want to see.

[Calculation Options](#)

[Check Box Options](#)

[Data File Options](#)

[Date Options](#)

[E-mail Address Options](#)

[Excel Cell Options](#)

[Image Options](#)

[Internet Address \(URL\) Options](#)

[Number Options](#)

[Selection Options](#)

[Sequence Number Options](#)

[Telephone Options](#)

[Text Options](#)

[Time Options](#)

Editing a Radio Group

There are two considerations you should bear in mind when editing [radio button](#) definitions using the [Edit Field dialog box](#).

First, you cannot delete a radio button. For example, once you save a definition that uses five radio buttons for the **Status** field, you can't go back to using only three buttons. The fourth and fifth will have to be labeled **Unused** or some such name if you no longer want to use those labels. Each button will continue to be counted towards the total number of [fields](#) and [connections](#) used for your [category](#).

Second, while you can change the radio button's label at any time, it is easiest to do so *before* you enter any data into the category. This is because data you enter is associated with the radio button *number*, not its label.

For example, if you have data associated with a radio button labeled **Meeting** and change the label to **Phone Call**, any items in the category that previously had the **Meeting** button turned on will now have the **Phone Call** button turned on.

Icon Modification Action

The **Icon Modification** [action](#) draws attention to a button on the [view bar](#) to alert you to open the view.

Use the **View Name** [drop-down list box](#) to select a [view](#) from among the views you currently have on the [view bar](#). View bar buttons have two appearances: **normal** and **alert**. The alert appearance can be used as a reminder that the view should be examined. The icon modification action can optionally sound an **audible alarm** to further alert you.

The icon modification action does not use values from [trigger](#) or [condition](#) item(s).

An agent using a [timer](#) trigger and an icon modification action is an easy way to periodically remind yourself to check important data.

Item Count Condition

An **Item Count** [condition](#) tests whether or not there are a specified number of data [items](#) in a [category](#), a [filtered](#) category or a named [view](#). The condition can be defined to look for an exact match to the condition count or for an item count less than or greater than the condition count.

Select either **View** or **Category** under **For Items In...** to specify the items that are checked by the condition.

If you select **View**, a [drop-down list box](#) appears that lets you select one of your current views. Note that selecting a view determines the category of the view.

If you select **Category**, a drop-down list box appears that lets you select one of your categories. If you want to limit the condition test to a sub-set of the category, use the **Select Filter** button to bring up the [Filters tab](#). Now you can define a [filter](#) for that category.

An **Item Count** can be defined to look for an exact match to the item count or a connection count less than or greater than the condition count. Use the [radio group](#) controls under **Trigger If...** to set the style of comparison. Enter the condition count in the [text box](#) to the left of **items are visible**.

An **Item Count** condition passes all the items in its test view or category as condition items.

Item Count conditions are useful for passing several data items at once to an action. Remember, if you want to design an agent that processes many items at once you should use an **Item Count** condition or a **Field Summary** condition since triggers only pass a single item as trigger data.

Tools Menu Commands

This menu provides access to various utilities provided by Commence.

[Outlook Sync](#) Synchronizes data with Microsoft Outlook.

[Spell Check](#) Check the spelling of words in a text [field](#); either the blinking cursor or some highlighted text must be present in the field to be checked.

[Schedule Meeting](#) Find an available meeting time for a group of participants and then add an appointment item to the group calendar.

[Field Summary](#) Display a summary of all the calculation and number fields selected for summary reporting (if any) in the active view. This command is available only if the active view is a report.

[Sync Link In](#) Read an [update file](#) for a particular database.

[Sync Link Out](#) Manage [remote databases](#) in the [sync link group](#).

[Import Import](#) data from an external file into a [category](#) in the open database.

[Export-By View Export](#) data from a category in the open database to an external file; only those items appearing in the [active view](#) are exported.

[Export-By Category](#) Export all data from a category in the open database to an external file.

[Transfer In](#) Read data definitions from a [transfer file](#) into the open database.

[Transfer Out](#) Copy data definitions into a transfer file from the open database.

Save Item Trigger

The **Save Item** [trigger](#) is fired when an [item](#) is saved in Commence. The specification of the trigger consists of identifying which items activate the trigger when they are saved. All **Save Item** triggers work with a single [category](#) (e.g., Account, Activity, etc.). The **Save Item** trigger passes data from the [item](#) that was saved (trigger data).

You can specify that the trigger fires when an item is added for the first time, when an item is edited or both. Select these options using the **added** and **edited** check boxes to the right of **An item is** in the **Trigger If** [group box](#).

You can set a **Save Item** trigger for items in a [view](#) or in a category. Make this selection by picking one of the **View** or **Category** [radio buttons](#) under **Trigger If**.

If you select **View**, a [drop-down list box](#) appears that lets you select one of your current views. Note that selecting a view determines the category of the view.

If you select **Category**, a drop-down list box appears that lets you select one of your categories. You can just set the alarm for any item in the category, or you can restrict it to a filtered sub-set of the category. Press the **Select Filter** button to bring up the [Filters tab](#) and define a [filter](#) for that category.

Pressing the **Options** button allows you to qualify the type of Save Item that has occurred. An add/edit item can occur in a number of ways. The table below summarizes the various options available for modifying items in Commence.

Option Item was added/edited via...

Detail Form -an item detail in which information was manually entered by a Commence user

Agent -an agent using an Add Item or Edit Item action

Transfer In -Transfer In from a Commence *.TFR file

Import -Import (or the Import action in an agent) from an ASCII, dBASE, DIF, or ODBC file

DDE -an external program or a Commence agent using Dynamic Data Exchange

Sync Link -Sync Link In (or the Sync Link In action in an agent) from a remote database

Workgroup -Workgroup Sync or automatic synchronization (only available in a shared database)

Internet/Intranet -an Allure-enabled web site

Pilot Link -HotSync with a Palm handheld device

Other programs -an external add-on using the Commence Database API or from a Commence detail form using the Database API in a VBScript

Outlook Sync -synchronization with Microsoft Outlook

By default, the Save Item trigger assumes that the agent will fire only if an item was manually added/edited via a detail form. Every one of these options, including the default detail form option, can be turned on or off independently, allowing you to custom select the types of save to suit your needs. For example, by turning off the agent option, you can be sure that an agent will never trigger itself.

The following steps describe how to access the options in the Save Item trigger.

1. Select **Customize-Database-Agent**.
2. Select **Add** to create a new agent.
3. Press the **T** button in the **If this Trigger occurs:** section. This will display the Add Trigger dialog.

4. Select **Save Item** from the list of Trigger types.
5. Select a view or category from either combo box.
6. Press the **Options...** button. The Updates screen will appear. Check as many options as needed. The agent will run whenever an item is added or edited via the selected options. For example, if the “Other program” option is selected, the agent will run when an Automation client adds an item to the selected view or category.
7. Complete the remaining selections for the agent (e.g. define any conditions and actions as needed).
8. Save the agent.

Note: The options also work with existing agents that already use the Save Item trigger. Simply edit the agent and modify the trigger. Then press the **Options** button and check the appropriate boxes as needed.

Sync Link Concepts

[See Also](#)

If you are using several PCs and are not on a [LAN](#), you can still maintain identical databases by using the Sync Link feature. Sync Link provides you with the benefits of information sharing without using a network to interconnect your PCs. Using Sync Link, you can compress a Commence database into a single file, and read that file into a copy of Commence running on another, unconnected computer. Thereafter, you can keep the two copies of the Commence database identical by sync linking the database changes from one PC to the other as you move between them.

The text under the heading *Establishing a Sync link Group* explains the general procedure for defining and maintaining a set of two or more identical databases. The section [Using Sync Link](#) details procedures for using the sync link group and for adding, editing, and deleting remote databases.

Establishing a Sync link Group

A [sync link group](#) consists of two or more Commence databases, usually located on different, unconnected computers.

Establishing a sync link group allows you to exchange files between the databases in the sync link group and keep the contents of the databases identical, or synchronized, as work and travel take you from computer to computer. The following diagram depicts a typical sync link group scenario.



Using Sync Link to update databases is much more efficient than backing up and restoring entire databases. After the initial [synchronization](#) (which occurs during the establishment of the sync link group), only the *changes* are sync linked from PC to PC.

Steps to Establish a Sync link Group

Before you can use Sync Link to synchronize databases, you must define your sync link group, create the remote databases on your remote PCs, and then populate the remote databases with the information in the base database. The general procedure is as follows:

1. Open the database that you want to sync link between computers. This database will be the [base database](#) for the sync link group.
2. With the base database open, define one or more [remote databases](#) for the sync link group.
3. Create an initial [update file](#) for each of the remote databases. This is called a "complete update" since it consists of all definitions and data in your base database.
4. For each remote, add the new remote database on the remote PC and read in the update file you created. This makes the base and the remote databases identical.

Defining the Sync link Group

Before beginning, decide which PC you want to use as the [base](#). Select whichever PC you use most frequently. If the data is not already on the base PC, copy the data directory to the base PC and use **File-Open/Manage Database** to add that database to Commence. Then follow these steps:

margin-bottom: 6.00pt;

text-indent: -18.00pt;">1. Start Commence on the PC you want to use as your base, and open the database that you want to sync link. This database will be your [base database](#).

If this database is not opened automatically when you start Commence, use the [Open/Manage Database](#) command to open it.

2. Select the [Tools-Sync Link Out](#) command. The [Sync Out dialog box](#)

is displayed. It should be empty. This dialog box lets you define the remote PCs that will be in your sync link group. There should not be any databases defined in the **Synchronize with Database** list box. If there are, you should follow the steps in the section *Adding Another Remote Database* in the description of the **Sync Out** dialog box.

3. Select the **Add** button from the **Define Remote Database** group box. The [Add Remote Database](#) dialog box is displayed. This dialog box lets you give a descriptive name to the remote database you are defining. The database name you specify must be unique within the currently defined list of names and must have 60 characters or less.

It is advisable to use a database name that identifies both the database and the PC on which it resides.

For example, if you want to use a database named "Sales Contacts"

as a base database and have a remote database on your home PC, then enter a name like "Sales Contacts on Home PC". This will help you

to remember which database you currently have open and the PC for which you are creating an update file. Select **OK**.

A dialog box will appear while Commence initializes the database in preparation for the first sync link out. As soon as the initialization is finished, you will be returned to the **Sync Out** dialog box.

4. The **Sync Type** should be set to Incremental. Because you have added a new remote database, Commence will automatically detect that an initial sync file containing the entire database must be created. Do *not*

select **OK** yet.

Now, you are ready to create the initial [update file](#).

Select the **Browse >>** button to see how to do this.

Initializing Remote Databases

Perform the following procedure for all of the remote databases in the sync link group:

1. Open Commence on the PC on which the remote database is to be located.
2. Create a new, empty database by using the [Open/Manage Database](#) command and selecting the **Add** button. You can give this database any name you wish, but to prevent confusion, you may want to use the same name that you gave to the base database when you defined the sync link group.
3. Insert the update diskette intended for this remote database into your diskette drive. (The update file may exist on any drive, but is commonly on a diskette.)
4. Select the [Sync Link In](#) command. The [Select File](#) dialog box is displayed.
5. Select the name of the update file in the **Files** list box that matches the one you selected for this database's **Sync Filename** in step 1 of the procedure for creating the initial update files above. Then select **OK**.
6. The **Sync In** message box is displayed to show you the status of the update.

When the Sync In finishes, the button changes to **OK**. Select **OK** on the message box.

Now, you are ready to use the [sync link group](#) you've established. Select the **Browse >>** button to see how to do this.

Using the Sync link Group

[See Also](#)

This section describes a common scenario for using your [sync link group](#). It assumes that you have a base database called Sales and two remote databases: "Sales on Home PC" and "Sales on Laptop". This scenario also assumes that you have followed the steps in the section [Sync Link Concepts](#) and have initialized both of your remote databases.

1. You are using your [base database](#) and are about to leave for a business trip. Just before closing Commence, you select [Sync Link Out](#) to create an incremental update of your database to take with you on your laptop.
2. Select the database named "Sales on Laptop" from the **Synchronize with Database** [drop-down list box](#) and make sure that the **Sync Type** [radio button](#) is set to **Incremental**, which is the default. Enter a name for the update file in the **Sync Filename** text box. If you selected a diskette drive for the file, make sure that there is a diskette in the diskette drive. Then select **OK**.

Commence creates the incremental [update file](#) for the Sales database on your laptop PC. This file only contains the changes you have made since the last time you [synchronized](#) your Sales on Laptop database.

3. On your laptop PC, start Commence and open the Sales database.
4. Select [Sync Link In](#) and select the filename that contains your incoming updates. Then select **OK**.

Commence applies all of the updates from your base database to your [remote database](#). When the synchronization is finished, this database is identical to your base database.

If you made any changes to your "Sales on Laptop" database during your trip, you would perform the same sequence of steps when you return, this time *from* your laptop and *to* your base PC. After you have re-synchronized with your base PC, you can follow

the same steps to create an update file for your other remote database, "Sales on Home PC." Then you can take this file home and synchronize your home PC so that it is identical to the others.

Some important things to remember:

- You must perform a **Complete** update (from the Base database) the first time you add a new remote database to a sync link group (see the following section). After you do this, you need only perform **Incremental** updates between databases in the sync link group.
- If a diskette containing an update file becomes unreadable, or you otherwise lose the update file, you will need to go back to *the last PC you used* and perform a **File-Sync Link Out** with the **Sync Type** radio button set to **Complete**. This file, like the one you first created on the base database, is a complete copy of the database. After you read it into the targeted database, you can use an **Incremental** update file again.
- Update files are targeted for a particular database in a sync link group. After you establish a sync link group, Commence will not let you read an update file into the wrong database.
- If you cancel a synchronization in progress, you *must* restart the synchronization from the same update file if you want to continue using the open database without any loss of data. Alternatively, you could go back to the database from which you created the update file and create a new *complete* (not incremental) update file for the open database.

Restore Database Dialog Box

The **Restore Database** [dialog box](#) is displayed while the [database](#) is being restored. If you select the **Cancel** button to cancel the backup, nothing is written to the database directory you specified. Once the backup is complete, select the **OK** button from the **Restore Database** dialog box to return to the [Open/Manage Database](#) dialog box.

Restore will read from multiple floppy diskettes if the backup file spans diskettes. Commence will prompt you for additional diskettes as needed.

Template Mapping Dialog Box

[See Also](#)

After selecting a [file format](#) for a template on the [Template Definition dialog box](#), you must tell Commence which [fields](#) in your target [category](#) correspond (or "map") to the fields in the external file.

To define your field [mapping](#), select the **Map** button on the [Template Definition](#) dialog box. Commence displays the **Template Mapping** dialog box, the contents of which depend on whether or not you are using a sample file, which is an option for dBASE and DIF file formats.

If you are not using a sample file, you must select field names from your target category *in the same order* that the fields appear in the external file.

If you are using a sample file, Commence will give you a list of the external field names so you can *match each external name with the corresponding field* in your target category; Commence then puts the fields in the correct order for you.

The following help topics discuss template mapping without and with sample files.

[Template Mapping Without Sample Files](#)

Discusses using the three **ASCII** file formats; the **dBASE, no sample file** format; and, the **DIF, no sample** file format.

[Template Mapping With Sample Files](#)

Pertains to the **dBASE, sample file** format; the **DIF, sample file** format; and, the **OLE DB/ODBC data source** format..

The process of [mapping](#) fields is identical for import and export with three exceptions.

1. A special **<Skip Field>** entry appears in the **Fields Not in Template** list box. This is used as a placeholder when mapping templates without a sample file. It instructs Commence to disregard the field data in that position of the import file. When you are importing data or exporting using a sample external file, the **<Skip Field>** does the same function as the **Unassign Field** button; it clears the selected field mapping causing Commence to skip over that field during the import/export.
2. There is no need to set **Import Rules** when a template will only be used for exporting data from a category. **Export Rules** apply only to OLE DB/ODBC exports.
3. Exporting a [sequence number](#) or [calculation field](#) may be useful, but these values cannot be imported since those field values are automatically generated and/or computed by Commence.

Setting up Windows Telephony

[See Also](#)

Select the [Edit-Preferences-Dialer](#) command to tell Commence what type of dialer you are using. If you select Windows Telephony as the [dialing device](#), you can specify default dialer settings for a modem connected to your PC. This will enable Commence to autodial a phone number from your PC.

1. Select the **Control Panel** button on the Dialer preferences tab. This will run the **Telephony** applet in Windows Control Panel.
2. The *Telephony Properties* dialog box will be displayed. Select the appropriate telephony driver for your modem. You will typically be given a choice of "Unimodem Service Provider". If the manufacturer of your dialing device has supplied you with a TAPI Service provider (*.TSP) file, it will be listed here after it has been properly installed.
3. Select the **Setup** button, then press **Properties**. The *Modems Properties* dialog box will be displayed. Select the correct communications Port and Speed for your modem and configuration. Click OK.
4. Select the **Dialing Properties** button. **Select** "Default Location" or press **New** to add a new location.

Enter your local area code (e.g. "908" for central New Jersey). Select the Country you are dialing from (e.g. "United States of America (1)" if you are in the United States).

If dialing through a PBX enter the appropriate prefixes to access an outside line. Typically, you would enter "9," for both local and long distance calls. Otherwise, leave both boxes blank. Click OK to save the dialing properties for this location.

5. Click Close to save the data.

Note: You will have to close Commence and restart it for **Control Panel** changes to take effect.

Once you have setup your dialing device you can use the **Tools-Dial Phone** command or the **Dial** button on the **Home** menu to dial any phone number displayed in the active view or item detail:

Note: Windows Telephony (TAPI) is a built-in component of Microsoft Windows.

Configuring E-Mail Client

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the [Edit-Preferences-Other Apps](#) command.

This preference allows you to configure your Commence database to receive e-mail.

The Commence agent trigger **Incoming Communication: E-Mail** can detect when you receive new E-Mail. It can then perform actions on the e-mail such as deleting the mail message, marking it as Read, or do any number of other agent actions such as adding the e-mail message as a new item in Commence.

Before Commence can detect that you have new e-mail, you must first configure Commence as an E-Mail client. To do so:

1. From the **Configure Commence as:** combo box, select **E-Mail client**.
2. From the **Mail Program:** combo box, select the appropriate protocol for your E-Mail application. For example, if you use Lotus cc:Mail, select **Lotus cc:Mail or VIM compatible (16-bit)**. If you use MS Outlook or another MAPI application such as Eudora, select **MS Outlook or MAPI-compatible (32-bit)**.
3. If you selected **VIM compatible**, you must also fill in the location of your **Post Office Path**. For Lotus Notes, enter the directory where VIM.DLL or VIM32.DLL can be found.
4. Enter your e-mail **User Name** and **Password**. (If you are using MS Outlook, enter your Profile Setting instead. The default is usually 'Microsoft Outlook'.) . Re-enter the password in the **Verify Password** box.
5. When completed, select **Done** to save the configuration.

Configuring Mobile Link and Microsoft Outlook

[See Also](#)

Commence can synchronize data with supported handheld devices and also with Microsoft Outlook.

Use the Preference screens in Commence to match each field in Commence with the corresponding field in the other application. These field mappings will be used during the synchronizations to ensure that the correct data is stored in the appropriate field in each application. Only those fields that will be used need to be mapped.

Refer to the following topics for detailed steps:

[Mapping fields for Mobile Link and Microsoft Outlook Calendar](#)

[Mapping fields for Mobile Link and Microsoft Outlook Contacts](#)

[Mapping fields for Mobile Link and Microsoft Outlook Tasks](#)

[Mapping fields for Mobile Link Notes](#)

MOBILE LINK SYNCHRONIZATION

You can begin to use Mobile Link once you have completed the mappings for your Commence database. For more details about how to use Mobile Link, please see the Mobile Link Guide (mobilelink.pdf) provided with your downloaded software.

OUTLOOK SYNCHRONIZATION

Step 1

To use the Outlook synchronization feature, Outlook must be installed on the same PC as Commence RM. Outlook should be setup using either of the following options:

- Corporate Workgroup: provides full MAPI compliance
- Internet Mail Only: provides services to connect to an Internet Service Provider (ISP).

To determine which setup option is installed, startup Outlook then select **Help -> About Microsoft Outlook**.

Step 2

Commence must also be configured as a MAPI 32-bit E-Mail client. This will enable Commence to access Outlook without prompting for your login information each time a synchronization with Outlook is initiated. Refer to [Configuring E-Mail](#) for detailed setup information.

Step 3

Before your first synchronization with Outlook, please backup your data both in Commence and in Microsoft Outlook. Refer to the Microsoft Office Integration Guide (msoffice.pdf) for more information about how to prepare your database for synchronization with Outlook.

Log In to Server Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the **Open** button on the [Open/Manage Database](#) dialog box if your Administrator has required a Login Password for the shared database you are opening.

LOGIN ID

Type in the [Login ID](#) you were assigned by the Commence Administrator.

LOGIN PASSWORD

Type in your [Login Password](#). The characters you type for your password are echoed to the screen as a series of asterisks to maintain the privacy of your password.

Note: Only the Commence Administrator can change your Login Password.

SAVE LOGIN ID ON DISK

The **Save Login ID on disk** [check box](#) tells Commence to remember your Login ID and automatically supply it whenever you open a shared database. If you turn on this check box, the next time you open this shared database, Commence will display your Login ID in the [edit box](#) and you will have to type in only your Login Password.

OK

Select **OK** to open the shared database.

Using Field Codes in Templates

[See Also](#)

By using Field Codes, you can insert values from a data [item](#) into your letter. For example, if you have chosen to associate a template with the Person/Company [category](#), you can use values from any direct field or [connected](#) field in the Person/Company category in the template. When the template is used to send a letter to a specific person, the Field Codes are replaced with the actual values from the person's data item.

The format for field codes depends on the word processor that is configured.

WORD 2000/XP

Field Codes use Word formatting and field code formats for additional functionality. The Microsoft Office Integration Guide (msoffice.pdf) includes more details on the use of Field Codes in Word 2000 and XP.

WordPerfect

Field Codes are simply the name of the field enclosed in parentheses and percent characters: (%Field Name%). For example, to insert the name of the item in the letter, the field variable (%Name%) would be used in the template. Data from connected fields can also be represented with Field Codes. The general format for a connected field is :

(%Connection%%Connected Category%%Field Name%)

For example, in a template for the Person/Company category, you can use the following Field Code: (%Has %%Notes/History%%Notes%). This represents the notes field in the Notes/History category.

Note: If a formatted template references a connected field and multiple items are connected to the data item for which a letter is being written, data from *all* the connected items is entered into the letter. Each connected item field is added on a separate line. For example, if you specify a connection of (%For%%Opportunity%Name%) in a letter template and this letter template is used to send a letter to a person that is connected to two opportunities, then fields from both connected items will be inserted into the letter, one field per line. The fields for each connected item appear in the order you specify in the template, but the order in which the connected items are displayed is determined by Commence.

Using Field Codes in Actions

[See Also](#)

Using Field Codes, you can insert values from the [trigger](#) or [condition item](#) into your [action](#) specifications.

For example, if you have chosen to use a trigger item from the Person/Company [category](#) in a [Status Bar Message](#) action, you can use values from any [field](#) in that category in the action specification. Thus you could display the name of a Person or Company item in the status bar message.

The concept here is the same as that used in a letter template. You define a letter template including Field Codes from a particular category. When the template is used to create a letter to a specific person, the Field Codes are replaced with the actual values from the person's data item. The same kind of substitution process happens when an agent operates. The agent definition (in particular the action specifications) determines which substitutions take place when the agent operates.

You can use a value from the trigger or condition item(s) in any text field in an action specification. This includes **Status Bar Message** text, **Message Box** text, text field values for **Add Item** and **Edit Item** items, **Application Launch** command lines and **Send DDE** messages. In all cases, inserting a Field Code in the action specification will cause a field value substitution when the agent operates.

Field Codes are simply the name of the field enclosed in parentheses and percent characters: (%Field Name%). For example, to use the name from an item in the text of a status line action, the Field Code (%Name%) would be inserted in the text. If you know the field names available from the trigger or condition data you have chosen, you can just type in the Field Code.

However, it is easier and probably less error prone to select the Field Codes from a list. You can display this list by selecting the **Insert Field** button on an action specification. The list includes all the fields that are available for the trigger or condition item being used for that action.

If you have selected a trigger item from all categories, the **Insert Field** button is not shown since Commence doesn't know the category of the item that will be passed. However, you can still type in Field Codes manually. If the Field Codes correspond to fields in the trigger item passed when the agent fires, the value will be substituted. For example, virtually all categories have a Name field, so the Field Code (%Name%) usually produces a useful value.

There are four special Field Codes that can be used with any category. The (-Date-) Code will generate the current date (that is the date at the time the agent operates). Similarly, the (-Time-) Field Code will generate the current time. The (-Category-) Field Code will insert the name of the category of the trigger or condition item.

The (-TrigItemName-) Field Code is resolved to the item name of the trigger item. If there is no trigger item, then the keyword translates to a zero length string. This keyword is useful when you want to create an agent that uses the trigger item name and values of the condition item fields in the action. To do this, select **Condition 1** or **Condition 2** in the **Using Values From** radio group of the **Add/Edit Action** dialog box. Then select the **Field Values** button to display the **Field Values** dialog box. You can use the keyword (-TrigItemName-) in the **Value** text box along with field names from the condition category.

For example, you can create an agent that has a Person item as a trigger, with a condition

to select all overdue To-Dos. The action can delegate all of these To-Dos to the highlighted person by selecting the Assigned to Person connection and typing "(-TrigItemName-)" into the **Value** text box.

If you are using an **Add Item** or **Edit Item** action, then Date fields can be edited using Field Codes. You can also enter dates like "Today" or "Next Monday" in a data item date field within an action. When the agent operates, the appropriate date will be entered into the fields. You can also use the dates from the trigger or condition item(s) by inserting Field Codes for the date

field that you want to reference. Finally, you can even combine date Field Codes with date operations to create new dates. For example: "5 days from (%StartDate%)" will create a date that is 5 days after the date in the "Start Date" field of the trigger item.

The Agent Bar

The agent tool bar is reserved for displaying user-selected buttons for tool bar [agents](#). You can add your own buttons to the tool bar by defining an agent with a [Tool Bar Pick trigger](#); see [Customize-Database-Agent](#).

Help-Context-Sensitive

Use this command to access Commence's on-line help system for help on a specific menu command or screen region without going through the [Help-Index](#) command.

Context-sensitive help lets both keyboard and mouse users get help on a specific command or screen region.

Context-sensitive help is available:

- for menu commands and screen regions
- for [dialog boxes](#) and message boxes

Getting Help on Menu Commands and Screen Regions

If there is no active dialog or message box, keyboard and mouse users access context-sensitive help as described in the next two subsections.

MOUSE USERS

If you have a mouse connected to your computer, you can get help on menu commands and screen regions by:

- Hover over the command with your mouse
- Press SHIFT+F1

When you point at a screen object (such as a button on the command bar) and then click Shift+F1, Commence displays a help topic that explains the object or command.

Exit the help topic by selecting ALT+F4 or **File-Close** from the help screen's menu bar.

Getting Help on Dialog and Message Boxes

If a dialog or message box is displayed, press F1 or SHIFT-F1 to display a help topic from the Commence Help System that describes the dialog box or message box (including error messages) in detail. Exit the help topic by selecting **ALT+F4** or **File-Close** from the help screen's menu bar.

Day Display Mode

The Day display mode provides:

DAY TITLES

Day titles are displayed at the top of the daily calendar just above the graphical display of time slots. Day titles are appointments or events that are scheduled for a day but do not have a start or end time. An example of a day title is "Anniversary". An arrow immediately to the right of the day title shows that there are more day titles for the day being displayed.

MONTHLY CALENDARS

The mini-month calendars are displayed on the right side of a calendar [view](#). The current monthly calendar display changes as you change the display using the calendar controls on the [Calendar Tool Bar](#). The [active date](#) is framed in a small rectangle. The calendar weeks are arranged according to the preference you set for the beginning day of the week using the [Edit-Preferences](#) command and clicking on the **Calendar** [tab](#).

LEGEND

A small window that explains the color coding scheme used in the busy bars. You can toggle the display of the legend by selecting the Legend button on the **Calendar Tool Bar** or by selecting the [Customize-Design View](#) command, selecting the **Color** [tab](#), and marking the **Show Legend** [checkbox](#). You can change the color coding scheme used by a calendar view by selecting a different color coding template on the **Color** [tab dialog box](#). You can create new color coding templates using the [Customize-Database](#) command and selecting the **Color Code** [tab](#).

Appointment Controls

The rest of the day calendar displays appointments that are scheduled for particular start times. The daily calendar shows as

many appointments as can fit in the current window size. If you make the window larger, the number of time slots displayed increases with the window size.

TIME SLOTS

Time intervals are labeled in this column by their start time. You can change the interval between time slots, and the time displayed in the top-most slot using the **Customize-Design View** command and then selecting the **Display** tab; The time is displayed in the format you set through the Windows Control Panel. The number of time slots displayed depends with on the window size (See above).

ITEM NAME SLOTS

The fields that are displayed for a scheduled item can be changed using the **Customize-Design View** command and selecting the **Fields** tab. These fields are displayed in the slot corresponding to the start time of the item. To display the [item detail](#) for an item in a time slot in Day display mode, double-click the mouse on the item name.

SCROLL BAR

Allows you to browse through the items not in the currently displayed time interval. Use the arrows and box in the scroll bar to move through the day's scheduled items. You can also use the **Page Up** and **Page Down** keys for the same purpose.

Using Appointments with Day Display Mode

This section describes how to add, view, move, copy, edit and delete appointments using a Calendar view in Day display mode.

Note: For keyboard users, highlighting an item or date and pressing the **Space Bar** is equivalent to double clicking the mouse button on an item.

Adding Appointments

Double click on a time slot. Commence displays the **Add Item** screen with the **Date** and **Start Time** set to the date and start time you selected. For example, if you double click on the 5:00pm time slot for Tuesday, 5/6/09, the **Date** will be set to 5/6/09 and the **Start Time** will be set to 5:00 p.m. To change one or both values, type over the information in the appropriate edit box.

To add a Day Title (an appointment with no start or end time), double click in the blank slot located at the top of the calendar below the Date Toolbar. The **Start Time** will default to the current system time; clear this value so that both the start and end times are blank.

Note: To add an appointment to your calendar regardless of the calendar mode: Enter **Ctrl + A** or select the **Add** button on the [tool bar](#).

Drag an item from a view of any other category over your calendar. If you drop the item over a time slot, it will be scheduled for that time slot. If you drop it over an area without a time, it will be added as a [Day Title](#). Commence will automatically connect the newly added appointment to the item you copied from another category. See [Drag and Drop](#) for more information.

Viewing and Editing Appointments

To display the [item detail](#) for an item in a time slot in the Day display mode, double-click the mouse on the item name, or highlight the time slot and press the **Enter** key. If multiple items are scheduled for the same time slot, the [Select Item](#) dialog box is displayed from which you select the item name of the item you want to display.

Moving and Copying Appointments

To move an appointment drag the item to another day or time slot. To move an appointment using the keyboard, highlight the item and select the [Edit-Edit Item](#) command.

To copy an appointment hold down the **Crtl** key when you select the item and drag the item to another day or time slot. To copy an appointment using the keyboard, highlight the item and select the [Edit-Copy Item](#) command.

See [Drag and Drop](#) for more information.

Deleting Appointments

To delete an appointment drag the item to the **Delete** button on the tool bar or highlight the item and select the [Edit-Delete Item](#) command, the **Delete** button on the [tool bar](#), or the **Delete** key.

Two Days Display Mode

Two days display mode shows as many of the day's items as possible for the current day of the week and the next day. If a day has more items than can be displayed in the window size, a down arrow appears at the bottom right corner of the day's rectangle. You can re-size the window to display more items per day.

To switch to a different display mode of the Calendar view, click the *right* mouse button over the day's date. Choose **Display Mode** from the right-click menu that appears, then select another display mode from the list. You can also left click on Display mode drop-down list on the calendar tool bar.

Note: For keyboard users, highlighting a date and pressing the **Space Bar** will switch to the day display mode. From there you can select any item on that day.

Using Appointments with Two Days Display Mode

This section describes how to add, view, move, copy, edit and delete appointments using a Calendar view in 2 days display mode.

Adding Appointments

Double click the mouse on any blank space within the day rectangle. An **Add Item** screen is displayed.

Note: To add an appointment to your calendar regardless of the calendar mode: Enter **Ctrl + A** or select the **Add** button on the [tool bar](#).

Drag an item from a view of any other category over your two day calendar, it will be added as a [Day Title](#). Commence will automatically connect the newly added appointment to the item you copied from another category. See [Drag and Drop](#) for more information.

Viewing and Editing Appointments

To display the [item detail](#) for an item in the 2 day calendar, double-click the mouse on the item name, or highlight the item name and press the **Enter** key.

Moving and Copying Appointments

To move an appointment drag the item to another day. If you drop it on a time slot in day mode, Commence will change its start time as well as its date. If you drop it on a date, its start time remains the same. To move an appointment using the keyboard, highlight the item and select the [Edit-Edit Item](#) command.

To copy an appointment hold down the **Ctrl** key when you select the item and drag the item to another day. To copy an appointment using the keyboard, highlight the item and select the [Edit-Copy Item](#) command.

See [Drag and Drop](#) for more information.

Deleting Appointments

To delete an appointment drag the item to the **Delete** button on the tool bar or double click on the item to display the Item Detail, and then select [Edit-Delete Item](#) command or the **Delete** button on the [tool bar](#).

Week Display Mode

Week display mode shows as many of the day's items as possible for each day of the week in which the [active date](#) occurs. If a day has more items than can be displayed in the current window size, a down arrow appears at the bottom right corner of the day's rectangle. Click the arrow to switch to the day display mode where more items can be displayed. You can re-size the window to display more items per day.

To switch to another display mode of the Calendar view, click the *right* mouse button over the day's date. Choose **Display Mode** from the right-click menu that appears, then select another display mode from the list. You can also left click on Display mode drop-down list on the calendar tool bar.

Using Appointments with Week Display Mode

This section describes how to add, view, move, copy, edit and delete appointments using a Calendar view in Week display mode.

Note: For keyboard users, highlighting an item or date and pressing the **Space Bar** will switch to the day display mode. From there you can select any item on that day.

Adding Appointments

Double click the mouse on any blank space within the day (or week) rectangle. An **Add Item** screen is displayed.

Note: To add an appointment to your calendar regardless of the calendar mode: Enter **Ctrl + A** or select the **Add** button on the [tool bar](#).

Drag an item from a view of any other category over your weekly calendar, it will be added as a [Day Title](#). Commence will automatically connect the newly added appointment to the item you copied from another category. See [Drag and Drop](#) for more information.

Viewing and Editing Appointments

To display the [item detail](#) for an item in the Week display mode, double-click the mouse on the item name, or highlight the item name and press the **Enter** key.

Moving and Copying Appointments

To move an appointment drag the item to another day. If you drop it on a time slot in day mode, Commence will change its start time as well as its date. If you drop it on a date, its start time remains the same. To move an appointment using the keyboard, highlight the item and select the [Edit-Edit Item](#) command.

To copy an appointment hold down the **Crtl** key when you select the item and drag the item to another day. To copy an appointment using the keyboard, highlight the item and select the [Edit-Copy Item](#) command.

See [Drag and Drop](#) for more information.

Deleting Appointments

To delete an appointment drag the item to the **Delete** button on the tool bar or double click on the item to display the Item Detail, and then select [Edit-Delete Item](#) command or the **Delete** button on the [tool bar](#).

Two Weeks Display Mode

Two Weeks display mode shows as many of the day's items as possible for each day of the current and the next week in which the [active date](#) occurs. If a day has more items than can be displayed in the current window size, a down arrow appears at the bottom right corner of the day's rectangle. You can re-size the window to display more items per day.

To switch to another display mode of the Calendar view, click the *right* mouse button over the day's date. Choose **Display Mode** from the right-click menu that appears, then select another display mode from the list. You can also left click on Display mode drop-down list on the calendar tool bar.

Note: For keyboard users, highlighting an item or date and pressing the **Space Bar** will switch to the day display mode. From there you can select any item on that day.

Using Appointments with Two Weeks Display Mode

This section describes how to add, view, move, copy, edit and delete appointments using a Calendar view in 2 Weeks display mode.

Adding Appointments

Double click the mouse on any blank space within the day (or week) rectangle. An **Add Item** screen is displayed.

Note: To add an appointment to your calendar regardless of the calendar mode: Enter **Ctrl + A** or select the **Add** button on the [tool bar](#).

Drag an item from a view of any other category over your weekly calendar, it will be added as a [Day Title](#). Commence will automatically connect the newly added appointment to the item you copied from another category. See [Drag and Drop](#) for more information.

Viewing and Editing Appointments

To display the [item detail](#) for an item in the 2 Weeks display mode, double-click the mouse on the item name, or highlight the item name and press the **Enter** key.

Moving and Copying Appointments

To move an appointment drag the item to another day. If you drop it on a time slot in day mode, Commence will change its start time as well as its date. If you drop it on a date, its start time remains the same. To move an appointment using the keyboard, highlight the item and select the [Edit-Edit Item](#) command.

To copy an appointment hold down the **Ctrl** key when you select the item and drag the item to another day. To copy an appointment using the keyboard, highlight the item and select the [Edit-Copy Item](#) command.

See [Drag and Drop](#) for more information.

Deleting Appointments

To delete an appointment drag the item to the **Delete** button on the tool bar or double click on the item to display the Item Detail, and then select [Edit-Delete Item](#) command or the **Delete** button on the [tool bar](#).

Month Display Mode

Month display mode shows as many of the day's items as possible for each day of the month in which the [active date](#) occurs. If a day has more items than can be displayed in the current window size, a down arrow appears at the bottom of the day's rectangle. Click the arrow to switch to the day display mode where more items can be displayed. Alternatively you can re-size the window to display more items per day.

To switch to a day Calendar view, click the left mouse button over a date and then select another display mode from the tool bar drop down list.

Note: For keyboard users, highlighting an item or date and pressing the **Space Bar** will switch to the day display mode. From there you can select any item on that day.

Using Appointments with Month Display Mode

This section describes how to add, view, move, copy, edit and delete appointments using a Calendar view in Month display mode.

Adding Appointments

Double click the mouse on any blank space within the day (or week) rectangle. An **Add Item** screen is displayed.

Note: To add an appointment to your calendar regardless of the calendar mode: Enter **Ctrl + A** or select the **Add** button on the [tool bar](#).

Drag an item from a view of any other category over your monthly calendar, it will be added as a Day Title. Commence will automatically connect the newly added appointment to the item you copied from another category. See [Drag and Drop](#) for more information.

Viewing and Editing Appointments

To display the [item detail](#) for an item in the Month display mode, double-click the mouse on the item name, or highlight the item name and press the **Enter** key.

Moving and Copying Appointments

To move an appointment drag the item to another day. If you drop it on a time slot in day mode, Commence will change its start time as well as its date. If you drop it on a date, its start time remains the same. To move an appointment using the keyboard, highlight the item and select the [Edit-Edit Item](#) command.

To copy an appointment hold down the **Ctrl** key when you select the item and drag the item to another day. To copy an appointment using the keyboard, highlight the item and select the [Edit-Copy Item](#) command.

See **Drag and Drop** for more information.

Deleting Appointments

To delete an appointment drag the item to the **Delete** button on the tool bar or double click on the item to display the Item Detail, and then select [Edit-Delete Item](#) command or the **Delete** button on the [tool bar](#).

Six Weeks Display Mode

Six Weeks display mode shows as many of the day's items as possible for each day the next six weeks, starting with the current week in which the [active date](#) occurs. If a day has more items than can be displayed in the current window size, a down arrow appears at the bottom of the day's rectangle. You can re-size the window to display more items per day.

To switch to a day Calendar view, click the left mouse button over a date and then select another display mode from the tool bar drop down list.

Note: For keyboard users, highlighting an item or date and pressing the **Space Bar** will switch to the day display mode. From there you can select any item on that day.

Using Appointments with Six Weeks Display Mode

This section describes how to add, view, move, copy, edit and delete appointments using a Calendar view in 6 Weeks display mode.

Adding Appointments

Double click the mouse on any blank space within the day (or week) rectangle. An **Add Item** screen is displayed.

Note: To add an appointment to your calendar regardless of the calendar mode: Enter **Ctrl + A** or select the **Add** button on the [tool bar](#).

Drag an item from a view of any other category over your 6 week calendar, it will be added as a Day Title. Commence will automatically connect the newly added appointment to the item you copied from another category. See [Drag and Drop](#) for more information.

Viewing and Editing Appointments

To display the [item detail](#) for an item in the 6 Weeks display mode, double-click the mouse on the item name, or highlight

the item name and press the **Enter** key.

Moving and Copying Appointments

To move an appointment drag the item to another day. If you drop it on a time slot in day mode, Commence will change its start time as well as its date. If you drop it on a date, its start time remains the same. To move an appointment using the keyboard, highlight the item and select the [Edit-Edit Item](#) command.

To copy an appointment hold down the **Ctrl** key when you select the item and drag the item to another day. To copy an appointment using the keyboard, highlight the item and select the [Edit-Copy Item](#) command.

See **Drag and Drop** for more information.

Deleting Appointments

To delete an appointment drag the item to the **Delete** button on the tool bar or double click on the item to display the Item Detail, and then select [Edit-Delete Item](#) command or the **Delete** button on the [tool bar](#).

Grid Display Mode

Grid mode allows you to see the items in the calendar for a particular day in a columnar format based on the time of the item and a connection to the item. For example, you can set up your calendar grid mode to show all the appointments that are connected to you and up to 7 other people (for a total of 8).

Using Appointments with Grid Display Mode

This section describes how to add, view, move, copy, edit and delete appointments using a Calendar view in Grid display mode.

Note: For keyboard users, highlighting an item or date and pressing the **Space Bar** is equivalent to double clicking the mouse button on an item.

Adding Appointments

Double click on an empty time slot. Commence displays the **Add Item** screen with the **Date** and **Start Time** set to the date and start time you selected and will automatically be connected to the item at the top of the column. For example, if you double click on Tuesday, 5/6/97, at 5:00 p.m., the **Date** will be set to 5/6/97 and the **Start Time** will be set to 5:00 p.m. To change one or both values, type over the information in the appropriate edit box.

Note: To add an appointment to your calendar regardless of the calendar mode: Enter **Ctrl + A** or select the **Add** button on the [tool bar](#).

Drag an item from a view of any other category over your calendar. If you drop the item over a time slot, it will be scheduled for that time slot and connected to the item shown at the top of the column. Commence will automatically connect the newly added appointment to the item you copied from another category. See [Drag and Drop](#) for more information.

Viewing and Editing Appointments

To display the [item detail](#) for an item in a time slot in the Day display mode, double-click the mouse on the item name, or highlight the time slot and press the **Enter** key. If multiple items are scheduled for the same time slot, the [Select Item](#) dialog box is displayed from which you select the item name of the item you want to display.

Moving and Copying Appointments

To move an appointment drag the item to another day or time slot. To move an appointment using the keyboard, highlight the item and select the [Edit-Edit Item](#) command.

To copy an appointment hold down the **Ctrl** key when you select the item and drag the item to another day or time slot. To copy an appointment using the keyboard, highlight the item and select the [Edit-Copy Item](#) command.

See [Drag and Drop](#) for more information.

Deleting Appointments

To delete an appointment drag the item to the **Delete** button on the tool bar or highlight the item and select the [Edit-Delete Item](#) command, the **Delete** button on the [tool bar](#), or the **Delete** key.

Year Display Mode

The Year display mode shows all the dates for the active year by displaying twelve monthly calendars. If you re-size the year mode window, the calendar will re-size also. To switch to a day Calendar view, double click the *right* mouse button over the day's date. You can also click the left mouse button over a date and then select another display mode from the drop down list on the tool bar.

Using Appointments with Year Display Mode

This section describes how to add, view, move, copy, edit and delete appointments using a Calendar view in Year display mode.

Note: For keyboard users, highlighting an item or date and pressing the **Space Bar** is equivalent to double clicking the mouse button on an item.

Adding Appointments

Double click the mouse on the date to display the [Calendar Items](#) dialog box. Then select the **Add** button on the dialog box to display an **Add Item** screen.

Note: To add an appointment to your calendar regardless of the calendar mode: Enter **Ctrl + A** or select the **Add** button on the [tool bar](#).

Drag an item from a view of any other category over your yearly calendar, it will be added as a Day Title. Commence will automatically connect the newly added appointment to the item you copied from another category. See [Drag and Drop](#) for more information.

Viewing and Editing Appointments

To display the [item detail](#) for an item in the Year display mode double click on the date to display the **Calendar Items** dialog box, from which you select the item name of the item you want to display and then select the **Edit** button in the dialog box.

Moving and Copying Appointments

To move or copy an appointment double click on the date to display the **Calendar Items** dialog box. Then highlight the item and then select the **Edit** button in the dialog box.

Deleting Appointments

To delete an appointment double click on the date to display the **Calendar Items** dialog box. Then highlight the item and then select the **Delete** button in the dialog box.

Form Properties Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#), accessed by selecting Edit-Properties on the [Design Detail Form](#) dialog box, allows you to set attributes for the active tab page of the detail form.

A form that has been created by Commence (i.e., one delivered with Commence or one created by Commence for a new category) will be set up to use the default form options.

CAPTION

Change the tab label by typing in a new description into the **Caption** text box.

FONTNAME

To change the font style for the tab label, click the button next to the FontName property. You can change the font, font size, font style (bold, italic, etc.), color, or effects (underline, etc.) all from this screen.

FONTSIZE

The font size for the tab label is easily set using the FontName property. If the specific font size you want is not available when setting the FontName property, you can override the size setting by manually entering the point size in this box. (e.g. 8.25)

BACKCOLOR

The **Background Color** box lets you reset the color of the form's background using virtually any color available on your PC. Click the ellipse button and a color palette will be displayed. Choose a system color based on your Windows Control Panel settings, or choose a basic color from the palette. If the desired color is not shown, it may be created by selecting the **Define Custom Colors >>** button from the color palette. This color will be used everywhere there isn't a label or a field. Select **Apply** to save your changes and return to the **Design Detail Form** dialog box.

You can also customize the tab pages of a form by adding, editing, and deleting tabs. See [Working with Detail Form Tabs](#) for more information.

Customize-Design View-Fields Tab (Report and Grid Views)

[See Also](#)

Selecting the [Customize-Design View](#) command while a report or grid [view](#) is the [active view](#) displays the Design View tab.

Use the **Fields** tab to choose the [fields](#) to appear in the view and set field options as explained below. If you select a [connection](#) name to appear in the view, you can choose a field from the connected category. The available options on the [Fields tab for a Report Viewer](#) differ slightly.

The **Fields in Report** and **Fields Not In Report** [list boxes](#) show the list of fields (including connection definitions) that appear in the view and those that don't appear in the view, respectively.

The **Fields in Report** list box displays field names in the order in which the fields appear in the view.

To append a field to the list of fields in the view (making the new field the last field listed in the view), highlight the field name in the **Fields Not In Report** list box and select the **Append Field** button.

Shortcut: Double-click the mouse on a field in the **Fields Not In Report** list box to append it to the **Fields In Report** list without selecting the **Append Field** button.

To insert a field into the list of fields in the view, highlight a field name in the **Fields Not In Report** list box and highlight the position where you want the field inserted in the **Fields In Report** list box. Then, select the **Insert Field** button.

If the field you select is a connection definition, you can choose to display any of the fields from the connected item in the view. For example, you could show the name and phone number of each person assigned to a To-Do item by highlighting **Assigned to Person** in the **Fields Not In Report** list box and selecting either the **Insert Field** or **Append Field** button. Commence displays a list box containing the list of fields in the connected category. Select the name and phone number fields, one field at a time, from the list. Note that connection definitions in the connected category are not displayed in the list box. You can only display

items that are directly connected to the category the view is defined for.

To remove a field from the view, highlight the field name in the **Fields In Report** list box and select the **Remove Field** button.

Shortcut: Double-click the mouse on a field in the **Fields In Report** list box to remove it without selecting the **Remove Field** button.

You can also combine fields in the view by selecting the [Combine Fields](#) button and then selecting the desired fields.

Any changes you make to the design are temporary unless you use [Views-Save View](#) or [Views-Save View As](#) to save the changed view.

Select Font Dialog Box

Type a font name and font size in the **Font Name** and **Font Size** text boxes, or select from the associated [drop-down list boxes](#). The valid font names and sizes in the list box reflect the fonts you have installed in Windows.

You can also change the font style to Bold, Italic and/or Underline by selecting the appropriate [check boxes](#).

The **Font Appearance** box shows you what the selected font and style look like.

Select **OK** once you've made your selections; you are returned to the [dialog box](#) from which this window was invoked.

Letter Template Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) appears when you select either the **Add Text** button or the **Edit** button (with a text template highlighted) on the [Letter Template](#) tab.

Select the topic below that matches the button you pressed:

[Adding a Text Template](#)

[Editing a Text Template](#)

Adding a Formatted Letter Template

[See Also](#)

To add a new [formatted letter template](#), select the **Add Formatted** button on the [Letter Template](#) tab. This displays the **Add Formatted Template** dialog box.

Type a brief description for the new template in the **Template Name** [text box](#).

Use the **For Category** [drop-down list box](#) to select the category that you want the template to be used with.

Finally, select the **Create Template** button to start up your word processor with the new (empty) template file.

If you are using Word 2000 or later version, you are prompted for the type of letter template to be created. Select the proper format. This determines how the template will look.

You can enter [Field Codes](#) into the template by using the **Commence** toolbar. Again, this assumes that you have installed the required letter macros for your word processor.

You can format the template file using any features that are available in your word processor: multiple fonts, page numbering, date fields, bookmarks, embedded graphics, etc. When you are satisfied with the template, save it, being sure to keep the original filename so that Commence can locate the template when it needs it to send letters.

Editing a Formatted Letter Template

To edit a [formatted letter template](#), select the **Edit** button on the [Letter Template tab](#) with a formatted template highlighted. This displays the **Edit Formatted Template** dialog box.

File Name shows you the filename of the letter template file. This file is stored in the **tmpls** subdirectory of the current database. Do not change the name of this file when editing the letter template.

To change the description of the template, use the **Template Name** [text box](#).

If you want to use the template with a different category, select the new category with the **For Category** [drop-down list box](#).

Note: If you change the category, the old [Field Codes](#) may not properly map into the new category specified (unless the field names were identical in both categories). You will need to select the **View** button to edit the template and run the appropriate macro for your Word Processor to insert the field codes for the new category. Then save the template. See [Using Field Codes in Templates](#) for instructions on how to insert field codes in templates.

If you select **Save**, then any changes you have made to the [category](#) or template name will be saved. If you select **Cancel**, the template will be left unchanged.

If you want to change the contents of the template file, select the **View** button. If you have changed the category or name, these changes will automatically be saved. Commence then launches your word processor and opens the template file. Use the word processor to make any changes to the template file (new text, Field Codes, formatting, etc.).

Add/Edit Trigger Dialog Box

Selecting the **T** button under **If this Trigger occurs** in the [New Agent](#) or [Edit Agent dialog box](#) brings up the **Add Trigger** dialog box. If you are editing an existing [trigger](#), then the [title bar](#) of the dialog box says **Edit Trigger** and the details of the existing trigger appear in the box. The controls and operation of the two boxes are identical.

The same dialog box is used for all triggers, but its contents vary depending on what you highlight in the **Trigger Type** list on the left hand side of the box. As you select a different trigger type, the right hand side of the box changes to present the options appropriate for the trigger type you have highlighted. Also, when you highlight a different **Trigger Type** a brief description of the trigger you have selected is shown under the list box.

If you select the **Clear** button in the **Add Trigger** or **Edit Trigger** dialog box, the options for the current trigger are cleared. The **OK** button returns you to the previous dialog box (**New Agent** or **Edit Agent**) and saves the trigger values you have defined. The **Cancel** command restores the previous trigger options (if any).

These are the triggers that you can use in Commence agents:

[Commence Event](#)

Fires when Commence starts or exits

[Incoming Communication](#)

Fires when a telephone call or E-Mail message is received

[Item Alarm](#)

Fires before a data [item](#) becomes current [Keyboard Hotkey](#)

Fires when you select a specific keyboard hotkey combination

[Menu Pick](#)

Fires when you select the associated menu pick from the [Tools menu](#)

Receive DDE

Receive parameterized data from other Windows applications and pass this data to the agent's actions [Save Item](#)

Fires when a data item is saved (added and/or edited)

Timer

Fires at predefined times

Tool Bar Pick

Fires when you select the associated button on the [tool bar](#)

Add/Edit Condition Dialog Box

To add, edit or delete a [condition](#) for an [agent](#), select one of the two condition buttons (**1** or **2**) on the [New Agent](#) or [Edit Agent dialog boxes](#).

Every agent can have up to two conditions in addition to its [trigger](#). Conditions place further qualifications on the initiation of an agent, or identify other items for the agent's actions to operate on. The **Time Interval** condition is only useful in the former mode: it simply provides an additional test to determine if the agent should be invoked. **Item Count** and **Field Summary** conditions can be used both to further define the agent initiation and to select condition items.

If you are adding a new condition, the **Add Condition** dialog box appears. If you are editing an existing trigger, then the **Edit Condition** box will appear. The controls and operation of the two boxes are identical. The same dialog box is used for all conditions, but its contents vary depending on what you highlight in the **Condition Type** list on the left hand side of the box. This dialog box lets you set the options for any condition type.

As you select different conditions, a brief description of the condition you have selected is shown under the list box.

If you select **Clear** in the **Add Condition** or **Edit Condition** box, the values for the current condition are cleared. The **OK** button saves the values, and the **Cancel** button restores the previous values (in an edit situation).

The three conditions available for use in Commence's Agents are the following:

[Field Summary Condition](#)

True based on a calculated value summarized across items
[Item Count](#)

True based on the number of item meeting its criteria [Time Interval](#)

True for specified date/time intervals

Clear

[See Also](#)

You have cleared the trigger, condition, or action that you were working on.

If you are editing an agent, select the same **Trigger**, **Condition**, or **Action Type** again to see the original definition.

Otherwise, select a new **Type** from the list box, or select one of the **OK** or **Cancel** buttons.

Add Item Action

The **Add Item** [action](#) creates a new [item](#), optionally using values in the new item from a [trigger](#) or [condition](#) item.

Select the [category](#) that the new item will be added to using the **Category** [drop-down list box](#) under **Add Items To**.

When you select the **Field Values** button, you are presented with a [Field Values dialog box](#) that lets you specify the field values for the new data item using text that you supply, default values for the category (if you leave the field blank), or Field Codes from the trigger or condition item.

Note that if the values for an **Add Item** action are taken from the trigger item, then the action creates a single data item. However, if an **Add Item** action uses condition items, it produces a new item for every item in the set of condition items passed to it.

If you select the **Display Item(s)** [check box](#), then the item(s) that you add are displayed when the agent operates. You can then manually add or edit the fields of the new item before it is saved. If you don't select **Display Item(s)**, Commence does all the work for you automatically. If you are displaying items, you can also specify the form that is used for the item detail using the **Form** drop-down list box. If condition data is being used (so that multiple items can be generated), a view of the new items is displayed. If you don't select the **Display Item(s)** check box, then **Form** is grayed out.

If you select the **Connect to Selected Item(s)** check box, then the new item is connected to the trigger or condition item using any available connection definition. This check box is available even in the case when the category of the incoming trigger item is unspecified. (For example, when using a trigger item from a **Menu Pick** trigger that is not associated with a specific category.)

Application Launch Action

The **Application Launch** [action](#) can start up another Windows application and pass it command line data.

In the **Run** area, use the **Program:** text box to enter the command line text (the command line specifies the application executable). If the application executable is in your path, you can just enter the filename (e.g., write.exe), otherwise enter the full path (e.g., c:\program files\microsoft office\office11\winword.exe).

If there are any command line arguments that are to be passed to the executable, enter them in the **Argument:** text box. The command line text can contain Field Codes from the selected [trigger](#) or [condition item](#).

If you want to browse your PC file system to locate the application path and insert it into the text box, use the **Select** button. Use the **Insert Field** button to insert valid Field Codes from the trigger or condition item(s).

By selecting the corresponding option in the **Mode** drop-down list, the application can be started in **Normal** mode (a standard window with the focus), **Maximized** (a full screen window with the focus), or **Minimized** (an icon without the focus, useful for background processing).

Backup Action

The **Backup** [action](#) creates a backup of your open database.

When this action is performed, it does a full backup of the database as if the **Backup** button had been selected from the [File-Open/Manage Database](#) dialog box.

When you highlight the **Backup** action type, the **Backup to** [group box](#) appears on the right side of the dialog box. Type in the name of the file to hold your backup data.

Note: If you would like to store the backup file on a diskette, specify **a:** in front of the filename in the group box.

Create E-Mail Action The Create E-Mail [action](#) creates and sends an electronic mail message. Before defining the actual message, you must choose whether the category containing the recipient's name will come from the trigger or condition data. This selection is made using the "To Recipients Specified Using:" radio group.

If your Create E-Mail action is defined with "To Recipients Specified Using: *Trigger*", one e-mail message will be created when the agent fires. If your Create E-Mail action is defined with "To Recipients Specified Using: *Condition 1 or 2*", one e-mail message will be sent for each item matching the condition.

Once this selection has been made, it is time to proceed to the [Define E-Mail](#) dialog box. This dialog box appears when the **Define Message** button is selected.

Delete Item Action The Delete Item [action](#) deletes one [item](#) when using values from the [trigger](#). This is equivalent to the [Edit-Delete Item](#) command.

When using values from a [condition](#) item, the **Delete Item** action deletes **ALL** the items which meet the condition. This is equivalent to the [Edit-Delete All Items](#) command.

Use this action carefully. You will not be presented with a confirmation message. The items will be deleted automatically.

Edit Item Action

The **Edit Item** [action](#) edits data [items](#), either the single [trigger](#) item or multiple items from one of the [conditions](#). When you select the **Field Values** button, Commence displays the [Field Values dialog box](#) that lets you specify the field values for the edited data item using text that you supply and/or Field Codes from the unedited values.

If you select the **Display Item(s)** [check box](#), then the item(s) that you edit are displayed when the agent operates. If you are displaying items, you can also specify the form to use for the item detail by using the **Form** [drop-down list box](#). If you do not select the **Display Item(s)** check box, then the **Form** drop-down list box will be grayed out.

If the values for an **Item Edit/Display** action are taken from the trigger item, then the action edits a single data item. However, if an **Item Edit/Display** action uses condition items, it edits all the items in the condition set. When multiple items are edited, a report view of the edited items is displayed if you select the **Display Item(s)** check box.

Note that the **Item Edit/Display** action requires selection of either a trigger or a condition from a specific [category](#).

Export Action

The **Export** [action](#) exports data from your open database to a pre-selected import/export file using a pre-selected template.

Note: Before defining this agent, make sure you already have an appropriate export template defined. If you do not, use the [Customize-Database-Import/Export](#) command to do so.

When you highlight the **Export** action type in the [Add or Edit Action](#) dialog box, the **Export Items From group boxes** appear on the right side of the dialog box. Use these group boxes to choose the items to export, to select an import/export template and to enter the name of an export file.

The **DOS Text** [checkbox](#) allows you to translate between the Windows standard character set and the DOS character set. If you are sharing information between Commence and other Windows applications, leave this box unchecked. If you are sharing information between Commence and other applications that run in DOS but are not designed specifically for Windows, you should check this box.

The **Archive after Export** [check box](#) allows you to delete all items that have been exported from your database.

Caution: Use this option only to archive and delete items you no longer need in your database.

Import Action

The **Import** [action](#) imports data from a pre-selected import/export file to your open database using a pre-selected template.

Note: Before defining this agent, make sure you already have an appropriate import template defined. If you do not, use the [File-Import](#) command to do so.

When you highlight the **Import** action type in the [Add or Edit Action](#) dialog box, the **Import Using** [group box](#) appears on the right side of the dialog box. Use this group box to select an import/export template and to enter the name of an import file.

The **DOS Text** [checkbox](#) allows you to translate between the Windows standard character set and the DOS character set. If you are sharing information between Commence and other Windows applications, leave this box unchecked. If you are sharing information between Commence and other applications that run in DOS but are not designed specifically for Windows, you should check this box.

Manage Desktop Action

The **Manage Desktop** [action](#) allows you to manipulate the views on the active desktop. It also allows you to open another desktop.

Choose one of the following radio buttons:

Cascade Overlaps all normal and maximized views on the desktop. The active view will be placed on top, and all other views will be stacked behind it. Minimized views are left minimized.

Resize All Resizes all views (except minimized views) so that they fit on the active desktop while maintaining the relative proportions and positions of each individual view.

Tile Horizontally Re-positions all normal and maximized views on the desktop. The active view will be placed on top, and all other views will be arranged under the active view. Minimized views are left minimized.

Tile Vertically Re-positions all normal and maximized views on the desktop. The active view will be positioned left-most on the desktop, and all other views will be arranged side-by-side to the right of the active view. Minimized views are left minimized.

Close All Closes all views, including minimized views.

Open Desktop Switches to the specified desktop.

If you select the **Open Desktop** option, you must also select the desktop you wish to open from the drop-down list box.

Message Box Action

The **Message Box** [action](#) displays a Commence message box that displays a message and up to four action buttons that allow the user to perform additional actions when the box is displayed. You control the text of the message and the buttons you want to appear in the box (if any).

Enter the text of the message in the **Display Message** [text box](#). The text of the message can contain Field Codes from the selected [trigger](#) or [condition](#) data. If you have selected trigger or condition item(s) from a specific [category](#), the **Insert Field** button will be active. You can then select **Insert Field** to add a Field Code to the **Display Message** text box. When the box is displayed, if you have checked **Audible Alarm**, a tone sounds to further alert you.

Three buttons may appear in any message box displayed by agents: **OK**, **Snooze** and **Snooze All**. If you select the **OK** button in the message box the message box disappears.

Selecting the **Snooze** or **Snooze All** button displays a [Set Snooze Time](#) dialog box that asks for the number of minutes after which you want the message box to reappear. **Snooze** affects only the currently displayed message box, while **Snooze All** affects the current message box and all currently pending message boxes. If you use the **Snooze** button and there are pending messages, the next pending message is displayed after you select the snooze time.

Note: The Message Box snooze alarm works only *within* a Commence session. That is, if you set a snooze time for a message box and then exit Commence, the snooze time is lost and the message box *will not* reappear when you reopen Commence.

The message box can optionally display up to four **Action Buttons**. Each of the **Action Buttons** can in turn invoke an additional sub-action (the full set of actions are available as possible sub-actions, except for **Message Box**). These actions are specified just like other [agent](#) actions, but only the action corresponding to the button you select when the agent executes is performed (i.e., you select one button, the corresponding action is performed, and then the message box exits). If you select the **OK** button in the message box, no action is performed and the message box disappears. If you select one of the action buttons, the corresponding sub-action will be performed.

If the **Message Action** is not the last action for the agent, a **Cancel** button is also displayed in the message box under the **OK** button. Selecting **Cancel** tells Commence to perform none of the sub-actions and cancel the remaining actions not yet performed by the agent.

When you select the **Action Buttons** button in the **Edit Action** or **New Action** [dialog boxes](#), Commence displays the [Message Box Actions](#) dialog box.

New View Action

A **New View** [action](#) creates and displays a new [view](#). The view can show a new view of the [trigger](#) item, the [condition](#) items, or any [category](#). Select the [radio button](#) under **View Items In** to make your choice.

If you select **Category**, a [drop-down list box](#) appears to the right that lets you choose the category you want to view. If you select **Category**, you can also use the **Select Filter** button to bring up [Filters tab](#) and define a [filter](#) for that category.

Select the [view type](#) for the new view using the **View As** drop-down list box. If you select report, you can choose to view the item [names](#) only, or all fields by choosing the corresponding button in the **Report Style** [radio group](#).

The new view action is a convenient way to display condition items in an [agent](#). In addition to being useful in a production agent, it is helpful to check out the operation of new agents.

Open View Action

An **Open View** [action](#) opens an existing [saved view](#). The view to be opened can be selected using the same category as the [trigger](#) item, or the [condition](#) items. Select the [radio button](#) under **Using Values From** to make your choice.

If you prefer, you may select a specific [category](#) to be used every time, regardless of the trigger or conditions. If you select **Category**, a [drop-down list box](#) appears to the right that lets you choose the category you want to view.

Use the **View Name** [drop-down list box](#) under **Open View** to select the view.

Open the view if another copy is already open.

Outlook Sync

This action allows you to automate the synchronization of data with Microsoft Outlook. The Outlook Sync action lets you select Contacts, Calendar, or Tasks for synchronization. If for example Contacts is the only selected application, then only the Contact information will synchronize with Outlook. If the agent is designed to synchronize just one application, this setting is enforced even if other Outlook Application preferences are mapped.

Play Multimedia Action

This action allows you to play multimedia files including sound and video files. If you have the proper hardware and Windows multimedia drivers installed, you can play a special sound or video clip. For example, you can play a special sound to warn you about pending appointments. To define a Play Multimedia action, file in the **File** text box with the path of the multimedia file to be played. You can use the **Select** button to search your PC for the path to a multimedia file. The type of multimedia file is identified by the file's extension. Common multimedia file types include: .WAV (sound files), .AVI (video files), .MID (MIDI files). See the Drivers section in your Windows Control Panel to determine which multimedia capabilities your system has installed.

Print Letter Action

A **Print Letter** [action](#) will generate a new letter based on one of Commence's [text letter templates](#) ([formatted letter templates](#) cannot be used with this action). It is equivalent to using the commands that create and print letters.

The action requires the use of either a [trigger item](#) or [condition](#) items. If you use a trigger item, a single letter is printed for the trigger item (similar to using [Send Letter](#) and selecting the **Merge/No Preview** option). If you use condition items, a letter is printed for each of the condition items (similar to [Send Letter](#)). Select the template to be used for the letter with the **Templates** [drop-down list box](#). The text templates available will be those for the [category](#) of the trigger or condition item(s) that you have selected. Thus you must select trigger or condition item(s) from a specific category to use this action.

You can select the **Log Item** [check box](#) if you wish to have a document log item created for the letter. If you select Log, use the **Item Name** [text box](#) to enter a name for the Log Item. You can insert a Field Code into the Log item name using **Insert Field**. (Keep in mind that Item names are limited to 50 characters: the name is truncated if it exceeds this limit.)

See [Letter File Storage](#) for an explanation of where on your hard disk letters are stored.

If you select the **Send to Printer** [radio button](#), then the letter will be printed. You can enter the number of copies that you want printed in the **Copies** text box. If you select the **Fonts** button, then you will see the [Select Font dialog box](#) that will let you specify the font to be used when the letter is printed.

If you select the **Send to File** radio button, then the letter is saved in a file instead of being printed. Enter the full path and name of the file in the text box below the button. You can use Field Codes in the text box, but be aware that the action will fail if the generated filename is invalid when the agent operates. If you select both **Send to File** and **Log Item** then the document log item will point to the file that you have specified. This option is

useful if you want to create text files that will be passed on to other applications (e.g., electronic mail packages).

The **Send to File** radio button can only be selected if you are using a trigger item (single letters) since condition items would generate multiple letters that could not be saved in a single file. Thus, if you select condition items the **Send to File** radio button is grayed out.

Process E-Mail Action

When used with the trigger, [Incoming Communication](#), this agent action can either delete the incoming E-Mail, or mark the E-Mail as Read. These actions can be performed whether the E-Mail application is running in the background or not.

Send DDE Action

[See Also](#)

A **Send DDE** [action](#) sends a DDE message to another Windows application. Press the **Define Message** button.

PROGRAM. . . GROUP BOX

If you want Commence to start up the other application if it is not already active, turn on the **Run If Necessary** [check box](#) and enter the path of the receiving application in the **File Name** text box. You can browse your PC's file system to find the application and insert its path in the **File Name** text box by using the **Select** button.

CONVERSATION. . . GROUP BOX

Enter the DDE name of the other application in the **Application Name** [text box](#). For Commence, the Application name is *Commence*. Enter the DDE Topic in the **Topic Name** text box. This information can be found in the manual for the other application.

DDE MESSAGE. . . GROUP BOX

You can send a DDE Execute message or a DDE Poke message with data to a Windows application.

To send a DDE Execute message, turn on the **Execute** radio button in the **DDE Message** group box and enter the text of the DDE message in the **Message Text** text box.

To send a DDE Poke message, turn on the **Poke** radio button in the **DDE Message** group box. The message must consist of two parts: the data and an item name . Enter the item name (or similar data identifier, such as row-column number for

spreadsheets) into the **Item Name** text box. Then specify the text of the Poke message in the **Message Text** box.

The DDE message can contain Field Codes from the selected [trigger](#) or [condition](#) item(s). Use the **Insert Field** command to include field codes from the trigger or condition data in the data identifier and/or the data. See [Using Trigger and Condition Data](#)

Notes: If you select to send DDE Poke message, make sure that the application expects this command instead of a DDE Execute message. DDE Request messages are not supported in Commence agent actions.

Set Agent Status

A **Set Agent Status** [action](#) is used to [activate](#) and [deactivate](#) other Commence agents. Select an [agent](#) name from the **Agent list box** and use the **Active** and **Inactive** [radio buttons](#) to select the action.

The **Set Agent Status** action does not use values from [trigger](#) or [condition item\(s\)](#).

Status Bar Message Action

A **Status Bar Message** [action](#) displays a message on Commence's [status bar](#). Enter the text of the message in the [text box](#) under **Display Status Bar Message**. The message text can contain Field Codes from the selected [trigger](#) or [condition item\(s\)](#).

Use the **Insert Field** button to select from a list of available Field Codes for the selected trigger or condition category. If you select the **Audible Alarm** [check box](#), an alarm will sound as the message is displayed. Messages on the status bar will clear after six seconds, or sooner if another message is written to the status bar.

All **Status Bar Messages** are added to the log of status bar message that can be viewed using the [Help-Message Log](#) command.

Sync Link In Action

A **Sync Link In** [action](#)

updates a database in a [Sync Link](#)

transport group with data from a pre-selected update file.

Note: Before defining this agent, make sure you already have an appropriate [sync link group](#) defined. If you do not, use the [Tools-Sync Link Out](#) command to do so.

When you highlight the **Sync Link In**

action type in the [Add or Edit Action](#)

dialog box, the **Sync Link In Using**

[group box](#)

appears on the right side of the dialog box. Use this group box to enter the name of the [update file](#).

Sync Link Out Action

A **Sync Link Out** [action](#)

generates updates to a pre-selected file that can be used to update a specific database in a [Sync Link](#) transport group.

Note: Before defining this agent, make sure you already have an appropriate [sync link group](#) defined. If you do not, use the [Tools-Sync Link Out](#) command to do so.

When you highlight the **Sync Link Out** action type in the [Add or Edit Action](#) dialog box, the **Sync Link Out Using** [group box](#)

appears on the right side of the dialog box. Use this group box to select a [remote database](#) name, and to enter the name of the [update file](#).

Use Telephone Action

The **Use Telephone** action can be used to answer an incoming phone call, hang up the phone, or dial the phone. This action can be used with the **Incoming Communication** trigger.

Using Trigger and Condition Data

All [actions](#) (except **Icon Modification**, **Open View**, and **Set Agent Status**) allow you to use the [trigger](#) item or one of the two [condition](#) item sets (if you have selected conditions for the agent) as part of the action specification.

One of the actions (**Edit Item**) requires this selection, since the item(s) to be edited must be either the trigger item or one of the two sets of condition items. You make the selection of trigger or condition item(s) by picking the appropriate [radio button](#) in the **Using Values From** section. If you have not selected conditions for the agent, the condition radio buttons will be grayed out. Also, if you select a trigger or condition that is not capable of passing items, then the corresponding button will also be grayed out. By default, the **Trigger** radio button is selected for new actions.

Whichever button you select, the corresponding [category](#) name will be shown after **Selected Category**. The category shown is determined by the category of the trigger item or the condition items. If no specific category is implied by your choice, then you will see **Selected Category: (All Categories)**.

Note that for any particular trigger or condition, the item(s) passed to an action will always come from one category. Furthermore, except for the case of a trigger item from **(All Categories)**, when you define an agent, you will know exactly what [fields](#) are available from the trigger or condition item, since the fields are determined by the category of the item. You can use data from these fields in the action by inserting Field Codes in the places where you want the data to appear. Whenever you have selected a specific category, an **Insert Field** button appears to let you select Field Codes from the category. When the agent operates, the Field Codes are replaced with the corresponding values from the trigger or condition item. See [Using Field Codes In Actions](#).

You can use trigger data when filtering a category in an Item Count condition. If you create an agent that has trigger data, then a condition in that same agent can contain a filter using field codes representing values from the trigger item. This lets you pass data from the trigger to the condition. An example is an agent that passes the Close Date to the connected Support Call when a Support Followup item is closed. . For this example, the condition filter must isolate the Item Name of the connected Support Call in order to accurately determine which Support Call item must be modified. The following filter on the Support Call category accomplishes this task.:

has - Support Followup - Name - Contains - (-TrigItemName-)

Filtering By Field Value

[See Also](#)

The available filter options are different for each [field type](#).

For a [calculation](#), [number](#), or [sequence number](#) field type, the comparison operators are **Equal To**, **Greater Than**, **Is Between**, **Less Than**, and **Not Equal To**. Choose the comparison you want and type a numeric comparison value into the **Field Value** [text box](#). When filtering for a range of numbers (**Is Between**), type the low number into the **Minimum Value** text box and type the high number into the **Maximum Value** text box.

A [check box](#) field type can only be **Checked** or **Not Checked**.

For a [date](#) field type, the comparison operators are **After**, **Before**, **Is Between**, **Is Blank**, and **On**. Choose the comparison you want and type a comparison value (in the appropriate date format selected via the Windows Control Panel) into the **Field Value** text box. When filtering for a range of dates (**Is Between**), type the start date into the **Minimum Value** text box and type the end date into the **Maximum Value** text box. You can specify a [natural language date](#) instead of a literal date.

For an [e-mail address](#), [internet address](#), or [text](#) field type, you can select from the following comparison operations:

Contains You want to see items whose selected field contains the value you typed into the edit box, but other text can appear in the field.

Does Not Contain You want to see items whose select field does not contain the value you typed into the edit box.

Equal To You only want to see items whose selected field exactly matches the value you typed into the text box. No other text should appear in the item's field value.

Is Between You only want to see items whose selected field contains values ranging between the **Minimum** and **Maximum Value**.

Is Blank You only want to see items whose selected field contains no text.

The [name](#) uses all the same comparison operators as text fields and also allows the following:

Has Duplicates You want to see items whose name fields contain the same value.

After selecting a comparison operator for the name, e-mail address, internet address, or text field types, you can then enter a single [field value](#), or press the **Options** button to enter 4 or more field values (up to 10). See the topic titled *Advanced Filter Options*. The **Match Case** checkbox allows you to perform either a case-sensitive or case-insensitive operation as needed.

Note: [Telephone](#) fields can be filtered using all the same comparison operations as text fields except **Is Between**. Advanced filter options are not available for telephone fields.

You can also use [wildcards](#) in a comparison value for a name, telephone, e-mail address, internet address, or text field type.

For a [selection](#) type field, you select one of the **Equals** or **Does Not Equal** comparison operators, and then select a value from the list box displayed.

For a [time](#) field, the comparison operators are **After**, **At**, **Before**, **Is Between**, and **Is Blank**. Choose the comparison you want and type a comparison value into the **Field Value** text box. When filtering for a range of times (**Is Between**), type the start time into the **Minimum Value** text box and type the end time into the **Maximum Value** text box. The time value entered must be in the

appropriate time format set via the Windows Control Panel. You can specify a [natural language time](#) value instead of a literal time.

Select **OK** to confirm your choice or **Cancel** to return to previous screen without selecting a field value.

Wildcards

Simple and multiple [filters](#) allow you to use wildcards that match one, or one or more, instances of a character. Wildcards can be used only when filtering by a [name](#), [text](#), or [telephone](#) field.

"?" is a special character that matches a single instance of any ASCII character in a name or text field. For example, "070??" would match any zip code beginning with **070** followed by two characters. To filter for blank fields, you can use the **Contains** qualifier as the comparison operator and search for "?".

"*" is a special character that matches zero or more instances of any ASCII character. For example, searching for "**Smith,***" in the Person's name field would select all people with the last name of **Smith**.

Note: In telephone field-based filters using the **Does Not Contain** or **Contains** qualifier, only "*" can be used as a wildcard as explained above. Neither a "?" nor a "*" can be used as a wildcard in a filter on a telephone field using the **Equal To** qualifier.

Select Color Field Dialog Box

When you select the **Add** button on the [Color Code](#) tab, the **Select Color Field** dialog box is displayed.

You should choose a [field](#) on which to base your color code template. When the field value changes, a different color will be used for that item. Highlight the name of the field and press the **Select** button to choose a field for the template. Only [selection](#) fields, [check box](#) fields, and [connection definitions](#) can be used in color templates, so those are the only fields listed to choose from.

Shortcut: Mouse users can double-click the left mouse button while pointing at a field name to choose it without using the **Select** button.

Once you choose a field, the [Color Code Template](#) dialog box is displayed.

Color Code Template Dialog Box

COLOR CODE NAME TEXT BOX

If you are adding a new color code template, fill in a short description of the template here. You must type in a name before you can save the template. Template names are limited to 24 characters.

If you are editing a color code template, you may edit the name if you wish.

UP TO EIGHT FIELD/COLOR BOX SLOTS

Beneath the **Color Code Name** [text box](#), up to eight colored boxes (depending on the field type) are displayed.

When you are adding a template, a number of blank slots are displayed, each with a color box and a [drop-down list box](#). You must select field values and color for each slot.

When you are editing a template, each slot displays a [field](#) value and the color assigned to that value. You can change the color assigned to a slot at any time.

To change a color, click on the colored box. Selecting one of the color boxes opens a drop-down color list box of 16 colors to choose from. Select a new color from the list.

If the field on which the template is based is a [selection](#) field, each slot corresponds to a [radio button](#) in the group (radio groups contain at most 8 radio buttons) or a selection in the combo box drop down list..

If the field on which the template is based is a [check box](#) field, two slots are displayed (check box fields have two possible values: checked or unchecked).

If the field on which the template is based is a [connection definition](#), eight slots are displayed, each with a drop-down list box initially set to **Unused**. If you select the arrow at the right of one of the list boxes, you'll see a list of all the connected items' names. You can select item names for the first six slots. If there are less than six connected items in the drop-down box, you should leave extra slots set to **Unused**. The last two slots are reserved for the special entries **None** and **Default Color**. **None** is used when the connected item has not been associated with a color. The **Default Color** is used when the connection on which the template is based is blank (unconnected) or if multiple items are connected.

SAVE AND CANCEL BUTTONS

Once you are satisfied with the template, select the **Save** button to save the template; select the **Cancel** button to cancel the add or edit operation.

Add Connection Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the **Add** button on the [Customize-Database-Connection](#) dialog box.

The [active category](#)'s name is highlighted in the **From** [text box](#) automatically. Highlight a category name for the other side of the link in the **To** box and select **OK**.

The [Names for New Connection](#) dialog box is displayed in which you specify one name for a simple connection or two names for a paired connection. The connection name(s) are used to label connection fields on item [detail forms](#).

Edit Connection Names Dialog Box

Names for New Connection Dialog Box

These identical [dialog boxes](#) are displayed when adding or editing [connection definitions](#) from the [Customize-Database-Connection](#) dialog box.

For a paired connection, two text boxes are displayed, labeled with the two categories participating in the connection definition. If you are editing a connection definition , the boxes contain the existing connection definition names.

For a simple connection, one text box are displayed, labeled with the category participating in the connection definition. If you are editing a connection definition , the box contains the existing connection definition name.

For a new connection definition, type a name into the text box(es). The name(s) you pick should reflect the purpose of the connection definition .

Select the **Save** button to save the names you choose. Select **Cancel** to cancel the add or edit operation.

If you're editing a connection definition name, Commence changes the connection definition name(s) in all items in the two categories once you select **Save**. This may take some time, depending on the number of existing category items. When it is finished, you are returned to the **Connection** dialog box, which now reflects the new connection name(s).

Connection Fields Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the **Advanced** button on the [Customize-Database-Connection](#) dialog box, then click **Field Option**. You can choose the [fields](#) to appear in the connection pop-up window and in the connection field on the detail form.

The **Fields in Report** and **Fields Not In Report** [list boxes](#) show the list of fields (including connection definitions) that appear in the connection and those that don't appear in the connection, respectively.

The **Fields in Report** list box displays field names in the order in which the fields appear in the view.

ADDING COLUMNS

To append a field to the list of fields in the view (making the new field the last field listed in the view), highlight the field name in the **Fields Not In Report** list box and select the **Append Field** button.

Shortcut: Double-click the mouse on a field in the **Fields Not In Report** list box to append it to the **Fields In Report** list without selecting the **Append Field** button.

To insert a field into the list of fields in the view, highlight a field name in the **Fields Not In Report** list box and highlight the position where you want the field inserted in the **Fields In Report** list box. Then, select the **Insert Field** button.

ADDING RELATED COLUMNS

If the field you select is a connection definition, you can choose to display any of the fields from the connected item. Commence displays a list box containing the list of fields in the connected category. Select the fields, one field at a time, from the list. Note that connection definitions in the connected category are not displayed in the list box.

REMOVING COLUMNS

To remove a field from the connection, highlight the field name in the **Fields In Report** list box and select the **Remove Field** button.

Shortcut: Double-click the mouse on a field in the **Fields In Report** list box to remove it without selecting the **Remove Field** button.

COLUMN HEADINGS

If needed, you can change the label that appears at the top of the column for each field in the connection. Highlight the field name in the **Fields In Report** list box and select the **Field Options** button. Then enter the new field label in the label box.

Design Form Dialog Box

If you select the **Add**, **Edit**, or **Copy** buttons from the [Detail Form dialog box](#), the dialog box named above is displayed.

From the [Display](#) tab, you can choose a name for a [detail form](#) and select the fields to appear on the form. You can also invoke dialog boxes that let you drag fields to new positions in the form, set the field attributes like color and font.

The [Advanced](#) tab lets you set printing and auto-selection options for the form.

From the [Scripting](#) tab, you can create Visual Basic scripts for each form. This enables such operations as setting default values, filling in fields, and navigating within the form, as well as performing validation checks before an item is saved.

SAVE

Select the **Save** button to save the detail form you are working on.

CANCEL

Select **Cancel** to cancel the new, edited, or copied detail form and return to the [Detail Form](#) dialog box.

Set Default Detail Forms Dialog Box

Use the **Set Defaults** button on the [Detail Form dialog box](#) to define which [detail form](#) to always use for adding an [item](#) (**Default for Add Item**) and which detail form to use when you edit or view an [item detail](#) (**Default for Item Detail**).

If you have more than one form defined for a [category](#) and do not select defaults, Commence will ask you to choose a detail form when you display or add an item detail.

If you have only one form for a category, Commence will automatically display that form for adding and displaying items, even if you have not set defaults.

Choose default forms for adding and editing items by selecting a form name from the drop-down list boxes on the **Set Defaults** dialog box. The same form name can be used for both defaults.

The **Auto Select Detail Form When** option on the [Design Form](#) dialog box overrides the default form for viewing or editing an item detail set using this dialog box.

Import Rules Dialog Box

When you select the **Import Rules** button from the [Template Definition](#) dialog box, Commence displays the **Import Rules dialog box**.

The **New Items** [radio group](#) tells Commence how to insert [items](#) with new names into your [category](#). Select the **Add** [radio button](#) to automatically add each item with a new name into the category. Select the **Ask before adding** radio button to have Commence prompt you for confirmation before adding each new item.

The **Existing Items** radio group tells Commence how to handle incoming items that have the same name as one or more existing items in your category. How you want to handle these items will depend in part on whether your category allows duplicates. The radio button choices are described below.

Delete all existing items before input

Deletes all items in the target category before adding the new data from the import file.

Replace duplicates, all fields

Deletes each item in the target category whose name matches that of an incoming data item and replaces it with the data item from the import file.

Replace duplicates, imported fields only

For duplicate items, replaces only the field values being imported. Other field values in the item remain unchanged.

Ask on duplicates, then replace all fields

For each item in the target category whose name matches that of an incoming data item, display a message box showing the item

name and you if it should replace the existing data item. If you select **OK**, the existing data item is deleted and the incoming data item is added.

Ask on duplicates, then replace imported fields only

For each item in the target category whose name matches that of an incoming data item, display a message box showing the item name and you if it should replace the data fields for this item. If you select **OK**, the existing data fields in the item is deleted and the incoming data item is added.

Add duplicates as new item

If the category allows duplicates, items with the same names as existing items will simply be added to the category.

If an incoming item has a blank name field, Commence automatically assigns the value **(none)** as the item name. To use this feature, make sure that your category allows duplicates. Turn on the **Add duplicates as new items** radio button, so that all of the items so named are imported into the category.

Skip duplicates

Ignore an incoming item that has the same name as an existing item.

When you have chosen the rules you want, select **OK** to return to the [Template Mapping](#) dialog box.

Export Rules Dialog Box

When you select the **Export Rules** button from the [Template Definition](#) dialog box, Commence displays the **Export Rules dialog box**.

The **New Items** [radio group](#) tells Commence how to handle [items](#) with new names that are not found in the external data source. Select the **Add** [radio button](#) to automatically add each item with a new name into the data source. Select the **Ask before adding** radio button to have Commence prompt you for confirmation before adding each new item.

The **Existing Items** radio group tells Commence how to handle exported items that have the same name as one or more existing items in your external data source. How you want to handle these items will depend in part on whether the table allows duplicates. The radio button choices are described below.

Delete all existing items before export

Deletes all items in the target data source before adding the new data from Commence.

Replace duplicates, all fields

Deletes each item in the target data source whose name matches that of an exported data item and replaces it with the data item from Commence.

Replace duplicates, exported fields only

For duplicate items, replaces only the columns in data source that have been mapped to field values being exported. Other columns in the item remain unchanged.

Ask on duplicates, then replace all fields

For each item in the target data source whose name matches that of an exported data item, display a message box showing the item name and you if it should replace the existing data item. If you select **OK**, the existing data item is deleted and the data from Commence item is added.

Ask on duplicates, then replace exported fields only

For each item in the target data source whose name matches that of an exported data item, display a message box showing the item name and you if it should replace the data fields for this item. If you select **OK**, the mapped fields in the item are cleared and the field data from Commence is added.

Add duplicates as new items

If the table allows duplicates, items with the same names as existing items will simply be added to the category.

Skip duplicates

Ignore an exported item that has the same name as an existing item in the data source.

When you have chosen the rule you want, select **OK** to return to the [Template Mapping](#) dialog box.

Server Communications Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you choose the **Edit** button from the [Workgroup Communications](#) dialog box on the Server. Fill in the necessary information for the selected method of syncing. All methods of syncing may be configured to accommodate each individual user's needs.

- ☐ Setting Server Communications

OK

Select **OK** to accept any changes you have made on this screen.

CANCEL

Select **Cancel** to return to the **Workgroup Communications** dialog box without saving your changes.

Configuring E-Mail Parameters

Perform the following procedure to configure the Server to use E-Mail

to exchange synchronizing information:

1. From the *Workgroup Communications* Dialog Box, highlight **E-Mail** and select the **Edit** button.

Note: It is assumed that the e-mail application is already installed and operational.

2. Configure the **E-Mail** parameters as follows:

- . **Mail**

Program - select the appropriate mail program/protocol from the pull-down menu.

- . **Post**

Office Path - only necessary if using **cc:Mail** or similar VIM-based mail system.

- . **Profile**

Name [only applies to Microsoft Outlook or MAPI compatible programs]

- the name used to log into E-Mail program.

. Login

Name [only applies to CMC-compatible programs] - the name used

by the Server to log into the E-Mail Account. This is the account that

the Server will be using to send/receive sync packets to and from clients.

. Password/Verify

Password - the password associated with the **Profile Name/Login Name** defined above.

Note: Although the same mail account can be used for the Server

and Clients, it is strongly recommended that the Server and each Client

be assigned separate mail accounts.

3. When the Server's e-mail login information is correct, select **OK**.
4. Next, the e-mail address for the Server must be specified. This is the address to which Clients mail their update information during a synchronization.
5. Indicate how often (in minutes) the Server will check the mail server for Client synchronization requests. This number should not be very large in order to assure the timely receipt of updated information by the Server. A recommended value is ten (10) minutes.

6. Select **OK**
when done. The *Workgroup Communications*
Dialog Box will be displayed.

Configuring Internet FTP Directory Parameters

Synchronizing via the Internet is much the same process as synchronizing via a shared LAN directory, only instead of the directory's being located on a LAN, it is now located remotely and is accessed via dial-up service (e.g. Internet Service Provider) or a dedicated Internet connection. The transferring of sync files between Client(s) and Server is then done using File Transfer Protocol (FTP) procedures.

Perform the following procedure to configure the server with the Internet FTP Directory information:

1. From the *Workgroup Communications* Dialog Box, highlight **Internet FTP Directory** and select the **Edit** button.
2. Enter the **Internet FTP Directory** information. The format of this address is **ftp://DIRECTORY_NAME**. If the **Internet FTP Directory** is unknown, it should be available from the Network Administrator responsible for the FTP site.
3. Enter the **User Name** under which the Server will log into the **Internet FTP Directory**. It is recommended that the **Admin** login be used.
4. Enter the **Password** for the Server's Login ID.
5. Enter the Password again to **Verify Password**.
6. Indicate how often (in minutes) the Server will check the **Internet FTP Directory** for Client synchronization requests. A recommended value is fifteen (15) minutes.
7. After the **Internet FTP Directory** parameters have been configured as desired, select **OK**. The *Workgroup Communications* Dialog Box will be displayed.

After all desired Server Communications Parameters have been successfully configured, select **OK** from the *Workgroup Communications* Dialog Box. The *Customize Workgroup - Communications* Dialog Box will again be displayed.

Configuring Shared LAN Directory Parameters

Perform the following procedure to configure the Server to use a Shared

LAN Directory for exchanging synchronizing information:

1. From the *Workgroup Communications* Dialog Box, highlight **Shared LAN Directory** and select the **Edit** button. See the following figure.
2. Set the path for the **Shared LAN Directory**. Enter this path as it would be seen by the Commence Server. It is through this directory that the Server will communicate with the Clients by sending and receiving data files. The directory selected should be accessible to all users, and should be a new directory that is not used by any other program or Commence. All users require full access (read/write/create/delete/etc.) to this directory.

Note: If unsure of the path to the Shared LAN Directory, or to create a new directory, click on **Select**.

If the desired directory exists, navigate to the directory, highlight

it, and click **OK**, then click **OK**

again. To create a new directory, click **Create Directory**, provide the name of the new Shared LAN Directory, click **OK**,

then click **OK**
again.

3. Indicate how frequently (in seconds) the Server should check the shared LAN directory for data updates sent by Clients.

A very small number will guarantee that updates are processed in a timely manner, although the Server may be busy for extended periods of time.

This limits the Server's ability to run other tasks. The default value

for this is every 15 seconds. This value should be adjusted to meet the specific needs for the Workgroup being established, as well as the hardware specifications.

4. When the Shared LAN Directory parameters have been configured as desired, select **OK**.

The *Workgroup Communications*

Dialog Box will be displayed.

Configuring E-Mail Parameters

Perform the following procedure to configure a Commence Client to use e-mail for synchronizing:

1. Select the **Communicate with Server using: E-Mail** radio button.
2. Click **OK**.

The *Client Communications* Dialog Box is displayed.

3. Complete the **User Address** for the Client. This is the address to which the Server sends synchronization information that is intended for this Client.
4. Click **OK**
to return to the *Customize Workgroup - Communications* Dialog Box.

Configuring Internet FTP Directory Parameters

Perform the following procedure to configure a Commence Client to use an Internet FTP Directory for synchronizing:

1. Select the **Communicate with Server using: Internet FTP directory** radio button.
2. Click **OK**. A message indicating that no further configuring of parameters is necessary is displayed.
3. Click **OK** to return to the *Customize Workgroup - Communications* Dialog Box.

Configuring Shared LAN Directory Parameters

The default method for synchronizing data within a Commence Workgroup is using a Shared LAN Directory.

Perform the following procedure to configure a Commence Client to use a Shared LAN Directory for synchronizing:

1. Select the **Communicate with Server using: Shared LAN directory** radio button.

2. Click **OK**.

A message indicating that no further configuring is necessary is displayed.

3. Click **OK**

to return to the *Customize Workgroup - Communications* Dialog Box.

Category Tab

Categories store your data. Sometimes you may want to add a new category or change one to meet your needs. To do this, select the [Customize-Database-Category](#) command. You will see a **Category Names** list box. Select a category from the list, then press the appropriate button, depending on what customization you need to do. Use the **Edit** button to customize your existing [category](#) definitions (i.e., number and types of [fields](#), field labels, default field values, and other attributes that vary between field types). You can add your own categories by adding entirely new definitions (**Add** button) or copying an existing definition and editing it (**Copy** button). You can also delete any category (**Delete** button). For more information about deleting categories, see [Deleting Categories](#) .

When you press the **Time Conflict** button, Commence displays the [Time Conflict Layout](#) dialog box. Enabling time conflict checking for a [category](#) means that Commence will check each [item](#) added to the category for a time conflict with items already in the category. If a conflict is detected, Commence asks you if you want to add the conflicting item anyway.

You can change a category definition at any time, even if the category has data in it. This means you can try out category definitions and fine tune them as you work, without having to re-enter any of your data. Use the Tutorial data to experiment with new category definitions (see [Help-Tutorial](#)).

The Add, Edit, and Copy [dialog boxes](#) are identical except for the following:

- Pressing the **Add** button opens a dialog box titled **Add New Category**; it is blank except for a **Name** field (of type [name](#)), which is required in every category.). You can edit the [field](#) to change its label. Regardless of how you label it, the value contained in this field is used by the various view types as a key for accessing [items](#).

- Pressing the **Edit** button opens a dialog box titled **Category Definition**; it is filled in with the definition of the selected category. You can change the name and the definition of any of the fields, but not a field's type.
- Pressing the **Copy** button opens a dialog box is titled **Copy Category**; it is filled in with the definition of the selected category, except that the **Category Name** is blank.

Note: **Copy Category** does *not* copy items or the connections to the new category, just the category definition (i.e., number and types of fields, etc.).

Once you have chosen to add, edit, or copy the selected category, the **Fields** list box will be displayed.

FIELDS LIST BOX

This list box displays the labels of the currently defined fields for the category. Highlight a field label in the list box and select one of the **Add**, **Edit**, or **Delete** buttons (described below) to add, edit, or delete the definition of the highlighted field.

Shortcut: Double-click the left mouse button while pointing at a field in the **Fields** box to edit a field's definition without selecting the **Edit** button.

ADD BUTTON

Select this button to add a field label and definition to the category. The [Add Field](#) dialog box is displayed.

Note: After you **Add** a new field, you can select the **Edit** button to change that field's type (regardless of whether you are adding, editing, or copying a category). After you select the **Save** button to save the category definition, however, the field type is made permanent and you cannot change it in subsequent editing sessions.

EDIT BUTTON

Select this button to edit a field label of an existing field, or the field label and/or type of a newly added field. The [Edit Field](#) dialog box is displayed.

You cannot change the field type of a field unless the field was just added using the **Add** button (see above). Once you select the **Save** button (see below), field types become permanent.

DELETE BUTTON

This button deletes the highlighted field from the category. You can delete a field of any type except a name field type.

Caution: If you are editing an existing category, the field is deleted from every existing item and any data in the field is lost once you select the **Save** button (see below). If you want to transfer this existing data to a new field with the type you want, use the [File-Export-By Category](#) command to export the data values from the old field, define a new field with the type you want, and then use [File-Import](#) to import the data values. After you do this, you can safely delete the old field.

Similarly, Commence deletes a field from any [detail forms](#) and views that use the category.

If you have any [agents](#) that depend on or use the field you deleted, you should edit the agent and ensure that it still functions as intended (this includes the predefined agents delivered with Commence). See [Customize-Database-Agent](#).

SAVE BUTTON

The changes you make to category definitions are not saved until you select this button. Once you select the **Save** button, Commence saves the new category definition or changes the definition of the edited category; it also updates an existing category's detail form(s) and any views that use the category with the changed category definition. Commence creates an initial form and default report view for a new category definition.

ADVANCED BUTTON

This button displays the [Advanced Category Options](#) dialog box, from which you can specify a clarify field and create secondary indices.

Calculation Field Using the Fields button and the arithmetic operators + (add), - (subtract), * (multiply), and / (divide), insert an equation for the [calculation field](#) into the Equation [text box](#).

Calculation fields can contain a formula using up to 256 characters, including the +, -, *, and / operators, parentheses () for grouping, and the currency symbol selected via the Windows Control Panel (in the United States and some other countries, this is the dollar sign \$).

The **Fields** button displays the [Select Field](#) dialog box, from which you select an *existing* currency, number, date, or time field to insert into the equation. All fields for the equation must already be defined to be used in the equation. All inserted fields must be separated by one of the arithmetic operators.

Check Box Field

When adding or editing a category, you can select the **Initial State** of a [check box field](#) by selecting one of the **Checked** or **Not Checked** [radio buttons](#). The default is **Not Checked**.

Agents with [Edit](#) Item or [Add](#) Item [actions](#) can be used to check or uncheck a checkbox. When inserting a **Value** for a checkbox field on the [Field Values](#) dialog box, the entire contents of the **Value text box** must contain values of **On**, **1**, **True**, or **Yes** to indicate a **Checked** condition; anything else is interpreted as a **Not Checked** condition.

Note: In Agents, a value of Checked does not indicate a **Checked** condition; it will be interpreted as **Not Checked**.

Data/Excel Cell/Image File Field These three field types have identical options.

Options are limited to a **Mandatory Field** [check box](#). If you turn on the **Mandatory Field** check box, Commence will not let you save an [item detail](#) on which this field appears unless there is a value in this field.

Date Field

If you enter a value into the **Default** [text box](#), this value will be displayed as the default value for this field whenever you add a new [item](#) to the [category](#). Default values for a date field must be either a date in the format set via the Windows Control Panel, or a natural language date less than 255 characters. See Natural Language Dates for more information.

The valid date range accepted by Commence extends from January 1, 1600, through December 31, 2999. This makes it easy to add the birthday of a favorite classical composer to a musical library database.

With the expanded range of valid dates available, the **Short Date Range** preference (**Edit- Preferences - Other - Short Date Range**) takes on greater importance when evaluating a two-digit year within a date field. For example, if the **Short Date Range** preference is set to be **1930–2029**, then the date **25 Jul 49** would be evaluated as **July 25, 1949**. However, if the **Short Date Range** preference is set to be **1950–2049**, then the date **25 Jul 49** would be evaluated as **July 25, 2049**.

If you turn on the **Mandatory Field** [check box](#), Commence will not let you save an [item detail](#) on which this field appears unless there is a value in this field.

If you turn on the **Recurring Date** check box, a **Recurring Item** check box will appear on any [detail form](#) that includes this field. See [Date Field](#) for a description of how the **Recurring Item** check box and the recurring date field are used.

E-Mail Address Field

This field type that is used specifically for electronic mail (E-Mail) addresses. Double clicking on an address within this field will open up a blank mail note (using the default e-mail software) with the **To:** field automatically filled in with the selected address. Commence allows up to eighty (80) characters for each e-mail address

In order for Commence to automatically address an electronic message, a compatible electronic mail program must be installed and properly configured. Some examples of supported e-mail applications are Microsoft Exchange, Lotus Notes, and Lotus cc:Mail.

Once Commence has been configured properly with the e-mail information, the next step is to include e-mail address information in a database. If there are multiple mail system protocols in use, a prefix can be used in order to identify which protocol is to be used. For example, entering **MAPI:fred** will use **MAPI** protocol to send an e-mail message to address **fred**. In addition to **MAPI**, Commence recognizes **VIM** and **CMC**. The corresponding mail programs must be installed and configured properly in order to take advantage of this feature.

Complete the following information on the E-Mail Address Add Field Dialog Box:

Field Label - this is the name of the field and will be used in all instances where field labels are displayed.

Default - if there is a default address used, enter that address in this area. This address will be stored in the E-Mail field in the event no other e-mail address is entered into the field.

Mandatory Field - if an e-mail address is required information, checking this box will assure that an item is not saved with an empty E-Mail field.

The new E-Mail Address field is automatically added to all Detail Forms associated with the category. If there are multiple tabs for any of the Detail Forms, the field is automatically added to the appropriate tab.

Internet Address (URL) Field

Commence includes a field that is used specifically for Uniform Resource Locator (URL) addresses. Double clicking on a URL address will launch the Web Browser (if not already open) and go directly to the indicated web site. Commence allows up to 1024 characters for each URL address.

In order for Commence to automatically display a homepage at a specific URL address, a compatible Internet Browser must be installed and properly configured. Two examples of supported browsers are Microsoft Internet Explorer and Netscape Navigator.

NOTE

Commence uses the web browser that is defined as the default browser.

For proper launching of any web browser, the full URL address must be specified. For example, **http://www.commence.com** must be specified, not just **commence.com**.

Complete the following information on the URL Address' *Add Field* dialog box:

Field Label – this is the name of the field, and will be used in all instances where Field Labels are displayed. In this example, the Field Label will be **Home Page**.

Default – if there is a default URL address to be used, enter that address in this area. This address will be stored in the **Home Page** field in the event no other URL address is entered into the field.

Mandatory Field – if an Internet (URL) address is required information, checking this box will assure that an item is not saved with an empty **Home Page** field.

Number/Telephone/Time/E-Mail Address/Internet Address Field

These five field types have identical options.

If you enter a value into the **Default** [text box](#), this value will be displayed as the default value for this field whenever you add a new [item](#) to the [category](#). Default values are limited to 255 characters, but are also limited by the type of the field (i.e a [time field](#) must contain a time in the currently selected Windows Control Panel format, or one of the time keywords listed in [Natural Language Times](#)).

If you turn on the **Mandatory Field** [check box](#), Commence will not let you save an [item detail](#) on which this field appears unless there is a value in this field.

Selection Field

A Selection Field may be displayed in one of two possible ways. In situations where there are eight (8) or fewer choices, a Radio Group can be used. For situations where there are more than eight (8) choices, or when space within a detail form is limited, a Combo Box should be used.

RADIO GROUP

The **Options** for a [radio group field](#) include a label for each of eight possible [radio buttons](#), and a **Default** radio group from which you select the radio button you want selected by default upon display of an add [item detail](#) that shows this field.

Type a label into the [text box](#) for each button that you want to define. Only the buttons you label will appear in the radio group.

Caution: When you are editing radio group fields, special care must be taken when attempting to change the number or order of radio buttons, or the meaning of a radio button that already has data associated with it. See [Editing a Radio Group](#).

Agents with [Edit](#) Item or [Add](#) Item [actions](#) can be used to select any button in a radio group. When inserting a **Value** for a radio group field on the [Field Values](#) dialog box, the entire contents of the **Value** [text box](#) must contain the label of one of the radio group's buttons, or the value will be ignored. The button label is case sensitive. If the value is ignored, the default button will be used. Note that you can specify a field code from the [trigger](#) data to be used as a value for the radio group, but the trigger data field's value must translate into a button name or it will be ignored.

COMBO BOX

Each [combo box](#) can have up to 4000 selections from which to choose. Each individual entry may be 60 characters long. Define the Combo Box Selections as follows:

Add - adds a Combo box selection to the list of current selections.

Edit - permits the Combo Box selection currently highlighted to be modified.

Move Up - moves the currently selected Combo Box selection up a position within the list of current selections. Used for customizing the order in which all selections are positioned.

Move Down - moves the currently selected Combo Box selection down a position within the list of current selections. Used for customizing the order in which all selections are positioned.

Caution: Once a selection has been defined within a Combo Box, it cannot be deleted later. If a selection becomes unnecessary at a later date, the text associated with the location can be edited (for example, to read **Unused** or **Unavailable**). Modifying the text for a single location does not affect the text for any other location. The obsolete selection (now labeled **Unused**) may then be moved down to the bottom of the list so that it is “out of the way.”

Sequence Number Field

The **Options** for a [sequence number field](#) are limited to an **Initial Value**. This value is placed in the field for the first item added, and is incremented by one with each subsequent item added. The default **Initial Value** is **1**. When adding a new sequence number field, you can change the **Initial Value** to any numeric value less than **2,000,000,000**.

Note: You change the initial value for an existing field by deleting the sequence number field and readding it. Any existing items in the category will be resequenced starting with the new initial value.

Text Field

The **Total Size** of a [text field](#) is, by default, **Small** (eighty characters or fewer). Alternatively, you can select a **Large** text field (up to 30,000 characters), or select the **Limit to** option and type a number of characters in the [text box](#) provided. Commence will limit text input for the field to the number of characters you specify.

If you enter a value into the **Default** text box, this value will be displayed as the default value for this field whenever you add a new item to the category. Default values are limited to 255 characters or the **Total Size** you specify, whichever is smaller.

If you turn on the **Mandatory Field** check box, Commence will not let you save an [item detail](#) on which this field appears unless there is a value in this field.

Timer Trigger

A **Timer** [trigger](#) fires at a given date and time, or at a given frequency. The **Timer** trigger does not depend on data in Commence, so its specification is limited to selecting the date and time parameters. Use the **Timer Frequency** [drop-down list box](#) to select the timer frequency. Depending on your choice of frequency, you can also specify **Time**, **Date**, **Day**, **Month**, and **Year** values with the other controls in the **Timer Information** section.

If you check **Trigger if Missed**, then if Commence is not active when the trigger should have fired, it fires as soon as Commence is restarted. However, the trigger only fires one time, even if several trigger times were missed.

A **Timer** trigger does not pass a trigger item to the agent's actions.

Timer triggers are often useful in conjunction with data conditions. They let you define agents that monitor data conditions of interest to you on a regular basis. For example, a complete agent of this type might be: every Monday at 9 AM, if I have any meetings with my manager this week, show me a warning message and print a listing of those meetings.

Template Mapping Without Sample Files

If you selected one of the [file formats](#) from the [Template Definition dialog box](#) that does not use a sample file, Commence displays the [Template Mapping](#) dialog box described below.

See [Template Mapping With Sample Files](#) for a description of this dialog box as it appears when you are using one of the file formats that uses a sample file.

Unless you are using the column-delimited ASCII format, the **Field Position** button will be unavailable.

Use the **Template Mapping** dialog box to make the [field](#) names in the **Fields In Template** list box mirror the field contents in your external file.

When you first see this dialog box, all the fields in your target category are displayed in the **Fields Not In Template** [list box](#). To select a field for your template, highlight a field and select either the **Append Field** or **Insert Field** button. The **Append Field** button moves the highlighted field to the bottom of the **Fields in Template** list. The **Insert Field** button moves the highlighted field to the highlighted location in the **Fields in Template** list.

A special **<skip>** entry also appears in the **Fields Not in Template** list box. Insert or Append this entry into the **Fields in Template** list box to tell Commence to skip over a field in the external file. Unlike field names, you can select the **<skip>** entry as many times as you need to.

To remove a field from the **Fields in Template** list box, highlight the field and select the **Remove Field** button. The field name will jump to the bottom of the **Fields Not In Template** list box.

Shortcut: Double-click the mouse on a field name in the **Fields Not In Template** list box to append it to the **Field In Template** list box without selecting the **Append Field** button. Double-click a field name in the **Fields In Template** list box to remove it to the **Field Not In Template** list box without selecting the **Remove Field** button.

When you have finished [mapping](#) all of your fields, select **OK** to return to the [Template Definition](#) dialog box.

If you are using **column delimited ASCII** format, see the [Field Position](#) dialog box for an explanation of the **Field Position** button.

Caution: The order of the fields in the **Fields In Template** list box must match the order of the fields in the external file. Otherwise you will get the wrong information loaded into your category's fields. For example, you may get telephone numbers loaded into the name field in your Person category.

Template Mapping With Sample Files

If you choose either the **dBASE, sample file** or the **DIF, sample file** format on the [Template Definition](#) dialog box, Commence displays the [Select Import/Export Sample File](#) dialog box when you select the **Map** button.

If you choose the **OLE DB/ODBC data source** format, Commence displays the [Select Data Source](#) dialog box when you select the **Map** button. This is followed by the [Select Table](#) dialog box which allows you to pick a specific table within the data source.

After selecting a file or specifying the data source and table for an ODBC database, the [Template Mapping](#) dialog box described below is displayed.

Commence retrieves the field names of the data from the external file or database. Therefore Commence is able to display the external field names in the **Fields in Template** list box as an aid to [mapping](#) the corresponding field names in your Commence category.

To map an external field to the corresponding field in Commence, first highlight the external field name, which appears on the left half of the screen in the **Fields in Template** list box. Then highlight the corresponding Commence field from the **Fields Not In Template** list box and select the **Assign Field** button. The Commence field name moves to the **Files in Template** list box alongside the matching external field.

Shortcut: Double-click the mouse on a field in the **Fields Not In Template** list box to assign it to the highlighted field in the **Fields In Template** list box.

A special **<Skip Field>** entry also appears in the **Fields Not in Template** list box. This performs the same function as the Unassign button. If you make a mistake in assigning Commence field names, highlight the field in the **Fields In Template** list box you want to unassign and select the **Unassign** button or the **<Skip Field>** entry from the **Fields Not In Template** list box. The Commence field will move to the bottom of the list in the **Fields Not In Template** list box.

When you have finished mapping all your fields, select **OK** to return to the **Template Definition** dialog box.

Mapping fields to Microsoft Outlook Calendar

This preference allows you to configure your Commence database to share meetings and contacts with Outlook users. Refer to [Configuring Microsoft Outlook](#) for additional setup steps that must be completed before synchronizing with Microsoft Outlook.

In order for Commence to copy data back and forth between applications, the fields in Commence must be mapped to the equivalent fields in Outlook. These field mappings will be used during the synchronizations with Outlook to ensure that the correct data is mapped to and stored in the appropriate field in each application. Only those fields that will be used need to be mapped.

To map Outlook fields to the corresponding fields in Commence:

- 1 Select the [Edit-Preferences-Other Apps](#) command. From the Configure Commence as: Combo Box, select Microsoft Outlook Calendar.
- 2 From the **Category** Combo Box, select the Commence category that is to be used as the calendar. This category should have a Date and Time field. Typically, this would be the Calendar category.
- 3 Double click on the desired **Outlook Field** on the left side of the form, or highlight the desired **Outlook Field** on the left and select **Edit**. Select the corresponding **Commence Field** from the Combo Box. Select **OK** when done.
- 4 Repeat the steps above for any remaining Outlook fields that correspond to Commence Fields. Not all fields need to be mapped.

The **Sync Condition** lets you specify a checkbox or connection field to determine if an item should be included in the Outlook synchronization. If a checkbox is used, then only those items with the box checked will synchronize to Outlook. If a

connection is used, it must be mapped to the connection between the selected category and the category used to store your Personal Information (a.k.a., the Me item). Only items connected to the Me item will synchronize with Outlook. If the Sync Condition is not mapped, all items in the selected category will synchronize.

The **Activity Type** looks for a selection field with a value of "Appointment". This is used when the Commence category that contains your appointments is the same category used to store your to-do's. If not mapped, all items in the selected category are included in the Outlook synchronization.

5 When the appropriate Outlook fields have been mapped to Commence Fields, select **Done** to save the configuration.

Mapping fields to Microsoft Outlook Contacts

This preference allows you to configure your Commence database to share meetings and contacts with Outlook users. Refer to [Configuring Microsoft Outlook](#) for additional setup steps that must be completed before synchronizing with Microsoft Outlook.

In order for Commence to copy data back and forth between applications, the fields in Commence must be mapped to the equivalent fields in Outlook. These field mappings will be used during the synchronizations with Outlook to ensure that the correct data is mapped to and stored in the appropriate field in each application. Only those fields that will be used need to be mapped.

To map Outlook fields to the corresponding fields in Commence:

- 1 Select the [Edit-Preferences-Other Apps](#) command. From the Configure Commence as: Combo Box, select Microsoft Outlook Contacts.
- 2 From the **Category** Combo Box, select the Commence category that contains contact information. Typically, this would be the Person/Company category.
- 3 Double click on the desired **Outlook Field** on the left side of the form, or highlight the desired **Outlook Field** on the left and select **Edit**.
- 4 Select the corresponding **Commence Field** from the Combo Box. Select **OK** when done.
- 5 Repeat the steps above for any remaining Outlook fields that correspond to Commence Fields. Not all fields need to be mapped.
- 6 When the appropriate Outlook fields have been mapped to Commence Fields, select **Done** to save the configuration.

Mapping fields to Microsoft Outlook Tasks

This preference allows you to configure your Commence database to share Task items with Outlook users. Refer to [Configuring Microsoft Outlook](#) for additional setup steps that must be completed before synchronizing with Microsoft Outlook.

In order for Commence to copy data back and forth between applications, the fields in Commence must be mapped to the equivalent fields in Outlook. These field mappings will be used during the synchronizations with Outlook to ensure that the correct data is mapped to and stored in the appropriate field in each application. Only those fields that will be used need to be mapped.

To map Outlook fields to the corresponding fields in Commence:

- 1 Select the [Edit-Preferences-Other Apps](#) command. From the Configure Commence as: Combo Box, select Microsoft Outlook Tasks.
- 2 From the **Category** Combo Box, select the Commence category that contains Task information. Typically, this would be the Activity or To-Do category.
- 3 Double click on the desired **Outlook Field** on the left side of the form, or highlight the desired **Outlook Field** on the left and select **Edit**.
- 4 Select the corresponding **Commence Field** from the Combo Box. Select **OK** when done.
- 5 Repeat the steps above for any remaining Outlook fields that correspond to Commence Fields. Not all fields need to be mapped.

The **Sync Condition** lets you specify a checkbox or connection field to determine if an item should be included in the Outlook synchronization. If a checkbox is used, then only those items with the box checked will synchronize to Outlook. If a connection is used, it must be mapped to the connection

between the selected category and the category used to store your Personal Information (a.k.a., the Me item). Only items connected to the Me item will synchronize with Outlook. If the Sync Condition is not mapped, all items in the selected category will synchronize.

The **Activity Type** looks for a selection field with a value of "Appointment". This is used when the Commence category that contains your appointments is the same category used to store your to-do's. If not mapped, all items in the selected category are included in the Outlook synchronization.

6 When the appropriate Outlook fields have been mapped to Commence Fields, select **Done** to save the configuration.

Mapping fields for Mobile Link Notes

This preference allows you to configure your Commence database to synchronize Notes items with your supported handheld device. Refer to [Configuring Mobile Link and Microsoft Outlook](#) for additional setup steps that must be completed before synchronizing.

In order for Commence to copy data between applications, the fields in Commence must be mapped to the equivalent fields in Outlook. These field mappings will be used during the synchronizations to ensure that the correct data is mapped to and stored in the appropriate field in each application. Only those fields that will be used need to be mapped.

To map the Notes fields to the corresponding fields in Commence:

- 1 Select the [Edit-Preferences-Other Apps](#) command. From the Configure Commence as: Combo Box, select Mobile Link Notes.
- 2 From the **Category** Combo Box, select the Commence category that contains Notes information.
- 3 Double click on the desired **Mobile Link / Outlook Field** on the left side of the form, or highlight the desired field on the left and select **Edit**.
- 4 Select the corresponding **Commence Field** from the Combo Box. Select **OK** when done.
- 5 Repeat the steps above for any remaining Outlook fields that correspond to Commence Fields. Not all fields need to be mapped.

The **Sync Condition** lets you specify a checkbox or connection field to determine if an item should be included in the synchronization.

- If a checkbox is used, then only those items with the box checked will synchronize.
- If a connection is used, it must be mapped to the

connection between the selected category and the category used to store your Personal Information (a.k.a., the Me item). Only items connected to the Me item will synchronize. If the Sync Condition is not mapped, all items in the selected category will synchronize.

- 6 When all the necessary fields have been mapped to Commence Fields, select **Done** to save the configuration.

Select Item Dialog Box

Highlight the name of the item you want to display in the list box and select the **Select** button. Alternatively, you can double-click the left mouse button while pointing at the name of the item you want to select it without using the **Select** button. Select **Cancel** to exit the dialog box without choosing an item.

Customize-Design View-Fields Tab (Report Viewer)

Selecting the [Customize-Design View](#) command while a report viewer is the [active view](#) displays the Design View tab.

Use the **Fields** tab to choose which [fields](#) will be available in the report designer. If you select a [connection](#) name to appear in the view, you can choose a field from the connected category.

The **Fields in Report** and **Fields Not In Report** [list boxes](#) show the list of fields (including connection definitions) that appear in the designer and those that don't appear in the designer, respectively.

To add a field to the list of fields in the view, highlight the field name in the **Fields Not In Report** list box and select the **Append Field** or **Insert Field** button. The order of fields does not matter.

Shortcut: Double-click the mouse on a field in the **Fields Not In Report** list box to append it to the **Fields In Report** list.

If the field you select is a connection definition, you can choose to display any of the fields from the connected item in the view. For example, you could show the name and phone number of each person assigned to a To-Do item by highlighting **Assigned to Person** in the **Fields Not In Report** list box and selecting either the **Insert Field** or **Append Field** button. Commence displays a list box containing the list of fields in the connected category. Select the name and phone number fields, one field at a time, from the list. Note that connection definitions in the connected category are not displayed in the list box. You can only display items that are directly connected to the category the view is defined for.

To remove a field from the view, highlight the field name in the **Fields In Report** list box and select the **Remove Field** button.

Shortcut: Double-click the mouse on a field in the **Fields In Report** list box to remove it without selecting the **Remove Field** button.

The Combine Fields button is not available for report viewers.

Instead, fields can be combined using the Report Designer.

Use the [Report Designer](#) to arrange the fields in the report and to customize the report layout.

Combine Fields Dialog Box

[See Also](#)

The Combine Fields button is used to display up to 4 fields on the same line of a book or report view. When selecting connection fields, the Name field type is automatically selected. Connected fields other than the Name field are not supported. The

Separator: text box is used to enter a delimiter between each of the fields you have selected. This box may be left blank if the fields must appear side by side with no spaces in between.

For example, when creating a report view that will be used to print labels and envelopes, the First and Last Name fields must be displayed on the same line. To combine these fields, select First Name from the **Field 1:** list box, select Last Name from the **Field 2:** list box. Enter a space in the **Separator:**. Box. Click OK to save the combined field.

Note: Combined fields will automatically be appended after the last field in the report. Combined fields cannot be inserted into a different position. When designing a report, plan ahead so that the combined field is placed in the correct position. After a combined field has been placed (and appears under **Fields in Report**), other fields may be appended or inserted around the combined field in the report.

Adding a Text Template

When you select the **Add Text** button on the [Letter Template](#) tab, you see a blank **Letter Template** dialog box.

Use the text box in the **Letter Template** dialog box to type in the text that you want in the body of the letter template. You can use the **Edit** menu commands to copy text to and from the Windows Clipboard. You can also use the Clipboard to copy text into the template from other applications. If you want, you can leave the template dialog box open, do other work in Commence, and then return to finish the template.

Keyboard shortcut: To move the cursor out of the text box, press ALT+*underlined-letter*, where *underlined-letter* is one of the underlined letters in a button or text box label.

FOR CATEGORY

Use the **For Category** [drop-down list box](#) to select the [category](#) with which the template will be used.

TEMPLATE NAME

Enter a brief description for the template in the **Template Name** [text box](#).

FIELD

When you want to include data from an item in Commence, position your cursor where you want the data to appear. Then select the **Field** button. (See the [Select Field](#) dialog box for more information about how to use this.) A [Field Code](#) will be inserted in the body of your letter template. This code is substituted when you create your letter, and tells Commence to get data from the category you chose for your letter template.

There are four special Field Codes that can be used in text letter templates only.

(-Category-) inserts the category of the item being used to supply data values.

(-Date-) inserts the current date (that is, the date when the letter was created).

(-Time-) inserts the current time.

(-Me-) inserts the item name from your Personal Info preference.

SPELL

When you have entered all the text and [Field Codes](#) that you want in the template, you can check the spelling in the template by selecting the **Spell** button. See [Tools-Spell Check](#) for details on the use of the spell checker.

SAVE

Select the **Save** button to save the template. The template is now ready to use to send letters.

CANCEL

If you select the **Cancel** button, Commence cancels the add template operation and does not save the file or the name of the template.

Editing a Text Template

When you select the **Edit** button on the [Letter Template](#) tab with a [text template](#) highlighted, you see the **Letter Template** dialog box filled out with the contents of the template. The file name of the template is shown in the upper right hand corner of the box. You can make changes to the template by simply typing new text in the [text box](#).

FIELD

You can use the **Field** button to add new field codes to the template (see the [Select Field](#) dialog box for how to do this).

Note: If a text template references a connected field and multiple items are connected to the data item for which a letter is being created, data from just the first connected item is entered into the letter.

FOR CATEGORY

If you want to use the template with a different [category](#), select the new category with the **For Category** [drop-down list box](#).

TEMPLATE NAME

To change the name of the template, type a new description in the **Template Name** text box.

SPELL

If you want to spell check your changes, select the **Spell** button (see [Tools-Spell Check](#) for instructions on using the Spell Checker).

SAVE

When you are ready to save the template, select the **Save** button.

CANCEL

If you don't want to save your changes, select the **Cancel** button.

Commence Event Trigger

[See Also](#)

The **Commence Event** [trigger](#) enables agents to run whenever Commence starts or closes. This trigger makes it easier to write agents to perform initialization and cleanup tasks.

If you choose to trigger on event: **Commence starts**, then the agent will fire immediately upon starting Commence, but only if the database in which the agent is defined is the active database. You can ensure that the correct database is opened when Commence starts by using either the **/prompt** or the **/database=** command line options. Otherwise, Commence will open the last database that was active when you last exited from Commence. Using **Open/Manage Database** to open the correct database later will *not* trigger the agent.

If you select to trigger on event: **Commence closes**, then the agent will not attempt to fire until you try to exit from Commence. Then, once the agent starts to fire, Commence will remain open until the agent has completed its actions. You can exit a number of different ways, by selecting [Exit](#) from the Commence Application menu, or by double-clicking on the Control box in the upper left corner of the Commence window, or by clicking on the close button in the upper right corner of the Commence window.

Warning: Do not attempt to reboot your PC if an agent is firing.

Incoming Communication Trigger

The **Incoming Communication** [trigger](#) allows you to detect when you have received new mail in your E-Mail inbox. The E-Mail application does not need to be running for this trigger to work; Commence, however, must be open to the database where the agent is defined. Along with this trigger, there are several new keywords that can be used in actions.

The **Incoming Communication** trigger can also be setup to detect when the telephone has rung. The incoming phone call can be logged, using several new keywords that can be used in actions.

Item Alarm Trigger

The **Item Alarm** [trigger](#) works as a warning signal. It is fired (at an interval that you select) before an [item](#) (an Calendar appointment, for example) becomes current. The specification of an **Item Alarm** trigger consists of identifying which items generate alarms, and how far in advance the alarm trigger goes off. All **Item Alarm** triggers work within a single category (e.g., Project, Calendar, etc.). You must also identify the date and time fields in the category that are used to set the alarm.

You can set an Item Alarm trigger for items in a view or in a [category](#). Make this selection by picking the **View** or **Category** radio button under **For Items In**.

If you select **View**, a [drop-down list box](#) appears that lets you select one of your current [views](#). Note that selecting a view determines the [category](#) of the view.

If you select **Category**, a drop-down list box appears that lets you select one of your categories. You can just set the alarm for any item in the category, or you can restrict it to a filtered sub-set of the category. Use the **Select Filter** button to bring up the [Filters tab](#) and define a [filter](#) for that category.

After you have selected a view or category, you must pick the [date](#) and [time fields](#) that will be used for the item alarm. Based on your choice of view or category, the **Trigger If** section of the box lets you select these fields. Use the drop-down list box next to **The date in field:** to pick the date field. Use the drop-down list box next to **and the time in field:** to pick the time field.

Set the amount of time before the value in the time field that the trigger will fire by adjusting the values in the **hour(s)** and **minute(s)** controls. (You can use the arrows to move the values up and down, or just type in a number.)

If you check **Trigger if Missed**, then if Commence is not active when the trigger should have fired, it fires as soon as Commence is restarted.

An **Item Alarm** trigger passes the data item that activated it as a trigger item.

Keyboard Hotkey Trigger

A **Keyboard Hotkey** [trigger](#) is manually controlled: it fires when you select the keystroke combination associated with the trigger. You can also specify which [desktop](#) the agent will be available.

To avoid conflicts, the keyboard combination must include CTRL + ALT + <key> or CTRL + SHIFT + <key> when using letters. However, function keys and numeric keypad keys can appear alone or in any combination with SHIFT, CTRL, or ALT. Also note that Commence will only process the keystroke combination if it is the active application.

Some sample keystroke combinations are:

CTRL + ALT + A CTRL + SHIFT + K

CTRL + SHIFT + HOME

F3

SHIFT + F3

ALT + F5

NUM 3 (*3 on the numeric keypad*) **WARNING** Do not try to define CTRL + ALT + DEL as a keystroke combination. Also, avoid using other system keystroke combinations (such as ALT+TAB, CTRL+F6, etc)

Some combinations are used by other applications, including Windows, and should not be used. Using these can cause unpredictable results. The following is a list of some of the key combinations that you cannot use.

CTRL + SHIFT + INSERT

CTRL + SHIFT + DELETE

CTRL + SHIFT + HOME

CTRL + SHIFT + END

CTRL + SHIFT + PAGEUP

CTRL + SHIFT + PAGEDOWN

CTRL + SHIFT + LEFTARROW

CTRL + SHIFT + RIGHTARROW

CTRL + SHIFT + UPARROW

CTRL + SHIFT + DOWNARROW

CTRL + F4...F10

ALT + TAB

CTRL + ESC

A **Keyboard Hotkey** trigger can be associated with a specific [category](#) (e.g., Person/Company) using the **Active Category drop-down list box**. If you make this association, then the menu item is only enabled when either a view of the category or an item detail from that category is active. If another category is active, the menu item is grayed out. If you check **All Categories**, then the menu pick can always be selected, regardless of the [active category](#).

A **Keyboard Hotkey** trigger that is associated with a category passes data from a single [item](#) in that category as trigger data. This trigger item is either the selected data item in a view, or the data item from the displayed [item detail](#) that has the focus.

Receive DDE Trigger

[See Also](#)

A **Receive DDE [trigger](#)** is fired by a user-specified DDE message from another Windows application. When Commence receives a DDE "FireTrigger" execute message, it checks the message text to see if it matches any [active DDE](#) trigger. If a match is found, the trigger is fired. The only specification required for a **DDE** trigger is the message text.

To fire a DDE trigger from another Windows application, the application must initiate a DDE conversation with Commence. Enter the text that you want to fire the trigger in the **Agent Message Text Received by DDE [text box](#)**.

No trigger item is passed from this trigger to an agent's actions.

Receive DDE triggers let you initiate agent processing within Commence from other Windows applications. Commence agents can also send DDE messages to other applications with the **Send DDE** action. Using these DDE-based facilities allows you to build cross-application systems that can link your work in Commence to tasks done with other applications.

You can pass arguments to be used by the agent actions. The arguments passed via a DDE trigger are accessible using the following keyword strings: (-0-), (-1-), (-2-), (-3-), (-4-), (-5-), (-6-), (-7-), (-8-), and (-9-). These keyword strings may be used to display the passed arguments using a message box or status bar action, to set values in an **Add** or **Edit Item** action or any other place that keyword replacement is allowed in agents. The following example illustrates how the DDE trigger arguments are mapped to keywords.

[FireTrigger(TrigStr, Arg2, Arg3, Arg4, Arg5, Arg6, Arg7, Arg8, Arg9)]

(-0-) = Always FireTrigger

(-1-) = Trigger String, e.g., TrigStr

(-2-) through (-9-) = The string passed in that position, e.g., Arg2 through Arg9 respectively.

The DDE trigger also allows arguments 2 and 3 to be mapped to a category name and an item name respectively. If the "arg2 equals" check box is checked (in the DDE Trigger definition dialog box), a category must be selected and Arg2 must equal that category name for that DDE trigger to fire. In addition, Arg3 must be the name of an item in the chosen category. If all of these conditions are met, the trigger fires and values from that item will be available for use in the agent's actions using the field name keywords such as (**%Name%**).

It is also possible to define a filter for a DDE trigger using the item mapping option (described above). Press the **Select Filter** button to bring up the [Filters tab](#) and define a [filter](#) for that category. If a filter is defined, not only do Arg2 and Arg3 have to match the category and an item name, but the item must also meet the filter criteria. If the item does not match the filter, the trigger will not fire.

Field Summary Condition

A **Field Summary** [condition](#) generates a summary value for all the [fields](#) in the [view](#) or [category](#) selected for the condition and compares it to a value. The field being summarized must be a [calculation](#) or [number field](#). The sum or the average of the individual fields is compared to the condition's value. If the summarized value meets the specified criteria, then the condition is true.

Select either **View** or **Category** under **For Items In...** to specify the items that are checked by the condition.

If you select **View**, a [drop-down list box](#) appears that lets you select one of your current views. Note that selecting a view determines the category of the view.

If you select **Category**, a drop-down list box appears that lets you select one of your categories. If you want to limit the condition test to a sub-set of the category, use the **Select Filter** button to bring up the [Filters tab](#). Now you can define a filter for that category.

Use the controls under **Trigger If...** to define the field summary and the value. Use the **Values in** drop-down list box to choose the data field that will be summarized. Select either the **total** or **average** radio button to sum or average the values respectively. Select the type of comparison to the condition value by selecting one of the following radio buttons: **more than**, **exactly**, or **less than**. Enter the condition value to be used in the comparison in the **Value** text box.

When a **Field Summary** condition is true, it passes all the items in its view, category or filtered category as condition items.

Field Summary conditions are useful for monitoring totals or averages for any fields that are numeric. Use the condition's view or [filter](#) specification to select the subset of items that you want included in the summary.

Time Interval Condition

A **Time Interval** [condition](#) tests whether or not the current time falls within a specified date and time interval. The condition's date interval can be defined as a specific date range, or as a repeating day interval using the controls in the **Date Interval** section of the dialog box. The time interval for the dates selected is set in the **Time Interval** section.

To set an interval between specific dates, select the **From** [radio button](#) in the **Date Interval** section. Enter the start date and end date of the interval in the two [text boxes](#) to the right. To set an interval based on days of the week, select the **Days** radio button. Select the days of the week using the [check boxes](#). If you select **All**, the other day check boxes are grayed out until you uncheck **All**.

To select all times for the date interval, check the **All Times** check box: the other controls in the Time Interval section will gray out. To select a time interval, uncheck **All Times** and use the increment controls to the right of **Start Time** and **End Time** to specify the time interval. (You can either use the arrow controls or just type the values into the boxes.)

A **Time Interval** condition does not pass any condition data.

Time Interval conditions are often useful for defining or limiting the times when an [agent](#) will operate.

Field Values Dialog Box

[See Also](#)

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you need to select [field](#) values for an [agent action](#) from the [Add Action](#) or [Edit Action](#) dialog boxes.

For an [Add Item](#) or [Edit Item](#) action, the **Field Values** dialog box allows you to select field values for the item to be added or edited by the action. You *must* do this for any mandatory fields in the category to which an item is *added* if these mandatory fields do not have default values (this will be at least the [name field](#)).

Note: You can avoid specifying field values at all by turning on the **Display Item(s)** [check box](#) on the **Add** or **Edit Action** dialog box.

You can select field values in one of two ways: type the value directly into the **Values** text box, or use the **Insert Field** button (if present; this button does not appear if no data is passed from the agent's [trigger](#)).

The **Fields** [list box](#) shows a list of all the valid fields for the [category](#) selected for the add or edit item action. Select the field for which you want to specify a value by highlighting it in the **Fields** list box.

Type the value you want for the highlighted field in the **Value** [text box](#). You must observe the value restrictions for the field type or the data you specify is ignored when the add or edit item action is executed (see the list of field types, below).

You can also specify Field Codes which are replaced with the actual field values from the an item's data. Field Codes are either; the name of a field enclosed in parentheses and percent characters: (%Field Name%); or a special Field Code enclosed in parentheses and dash characters. These special Field Codes can

be used with any category; an example is the (Date) Code which will generate the current date. The action defined for the agent determines which substitutions take place when the agent operates. See [Using Field Codes in Actions](#) for the basics of using field codes in agent actions.

When you select a text field in the **Fields** list box the **Value** text box becomes a large edit box. To enter multi-line text, keep typing and Commence will automatically word-wrap the text lines for you. If you want to insert carriage returns in the **Value** text box, simply press **Return** wherever you want a carriage return, then continue typing. If you use the **Insert Fields** button to select field values, you may wish to separate each field value with a carriage return.

If data is passed to the action from the [trigger](#), you can also select the **Insert Field** button to insert Field Codes from the passed data into the **Value** [text box](#). The name of the category from which the data is passed is shown above the **Insert Field** button in the lower right of the box. Selecting this button displays the [Select Field](#) dialog box. You should be careful that the type of the field you choose from the trigger data matches the type of the field you select from the **Select Field** dialog box, or the data will be ignored when the item is added or edited (with the exception of check box fields; see the list of fields below).

If the value you specify for a mandatory field is ignored and the field has a default value, the default value is assigned to the field when the item is added or edited. If the value you specify for a mandatory field is ignored and the field *does not* have a default value, an error is posted to the [Message Log](#), and the item will not be added (or, edited as you intended).

If you *do not* highlight a field and enter a **Value** for it at all, the default value for that field is used for the new item, if a default is defined (edit the [category](#) from which the trigger data is taken

using [Customize-Database-Category](#) to see which fields have default values). Again, you will be required to enter values for all mandatory fields in the added/edited item's category that do not have a default value defined.

Calculations can be specified in the **Value** text box for any [number](#) type field. For example, if you have a number type field named *Number*, you can define an agent that adds a new item with a *Number* value one greater than the *Number* value in an item selected by the agent's condition(s). The **Value** is:

(%Number%). + 1

The operators allowed in agent field value specifications are the same as the operators allowed in calculation fields (, , ,). Parentheses are allowed for grouping.

The following is a list of all the available field types. To see a definition of the capabilities of the field, select the field type name below. To see a description of the field's options as they appear in this dialog box, as well as an explanation of valid field **Values**, select the word **Options** next to the field type whose options you want to see.

[Check Box Options](#)

[Connection Definition Options](#)

[Data File Options](#)

[Date Options](#)

[Excel Cell Options](#)

[Image Options](#)

[Number Options](#)

[Selection Options](#)

[Sequence Number Options](#)

[Telephone Options](#)

[Text Options](#)

[Time Options](#)

When you have set all the fields you wish to edit, select **OK** to save your work and return to the **New** or **Edit Action** dialog box. If you select **Cancel**, the previous values will be restored.

Define E-Mail Dialog Box

The **Recipient** field contains an electronic mail address. The **Insert Field** button inserts an item value parameter such as "(%E-mail%)" into the field. Commence does no validation on the address placed in this field. Any text is accepted and passed on to the e-mail package.

Only one recipient may be placed in this field. The Create E-Mail dialog box offers a choice of using the trigger or a condition as a source of data values. This choice is shown by a radio group labeled "To Recipients Specified Using:". If your Create E-Mail action is defined with "To Recipients Specified Using: *Trigger*", one e-mail message will be created when the agent fires. If your Create E-Mail action is defined with "To Recipients Specified Using: *Condition 1 or 2*", one e-mail message will be sent for each item matching the condition. Alternatively, the value placed in the recipient field may be the name of a list of recipients such as "My Department" if such a list is defined within your electronic mail program.

Note: If you have multiple e-mail packages installed on your system that use different protocols, you can target a message to use a specific mail server protocol by preceding the recipient's e-mail address with one of the following strings: "VIM:", "MAPI:" or "CMC:".

The **Subject** of the message summarizes its contents. The **Insert Field** button next to the **Subject** field inserts an item value parameter such as "(%Name%)" into the field.

The text of the message may be created using a text letter template or by entering text directly. If you select the **Use Letter Template** option, you can select a text letter template from the drop-down list. To create a text letter template, use the [Customize-Database-Letter Template](#) command. More information on creating letter templates may be found in the *Commence User's Guide*.

If you select the **Text** option, you can type in a message directly. You can insert item values into the text field using **Insert Field**.

If you select the **Preview before sending** check box, you will be given the opportunity to enter or modify the message within your e-mail package before it is actually sent. While previewing a message, you are able to enter or change its recipients, subject, text or attachments. You are also given the option of canceling the message.

Any message fields can be left blank when the message is created in Commence. If you use **Preview before sending**, you will have a second chance to fill in blank fields before the message is sent. Any field can be left blank when the message is sent except Recipients.

You can send one file along with a message by selecting **Attach File** and giving the path of the file to be sent. Although no **Insert Field** button is provided for the **Attach File** box, item value parameters may be placed in this field such as (%Document%).

Set Snooze Time Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select the **Snooze** button or the **Snooze All** button from a message box.

Enter the number of minutes after which you want the message box to reappear. The default snooze time is 10 minutes. You can change the number of minutes you want the message to snooze by typing a number between 1 and 999 into the text box provided. Select **OK** to make the message disappear temporarily. It will reappear after the designated number of minutes have elapsed.

Select **Cancel** to return to the original message box.

Snooze affects only the currently displayed message box, while **Snooze All** affects the current message box and all currently pending message boxes. If you use the **Snooze** button and there are pending messages, the next pending message is displayed when you select **OK** in the **Set Snooze Time** dialog box.

Note: The Message Box snooze alarm works only *within* a Commence session. That is, if you set a snooze time for a message box and then exit Commence, the snooze time is lost and the message box *will not* reappear when you reopen Commence.

Message Box Actions Dialog Box

When you select the **Action Buttons** button in the [Add Action](#) or [Edit Action dialog boxes](#) for a [Message Box Action](#), Commence displays the **Message Box Actions** dialog box (for a new action, all the fields will be empty).

You can enter text for any of the buttons in the **Button 1-4** [text boxes](#). When you select the corresponding **Action** button, you get the normal selection of possible actions; that is you will see a new **Edit Action** dialog box (titled **Add Message Box Action**), with all the actions available except **Message Box**). Using this box you can define an action that will only be performed when you select the corresponding button in the message box displayed by Commence. Use the **Add Message Box Action** dialog box exactly as you use the **Add** or **Edit Action** dialog boxes.

Any message box that is displayed can be put back to sleep for a few minutes by the user before the message box is re-displayed. This works much the same way the snooze button on an alarm clock works. This feature is automatically available to the user whenever an agent-generated message box is displayed.

When you are done specifying all the sub-actions for your message box action, select **OK** on the **Message Box Actions** to save your work and return to the **Add** or **Edit Action** dialog box. Select **Cancel** if you don't want your message box actions saved.

Letter File Storage

Commence stores letter files in a location on your hard disk that depends on whether you view the letter, print the letter with logging turned on, or print a letter with logging turned off. The first two alternatives save a permanent copy of the letter(s) viewed or printed; the third alternative saves only a temporary copy.

All letters created by selecting the **View** button on the [Send Letter dialog box](#) are saved in the directory specified using the [Edit-Preferences-Letter](#) command. This is, by default, the **letters** subdirectory under your Commence program directory.

If you **Print** a letter, and the **Log** check box is turned *on*, then the letter is stored in the directory referred to above (actually, in the case of **Send Letter to All Items**, a copy of the template used to print the letters is saved, so that the log item can point to a copy of what was printed).

If you **Print** a letter, and the **Log** check box is turned *off*, then the letter is stored in the directory specified by your DOS **TEMP** environment variable. This variable is usually set to a subdirectory of your hard disk (such as **temp**) using the DOS **set** command in your **autoexec.bat** file.

Commence will, whenever it exits, delete any letter files more than one day old from the **TEMP** directory. This keeps unneeded files from accumulating. If you want to save a letter that Commence saves in the **TEMP** directory, you should edit the file, change its name, and save it to another directory. (Commence uses strings beginning with **~JJ** as file names for saved letter files).

To improve performance of Commence, you should set the **TEMP** variable to a directory only one or two levels down from the root directory. See your DOS and Windows documentation for details of the **set** command, the **autoexec.bat** file, your hard disk file system, and Windows performance considerations.

Design Form Display Dialog Box

DETAIL FORM NAME

The **Detail Form Name** identifies the form and must be unique within a [category](#). It can be up to 16 characters. When adding or copying a form, this [text box](#) is blank; when editing a form, it contains the current form name

DETAIL FORM DESCRIPTION

The **Detail Form Description** is optional and can be up to 34 characters. When adding or copying a form, this text box is blank; when editing a form, it contains the current form description. If you provide a description, it will appear in the **Detail Form Description** field in the **Detail Forms** dialog box.

LAUNCH DESIGNER

Press this button to open the [Detail Form Design](#) dialog box. You can customize the form in a number of ways from this screen.

SAVE

Select the **Save** button to save the detail form you are working on.

CANCEL

Select **Cancel** to cancel the new, edited, or copied detail form and return to the [Detail Form](#) dialog box.

Design Form Advanced Dialog Box

If you select the **Form Options** button from the [Design Form dialog box](#), you can:

- define when a [detail form](#) will be used to display an [item](#)
- select how multi-line fields are printed when you print using this form

FILTER BUTTON

The **Filter** option for the **Auto-Select Detail Form When...** group box lets you define when this form will be used to display an item. You define the condition using the **Filter** button, which displays the [Filters](#) dialog box.

For example, in the History category, two forms, called **Email**, and **History**, are defined and used when items in the History category are of these specific types. You can then use the **Filter** option on the **Detail Form Options** dialog box to define a filter that says "Type equal to E-mail Received" or "Type equal to E-mail Sent".

Now, whenever you enter a new item detail of the History category, you see the **History Form**, which allows you to choose a type of note. From that point, the item detail is displayed as a **History**, or **Email Form** depending on the chosen type.

The **Auto Select** option overrides the default form for editing chosen on the [Set Default Detail Forms](#) dialog box.

MULTILINE FIELD PRINTING

The **Multiline Field Printing** option lets you control how multi-line (large) text fields in the form are printed. The **Truncate** option tells Commence to only print as much of a multi-line field as is displayed on the screen. The **Expand** option says to print all the text of a multi-line field, regardless of what the screen display size is for the field.

Design Form Scripting Dialog Box [See Also](#)

For an overview of how to use VBScripting, or for detailed examples and descriptions of the supported VBScript objects, see the topic titled **VBScript**.

Once you have created a VBScript for a detail form, edit the detail form then install the script. See **Installing a VBScript** for detailed steps. Then the script will automatically execute for that detail form.

Advanced Category Options Dialog Box

This dialog box is displayed when you select the **Advanced** button when adding, editing, or copying a [Category Definition](#).

A **clarify field** designates a secondary field from among the fields already-defined in the category. This other field should contain unique data, which will be used by Commence to distinguish between duplicate items. Having a clarify field is useful when you have a large number of items in your category with the same name.

To designate a clarify field for a [category](#), select a [field](#) from the **Field drop-down list box**.

Any three characters can be used as the **Separator**. The default characters are a space, followed by a short dash, followed by a space. Type a **Separator** in the [text box](#) provided.

Only the Name field can be clarified. The **Clarify Field** will be displayed to the right of the item name, and after the chosen **Separator**, when you:

- assign [connections](#), the list of items in the connected category will be displayed with the clarify field. (see [Customize-Database-Connection](#))

- select a connection field to [filter](#) a view, the list of items in the connected category will be displayed with the clarify field. (see [Customize-Filter View](#))

- display items in a Gantt view, provided the Clarify Field is not used as the start date or end date in this view (see [Customize-Design View Fields Tab \(Gantt Views\)](#))

You can change the clarify field at any time.

A **secondary index** is most useful when there are very large amounts of data to be viewed. Commence enables users to specify an additional two (2) fields that are to be indexed. Sorting data on a field other than the *Name* field could consume a large percentage of the total time needed to open the view. By using a secondary index field, these sort times can be cut drastically, thus reducing the amount of time needed to open a view.

Select the desired Secondary Index Field(s) from the *Create Index On* combo box. It is recommended that the Secondary Index Field be set to the field(s) used most often for sorting the category.

The following fields are not available for use as Secondary Index Fields: connections, Data Files, Image, Excel Cell, Calculation, or Number Fields.

Caution: The use of a secondary index may slow down the process of saving items slightly.

The **Allow Duplicate Names** [check box](#) lets you specify if items in the category must have unique names. For example, if this option is checked, you can add two people to the Person/Company category that are both named "Jones, Joe". You must allow duplicate names if you will be using recurring date fields with this category.

If **Allow Duplicate Names** isn't checked, name uniqueness is enforced within the category. If you try to add a second person named "Jones, Joe" to a category that doesn't allow duplicate names, Commence will display an error message telling you there is already an item with that name.

You can change the **Allow Duplicate Names** value at any time. There are only two constraints that will keep you from applying name uniqueness to a category. If your data contains duplicate names or if a recurring date field is defined for the category, Commence will display an error message and will not save your category definition changes until you turn on **Allow Duplicate Names**.

If the [File-Import](#) command reads an incoming item has a blank name field, Commence automatically assigns the value **(none)** as the item name. To use this feature, make sure that you turn on **Allow Duplicate Names**. Also select edit the Import/Export template and turn on the **Add duplicates as new items** radio button on the [Import Rules](#) dialog box, so that all of the items with blank names are imported into the category.

If you allow duplicate names, you may also want to select a [clarify field](#) with the **Advanced...** button.

Select Field Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select:

- the **Field** button from the [Letter Template](#) dialog box
- the **Insert Field** button from an [Add Action](#), [Edit Action](#), or [Field Values](#) dialog box
- the **Fields** button when adding or editing a [calculation](#) field in the [Add Field](#) or [Edit Field](#) dialog boxes.

Use this dialog box to choose the field that you want to use in your letter or agent action. (See [Using Field Codes in Templates](#) for the basics of using field codes in letters. See [Using Field Codes in Actions](#) for the basics of using field codes in agent actions.)

Highlight the field you want to insert from the **Fields** [list box](#). At the top of the list are the three special Field Codes that work with any [category](#): **(-Date-)**, **(-Time-)**, and **(-Category-)**. These represent the date, time and selected category respectively. The rest of the fields listed are the fields and [connection definitions](#) for the category.

When you turn off the **Show Indirect Field** [check box](#), the list will not contain the connection definitions. The names of the connection definitions are listed with trailing ellipses (e.g., **Is Employed by Company...**).

When you highlight one of the three special Field Codes or a name for a direct field (like Name) and select the **Select** button, the corresponding Field Code is inserted in the text box on the previous dialog box at the current insertion point. For example, if you select Name, then **(%Name%)** is inserted into the text box.

If the [connection fields](#) are listed, when you highlight one of them and select the **Select** button, Commence displays the [Select Connected Field](#) dialog box, from which you select a field from the connected category for inclusion in your letter or action.

Mouse users can double-click the left mouse button while pointing at a field to select it without using the **Select** button.

Select **Cancel** to exit the **Select Field** dialog box without selecting a field.

Field Position Dialog Box

If you are using **column delimited ASCII** file format for an import/export template, you must assign [field](#) positions for the information to be imported or exported.

The [dialog box](#) described below is displayed when you select the **Field Position** button from the [Template Mapping](#) dialog box.

Type the column position for the start of the field into the **Start Position** edit box. Type the column position for the end of the field into the **End Position** edit box. For example, if your first field begins in column 1 and ends in column 35, enter "1" in **Start Position** and "35" in **End Position**. Select **OK** to return to the **Template Mapping** dialog box.

Caution: For column delimited ASCII format, you need to define the field position for each field listed in the **Fields in Templates** list box.

When you have defined the positions of all your fields, select **OK** to return to the **Template Mapping** dialog box.

Select Data Source Dialog Box

When you select the **Map** button from the [Template Definition](#) dialog box, Commence displays this [dialog box](#).

Press the **Select External Data Source** button. A list of installed OLE DB providers is displayed. Choose the data source that most closely matches your external database. For example, if you will be exchanging data with Microsoft Access, choose the “Microsoft JET OLE DB Provider” for a straightforward setup.

Data sources can be configured for a variety of file and database formats including: dBASE files, Excel files, FoxPro files, MS Access databases, Visual FoxPro databases and tables, SQL databases, and Oracle databases.

Note: If no applicable data source is listed, you may add one from Windows Control Panel. Double-click on the **ODBC (32bit)** icon and click **Add**. This launches the ODBC Data Source Administrator. Press the **Help** button for detailed assistance.

Click **Next >>** to display the Connection window. Enter any necessary connection information, such as the path to the external data source, or the data source name and catalog. If a login and password is needed to access the data, enter that information here. Click **OK** to return to the *Select Data Source* dialog box.

Select an appropriate **Query Mode**:

The default option, “**Basic (using table selection)**”, allows you to access a table directly by name and use the query already defined in the external table. Click **Next >** to display the [Select Table](#) dialog box. Commence will connect via ODBC and retrieve a list of all available tables from the external data source. Select a table from the list then click **Finish**.

Instead of accessing a table directly by its name using the “Basic” option above, you may select “**Advanced (using SQL)**” to specify a custom SQL statement that is used when importing data from an external data source. Click **Next >** to display the [SQL Query](#) dialog box. Enter the SQL query needed to retrieve the desired table name(s) and the required fields. Click **Finish**.

The [Template Mapping](#) dialog box is displayed.

Select Table Dialog Box

When you select “Basic (using table selection)” then click the **Next >** button from the [Select Data Source](#) dialog box, Commence displays the **Select Table** [dialog box](#).

This option allows you to access a table directly in the data source by specifying the table name. Commence will retrieve the columns and records already defined in the external table. Select a table from the list, then click Finish.

Connection Definition Values

If you select a [connection definition](#) in the **Fields** list box of the **Field Values** dialog box, you have several choices for entering text into the **Value** text box.

You can copy all of the connected items from a connection definition in a trigger or condition to a connection definition in an action. You do this by specifying

(%ConnectionName%%CategoryName%%Name%)

You can specify multiple field names to the connection definition in the action. To do this, enter multiple field names in the **Value** text box, each separated by a carriage return. For example, if you were editing the Employs Person connection in the Company category and entered:

Jones, Mary

Durkee, Fred

Johnson, Jerry

in the **Value** text box, assuming all three of these names were valid Person items, all three people would be connected with the Company item(s) you were editing.

You define an action that disconnects one or more connected items from a pre-selected connection definition. This works only for an Edit Item action. Enter:

(-clear-)

in the **Value** text box. This keyword removes any connected item names, thereby clearing the connection. This keyword can be modified to take on additional functionality, as shown below.

- To clear a connection and then connect to the item named *ItemName*, type "(-clear-) *ItemName*" in the **Value** edit box.
- To clear a connection and then connect to the item name passed from the specified field passed from the trigger or

condition data, type "(-clear-) (%FieldName%)" in the **Value** edit box.

- To clear a connection and then connect it to all the same items that are connected to the named connection passed from the trigger or condition data, type "(-clear-) (%ConnectionName%%CategoryName%)" in the **Value** edit box.

Customize-Design View-Fields Tab (Gantt Views)

Selecting the [Customize-Design View](#) command while a Gantt chart view is the [active view](#) displays the Design View tab.

If the category contains fields called 'Start Date' and 'End Date', Commence will automatically select these fields. If the category has more than one set of start date and end [date fields](#), you can use the **Fields** tab to change the fields used to display the time bar for each item.

Commence uses the [fields](#) specified for **Start Date** and **End Date** to display a time bar indicating an [item's](#) duration. The time bar is shown as a color-coded horizontal bar on the Gantt chart spanning from the **Start Date** to the **End Date**.

Upon creation of a new Gantt view, the time scale is set to Auto. An appropriate time scale for the view is determined based on the item with the largest span of time (between the selected **Start Date** and **End Date**).

Items in a Gantt chart view, by default, are sorted according to their Start Dates. Items with the same **Start Date** are sorted by their **End Dates**. Items with the same **Start** and **End Dates** are sorted alphanumerically by their item names. This is done by automatically setting a sort order for the Gantt chart view upon creation of the new view. If you change the **Start** and **End Date** fields here, be sure to change the sort order too. (See [Customize-Sort View](#)).

Select the **OK** button to confirm your layout changes.

Any changes you make to the layout are temporary unless you use [Views-Save View](#) or [Views-Save View As](#) to save the changed view.

Select Connected Field Dialog Box

This [dialog box](#) is displayed when you select a [connection definition](#) name from the [Select Field](#) dialog box.

The [list box](#) displays the [fields](#) from the [category](#) for the connection definition you selected.

Highlight the field that you want to insert into your letter from the list box. When you select the **Select** button, the Field Code for the indirect field is inserted in the template. Mouse users can double-click the left mouse button while pointing at a field to select it without using the **Select** button.

For example, if you had selected the **Has Notes/History...** connection definition in the **Select Field** dialog box and selected **Notes** in this box, you would get the Field Code **(%Has%%Notes/History%%Notes%)** in your letter.

If you select **Cancel** in the **Select Connected Field** dialog box you are returned to the **Select Field** dialog box without making a selection.

SQL Query Dialog Box

When you select “Advanced (using SQL)” then click the **Next >** button from the [Select Data Source](#) dialog box, Commence displays the **SQL Query [dialog box](#)**.

Advanced users may use this screen to create a SQL query to give them more flexibility in accessing external data. Using a SQL query allows the user to join multiple tables so that they appear as a single table when importing into Commence. Another reason to use a SQL query is to be able to specify the columns to be accessed from the data source or to set a query for a subset of the rows from the external data source. Specifying the columns or a subset query to limit the data that is accessed will improve performance during the import process, since less data will be accessed from the external data source.

In order to properly use the Advanced dialog, users will need to be knowledgeable of the syntax for creating proper SQL queries. In addition, they will need to know the details of the external database schema they are importing from, so that the proper table names and columns can be used in the SQL query.

SQL QUERY:

The SQL query should be entered into the edit control on the dialog.

QUERY STATUS:

While the query is being entered, the "Query Status" control will display the current status, such as "editing query".

EXECUTE QUERY

After the SQL query has been completely entered, the "Execute Query" button should be pressed to test the Query. Commence will open a connection to the database and run the SQL query to verify that it is correct. If the SQL query runs correctly, the status will be updated to "query has been evaluated and is valid".

Otherwise an error message is displayed that contains error information from the data source indicating why the SQL query couldn't be run.

FINISH

After the SQL query has been entered, press Finish to save the query into the import/export template.